

Macbeth

William Shakespeare · 1606

First Folio (1623) text as edited by Standard Ebooks

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

29 scene lessons plus 2 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 28 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 6 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC
Cover: Caspar David Friedrich, Wanderer above the Sea of Fog (c. 1818). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).

Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–29), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Macbeth survives only in the 1623 First Folio. The reading text is the Standard Ebooks edition, divided into the conventional 28 scenes (plus the cast list). Most scholars think the Hecate passages (Act III, Scene V and part of Act IV, Scene I) were added by another writer, probably Thomas Middleton. Cite act, scene and line from this edition.

Content note for teachers: Recurring violence (murders on and off stage, including a child), witchcraft, a reported suicide and a severed head; the play's treatment of 'manhood' and of Lady Macbeth draws on period gender ideas that deserve critical discussion. See the scene notes and the safe-messaging script.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Scaffolded-support track (grade-9 floor): students work from teacher-selected passages with scaffolds, sentence starters and partial-credit probes. **Weeks:** 6. **Class days:** 28 × 90 minutes (29 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Macbeth suggest about ambition and its costs?
- What does Macbeth suggest about fate and free will?
- What does Macbeth suggest about guilt and conscience?
- What does Macbeth suggest about appearance versus reality?
- What does Macbeth suggest about masculinity, power and violence?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the play in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.

- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the scene quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Dramatis Personae (20-minute preview) and Act I, Scene I (20-minute preview) and Act I, Scene II Act I, Scene III Act I, Scene IV Act I, Scene V	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*ambition and its costs* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Act I, Scene VI (20-minute preview) and Act I, Scene VII *Socratic seminar on ambition and its costs* Act II, Scene I Act II, Scene II Act II, Scene III	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*fate and free will* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on ambition and its costs • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Act II, Scene IV Act III, Scene I Act III, Scene II Act III, Scene III Act III, Scene IV	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*guilt and conscience* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
4	Act III, Scene V (20-minute preview) and Act III, Scene VI Act IV, Scene I *Socratic seminar on fate and free will* Act IV, Scene II Act IV, Scene III	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*appearance versus reality* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on fate and free will • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
5	Act V, Scene I Act V, Scene II (20-minute preview) and Act V, Scene III	5 × 90 min	*masculinity, power and violence* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories,	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

	Act V, Scene IV (20-minute preview) and Act V, Scene V Act V, Scene VI (20-minute preview) and Act V, Scene VII Act V, Scene VIII	(450 min)	background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	
6	*Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)* *Final paper: peer review, revision and submission*	3 × 90 min (270 min)	*ambition and its costs* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework) • Final paper: peer review, revision and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Macbeth

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about William Shakespeare's life or times connects to ambition and its costs in “Macbeth”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (ambition and its costs, fate and free will, guilt and conscience).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, the son of John Shakespeare, a glover and town official, and Mary Arden. He probably attended Stratford's grammar school, married Anne Hathaway in 1582, and had three children: Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith (Hamnet died aged eleven in 1596). By the early 1590s he was an actor and playwright in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, who built the Globe theatre in 1599 and became the King's Men when James VI of Scotland became James I of England in 1603. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays and the Sonnets, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. Seven years later his fellow actors John Heminges and Henry Condell published 36 of his plays in the First Folio (1623).

Historical and cultural context

Macbeth was written around 1606 for a company that now served a Scottish king. James I was fascinated by witchcraft (he wrote a treatise, Daemonologie, in 1597, and had taken part in witch trials in Scotland) and traced his descent from Banquo, whom the play makes noble. In November 1605 the Gunpowder Plot to blow up the king and Parliament was discovered; at the 1606 trial of the Jesuit Henry Garnet, "equivocation" (misleading by ambiguous speech) became notorious, and the Porter's joke about an "equivocator" in Act II, Scene III points to it. Shakespeare took his story from Raphael Holinshed's Chronicles (1587), changing much: the historical Macbeth ruled Scotland from 1040 to 1057 and killed Duncan I in battle, not in his bed.

Publication and reception, then and now

The play was first printed in the First Folio (1623), the only early text. It is Shakespeare's shortest tragedy, and most scholars think the version we have was adapted after his death, with the Hecate passages probably added by Thomas Middleton. The earliest surviving eyewitness account of a performance is the astrologer Simon Forman's description of a Macbeth at the Globe in April 1611.

Then: Little is recorded about first reactions. After the theatres reopened in 1660, William Davenant staged a version with added songs and flying witches that held the stage for decades; the actor David Garrick restored much of Shakespeare's text in 1744. Romantic critics such as Thomas De Quincey ("On the Knocking at the Gate in Macbeth," 1823) praised its psychological intensity.

Now: Macbeth is among the most performed and taught of all plays. Film versions range from Akira Kurosawa's Throne of Blood (1957) to Roman Polanski's (1971) and Joel Coen's The Tragedy of Macbeth (2021). Theatre superstition calls it "the Scottish play" and avoids saying its name backstage. Modern critics

debate its gender politics (Lady Macbeth's "unsex me here"), its view of fate and free will, and its politics of tyranny and succession.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Returning from a victorious battle, the Scottish general Macbeth meets three witches who greet him with titles, including "king hereafter." What Macbeth and his wife do with that prophecy, and what it does to them and to Scotland, is the play.

Main themes

- ambition: watch how wanting becomes doing, and what each crime demands next.
- fate and free will: the witches predict, but who decides?
- appearance and reality: "fair is foul": faces, words and prophecies that hide their meaning.
- guilt and conscience: blood, sleep and hands; how guilt shows itself.
- masculinity and power: what "being a man" means to each character.

Why it matters

Macbeth is the classic study of how a decent, admired person talks himself into doing evil, and of how leaders who seize power must keep using violence to hold it. Those patterns are visible in politics and in ordinary life, and the play's language about guilt has entered everyday English ("out, damned spot").

Spoilers · teacher only

Macbeth murders King Duncan in his sleep, urged by Lady Macbeth; Duncan's sons flee and Macbeth is crowned. He has Banquo murdered (Fleance escapes), sees Banquo's ghost, returns to the witches and receives riddling prophecies, and has Macduff's family slaughtered. Lady Macbeth sleepwalks and dies, probably by suicide. Malcolm's army, carrying branches from Birnam Wood, attacks Dunsinane; Macduff, "from his mother's womb / Untimely ripp'd," kills Macbeth, and Malcolm becomes king.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open Macbeth: Imagine someone tells you that you will definitely get something you want. Would you wait for it, or try to make it happen? Write for five minutes.
Prompt: Before we open Macbeth: Imagine someone tells you that you will definitely get something you want. Would you wait for it, or try to make it happen? Write for five minutes.

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
tragedy (a play in which a great figure falls through his own choices); soliloquy (a speech alone on stage revealing thoughts); aside (a remark the audience hears but other characters do not); dramatic irony (the audience knows what a character does not); blank verse (unrhymed iambic pentameter); thane (a Scottish lord).

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).

About the author. William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, the son of John Shakespeare, a glover and town official, and Mary Arden. He probably attended Stratford's grammar school, married Anne Hathaway in 1582, and had three children: Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith (Hamnet died aged eleven in 1596). By the early 1590s he was an actor and playwright in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, who built the Globe theatre in 1599 and became the King's Men when James VI of Scotland became James I of England in 1603. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays and the Sonnets, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. Seven years later his fellow actors John Heminges and Henry Condell published 36 of his plays in the First Folio (1623). The world of the book. Macbeth was written around 1606 for a company that now served a Scottish king. James I was fascinated by witchcraft (he wrote a treatise, Daemonologie, in 1597, and had taken part in witch trials in Scotland) and traced his descent from Banquo, whom the play makes noble. In November 1605 the Gunpowder Plot to blow up the king and Parliament was discovered; at the 1606 trial of the Jesuit Henry Garnet, "equivocation" (misleading by ambiguous speech) became notorious, and the Porter's joke about an "equivocator" in Act II, Scene III points to it. Shakespeare took his story from Raphael Holinshed's Chronicles (1587), changing much: the historical Macbeth ruled Scotland from 1040 to 1057 and killed Duncan I in battle, not in his bed. Publication and reception. The play was first printed in the First Folio (1623), the only early text. It is Shakespeare's shortest tragedy, and most scholars think the version we have was adapted after his death, with the Hecate passages probably added by Thomas Middleton. The earliest surviving eyewitness account of a performance is the astrologer Simon Forman's description of a Macbeth at the Globe in April 1611. Then: Little is recorded about first reactions. After the theatres reopened in 1660, William Davenant staged a version with added songs and flying witches that held the stage for decades; the actor David Garrick restored much of Shakespeare's text in 1744. Romantic critics such as Thomas De Quincey ("On the Knocking at the Gate in Macbeth," 1823) praised its psychological intensity. Now: Macbeth is among the most performed and taught of all plays. Film versions range from Akira Kurosawa's Throne of Blood (1957) to Roman Polanski's (1971) and Joel Coen's The Tragedy of Macbeth (2021). Theatre superstition calls it "the Scottish play" and avoids saying its name backstage. Modern critics debate its gender politics (Lady Macbeth's "unsex me here"), its view of fate and free will, and its politics of tyranny and succession.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" slowly and put it in my own words: The three witches chant together that fair is foul and foul is fair. Next, craft. I notice the chiasmus, a mirrored pattern that flips good and bad in a single line, like a spell. The strongest word is "foul": the word for ugly or evil is set equal to "fair," so values are turned upside down. Then, effect. What does the witches' chant tell us about the world of the play? My answer: The witches announce a world where appearances deceive and moral order is reversed; Macbeth, who seems a loyal hero, will become a murderer, and his first line will echo theirs.

> *Fair is foul, and foul is fair* *(Act I, Scene I, All)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" slowly and put it in my own words: The three witches chant together that fair is foul and foul is fair. Next, craft. I notice the chiasmus, a mirrored pattern that flips good and bad in a single line, like a spell. The strongest word is "foul": the word for ugly or evil is set equal to "fair," so values are turned upside down. Then, effect. What does the witches' chant tell us about the world of the play? My answer: The witches announce a world where appearances deceive and moral order is reversed; Macbeth, who seems a loyal hero, will become a murderer, and his first line will echo theirs.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Returning from a victorious battle, the Scottish general Macbeth meets three witches who greet him with titles, including "king hereafter." What Macbeth and his wife do with that prophecy, and what it does to them and to Scotland, is the play. Themes to track: ambition: watch how wanting becomes doing, and what each crime demands next. fate and free will: the witches predict, but who decides? appearance and reality: "fair is foul": faces, words and prophecies that hide their meaning. guilt and conscience: blood, sleep and hands; how guilt shows itself. masculinity and power: what "being a man" means to each character.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "fate and free will": Prediction: the witches will be right but in an unexpected way. Question: would Macbeth have killed anyone without them?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Macbeth: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page "fate and free will": Prediction: the witches will be right but in an unexpected way. Question: would Macbeth have killed anyone without them?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Macbeth still matter? Macbeth is the classic study of how a decent, admired person talks himself into doing evil, and of how leaders who seize power must keep using violence to hold it. Those patterns are visible in politics and in ordinary life, and the play's language about guilt has entered everyday English ("out, damned spot").
Anchor question: Why might Macbeth still be taught today?
Facilitation: Macbeth is the classic study of how a decent, admired person talks himself into doing evil, and of how leaders who seize power must keep using violence to hold it. Those patterns are visible in politics and in ordinary life, and the play's language about guilt has entered everyday English ("out, damned spot").

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Shakespeare wrote Macbeth around 1606, soon after King James I, who believed in witchcraft and claimed descent from Banquo, survived the Gunpowder Plot to blow up Parliament. How might that context shape a play about killing a king? Answer: Accept answers such as: James's interest in witches explains their prominence; showing regicide as monstrous flattered a king who had just escaped assassination; Banquo is shown as noble because he was James's ancestor.
Exit ticket: Shakespeare wrote Macbeth around 1606, soon after King James I, who believed in witchcraft and claimed descent from Banquo, survived the Gunpowder Plot to blow up Parliament. How might that context shape a play about killing a king?
Answer: Accept answers such as: James's interest in witches explains their prominence; showing regicide as monstrous flattered a king who had just escaped assassination; Banquo is shown as noble because he was James's ancestor.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Dramatis Personae.

Teacher notes · sources: Folger Shakespeare Library, "Shakespeare's life" and "Macbeth" (https://www.folger.edu/explore/shakespeares-works/macbeth/); Royal Shakespeare Company, "Macbeth: about the play" (https://www.rsc.org.uk/macbeth/about-the-play); British Library, "Macbeth, Holinshed and the Gunpowder Plot" (https://www.bl.uk/shakespeare/articles/macbeth-and-the-gunpowder-plot); Britannica, "Macbeth" (king of Scotland) (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Macbeth-king-of-Scotland); Simon Forman, Booke of Plaies (Bodleian MS Ashmole 208) (https://www.bodleian.ox.ac.uk/); Thomas De Quincey, "On the Knocking at the Gate in Macbeth" (1823) (https://www.gutenberg.org/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- The date "around 1606" is a scholarly inference (the Porter's equivocation joke, the Gunpowder Plot, a probable performance before King James); no record fixes it.
- The Middleton revision of the Hecate scenes is the majority view, not a certainty.
- Whether Lady Macbeth's death is suicide rests on Malcolm's report in the last scene ("by self and violent hands"); present it as reported.

Lesson 2: Dramatis Personae

Focus: the cast and world of the play

Objective: Students will identify at least 5 characters from the cast list and explain, in one sentence each, how each is related to the play's central family or court.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3

Teacher only · spoilers

The cast list sets up two kingdoms (Scotland and England), King Duncan and his sons Malcolm and Donalbain, the generals Macbeth and Banquo, the thanes (Macduff, Lennox, Ross and others), Lady Macbeth and Lady Macduff, Hecate and three Witches, and apparitions. The play moves between Scottish castles, a heath, a battlefield and the English court.

Background: Shakespeare wrote Macbeth around 1606, soon after James VI of Scotland became James I of England (1603). James claimed descent from Banquo, had written a book on witchcraft (Daemonologie, 1597) and had survived the Gunpowder Plot (1605). Shakespeare drew the story loosely from Holinshed's Chronicles (1587).

Significance: A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the first scene.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because....*
> **Prompt:** If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Shakespeare wrote Macbeth around 1606, soon after James VI of Scotland became James I of England (1603). James claimed descent from Banquo, had written a book on witchcraft (Daemonologie, 1597) and had survived the Gunpowder Plot (1605). Shakespeare drew the story loosely from Holinshed's Chronicles (1587). A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the first scene. Characterization: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test. Setting: "Scotland; England": a divided map. England will be where the rightful heir and the forces of order gather. Structure: Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "Duncan, king of Scotland" (Dramatis Personae).

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the cast and world of the play. Key takeaway: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test.
- **Setting:** "Scotland; England": a divided map. England will be where the rightful heir and the forces of order gather.
- **Structure:** Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Duncan, king of Scotland” (Dramatis Personae).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break.
- “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil.
- “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae) Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation.
Evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae)
Reasoning: Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

Discussion questions

1. If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which characters on the cast list are women? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff, the Gentlewoman, Hecate and the three Witches.
2. Who is the king of Scotland at the start of the play? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Duncan
3. Which two countries does the play take place in? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Scotland and England
4. What are Malcolm and Donalbain to Duncan? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His sons

5. Which character is listed as general of the king's army? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Macbeth
6. Which supernatural figure leads the Witches? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hecate
7. Retell the three most important events of "Dramatis Personae" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The cast list sets up two kingdoms (Scotland and England), King Duncan and his sons Malcolm and Donalbain, the generals Macbeth and Banquo, the thanes (Macduff, Lennox, Ross and others), Lady Macbeth and Lady Macduff, Hecate and three Witches, and apparitions. The play moves between Scottish castles, a heath, a battlefield and the English court.
8. Who is on stage in "Dramatis Personae", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Dramatis Personae" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. In the passage that begins "Duncan, king of Scotland", who is speaking or being described, and what do they say or do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Literal paraphrase of the anchor passage.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Shakespeare's first audience, under King James, have watched Banquo with special interest? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: James I claimed descent from Banquo; the play flatters that line.
2. What does "Dramatis Personae" suggest about the cast and world of the play? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the first scene.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the cast and world of the play? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: "Macbeth, general of the king's army" (Dramatis Personae): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. On characterization: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Duncan, king of Scotland", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Dramatis Personae”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The cast list sets up two kingdoms (Scotland and England), King Duncan and his sons Malcolm and Donalbain, the generals Macbeth and Banquo, the thanes (Macduff, Lennox, Ross and others), Lady Macbeth and Lady Macduff, Hecate and three Witches, and apparitions. The play moves between Scottish…
7. As the opening scene, what does “Dramatis Personae” set up that the rest of Macbeth will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. On structure: Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). On characterization: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. On structure: Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is a cast list a neutral document? What does the order of names suggest about who matters in this world? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Rank and gender shape the order; kings and lords first, women and servants later.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the first scene.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. On characterization: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Dramatis Personae”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the cast and world of the play. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. On structure: Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Dramatis Personae”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so

that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. On setting: "Scotland; England": a divided map. England will be where the rightful heir and the forces of order gather. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Dramatis Personae” treats the cast and world of the play with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose

power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the cast and world of the play? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: "Banquo, general of the king's army" (Dramatis Personae): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What are Malcolm and Donalbain to Duncan?
    A. His nephews
    B. His generals
    C. His sons
    D. His brothers

    Key: C (His sons)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Dramatis Personae: "Macbeth, _____ of the king's army"

    Key: general

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which two countries does the play take place in?
    A. Denmark and Scotland
    B. Scotland and Norway
    C. England and France
    D. Scotland and England

    Key: D (Scotland and England)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is the king of Scotland at the start of the play?
    A. Macbeth
    B. Duncan
    C. Edward
    D. Malcolm

    Key: B (Duncan)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which character is listed as general of the king's army?

   A. Macduff

   B. Seyton

   C. Macbeth

   D. Ross

   Key: C (Macbeth)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Dramatis Personae: “Banquo, _____ of the king’s army”

   Key: general

7. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which characters on the cast list are women?

   Sample answer: Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff, the Gentlewoman, Hecate and the three Witches.

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which supernatural figure leads the Witches?

   A. Hecate

   B. The Porter

   C. An apparition

   D. Banquo's ghost

   Key: A (Hecate)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

   Sample answer: Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. The evidence is “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae). This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why might Shakespeare's first audience, under King James, have watched Banquo with special interest?

    Sample answer: James I claimed descent from Banquo; the play flatters that line. The evidence is “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae), which shows the identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae)

    A. Macbeth to the ghost.

    B. Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).

    C. Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters.

    D. His followers obey from fear.

    Key: B (Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae)

    A. The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil.

    B. Macduff's redefinition of manhood.

    C. Malcolm as an obstacle.

D. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

Key: A (The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Dramatis Personae”?

    A. The apparitions and false security

    B. Hecate and the machinery of fate

    C. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

    D. The cast and world of the play

    Key: D (The cast and world of the play)

14. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is a cast list a neutral document? What does the order of names suggest about who matters in this world?

    Sample answer: Rank and gender shape the order; kings and lords first, women and servants later. The evidence is “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) — Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position.

15. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. The evidence is “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae). This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). The evidence is “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae). This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how masculinity and power develops from the opening of “Dramatis Personae” to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.

    Sample answer: Near the start, “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) — Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. Later, “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae) — Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). Almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. The evidence is “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae). This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. The words “general” and “king” carry that meaning: they are the

charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae).
    Sample answer: Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position. The evidence is “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) — Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. The evidence is “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae). This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. The words “general” and “king” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Dramatis Personae”? The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, ‘general of the king's army’: they begin as equals,…
    A. Personification
    B. Characterization
    C. Alliteration
    D. Simile

    Key: B (Characterization)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14	recall 8, inference 5, analysis 0, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 2, 5, 3, 8, 6, 7, 4, 15, 10, 16, 17, 14, 18	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 1, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	7, 1, 4, 8, 5, 2, 6, 3, 10, 16, 19, 14, 17, 20	recall 8, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 3
HS Junior	2, 1, 4, 7, 6, 3, 5, 8, 9, 10, 16, 20, 17, 14	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 1, synthesis 3
HS Senior	3, 8, 2, 5, 6, 7, 4, 1, 10, 16, 18, 17, 14, 20	recall 8, inference 1, analysis 1, synthesis 4
AP	6, 1, 2, 5, 4, 8, 3, 7, 11, 9, 13, 10, 14, 20	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 0, synthesis 2
College Freshman	4, 8, 7, 2, 3, 6, 5, 1, 9, 10, 11, 15, 14, 17	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 0, synthesis 2
College Sophomore	8, 1, 4, 2, 6, 3, 5, 7, 15, 10, 19, 21, 16, 14	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
College Junior	4, 1, 6, 2, 5, 8, 3, 7, 15, 10, 9, 16, 17, 14	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 1, synthesis 2
College Senior	5, 8, 3, 6, 7, 4, 2, 1, 15, 11, 10, 19, 21, 14	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1

Graduate / PhD	5, 1, 4, 8, 2, 6, 3, 7, 10, 16, 20, 18, 17, 14	recall 8, inference 1, analysis 1, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Dramatis Personae,” how does Shakespeare show the cast and world of the play? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Dramatis Personae, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the cast and world of the play? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the cast and world of the play. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Dramatis Personae (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the cast and world of the play. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Dramatis Personae suggests about the cast and world of the play. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Dramatis Personae to complicate the reader's understanding of the cast and world of the play. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Dramatis Personae within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the cast and world of the play responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Dramatis Personae alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the cast and world of the play follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Dramatis Personae and its treatment of

the cast and world of the play. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Dramatis Personae as evidence for a larger claim about the cast and world of the play in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Dramatis Personae as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the cast and world of the play. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Duncan, king of Scotland*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Dramatis Personae”?

   A. The cast and world of the play

   B. The prophecies and their pull

   C. The ghost at the banquet

   D. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

SAT key: 1. A (The cast and world of the play)

Lesson 3: Act I, Scene I

Focus: the Witches' riddling world

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act I, Scene I (the Witches' riddling world) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.3

Teacher only · spoilers

In thunder and lightning on a deserted place, three Witches agree to meet again 'when the hurlyburly's done, when the battle's lost and won,' upon the heath, to meet Macbeth. Called away by their familiars, they chant 'Fair is foul, and foul is fair' and vanish into the fog and filthy air.

Background: Jacobean audiences took witchcraft seriously: the 1604 Witchcraft Act made conjuring spirits a capital crime. Storms were believed to signal disorder in nature and the state.

Significance: The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....
Prompt: Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Jacobean audiences took witchcraft seriously: the 1604 Witchcraft Act made conjuring spirits a capital crime. Storms were believed to signal disorder in nature and the state. The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech. Setting: A desert place in thunder and lightning: a world out of order before the story begins. Diction / vocabulary: Short rhyming lines in trochaic rhythm (stressed first syllables) set the witches apart from the blank verse of humans. FigurativeLanguage: Paradox ("When the battle's lost and won"; "Fair is foul") makes contradiction the witches' language. Watch for equivocation: "Fair is foul": appearances and words that mean two things, from the witches to the Porter to the prophecies. In this scene: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair: / Hover through the fog and” (Act I, Scene I, All).

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how setting shapes the Witches' riddling world. Key takeaway: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** A desert place in thunder and lightning: a world out of order before the story begins.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Short rhyming lines in trochaic rhythm (stressed first syllables) set the witches apart from the blank verse of humans.
- **FigurativeLanguage:** Paradox ("When the battle's lost and won"; "Fair is foul") makes contradiction the witches' language.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.

Symbols and motifs

- **equivocation:** "Fair is foul": appearances and words that mean two things, from the witches to the Porter to the prophecies. In this scene: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair: / Hover through the fog and” (Act I, Scene I, All).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch) The opening question: a world of storm and repetition.
- “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch) Paradox: every battle is lost by someone.
- “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All) The play's motto: moral values inverted.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed.
Evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All)
Reasoning: The witches' chant "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" collapses good and evil into each other, and their paradox "the battle's lost and won" warns that victory and defeat can be the same event.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

Discussion questions

1. Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What do the Witches say they will do when the hurlyburly is done? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Meet again, upon the heath, to meet with Macbeth.
2. What weather opens the play? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Thunder and lightning
3. Whom do the Witches plan to meet? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Macbeth
4. Where do the Witches agree to meet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Upon the heath
5. What paradox do the Witches chant? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Fair is foul, and foul is fair
6. When will the Witches meet again? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: When the battle's lost and won
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act I, Scene I” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In thunder and lightning on a deserted place, three Witches agree to meet again 'when the hurlyburly's done, when the battle's lost and won,' upon the heath, to meet Macbeth. Called away by their familiars, they chant 'Fair is foul, and foul is fair' and vanish into the fog and filthy air.
8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene I”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act I, Scene I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. In the passage that begins “A desert place.”, who is speaking or being described, and what do they say or do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Literal paraphrase of the anchor passage.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Shakespeare open with the Witches instead of the battle or the king? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: It frames events as shaped by uncanny forces and sets the paradox before the hero appears.
2. What does “Act I, Scene I” suggest about the Witches' riddling world? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the foreshadowing in this scene shape what we understand about the Witches' riddling world? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “A desert place.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: In thunder and lightning on a deserted place, three Witches agree to meet again 'when the hurlyburly's done, when the battle's lost and won,' upon the heath, to meet Macbeth. Called away by their familiars, they chant 'Fair is foul, and foul is fair' and vanish into the fog and filthy air.
7. How does “Act I, Scene I” build on “Dramatis Personae”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing

will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. On diction / vocabulary: Short rhyming lines in trochaic rhythm (stressed first syllables) set the witches apart from the blank verse of humans. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. How would you stage the Witches today so that they still feel threatening? Defend your choice. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A staging choice justified by the scene's language and mood.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the Witches' riddling world. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. On setting: A desert place in thunder and lightning: a world out of order before the story begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene I” treats the Witches' riddling world with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act I, Scene II" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: "When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain" (Act I, Scene I, First Witch): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the Witches' riddling world? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: "When the hurlyburly's done, / When the battle's lost and won" (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene I, Second Witch: "When the _____'s done, / When the battle's lost and won"
   Key: hurlyburly
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] When will the Witches meet again?
   A. At midnight on Christmas
   B. Before the next storm
   C. When the battle's lost and won
   D. After Duncan is crowned
   Key: C (When the battle's lost and won)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What paradox do the Witches chant?
   A. Out, damned spot
   B. Double, double toil and trouble
   C. Fair is foul, and foul is fair
   D. All hail, Macbeth
   Key: C (Fair is foul, and foul is fair)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene I, First Witch: "When shall we three meet again / In thunder, _____, or in rain"

   Key: lightning

5. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the Witches say they will do when the hurlyburly is done?

   Sample answer: Meet again, upon the heath, to meet with Macbeth.

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom do the Witches plan to meet?

   A. Duncan
   B. Macbeth
   C. Macduff
   D. Banquo

   Key: B (Macbeth)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where do the Witches agree to meet?

   A. Upon the heath
   B. In England
   C. At Duncan's camp
   D. At Inverness castle

   Key: A (Upon the heath)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What weather opens the play?

   A. Heavy snow
   B. A clear summer day
   C. Thunder and lightning
   D. A calm night

   Key: C (Thunder and lightning)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why might Shakespeare open with the Witches instead of the battle or the king?

   Sample answer: It frames events as shaped by uncanny forces and sets the paradox before the hero appears. The evidence is "When the hurlyburly's done, / When the battle's lost and won" (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch) — Paradox: every battle is lost by someone.

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene I"?

    A. The discovery of the murder
    B. The tyrant's end and a new order
    C. The murder of the innocent
    D. The Witches' riddling world

    Key: D (The Witches' riddling world)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "When the hurlyburly's done, / When the battle's lost and won" (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. The evidence is "When the hurlyburly's done, / When the battle's

lost and won" (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch). This develops appearance and reality: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.

12. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" (Act I, Scene I, All). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The play's motto: moral values inverted. The evidence is "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" (Act I, Scene I, All). This develops appearance and reality: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. The words "fair" and "foul" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

13. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] How would you stage the Witches today so that they still feel threatening? Defend your choice.
    Sample answer: A staging choice justified by the scene's language and mood. The evidence is "When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain" (Act I, Scene I, First Witch), which shows the opening question: a world of storm and repetition. This develops appearance and reality: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. The witches' chant "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" collapses good and evil into each other, and their paradox "the battle's lost and won" warns that victory and defeat can be the same event.

14. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how appearance and reality develops from Dramatis Personae to Act I, Scene I. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Dramatis Personae, the text reads "Macbeth, general of the king's army" — Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. In Act I, Scene I, "When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain" (Act I, Scene I, First Witch), which shows the opening question: a world of storm and repetition. The first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" (Act I, Scene I, All).
    Sample answer: The witches' chant "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" collapses good and evil into each other, and their paradox "the battle's lost and won" warns that victory and defeat can be the same event. The evidence is "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" (Act I, Scene I, All), which shows the play's motto: moral values inverted. This develops appearance and reality: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.

16. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Act I, Scene I"? A desert place in thunder and lightning: a world out of order before the story begins.
    A. Theme
    B. Allusion
    C. Plot
    D. Setting

    Key: D (Setting)

17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "When the hurlyburly's done, / When the battle's lost and won" (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. The evidence is "When the hurlyburly's done, / When the battle's lost and won" (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch). This develops appearance and reality: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. The words "hurlyburly" and "battle" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The witches' chant "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" collapses good and evil into each other, and their paradox "the battle's lost and won" warns that victory and defeat can be the same event.

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene I”? Short rhyming lines in trochaic rhythm (stressed first syllables) set the witches apart from the blank verse of humans.

    A. Structure

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Characterization

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: D (Diction / vocabulary)

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All)

    A. Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them.

    B. Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic.

    C. Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls.

    D. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

    Key: D (The play's motto: moral values inverted.)

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. The evidence is “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch). This develops appearance and reality: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. The words “lightning” and “thunder” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The witches' chant "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" collapses good and evil into each other, and their paradox "the battle's lost and won" warns that victory and defeat can be the same event.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 1, synthesis 2
HS Freshman	4, 8, 3, 6, 1, 7, 5, 2, 9, 15, 16, 14, 17, 13	recall 8, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	2, 3, 6, 1, 7, 5, 8, 4, 9, 11, 18, 15, 13, 14	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 3, 5, 8, 1, 7, 6, 2, 9, 15, 16, 14, 17, 13	recall 8, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 3
HS Senior	5, 2, 6, 8, 3, 7, 4, 1, 10, 9, 12, 14, 17, 13	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 1, synthesis 3
AP	2, 5, 3, 6, 7, 1, 8, 4, 9, 18, 12, 14, 17, 13	recall 8, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 3
College Freshman	2, 3, 6, 4, 5, 8, 7, 1, 11, 19, 9, 18, 13, 14	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 1, synthesis 2
College Sophomore	8, 4, 7, 3, 1, 6, 5, 2, 9, 11, 12, 16, 13, 14	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 2
College Junior	3, 8, 5, 6, 4, 7, 1, 2, 10, 9, 19, 11, 14, 13	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 0, synthesis 2
College Senior	6, 7, 2, 3, 4, 8, 1, 5, 9, 16, 12, 17, 13, 14	recall 8, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 3
Graduate / PhD	1, 6, 7, 5, 3, 8, 2, 19, 11, 9, 18, 20, 14, 13	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 1, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the Witches' riddling world? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the Witches' riddling world? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the Witches' riddling world. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the Witches' riddling world. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene I suggests about the Witches' riddling world. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act I, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the Witches' riddling world. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the Witches' riddling world responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the Witches' riddling world follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene I and its treatment of the Witches' riddling world. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the Witches' riddling world in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the Witches' riddling world. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *A desert place.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene I"?

   A. The murder of the innocent

   B. The army reveals itself

   C. The tyrant's end and a new order

   D. The Witches' riddling world

SAT key: 1. D (The Witches' riddling world)

Lesson 4: Act I, Scene II

Focus: Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act I, Scene II” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (battlefield violence, sexual language): The Captain describes Macbeth cutting a rebel open 'from the nave to the chaps' and fixing his head on the battlements. Keep focus on what the praise says about Macbeth, not the gore. The Captain calls Fortune 'a rebel's whore' (fickle, unfaithful); gloss briefly.
Student preview: This scene describes battlefield violence in vivid terms.
Suggested language: “Why is Macbeth praised for this? What does that tell us about this world?”

Teacher only · spoilers

At a camp near Forres a bleeding Captain tells Duncan how 'brave Macbeth' cut the rebel Macdonwald open 'from the nave to the chaps' and, with Banquo, fought on against a fresh Norwegian attack. Ross reports the treachery of the Thane of Cawdor and the victory over Norway. Duncan orders Cawdor's execution and gives his title to Macbeth.

Background: Thanes were Scottish nobles holding land from the king. Rebellion (Macdonwald) and treason by a trusted noble (Cawdor) were real fears; the 1605 Gunpowder Plot was fresh in memory.

Significance: We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition because.... Content note before we start: This scene describes battlefield violence in vivid terms.
Prompt: Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.

8–13 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (5 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: disbursed — paid out (money); furbish — to polish and make (weapons) ready again; overcharged — loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge; cannons — large guns that fire heavy shot; vantage — an opportunity or advantage. "disbursed": Origin of "disburse": Old French desbourser. "overcharged": Origin of "overcharge": an English formation from over- + charge.
Words: disbursed: paid out (money) · furbish: to polish and make (weapons) ready again · overcharged: loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge · cannons: large guns that fire heavy shot · vantage: an opportunity or advantage

13–18 min · Background and context · I do (5 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Thanes were Scottish nobles holding land from the king. Rebellion (Macdonwald) and treason by a trusted noble (Cawdor) were real fears; the 1605 Gunpowder Plot was fresh in memory. We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor. Characterization: The bleeding Captain's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps." Irony: Duncan gives the traitor Cawdor's title to Macbeth, the next traitor. Imagery: Blood, already: the Captain's wounds and Macbeth's sword "which smoked with bloody execution." Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "fought / 'Gainst my captivity. Hail, brave friend! / Say to the king the knowledge of the broil / As thou didst leave it" (Act I, Scene II, Malcolm).

18–25 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (7 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" slowly and put it in my own words: The wounded Sergeant tells Duncan that brave Macbeth well deserves that name for how he fought. Next, craft. I notice the interruption of his own sentence with a dash, as if he must stop to praise Macbeth. The strongest word is "brave": it is the reputation Macbeth begins with, which makes his fall greater. Then, effect. How does the Sergeant present Macbeth to Duncan? My answer: The Sergeant presents Macbeth to Duncan as a fearless, loyal warrior who carved his way through the rebels; the praise sets up the tragedy, since his courage in battle will become ruthless ambition.

> *For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" slowly and put it in my own words: The wounded Sergeant tells Duncan that brave Macbeth well deserves that name for how he fought. Next, craft. I notice the interruption of his own sentence with a dash, as if he must stop to praise Macbeth. The strongest word is "brave": it is the reputation Macbeth begins with, which makes his fall greater. Then, effect. How does the Sergeant present Macbeth to Duncan? My answer: The Sergeant presents Macbeth to Duncan as a fearless, loyal warrior who carved his way through the rebels; the praise sets up the tragedy, since his courage in battle will become ruthless ambition.

25–30 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (5 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Duncan's line repeats "lost" and "won" from Scene I: dramatic irony, since Macbeth will inherit Cawdor's treason as well as his title. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition? Expected: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. (Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won.")

> *What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won* *(Act I, Scene II, Duncan)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Duncan's line repeats "lost" and "won" from Scene I: dramatic irony, since Macbeth will inherit Cawdor's treason as well as his title.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition?
Expected answer: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. (Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won.")

30–35 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. When the text says "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant), it shows this directly. The Captain calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. When the text says "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant), it shows this directly. The Captain calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.

35–40 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else? Ask: is it unsettling that the hero is introduced through such brutal violence?
Anchor question: Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else?
Facilitation: Ask: is it unsettling that the hero is introduced through such brutal violence?

40–47 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. ("For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name", Act I, Scene II, Sergeant). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. ("For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name", Act I, Scene II, Sergeant). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

47–50 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Key takeaway: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.

Total: 50 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The bleeding Captain's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps."
- **Irony:** Duncan gives the traitor Cawdor's title to Macbeth, the next traitor.
- **Imagery:** Blood, already: the Captain's wounds and Macbeth's sword "which smoked with bloody execution."

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition:** Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “fought / ’Gainst my captivity. Hail, brave friend! / Say to the king the knowledge of the broil / As thou didst leave it” (Act I, Scene II, Malcolm).
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: “What bloody man is that? He can report, / As seemeth by his plight” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant) The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic.
- “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant) Graphic violence praised as service.
- “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan) Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won."

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king.
Evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant)
Reasoning: The Captain calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
disbursed (verb)	paid out (money)	*That now Sweno, the Norways’ king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme’s inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use.*	“disbursed”: Origin of “disburse”: Old French desbourser. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disburse#Etymology)
furbish (verb)	to polish and make (weapons) ready again	*Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm’d Compell’d these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish’d arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.*	
overcharged (adjective)	loaded with too much powder;	*If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled*	“overcharged”: Origin of “overcharge”: an English formation from over- + charge. (Liber et Libri origin note,

	here, packed with a double charge	*strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*	https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/overcharge#Etymology)
cannons (noun)	large guns that fire heavy shot	*If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*	
vantage (noun)	an opportunity or advantage	*Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm'd Compell'd these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish'd arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.*	
banners (noun)	flags carried by an army	*From Fife, great king; Where the Norweyan banners flout the sky And fan our people cold.*	
battlements (noun)	the notched wall along the top of a castle	*Till he unseam'd him from the nave to the chaps, / And fix'd his head upon our battlements.*	"battlements": Origin of "battlement": Old French bataillement. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/battlement#Etymology)
pronounce (verb)	to declare or say aloud	*No more that thane of Cawdor shall deceive Our bosom interest: go pronounce his present death, And with his former title greet Macbeth.*	
traitor (noun)	a person who betrays his country	*With terrible numbers, / Assisted by that most disloyal traitor*	

Discussion questions

1. Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16,

17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which two captains does the Captain compare to 'cannons overcharged with double cracks'? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Macbeth and Banquo.
2. Who reports Macbeth's deeds in battle at the start of the scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A wounded Captain
3. What does Macbeth do to the rebel Macdonwald? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cuts him open and fixes his head on the battlements
4. Which noble has betrayed Scotland by helping Norway? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Thane of Cawdor
5. What does Duncan order for the Thane of Cawdor? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His execution
6. What reward does Duncan give Macbeth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The title Thane of Cawdor
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act I, Scene II” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At a camp near Forres a bleeding Captain tells Duncan how 'brave Macbeth' cut the rebel Macdonwald open 'from the nave to the chaps' and, with Banquo, fought on against a fresh Norwegian attack. Ross reports the treachery of the Thane of Cawdor and the victory over Norway. Duncan orders Cawdor's execution and gives his title to Macbeth.
8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act I, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “That now Sweno, the Norways’ king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme’s inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use.” What does “disbursed” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: disbursed: paid out (money).

Inferential / analytical

1. Duncan says 'What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won.' What irony does this line carry for the audience? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Macbeth inherits Cawdor's title and also his treachery.
2. What does “Act I, Scene II” suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor.

3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. On characterization: The bleeding Captain's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Doubtful it stood; As two spent swimmers, that do cling together And choke their art.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: At a camp near Forres a bleeding Captain tells Duncan how 'brave Macbeth' cut the rebel Macdonwald open 'from the nave to the chaps' and, with Banquo, fought on against a fresh Norwegian attack. Ross reports the treachery of the Thane of Cawdor and the victory over Norway. Duncan orders Cawdor's…
7. How does “Act I, Scene II” build on “Act I, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant): Graphic violence praised as service. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." On characterization: The bleeding Captain's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. On irony: Duncan gives the traitor Cawdor's title to Macbeth, the next traitor. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Duncan trusted Cawdor completely. Is trust a strength or a weakness in a ruler? Judge Duncan. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment about Duncan's trust with evidence from I.ii and I.iv.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant): Graphic violence praised as service. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. On characterization: The bleeding Captain's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant): Graphic violence praised as service. Theme link:

Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant): Graphic violence praised as service. On imagery: Blood, already: the Captain's wounds and Macbeth's sword "which smoked with bloody execution." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene II” treats Macbeth's reputation as a warrior with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well

he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: "Till he unseam'd him from the nave to the chaps" (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant): Graphic violence praised as service. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth do to the rebel Macdonwald?

    A. Pardons him

    B. Takes him prisoner

    C. Cuts him open and fixes his head on the battlements

    D. Lets him escape

    Key: C (Cuts him open and fixes his head on the battlements)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene II, Sergeant: "Till he _____'d him from the nave to the chaps"

    Key: unseam

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which noble has betrayed Scotland by helping Norway?

    A. The Thane of Fife

    B. Banquo

    C. The Thane of Cawdor

    D. Lennox

    Key: C (The Thane of Cawdor)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.", what does "cannons" most nearly mean?

    A. large guns that fire heavy shot

    B. to defeat completely

C. the nuts of the chestnut tree

D. a greeting

Key: A (large guns that fire heavy shot)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps, / And fix’d his head upon our _____.” Word bank: battlements, overcharged, furbish, disbursed

   Key: battlements

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Duncan order for the Thane of Cawdor?

   A. His execution

   B. A pardon

   C. His banishment

   D. A trial in England

   Key: A (His execution)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “That now Sweno, the Norways’ king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme’s inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use.”, what does “disbursed” most nearly mean?

   A. causing wonder; astonishing

   B. an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging

   C. paid out (money)

   D. stinging creatures (an image of torment)

   Key: C (paid out (money))

8. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which two captains does the Captain compare to 'cannons overcharged with double cracks'?

   Sample answer: Macbeth and Banquo.

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm’d Compell’d these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying _____, With furbish’d arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.” Word bank: furbish, disbursed, vantage, overcharged

   Key: vantage

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What reward does Duncan give Macbeth?

    A. Gold and land in England

    B. The title Thane of Cawdor

    C. Command of the navy

    D. The crown

    Key: B (The title Thane of Cawdor)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “No more that thane of Cawdor shall deceive Our bosom interest: go _____ his present death, And with his former title greet Macbeth.” Word bank: disbursed, pronounce, furbish, overcharged

    Key: pronounce

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Duncan says 'What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won.' What irony does this line carry for the audience?

Sample answer: Macbeth inherits Cawdor's title and also his treachery. The evidence is “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan) — Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won.".

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene II”?

    A. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

    B. Life as a tale told by an idiot

    C. The guilt that will not wash away

    D. The last false confidence

    Key: A (Macbeth's reputation as a warrior)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won.". The evidence is “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan). This develops ambition: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. The words “noble” and “lost” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant).

    Sample answer: The Captain calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery. The evidence is “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant), which shows the play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. This develops ambition: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Duncan trusted Cawdor completely. Is trust a strength or a weakness in a ruler? Judge Duncan.

    Sample answer: A judgment about Duncan's trust with evidence from I.ii and I.iv. The evidence is “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan) — Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won.". This develops ambition: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. The Captain calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene II, paragraph 2: “Enter Duncan, Malcolm, Donalbain, Lennox, with Attendants, meeting a _____ Sergeant.” Word bank: bleeding, strange, captivity, swimmers

    Key: bleeding

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act I, Scene II, paragraph 8? “Dismay’d not this Our _____, Macbeth and Banquo?”

    A. gashes

    B. captains

    C. strange

    D. captivity

    Key: B (captains)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “From Fife, great king; Where the Norweyan _____ flout the sky And fan our people cold.” Word bank: disbursed, furbish, overcharged, banners

    Key: banners

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.”, what does “overcharged” most nearly mean?

    A. thin lines (of light)

    B. a bold or risky undertaking

    C. too bold; presumptuous

    D. loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge

    Key: D (loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act I, Scene II?

    A. “This is the sergeant Who like a good and hardy soldier fought ’Gainst my captivity.”

    B. “Enter Duncan, Malcolm, Donalbain, Lennox, with Attendants, meeting a bleeding Sergeant.”

    C. “Say to the king the knowledge of the broil As thou didst leave it.”

    D. “He can report, As seemeth by his plight, of the revolt The newest state.”

    Key: B (“Enter Duncan, Malcolm, Donalbain, Lennox, with Attendants, meeting a bleeding Sergeant.”)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene II”? Duncan gives the traitor Cawdor's title to Macbeth, the next traitor.

    A. Conflict

    B. Symbolism

    C. Irony

    D. Plot

    Key: C (Irony)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene II, paragraph 4 shapes its tone: “Say to the king the knowledge of the broil As thou didst leave it.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “knowledge” (Act I, Scene II, paragraph 4) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act I, Scene II, paragraph 10 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “So well thy words become thee as thy wounds; They smack of honour both.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act I, Scene II, paragraph 10) develops masculinity, power and violence: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Its words “become” and “honour” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “He can report, As seemeth by his plight, of the revolt The newest state.” (Act I, Scene II, paragraph 3), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how ambition develops from Act I, Scene I to Act I, Scene II. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act I, Scene I, First Witch, the text reads “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain”, which shows the opening question: a world of storm and repetition. In Act I, Scene II, “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant), which shows the play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.
26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. The evidence is “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant). This develops ambition: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.
27. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Graphic violence praised as service. The evidence is “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant). This develops ambition: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.
28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene II, Sergeant: “For brave Macbeth—well he _____ that name”
    Key: deserves
29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Who reports Macbeth's deeds in battle at the start of the scene?
    A. Banquo
    B. A Witch
    C. Macduff
    D. A wounded Captain

    Key: D (A wounded Captain)
30. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, Duncan)
    A. Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won."
    B. Banquo's image of nature and holiness.
    C. The opening question: a world of storm and repetition.
    D. The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious.

    Key: A (Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won.")
31. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant)
    A. Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight.
    B. The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic.
    C. Macduff's redefinition of manhood.
    D. Banquo's image of nature and holiness.

    Key: B (The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic.)

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] In the line “Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm’d Compell’d these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish’d arms and new supplies of men Began a…”, what does “furbish” most nearly mean?

    A. to polish and make (weapons) ready again

    B. loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge

    C. paid out (money)

    D. large guns that fire heavy shot

    Key: A (to polish and make (weapons) ready again)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Graphic violence praised as service. The evidence is “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant). This develops ambition: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. The words “unseam” and “chaps” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Captain calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant)

    A. The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil.

    B. Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls.

    C. Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them.

    D. Graphic violence praised as service.

    Key: D (Graphic violence praised as service.)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	2, 17, 18, 3, 19, 1, 20, 8, 11, 9, 21, 12, 22, 23, 14, 24	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	11, 19, 8, 17, 6, 3, 9, 2, 5, 13, 21, 12, 14, 23, 25, 16	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Junior	11, 10, 7, 1, 17, 6, 8, 12, 26, 27, 21, 14, 23, 22, 24, 25	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Senior	28, 3, 1, 8, 7, 18, 17, 20, 13, 12, 21, 23, 14, 25, 24, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 3
AP	9, 19, 20, 6, 8, 1, 18, 12, 21, 27, 22, 23, 14, 16, 25, 24	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Freshman	17, 9, 1, 29, 7, 3, 12, 27, 30, 31, 21, 23, 22, 25, 16, 24	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	32, 29, 8, 10, 19, 5, 17, 28, 21, 12, 23, 22, 14, 24, 25, 16	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Junior	9, 19, 8, 29, 6, 3, 13, 12, 21, 26, 23, 14, 33, 25, 24, 16	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 4
College Senior	29, 9, 11, 10, 4, 8, 26, 12, 34, 13, 21, 23, 14, 25, 16, 24	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 3
Graduate / PhD	4, 11, 2, 17, 10, 19, 26, 21, 12, 22, 14, 23, 24, 16, 33, 25	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene II suggests about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act I, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene II and its treatment of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “overcharged” most nearly mean?

   A. loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge

   B. to declare or say aloud

   C. the notched wall along the top of a castle

   D. a person who betrays his country

2. *Doubtful it stood; As two spent swimmers, that do cling together And choke their art. The merciless Macdonwald— Worthy to be a rebel, for to that The multiplying villainies of nature Do swarm upon him— from the western isles Of kerns and gallowglasses is supplied; And fortune, on his damned quarrel smiling, Show’d like a rebel’s whore: but all’s too weak: For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name— Disdaining fortune, with his brandish’d steel, Which smoked with bloody execution, Like valour’s minion carved out his passage Till he faced the slave; Which ne’er shook hands, nor bade farewell to him, Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps, And fix’d his head upon our battlements.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene II”?

   A. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

   B. Suspicion spoken through irony

   C. The dagger of the mind

   D. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

SAT key: 1. A (loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge); 2. D (Macbeth's reputation as a warrior)

Lesson 5: Act I, Scene III

Focus: the prophecies and their pull

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in “Act I, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

On the heath the Witches hail Macbeth as Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor and 'king hereafter', and tell Banquo he will 'get kings, though thou be none.' They vanish. Ross and Angus arrive to tell Macbeth he is now Thane of Cawdor. Macbeth, startled, imagines murder ('horrible imaginings') and decides 'chance may crown me'; Banquo warns that 'instruments of darkness tell us truths' to betray us.

Background: Prophecy was a dangerous subject: predicting a monarch's death could be treason. Banquo's line about 'instruments of darkness' reflects the period's belief that the devil tells half-truths to trap souls.

Significance: The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....*
> **Prompt:** If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: prologues — opening speeches or events that come before the main action; shipman — a sailor; enkindle — to stir up or set on fire (a desire); treasons — acts of betraying one's king or country; soliciting — urging or tempting someone to act. “soliciting”: Origin of “solicit”: Old French soliciter; earlier Latin sollicitō (“stir”).*
> **Words:** prologues: opening speeches or events that come before the main action · shipman: a sailor · enkindle: to stir up or set on fire (a desire) · treasons: acts of betraying one's king or country · soliciting: urging or tempting someone to act

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Prophecy was a dangerous subject: predicting a monarch's death could be treason. Banquo's line about 'instruments of darkness' reflects the period's belief that the devil tells half-truths to trap souls. The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will. Characterization: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder. Dramatic irony: The audience knows Macbeth is Cawdor before he does; the prophecy's first part comes true at once. Diction / vocabulary: Macbeth's first line echoes the witches: "So foul and fair a day I have not seen." Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Good sir, why do you start; and seem to fear / Things that do sound so fair? I' the name of truth" (Act I, Scene III, Banquo).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "So foul and fair a day I have not seen" slowly and put it in my own words: Returning from battle, Macbeth says he has never seen so foul and fair a day. Next, craft. I notice his words repeat the witches' "fair" and "foul" before he has even met them. The strongest word is "foul": the word links him to the witches' upside-down world. Then, effect. Why does Macbeth's first line echo the witches? My answer: Without knowing it, Macbeth speaks the witches' language; Shakespeare hints that he is already connected to the evil that will tempt him moments later.

> *So foul and fair a day I have not seen (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "So foul and fair a day I have not seen" slowly and put it in my own words: Returning from battle, Macbeth says he has never seen so foul and fair a day. Next, craft. I notice his words repeat the witches' "fair" and "foul" before he has even met them. The strongest word is "foul": the word links him to the witches' upside-down world. Then, effect. Why does Macbeth's first line echo the witches? My answer: Without knowing it, Macbeth speaks the witches' language; Shakespeare hints that he is already connected to the evil that will tempt him moments later.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Suggestion" means temptation; "horrid image" is his own vision. Expected link: fate and free will: the witches never mention murder. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: The prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. (Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought.)

> *why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair* (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Suggestion" means temptation; "horrid image" is his own vision. Expected link: fate and free will: the witches never mention murder.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: The prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. (Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the prophecies and their pull? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of the prophecies and their pull. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. When the text says "why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair" (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth), it shows this directly. Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the prophecies and their pull? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of the prophecies and their pull. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. When the text says “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth), it shows this directly. Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not? Have students compare Banquo's and Macbeth's responses line by line.
Anchor question: If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not?
Facilitation: Have students compare Banquo's and Macbeth's responses line by line.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the prophecies and their pull? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. ("why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair", Act I, Scene III, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the prophecies and their pull? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. ("why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair", Act I, Scene III, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the prophecies and their pull. Key takeaway: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder.
- **Dramatic irony:** The audience knows Macbeth is Cawdor before he does; the prophecy's first part comes true at once.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Macbeth's first line echoes the witches: "So foul and fair a day I have not seen."

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Good sir, why do you start; and seem to fear / Things that do sound so fair? I’ the name of truth” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “All hail, Macbeth! hail to thee, thane of Glamis” (Act I, Scene III, First Witch).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them.
- “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo) Banquo's warning.
- “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea.
Evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth)
Reasoning: Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
prologues (noun)	opening speeches or events that come before the main action	*Two truths are told, As happy prologues to the swelling act Of the imperial theme.—I thank you, gentlemen.*	
shipman (noun)	a sailor	*I myself have all the other, And the very ports they blow, All the quarters that they know I’ the shipman’s card.*	
enkindle (verb)	to stir up or set on fire (a desire)	*That trusted home Might yet enkindle you unto the crown, Besides the thane of Cawdor.*	
treasons (noun)	acts of betraying one's king or country	*Whether he was combined With those of Norway, or did line the rebel With hidden help and vantage, or that with both He labour’d in his country’s wreck, I know not; But treasons capital, confess’d and proved, Have overthrown him.*	

soliciting (noun)	urging or tempting someone to act	*This supernatural soliciting Cannot be ill, cannot be good: if ill, Why hath it given me earnest of success, Commencing in a truth?*	"soliciting": Origin of "solicit": Old French soliciter; earlier Latin sollicitō ("stir"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/solicit#Etymology)
selfsame (adjective)	exactly the same	*To the selfsame tune and words.*	
chestnuts (noun)	the nuts of the chestnut tree	*A sailor's wife had chestnuts in her lap, And munch'd, and munch'd, and munch'd: —"Give me," quoth I: "Aroint thee, witch!" the rump-fed ronyon cries.*	
smother (verb)	to stifle or suffocate	*Present fears Are less than horrible imaginings: My thought, whose murder yet is but fantastical, Shakes so my single state of man that function Is smother'd in surmise, and nothing is But what is not.*	
prediction (noun)	a statement of what will happen in the future	*My noble partner You greet with present grace and great prediction Of noble having and of royal hope, That he seems rapt withal: to me you speak not.*	
corporal (adjective)	bodily; of the body	*Into the air; and what seem'd corporal melted As breath into the wind.*	"corporal": Origin: Old French corporal; earlier Latin corporālis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/corporal#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Macbeth say makes his 'seated heart knock at my ribs'? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The 'horrid image' (suggestion) of murdering the king.

2. What three titles do the Witches give Macbeth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor, and king hereafter
3. What do the Witches predict for Banquo? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He will father kings but not be one
4. Who brings news that Macbeth is Thane of Cawdor? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Ross and Angus
5. How does Banquo warn Macbeth about the Witches? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Evil powers tell small truths to betray us in greater things
6. What does Macbeth say chance may do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Crown him without his doing anything
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On the heath the Witches hail Macbeth as Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor and 'king hereafter', and tell Banquo he will 'get kings, though thou be none.' They vanish. Ross and Angus arrive to tell Macbeth he is now Thane of Cawdor. Macbeth, startled, imagines murder ('horrible imaginings') and decides 'chance may crown me'; Banquo warns that 'instruments of darkness tell us truths' to betray us.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Two truths are told, As happy prologues to the swelling act Of the imperial theme.—I thank you, gentlemen." What does "prologues" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: prologues: opening speeches or events that come before the main action.

Inferential / analytical

1. Macbeth's first line is 'So foul and fair a day I have not seen.' What does the echo of the Witches suggest? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: He is already linked to their inverted world before meeting them.
2. Why does Macbeth react with fear while Banquo reacts with curiosity? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Macbeth's fear suggests the thought of murder was already present.
3. What does "Act I, Scene III" suggest about the prophecies and their pull? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will.
4. Find one example of foreshadowing in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
5. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the prophecies and their pull? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own

imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. On characterization: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. In the passage that begins “A sailor’s wife had chestnuts in her lap, And munch’d, and munch’d, and munch’d:—“Give me,””, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: On the heath the Witches hail Macbeth as Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor and 'king hereafter', and tell Banquo he will 'get kings, though thou be none.' They vanish. Ross and Angus arrive to tell Macbeth he is now Thane of Cawdor. Macbeth, startled, imagines murder ('horrible imaginings') and…
8. How does “Act I, Scene III” build on “Act I, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo): Banquo's warning. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. On characterization: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Do the Witches cause Macbeth's crimes, or only reveal what he already wants? Take a position using this scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position on fate versus free will.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Theme link: the prophecy makes

no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo): Banquo's warning. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. On characterization: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the prophecies and their pull. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo): Banquo's warning. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. Theme

link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the foreshadowing in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene III” treats the prophecies and their pull with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo): Banquo's warning. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the prophecies and their pull? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the Witches predict for Banquo?
   A. He will become Thane of Cawdor
   B. He will be king soon
   C. He will die in battle tomorrow
   D. He will father kings but not be one

   Key: D (He will father kings but not be one)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who brings news that Macbeth is Thane of Cawdor?
   A. Duncan himself
   B. Ross and Angus
   C. Banquo
   D. Lady Macbeth

   Key: B (Ross and Angus)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Present fears Are less than horrible imaginings: My thought, whose murder yet is but fantastical, Shakes so my single state of man that function Is _____'d in surmise, and nothing is But what is not." Word bank: prologues, enkindle, shipman, smother

   Key: smother
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene III, Macbeth: "why do I yield to that _____ / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair"

   Key: suggestion
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "To the _____ tune and words." Word bank: enkindle, selfsame, prologues, shipman

   Key: selfsame
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Banquo warn Macbeth about the Witches?
   A. The Witches always lie
   B. They should tell the king at once
   C. Prophecies cannot come true
   D. Evil powers tell small truths to betray us in greater things

   Key: D (Evil powers tell small truths to betray us in greater things)
7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "This supernatural _____ Cannot be ill, cannot be good: if ill, Why hath it given me earnest of success, Commencing in a truth?" Word bank: prologues, soliciting, shipman, enkindle

   Key: soliciting
8. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say makes his 'seated heart knock at my ribs'?

   Sample answer: The 'horrid image' (suggestion) of murdering the king.
9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What three titles do the Witches give Macbeth?
   A. Thane of Fife, prince, and king
   B. General, Thane of Ross, and king

C. Lord of the Isles, Thane of Cawdor, and prince

D. Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor, and king hereafter

Key: D (Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor, and king hereafter)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Two truths are told, As happy prologues to the swelling act Of the imperial theme.—I thank you, gentlemen.”, what does “prologues” most nearly mean?

    A. loyalty owed to a ruler

    B. to polish and make (weapons) ready again

    C. opening speeches or events that come before the main action

    D. clinging to; refusing to come off (like blood)

    Key: C (opening speeches or events that come before the main action)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “A sailor’s wife had _____ in her lap, And munch’d, and munch’d, and munch’d:—‘Give me,’ quoth I: ‘Aroint thee, witch!’ the rump-fed ronyon cries.” Word bank: chestnuts, shipman, prologues, enkindle

    Key: chestnuts

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Macbeth's first line is 'So foul and fair a day I have not seen.' What does the echo of the Witches suggest?

    Sample answer: He is already linked to their inverted world before meeting them. The evidence is “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) — Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Macbeth react with fear while Banquo reacts with curiosity?

    Sample answer: Macbeth's fear suggests the thought of murder was already present. The evidence is “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) — Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth).

    Sample answer: Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within. The evidence is “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) — Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. This develops fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene III”? Macbeth ‘starts’ at the prophecy; Banquo is wary (‘instruments of darkness’). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder.

    A. Allusion

    B. Personification

    C. Characterization

    D. Simile

    Key: C (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with

evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) supports it: Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within. But “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) complicates it: Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say chance may do?

    A. Make Banquo king

    B. Kill Duncan for him

    C. Crown him without his doing anything

    D. Reveal his secret

    Key: C (Crown him without his doing anything)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “That trusted home Might yet enkindle you unto the crown, Besides the thane of Cawdor.”, what does “enkindle” most nearly mean?

    A. fearless; not discouraged

    B. to stir up or set on fire (a desire)

    C. under a curse

    D. to make up; to form

    Key: B (to stir up or set on fire (a desire))

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “I myself have all the other, And the very ports they blow, All the quarters that they know I’ the shipman’s card.”, what does “shipman” most nearly mean?

    A. a sailor

    B. full of pity; compassionate

    C. kinsmen; relatives (here, Duncan's sons)

    D. made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison

    Key: A (a sailor)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Banquo's warning. The evidence is “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's ‘horrible imaginings’ supply the murder.

    A. Fate and free will

    B. Guilt and conscience

    C. Appearance versus reality

    D. Ambition and its costs

    Key: A (Fate and free will)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 39: “As thick as hail Came post with post; and every one did bear Thy _____ in his kingdom’s great defence, And pour’d them down before him.” Word bank: praises, chanced, addition, children

    Key: praises

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 43 reveal about the character or situation? “The thane of Cawdor lives: why do you dress me In borrow’d robes?” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 43) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The words “borrow” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act I, Scene III?

    A. “Here I have a pilot’s thumb, Wreck’d as homeward he did come.”

    B. “Live you? or are you aught That man may question?”

    C. “The weird sisters, hand in hand, Posters of the sea and land, Thus do go about, about: Thrice to thine and thrice to mine And thrice again,…”

    D. “What are these So wither’d and so wild in their attire, That look not like the inhabitants o’ the earth, And yet are on’t?”

    Key: A (“Here I have a pilot’s thumb, Wreck’d as homeward he did come.”)

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 53 shapes its tone: “Kind gentlemen, your pains Are register’d where every day I turn The leaf to read them.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “gentlemen” and “register” (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 53) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 17 shapes its tone: “Live you? or are you aught That man may question?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “question” (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 17) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 30 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “Say from whence You owe this strange intelligence? or why Upon this blasted heath you stop our way With such prophetic greeting?” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 30) develops masculinity, power and violence: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Its words “intelligence” and “prophetic” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Stay, you imperfect speakers, tell me more: By Sinel’s death I know I am thane of Glamis; But how of Cawdor? the thane…” (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 30), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “Whether he was combined With those of Norway, or did line the rebel With hidden help and vantage, or that with both He labour’d in his country’s wreck, I know not; But treasons capital, confess’d and proved, Have…”, what does “treasons” most nearly mean?

    A. acts of betraying one's king or country

    B. sweet-smelling liquids

    C. gives orders to

    D. people who swear oaths

    Key: A (acts of betraying one's king or country)

29. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene III”?

    A. The discovery of the murder

    B. The ghost at the banquet

    C. The tyrant's end and a new order

    D. The prophecies and their pull

    Key: D (The prophecies and their pull)

30. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. The evidence is “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. The evidence is “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The words “suggestion” and “horrid” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how fate and free will develops from Act I, Scene II to Act I, Scene III. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act I, Scene II, Sergeant, the text reads “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name”, which shows the play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. In Act I, Scene III, “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) — Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. The prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 36 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “And thane of Cawdor too: went it not so?” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 36) develops guilt and conscience: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The king hath happily received, Macbeth, The news of thy success; and when he reads Thy personal venture in the rebels’…” (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 39), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth)

    A. The opening question: a world of storm and repetition.

    B. Malcolm as an obstacle.

    C. Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought.

    D. Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won."

    Key: C (Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought.)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene III”? The audience knows Macbeth is Cawdor before he does; the prophecy's first part comes true at once.

    A. Hyperbole

    B. Allusion

    C. Dramatic irony

    D. Structure

    Key: C (Dramatic irony)

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Do the Witches cause Macbeth's crimes, or only reveal what he already wants? Take a position using this scene.

    Sample answer: A defended position on fate versus free will. The evidence is “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) — Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. This develops fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within.

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth)

    A. Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them.

    B. Kingship without security means nothing.

    C. He knows it is imaginary.

    D. Echo of "what's done is done."

    Key: A (Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them.)

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Banquo's warning. The evidence is “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The words “instruments” and “oftentimes” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. The evidence is “So foul and fair a day I have

not seen" (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The words "have" and "foul" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within.

40. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene III, Banquo: "oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The _____ of darkness tell us truths"
    Key: instruments

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 17, 18, 19, 8, 1, 11, 10, 4, 12, 20, 13, 21, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	9, 6, 3, 7, 5, 22, 23, 20, 12, 24, 13, 25, 26, 21, 27, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	11, 19, 18, 6, 28, 7, 4, 29, 20, 12, 30, 13, 21, 31, 32, 16	recall 7, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 17, 1, 3, 12, 23, 30, 24, 13, 14, 15, 21, 26, 33, 27, 32	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	7, 5, 2, 24, 34, 13, 23, 25, 35, 21, 26, 32, 36, 27, 33, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	7, 5, 19, 24, 37, 23, 13, 35, 26, 31, 25, 21, 32, 36, 38, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	7, 5, 13, 12, 24, 34, 26, 21, 25, 15, 32, 16, 33, 39, 36, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 6
College Junior	28, 5, 7, 24, 23, 25, 21, 26, 15, 31, 39, 32, 16, 36, 33, 27	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	6, 7, 5, 24, 23, 31, 21, 25, 26, 15, 38, 36, 33, 16, 32, 27	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	40, 7, 9, 29, 12, 24, 13, 26, 31, 21, 27, 16, 36, 33, 39, 32	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act I, Scene III," how does Shakespeare show the prophecies and their pull? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the prophecies and their pull? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of the prophecies and their pull. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the prophecies and their pull. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene III suggests about the prophecies and their pull. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses foreshadowing in Act I, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the prophecies and their pull. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the prophecies and their pull responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the prophecies and their pull follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene III and its treatment of the prophecies and their pull. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about the prophecies and their pull in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the prophecies and their pull. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *That trusted home Might yet enkindle you unto the crown, Besides the thane of Cawdor.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “enkindle” most nearly mean?

   A. bodily; of the body

B. to stifle or suffocate

C. a statement of what will happen in the future

D. to stir up or set on fire (a desire)

2. *A sailor's wife had chestnuts in her lap, And munch'd, and munch'd, and munch'd:—"Give me," quoth I: "Aroint thee, witch!" the rump-fed ronyon cries. Her husband's to Aleppo gone, master o' the Tiger: But in a sieve I'll thither sail, And, like a rat without a tail, I'll do, I'll do, and I'll do.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene III"?

A. The decision to murder

B. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

C. The cast and world of the play

D. The prophecies and their pull

SAT key: 1. D (to stir up or set on fire (a desire)); 2. D (The prophecies and their pull)

Lesson 6: Act I, Scene IV

Focus: the hidden mind behind a loyal face

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Act I, Scene IV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Malcolm reports that Cawdor died nobly, confessing his treason. Duncan reflects 'There's no art to find the mind's construction in the face' just as Macbeth enters. He thanks Macbeth and Banquo, then names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland, his heir. Macbeth, aside, sees Malcolm as a step he must 'o'erleap' and asks the stars to hide his 'black and deep desires.' Duncan will visit Macbeth's castle at Inverness.

Background: Scottish kingship was not strictly hereditary at this time; naming Malcolm Prince of Cumberland made him heir and closed Macbeth's lawful path to the throne.

Significance: Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....*
> **Prompt:** Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example.
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: harbinger — a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming; peerless — without equal; recompense — reward or repayment; ingratitude — failure to show thanks; overtake — to catch up with.*
> *“recompense”: Origin: Old French recompense. “ingratitude”: Origin: Old French ingratitude; earlier Late Latin ingrātitūdō.*
> **Words:** harbinger: a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming · peerless: without equal · recompense: reward or repayment · ingratitude: failure to show thanks · overtake: to catch up with

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Scottish kingship was not strictly hereditary at this time; naming Malcolm Prince of Cumberland made him heir and closed Macbeth's lawful path to the throne. Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime. Dramatic irony: Duncan says of Cawdor, "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face," just as Macbeth enters. Characterization: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Imagery: "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires." Watch for darkness and light: Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder. In this scene: "Not unaccompanied invest him only, / But signs of nobleness, like stars, shall shine / On all deservers. From hence to Inverness, / And bind" (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" slowly and put it in my own words: Speaking of the traitor Cawdor, Duncan says there is no art to find the mind's construction in the face. Next, craft. I notice the irony: he says this just before Macbeth, the next traitor, enters. The strongest word is "face": it names the surface that hides a person's real thoughts. Then, effect. What does Duncan say about reading people's faces? My answer: Duncan says there is no art to read people's faces, because he trusted the traitor Cawdor; he is fatally wrong again, since he is about to give the same trust to Macbeth, who will murder him.

> *There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" slowly and put it in my own words: Speaking of the traitor Cawdor, Duncan says there is no art to find the mind's construction in the face. Next, craft. I notice the irony: he says this just before Macbeth, the next traitor, enters. The strongest word is "face": it names the surface that hides a person's real thoughts. Then, effect. What does Duncan say about reading people's faces? My answer: Duncan says there is no art to read people's faces, because he trusted the traitor Cawdor; he is fatally wrong again, since he is about to give the same trust to Macbeth, who will murder him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Look at the craft: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality? Expected: The loyal face hides the disloyal mind. (Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery.)

> *Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Look at the craft: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap."
Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality?
Expected answer: The loyal face hides the disloyal mind. (Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. When the text says "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires" (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth), it shows this directly. Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires."
Task: Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. When the text says “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth), it shows this directly. Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example. Ask: is Duncan naive, or is trust a virtue the play wants us to value?
Anchor question: Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example.
Facilitation: Ask: is Duncan naive, or is trust a virtue the play wants us to value?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. ("Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires", Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. ("Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires", Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Key takeaway: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Duncan says of Cawdor, "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face," just as Macbeth enters.
- **Characterization:** Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap."
- **Imagery:** "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires."

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** the loyal face hides the disloyal mind.

Symbols and motifs

- **darkness and light:** Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder. In this scene: "Not unaccompanied invest him only, / But signs of nobleness, like stars, shall shine / On all deservers. From hence to Inverness, / And bind" (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan) Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters.

- “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth) Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery.
- “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth) Malcolm as an obstacle.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face.
Evidence: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth)
Reasoning: Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
harbinger (noun)	a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming	*The rest is labour, which is not used for you: I’ll be myself the harbinger and make joyful The hearing of my wife with your approach; So humbly take my leave.*	
peerless (adjective)	without equal	*Let’s after him, Whose care is gone before to bid us welcome: It is a peerless kinsman.*	
recompense (noun)	reward or repayment	*The sin of my ingratitude even now Was heavy on me: thou art so far before That swiftest wing of recompense is slow To overtake thee.*	“recompense”: Origin: Old French recompense. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/recompense#Etymology)
ingratitude (noun)	failure to show thanks	*The sin of my ingratitude even now Was heavy on me: thou art so far before That swiftest wing of recompense is slow To overtake thee.*	“ingratitude”: Origin: Old French ingratitude; earlier Late Latin ingrātitūdō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ingratitude#Etymology)
overtake (verb)	to catch up with	*The sin of my ingratitude even now Was heavy on me: thou art so far before That swiftest wing of recompense is slow To overtake thee.*	
kinsman (noun)	a male relative	*Let’s after him, Whose care is gone before to bid us welcome: It is a peerless kinsman.*	
highness (noun)	a title of respect used to address a king	*Your highness’ part Is to receive our duties; and our duties Are to your throne and state children and servants, Which do but what they*	

		should, by doing every thing Safe toward your love and honour.	
hereafter (adverb)	later; at some future time	*We will establish our estate upon / Our eldest, Malcolm, whom we name hereafter*	

Discussion questions

1. Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example.
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Complete Duncan's line about the old Cawdor: 'He was a gentleman on whom I built…' [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: '…an absolute trust.'
2. How did the old Thane of Cawdor die, according to Malcolm? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Nobly, confessing his treasons
3. What title does Duncan give Malcolm? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Prince of Cumberland
4. Why is Malcolm's new title a problem for Macbeth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It makes Malcolm the heir and blocks Macbeth's path
5. What does Macbeth ask the stars to do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hide their fires so no one sees his dark desires
6. Where will Duncan go next? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To Macbeth's castle at Inverness
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Malcolm reports that Cawdor died nobly, confessing his treason. Duncan reflects 'There's no art to find the mind's construction in the face' just as Macbeth enters. He thanks Macbeth and Banquo, then names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland, his heir. Macbeth, aside, sees Malcolm as a step he must 'o'erleap' and asks the stars to hide his 'black and deep desires.' Duncan will visit Macbeth's castle at…
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “The rest is labour, which is not used for you: I’ll be myself the harbinger and make joyful The hearing of my wife with your approach; So humbly take my leave.” What does “harbinger” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: harbinger: a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is it ironic that Macbeth enters right after Duncan's line about reading faces? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Duncan is about to trust another hidden traitor.
2. What does “Act I, Scene IV” suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the imagery in this scene shape what we understand about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. On imagery: "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “My liege, They are not yet come back.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Malcolm reports that Cawdor died nobly, confessing his treason. Duncan reflects 'There's no art to find the mind's construction in the face' just as Macbeth enters. He thanks Macbeth and Banquo, then names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland, his heir. Macbeth, aside, sees Malcolm as a step he must…
7. How does “Act I, Scene IV” build on “Act I, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous

thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth): Malcolm as an obstacle. On characterization: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. On characterization: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Was naming an heir at this moment a wise political move by Duncan? Argue from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Evaluation of Duncan's timing and judgment.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth): Malcolm as an obstacle. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. On characterization: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap."

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth): Malcolm as an obstacle. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene IV” treats the hidden mind behind a loyal face with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth): Malcolm as an obstacle. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act I, Scene V" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires" (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 53: "Give me your favour: my dull brain was wrought With things _____." Word bank: prisoner, though, children, forgotten

   Key: forgotten

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 17? "What are these So wither'd and so wild in their attire, That look not like the _____ o' the earth, And yet are on't?"

   A. addition
   B. prisoner
   C. forgotten
   D. inhabitants

   Key: D (inhabitants)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What title does Duncan give Malcolm?

   A. King of Scotland
   B. Thane of Cawdor
   C. Prince of Cumberland
   D. Lord of the Isles

Key: C (Prince of Cumberland)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth: “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’_____”

   Key: erleap

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 15? “True, worthy Banquo; he is full so valiant, And in his _____ I am fed; It is a banquet to me.”

   A. service

   B. themselves

   C. deserved

   D. commendations

   Key: D (commendations)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Let’s after him, Whose care is gone before to bid us welcome: It is a peerless _____.” Word bank: peerless, kinsman, recompense, harbinger

   Key: kinsman

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene IV, Duncan: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s _____ in the face”

   Key: construction

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where will Duncan go next?

   A. To Scone

   B. To Forres

   C. To England

   D. To Macbeth's castle at Inverness

   Key: D (To Macbeth's castle at Inverness)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “We will establish our estate upon / Our eldest, Malcolm, whom we name _____” Word bank: hereafter, harbinger, peerless, recompense

   Key: hereafter

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 30 reveal about the character or situation? “Stay, you imperfect speakers, tell me more: By Sinel’s death I know I am thane of Glamis; But how of Cawdor? the thane of Cawdor lives, A prosperous gentleman; and to be king Stands not within the prospect of belief, No more than to be…” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 30) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The words “prosperous” and “gentleman” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act I, Scene III?

    A. “All hail, Macbeth, thou shalt be king hereafter!”

    B. “All hail, Macbeth! hail to thee, thane of Glamis!”

C. “You seem to understand me, By each at once her choppy finger laying Upon her skinny lips: you should be women, And yet your beards forbid…”

D. “All hail, Macbeth, hail to thee, thane of Cawdor!”

Key: C (“You seem to understand me, By each at once her choppy finger laying Upon her skinny lips: you should be women, And yet your beards forbid…”)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 7 reveal about the character or situation? “Would thou hadst less deserved, That the proportion both of thanks and payment Might have been mine! only I have left to say, More is thy due than more than all can pay.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 7) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. The words “proportion” and “deserved” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why is it ironic that Macbeth enters right after Duncan's line about reading faces?

Sample answer: Duncan is about to trust another hidden traitor. The evidence is “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan) — Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 39 shapes its tone: “The king hath happily received, Macbeth, The news of thy success; and when he reads Thy personal venture in the rebels’ fight, His wonders and his praises do contend Which should be thine or his: silenced with that, In viewing o’er the…” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “selfsame” and “received” (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 39) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 49 shapes its tone: “If chance will have me king, why, chance may crown me, Without my stir.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “chance” (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 49) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how appearance and reality develops from Act I, Scene I to Act I, Scene IV. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Act I, Scene I, First Witch, the text reads “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain”, which shows the opening question: a world of storm and repetition. In Act I, Scene IV, “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan) — Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. The loyal face hides the disloyal mind.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene II, paragraph 5: “Doubtful it stood; As two spent _____, that do cling together And choke their art.” Word bank: swimmers, bleeding, captivity, gashes

Key: swimmers

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act I, Scene II, paragraph 13? “So should he look That seems to speak things _____.”

A. captivity

B. swimmers

C. captains

D. strange

Key: D (strange)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 31: “The earth hath _____, as the water has, And these are of them.” Word bank: bubbles, praises, though, homeward
Key: bubbles

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 41? “And, for an earnest of a greater honour, He bade me, from him, call thee thane of Cawdor: In which _____, hail, most worthy thane!”

A. prisoner

B. addition

C. forgotten

D. praises

Key: B (addition)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Your _____’ part Is to receive our duties; and our duties Are to your throne and state children and servants, Which do but what they should, by doing every thing Safe toward your love and honour.” Word bank: highness, recompense, harbinger, peerless
Key: highness

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The sin of my ingratitude even now Was heavy on me: thou art so far before That swiftest wing of recompense is slow To _____ thee.” Word bank: peerless, recompense, overtake, harbinger
Key: overtake

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act I, Scene II, paragraph 3 reveal about the character or situation? “He can report, As seemeth by his plight, of the revolt The newest state.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (Act I, Scene II, paragraph 3) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. The words “seemeth” and “revolt” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: “From hence to Inverness, And bind us further to you.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “further” (Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene IV”? Duncan says of Cawdor, ‘There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face,’ just as Macbeth enters.

A. Dramatic irony

B. Alliteration

C. Diction / vocabulary

D. Metaphor

Key: A (Dramatic irony)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. The evidence is “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan). This develops appearance and reality: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. The words “construction” and “face” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires.".

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How did the old Thane of Cawdor die, according to Malcolm?

    A. Cursing the king

    B. Trying to escape

    C. In battle

    D. Nobly, confessing his treasons

    Key: D (Nobly, confessing his treasons)

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 8: “The _____ and the loyalty I owe, In doing it, pays itself.” Word bank: service, deserved, commendations, themselves

    Key: service

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “The rest is labour, which is not used for you: I’ll be myself the harbinger and make joyful The hearing of my wife with your approach; So humbly take my leave.”, what does “harbinger” most nearly mean?

    A. a supreme piece of work

    B. based on guesswork

    C. a convenient time

    D. a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming

    Key: D (a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming)

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene II, paragraph 9 shapes its tone: “Yes; As sparrows eagles, or the hare the lion.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “sparrows” and “eagles” (Act I, Scene II, paragraph 9) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 19 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “All hail, Macbeth! hail to thee, thane of Glamis!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 19) develops guilt and conscience: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “All hail, Macbeth, thou shalt be king hereafter!” (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 21), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Was naming an heir at this moment a wise political move by Duncan? Argue from the scene.

Sample answer: Evaluation of Duncan's timing and judgment. The evidence is “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan) — Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. This develops appearance and reality: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires.".

33. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep _____”

    Key: desires

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene IV”?

    A. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief
    B. The murder and its first guilt
    C. The dagger of the mind
    D. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

    Key: D (The hidden mind behind a loyal face)

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan)

    A. Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight.
    B. Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).
    C. Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters.
    D. Sleep as innocence destroyed.

    Key: C (Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters.)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Malcolm as an obstacle. The evidence is “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth). This develops appearance and reality: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. The words “erleap” and “which” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth) supports it: Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires.". But “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan) complicates it: Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters, and its “no” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. A fair verdict is that the claim is mostly right but overstated; it needs a limiting clause to cover that passage.

38. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Why is Malcolm's new title a problem for Macbeth?

    A. It makes Malcolm the heir and blocks Macbeth's path
    B. It sends Macbeth to England
    C. It makes Malcolm Macbeth's commander

D. It takes Macbeth's lands

Key: A (It makes Malcolm the heir and blocks Macbeth's path)

39. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does Macbeth ask the stars to do?

    A. Guide him to Inverness

    B. Hide their fires so no one sees his dark desires

    C. Show him the future

    D. Protect Duncan

    Key: B (Hide their fires so no one sees his dark desires)

40. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth)

    A. Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).

    B. Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won."

    C. Sleep as innocence destroyed.

    D. Malcolm as an obstacle.

    Key: D (Malcolm as an obstacle.)

41. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene IV”? Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must ‘o'erleap.’

    A. Hyperbole

    B. Characterization

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Setting

    Key: B (Characterization)

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. The evidence is “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth). This develops appearance and reality: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. The words “desires” and “light” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires.".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 2, 19, 20, 6, 21, 22, 23, 11, 12, 13, 15, 24, 25, 26	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	20, 1, 27, 28, 4, 29, 23, 11, 10, 13, 12, 30, 14, 24, 31, 32	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2

HS Junior	20, 1, 27, 8, 33, 23, 11, 13, 34, 12, 30, 14, 15, 24, 16, 32	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	5, 27, 9, 21, 23, 10, 11, 13, 12, 30, 15, 25, 24, 31, 32, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	17, 29, 6, 23, 11, 13, 35, 14, 15, 36, 24, 25, 31, 16, 32, 37	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	21, 29, 38, 9, 11, 13, 12, 30, 15, 14, 36, 25, 31, 32, 16, 37	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	6, 21, 27, 3, 38, 39, 30, 15, 14, 24, 36, 31, 16, 26, 37, 32	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	5, 9, 6, 27, 23, 40, 30, 15, 14, 24, 41, 31, 37, 26, 16, 32	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	22, 6, 27, 3, 11, 10, 14, 15, 36, 24, 25, 31, 32, 16, 37, 42	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	22, 21, 23, 11, 34, 40, 13, 35, 30, 15, 14, 24, 31, 16, 37, 32	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene IV,” how does Shakespeare show the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the hidden mind behind a loyal face? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene IV suggests about the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act I, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the hidden mind behind a loyal face responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the hidden mind behind a loyal face follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene IV and its treatment of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about the hidden mind behind a loyal face in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *The sin of my ingratitude even now Was heavy on me: thou art so far before That swiftest wing of recompense is slow To overtake thee.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “recompense” most nearly mean?

   A. reward or repayment

   B. a title of respect used to address a king

   C. a male relative

   D. later; at some future time

2. *My liege, They are not yet come back. But I have spoke With one that saw him die: who did report That very frankly he confess’d his treasons, Implored your highness’ pardon and set forth A deep repentance: nothing in his life Became him like the leaving it; he died As one that had been studied in his death To throw away the dearest thing he owed, As ’twere a careless trifle.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene IV"?

A. The prophecies and their pull

B. Lady Macbeth's resolve

C. The murder and its first guilt

D. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

SAT key: 1. A (reward or repayment); 2. D (The hidden mind behind a loyal face)

Lesson 7: Act I, Scene V

Focus: Lady Macbeth's resolve

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act I, Scene V” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter about the prophecies and fears his nature is 'too full o' the milk of human kindness.' Hearing that Duncan will stay the night, she calls on spirits to 'unsex me here' and fill her with cruelty, and asks thick night to hide her knife. Macbeth arrives; she tells him to 'look like the innocent flower, but be the serpent under't' and to leave the business to her.

Background: Early modern ideas of gender linked women with pity and nursing and men with violence; Lady Macbeth's invocation deliberately reverses those expectations. Calling on spirits echoed what the witchcraft laws punished.

Significance: Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because....*
> **Prompt:** Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: chastise — to drive off by scolding; to punish with words; murdering — that kill; deadly; beguile — to deceive; to fool; dispatch — prompt handling or management of a task; substances — bodies or forms.*
> **Words:** chastise: to drive off by scolding; to punish with words · murdering: that kill; deadly · beguile: to deceive; to fool · dispatch: prompt handling or management of a task · substances: bodies or forms

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Early modern ideas of gender linked women with pity and nursing and men with violence; Lady Macbeth's invocation deliberately reverses those expectations. Calling on spirits echoed what the witchcraft laws punished. Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan. Characterization: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here." Imagery: Milk vs. gall, light vs. "thick night": the imagery of nurturing turned to poison. Soliloquy: Her speeches reveal resolve and fear of her own pity. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "and shalt be / What thou art promised: yet do I fear thy nature; / It is too full o' the milk of human" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way" slowly and put it in my own words: Reading his letter, Lady Macbeth fears Macbeth is too full of the milk of human kindness to take the quickest path to the crown. Next, craft. I notice the image of milk, nourishment associated with mothers and gentleness. The strongest word is "kindness": it means natural human feeling, which she sees as weakness. Then, effect. What does Lady Macbeth fear about her husband's nature? My answer: She believes Macbeth is too gentle to murder; she resolves to push him, and later calls on spirits to "unsex" her, rejecting her own nurturing nature.

> *It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way" slowly and put it in my own words: Reading his letter, Lady Macbeth fears Macbeth is too full of the milk of human kindness to take the quickest path to the crown. Next, craft. I notice the image of milk, nourishment associated with mothers and gentleness. The strongest word is "kindness": it means natural human feeling, which she sees as weakness. Then, effect. What does Lady Macbeth fear about her husband's nature? My answer: She believes Macbeth is too gentle to murder; she resolves to push him, and later calls on spirits to "unsex" her, rejecting her own nurturing nature.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Milk is nurturing; she wants to replace it with gall (bitterness). She advises: "look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under't": appearance and reality. Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected: She rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. (Appearance and reality.)

> *look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under't* (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Milk is nurturing; she wants to replace it with gall (bitterness). She advises: "look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under't": appearance and reality.
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected answer: She rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. (Appearance and reality.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. When the text says “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth), it shows this directly. She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. When the text says “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth), it shows this directly. She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want? Ask: does Lady Macbeth really lack pity? Look for cracks later (II.ii).
Anchor question: Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want?
Facilitation: Ask: does Lady Macbeth really lack pity? Look for cracks later (II.ii).

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. ("Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here", Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. ("Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here", Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Lady Macbeth's resolve. Key takeaway: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here."
- **Imagery:** Milk vs. gall, light vs. "thick night": the imagery of nurturing turned to poison.
- **Soliloquy:** Her speeches reveal resolve and fear of her own pity.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "and shalt be / What thou art promised: yet do I fear thy nature; / It is too full o' the milk of human" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "rapt in the wonder of it, came missives from the king, who all-hailed me 'Thane of Cawdor;' by which title, before, these" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth) Her judgment of her husband.

- "Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth) Her invocation.
- "look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under't" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth) Appearance and reality.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity.
Evidence: "Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth)
Reasoning: She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
chastise (verb)	to drive off by scolding; to punish with words	*Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that impedes thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown'd withal.*	
murdering (adjective)	that kill; deadly	*Come to my woman's breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless substances You wait on nature's mischief!*	
beguile (verb)	to deceive; to fool	*To beguile the time, Look like the time; bear welcome in your eye, Your hand, your tongue: look like the innocent flower, But be the serpent under't.*	
dispatch (noun)	prompt handling or management of a task	*He that's coming Must be provided for: and you shall put This night's great business into my dispatch; Which shall to all our nights and days to come Give solely sovereign sway and masterdom.*	
substances (noun)	bodies or forms	*Come to my woman's breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless substances You wait on nature's mischief!*	
transported (verb)	carried away by strong feeling	*Thy letters have transported me beyond This ignorant present, and I feel now The future in the instant.*	
ambition (noun)	a strong desire for power or success	*To catch the nearest way: thou wouldst be great; / Art not without ambition, but without*	
impedes (verb)	gets in the way of; hinders	*Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that impedes thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown'd withal.*	
sightless (adjective)	invisible		

		Come to my woman's breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless substances You wait on nature's mischief!	
metaphysical (adjective)	supernatural; beyond the physical world	*Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that impedes thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown'd withal.*	

Discussion questions

1. Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does Lady Macbeth learn about the prophecies? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: From Macbeth's letter, which she reads aloud.
2. What does Lady Macbeth fear about her husband's nature? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It is too full of the milk of human kindness
3. What does Lady Macbeth ask the spirits to do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Unsex her and fill her with cruelty
4. What news does the messenger bring? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The king comes here tonight
5. What advice does she give Macbeth about his face? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Look like the innocent flower but be the serpent under it
6. What does she ask the night to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hide her knife so it cannot see the wound it makes
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter about the prophecies and fears his nature is 'too full o' the milk of human kindness.' Hearing that Duncan will stay the night, she calls on spirits to 'unsex me here' and fill her with cruelty, and asks thick night to hide her knife. Macbeth arrives; she tells him to 'look like the innocent flower, but be the serpent under't' and to leave the business to her.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “Act I, Scene V” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that impedes thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown’d withal.” What does “chastise” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: chastise: to drive off by scolding; to punish with words.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Lady Macbeth connect kindness with milk, and cruelty with being 'unsexed'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: She links tenderness with womanhood and thinks murder requires abandoning it.
2. What does “Act I, Scene V” suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Lady Macbeth's resolve? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Her judgment of her husband. On characterization: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Give him tending; He brings great news.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter about the prophecies and fears his nature is 'too full o' the milk of human kindness.' Hearing that Duncan will stay the night, she calls on spirits to 'unsex me here' and fill her with cruelty, and asks thick night to hide her knife. Macbeth arrives; she tells…
7. How does “Act I, Scene V” build on “Act I, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Her invocation. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Appearance and reality. On characterization: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Her judgment of her husband. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Lady Macbeth more ambitious than Macbeth, or simply more decisive? Use both I.v and I.vii. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A comparative judgment with evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Her invocation. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Appearance and reality. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must

destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Her judgment of her husband. On characterization: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Lady Macbeth's resolve. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Her invocation. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Appearance and reality. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Her judgment of her husband. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Her invocation. On imagery: Milk vs. gall, light vs. "thick night": the imagery of nurturing turned to poison. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene V” treats Lady Macbeth's resolve with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Appearance and reality. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain

power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act I, Scene VI" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: "It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Her judgment of her husband. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Lady Macbeth's resolve? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: "Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here" (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth): Her invocation. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What news does the messenger bring?

   A. Norway attacks again

   B. Banquo is dead

   C. Malcolm is crowned

   D. The king comes here tonight

   Key: D (The king comes here tonight)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth fear about her husband's nature?

   A. He does not want to be king

   B. He is a coward in battle

   C. It is too cruel

   D. It is too full of the milk of human kindness

   Key: D (It is too full of the milk of human kindness)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What advice does she give Macbeth about his face?

   A. Weep to show loyalty

   B. Avoid the king completely

C. Look like the innocent flower but be the serpent under it

D. Show his anger openly

Key: C (Look like the innocent flower but be the serpent under it)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth: "Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal _____, unsex me here"

   Key: thoughts

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth: "look like the _____ flower, / But be the serpent under't"

   Key: innocent

6. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Lady Macbeth learn about the prophecies?

   Sample answer: From Macbeth's letter, which she reads aloud.

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "He that's coming Must be provided for: and you shall put This night's great business into my dispatch; Which shall to all our nights and days to come Give solely sovereign sway and masterdom.", what does "dispatch" most nearly mean?

   A. the thing that gives honor or beauty; here, the crown

   B. blows in battle

   C. prompt handling or management of a task

   D. past days

   Key: C (prompt handling or management of a task)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that _____ thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown'd withal."

   Word bank: chastise, beguile, murdering, impedes

   Key: impedes

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "To beguile the time, Look like the time; bear welcome in your eye, Your hand, your tongue: look like the innocent flower, But be the serpent under't.", what does "beguile" most nearly mean?

   A. to deceive; to fool

   B. to change

   C. failure to show thanks

   D. people who held a position earlier

   Key: A (to deceive; to fool)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Come to my woman's breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless _____ You wait on nature's mischief!" Word bank: beguile, substances, chastise, murdering

    Key: substances

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Thy letters have _____ me beyond This ignorant present, and I feel now The future in the instant." Word bank: murdering, beguile, transported, chastise

    Key: transported

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Her judgment of her husband. The evidence is “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth).
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Lady Macbeth connect kindness with milk, and cruelty with being 'unsexed'?
    Sample answer: She links tenderness with womanhood and thinks murder requires abandoning it. The evidence is “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth), which shows her judgment of her husband.
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene V”? Milk vs. gall, light vs. ‘thick night’: the this device of nurturing turned to poison.
    A. Structure
    B. Imagery
    C. Foreshadowing
    D. Allusion

    Key: B (Imagery)
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Appearance and reality. The evidence is “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. The words “innocent” and “serpent” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how masculinity and power develops from Dramatis Personae to Act I, Scene V. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Dramatis Personae, the text reads “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” — Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. In Act I, Scene V, “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth), which shows her judgment of her husband. She rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 17? “What are these So wither’d and so wild in their attire, That look not like the _____ o’ the earth, And yet are on’t?”
    A. addition
    B. prisoner
    C. forgotten
    D. inhabitants

    Key: D (inhabitants)
18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 53: “Give me your favour: my dull brain was wrought With things _____.” Word bank: prisoner, though, children, forgotten
    Key: forgotten

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 8: "The _____ and the loyalty I owe, In doing it, pays itself." Word bank: service, deserved, commendations, themselves

    Key: service

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act I, Scene V, paragraph 9? "Come, thick night, And pall thee in the _____ smoke of hell, That my keen knife see not the wound it makes, Nor heaven peep through the blanket of the dark, To cry 'Hold, hold!'"

    A. favour
    B. perfectest
    C. dunnest
    D. scarcely

    Key: C (dunnest)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does she ask the night to do?

    A. Bring a storm
    B. Wake the king early
    C. Hide her knife so it cannot see the wound it makes
    D. Reveal the Witches

    Key: C (Hide her knife so it cannot see the wound it makes)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth ask the spirits to do?

    A. Make Macbeth king without murder
    B. Show her the future
    C. Protect Duncan
    D. Unsex her and fill her with cruelty

    Key: D (Unsex her and fill her with cruelty)

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 30 reveal about the character or situation? "Stay, you imperfect speakers, tell me more: By Sinel's death I know I am thane of Glamis; But how of Cawdor? the thane of Cawdor lives, A prosperous gentleman; and to be king Stands not within the prospect of belief, No more than to be…" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 30) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The words "prosperous" and "gentleman" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act I, Scene III?

    A. "All hail, Macbeth, thou shalt be king hereafter!"
    B. "All hail, Macbeth! hail to thee, thane of Glamis!"
    C. "You seem to understand me, By each at once her choppy finger laying Upon her skinny lips: you should be women, And yet your beards forbid…"
    D. "All hail, Macbeth, hail to thee, thane of Cawdor!"

    Key: C ("You seem to understand me, By each at once her choppy finger laying Upon her skinny lips: you should be women, And yet your beards forbid…")

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act I, Scene V?

    A. “Come, thick night, And pall thee in the dunnest smoke of hell, That my keen knife see not the wound it makes, Nor heaven peep through the…”

    B. “The raven himself is hoarse That croaks the fatal entrance of Duncan Under my battlements.”

    C. “So please you, it is true: our thane is coming: One of my fellows had the speed of him, Who, almost dead for breath, had scarcely more Than…”

    D. “Your face, my thane, is as a book where men May read strange matters.”

    Key: C (“So please you, it is true: our thane is coming: One of my fellows had the speed of him, Who, almost dead for breath, had scarcely more Than…”)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 39 shapes its tone: “The king hath happily received, Macbeth, The news of thy success; and when he reads Thy personal venture in the rebels’ fight, His wonders and his praises do contend Which should be thine or his: silenced with that, In viewing o’er the…” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “selfsame” and “received” (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 39) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 49 shapes its tone: “If chance will have me king, why, chance may crown me, Without my stir.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “chance” (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 49) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Lady Macbeth more ambitious than Macbeth, or simply more decisive? Use both I.v and I.vii.

    Sample answer: A comparative judgment with evidence: her judgment of her husband. The evidence is “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 41? “And, for an earnest of a greater honour, He bade me, from him, call thee thane of Cawdor: In which _____, hail, most worthy thane!”

    A. prisoner

    B. addition

    C. forgotten

    D. praises

    Key: B (addition)

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “To catch the nearest way: thou wouldst be great; / Art not without _____, but without” Word bank: beguile, ambition, murdering, chastise

    Key: ambition

31. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 7 reveal about the character or situation? “Would thou hadst less deserved, That the proportion both of thanks and payment Might have been mine! only I have left to say, More is thy due than more than all can pay.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 7) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. The words “proportion” and “deserved” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: “From hence to Inverness, And bind us further to you.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “further” (Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act I, Scene III, paragraph 19 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “All hail, Macbeth! hail to thee, thane of Glamis!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 19) develops guilt and conscience: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “All hail, Macbeth, thou shalt be king hereafter!” (Act I, Scene III, paragraph 21), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene V”?

    A. The guilt that will not wash away
    B. The hidden mind behind a loyal face
    C. The last false confidence
    D. Lady Macbeth's resolve

    Key: D (Lady Macbeth's resolve)

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act I, Scene V, paragraph 9 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “The raven himself is hoarse That croaks the fatal entrance of Duncan Under my battlements.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act I, Scene V, paragraph 9) develops guilt and conscience: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Its words “battlements” and “entrance” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Your face, my thane, is as a book where men May read strange matters.” (Act I, Scene V, paragraph 15), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth).

    Sample answer: She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power. The evidence is “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth) — Her invocation. This develops masculinity and power: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth)

    A. He shuts her out.

    B. Malcolm as an obstacle.

    C. Her judgment of her husband.

    D. Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).

    Key: C (Her judgment of her husband.)

38. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene V”? Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is ‘too full o' the milk of human kindness,’ and calls on spirits to ‘unsex me here.’

    A. Theme

    B. Irony

    C. Characterization

    D. Personification

    Key: C (Characterization)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Her judgment of her husband. The evidence is “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. The words “kindness” and “nearest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.

40. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Her invocation. The evidence is “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 4, 22, 7, 23, 24, 13, 25, 26, 27, 15, 28	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	29, 30, 5, 1, 20, 8, 24, 23, 31, 25, 13, 26, 32, 15, 33, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	17, 11, 3, 7, 10, 24, 31, 34, 25, 13, 26, 27, 32, 15, 16, 35	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 10, 11, 6, 24, 23, 31, 25, 13, 26, 27, 14, 36, 33, 35, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3

AP	17, 10, 11, 24, 23, 37, 13, 27, 26, 32, 15, 38, 33, 16, 28, 35	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	19, 11, 22, 24, 31, 37, 13, 26, 27, 32, 14, 15, 33, 16, 35, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	17, 10, 11, 24, 34, 25, 26, 27, 32, 36, 15, 33, 28, 35, 16, 39	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	30, 3, 11, 2, 23, 34, 25, 40, 26, 27, 32, 15, 33, 28, 16, 35	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	3, 10, 11, 23, 24, 25, 27, 26, 32, 38, 15, 33, 28, 16, 35, 39	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	10, 11, 21, 24, 23, 31, 25, 13, 26, 27, 32, 14, 33, 28, 16, 35	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show Lady Macbeth's resolve? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Lady Macbeth's resolve? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene V suggests about Lady Macbeth's resolve. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act I, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Lady Macbeth's resolve responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Lady Macbeth's resolve follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene V and its treatment of Lady Macbeth's resolve. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about Lady Macbeth's resolve in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *To beguile the time, Look like the time; bear welcome in your eye, Your hand, your tongue: look like the innocent flower, But be the serpent under't.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “beguile” most nearly mean?

   A. invisible

   B. supernatural; beyond the physical world

   C. to deceive; to fool

   D. gets in the way of; hinders

2. *Give him tending; He brings great news. Exit Messenger. The raven himself is hoarse That croaks the fatal entrance of Duncan Under my battlements. Come, you spirits That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here, And fill me from the crown to the toe top-full Of direst cruelty! make thick my blood; Stop up the access and passage to remorse, That no compunctious visitings of nature Shake my fell purpose, nor keep peace between The effect and it! Come to my woman's breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless substances You wait on nature's mischief! Come, thick night, And pall thee in the dunnest smoke of hell, That my keen knife see not the wound it makes, Nor heaven peep through the blanket of the dark, To cry “Hold, hold!”*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene V"?

A. Lady Macbeth's resolve

B. A marriage drifting apart

C. The dagger of the mind

D. The Witches' riddling world

SAT key: 1. C (to deceive; to fool); 2. A (Lady Macbeth's resolve)

Lesson 8: Act I, Scene VI

Focus: dramatic irony at the castle gate

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act I, Scene VI (dramatic irony at the castle gate) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Duncan and Banquo arrive at Inverness and praise the castle's pleasant seat and sweet air, where the martlet nests. Lady Macbeth welcomes the king with elaborate courtesy, saying all she and her household have is his. Duncan asks to be taken to his host, whom he loves highly.

Background: Hospitality was a sacred duty: killing a guest under one's roof violated religious and social law, which makes the coming murder doubly monstrous to the audience.

Significance: The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....
Prompt: When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: a welcoming home that is a death-trap.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Hospitality was a sacred duty: killing a guest under one's roof violated religious and social law, which makes the coming murder doubly monstrous to the audience. The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows. Dramatic irony: Duncan praises the castle's "pleasant seat" and sweet air; the audience knows it is a trap. Imagery: The martlet nesting in the castle's walls: an image of peace and trust. Characterization: Lady Macbeth's elaborate courtesy hides her intent. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "Where's the thane of Cawdor? / We coursed him at the heels, and had a" (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan).

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes dramatic irony at the castle gate. Key takeaway: a welcoming home that is a death-trap.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Duncan praises the castle's "pleasant seat" and sweet air; the audience knows it is a trap.
- **Imagery:** The martlet nesting in the castle's walls: an image of peace and trust.
- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth's elaborate courtesy hides her intent.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** a welcoming home that is a death-trap.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Where’s the thane of Cawdor? / We coursed him at the heels, and had a” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan).
- **equivocation:** "Fair is foul": appearances and words that mean two things, from the witches to the Porter to the prophecies. In this scene: “his spur, hath holp him / To his home before us. Fair and noble hostess, / We are your guest to-night” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan) Duncan's innocence.
- “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo) Banquo's image of nature and holiness.
- “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth) Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes.
Evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo)
Reasoning: He says "this castle hath a pleasant seat," and Banquo describes "the temple-haunting martlet" nesting there, images of peace in the place of murder.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
purveyor (noun)	an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging	*We coursed him at the heels, and had a purpose To be his purveyor: but he rides well; And his great love, sharp as his spur, hath holp him To his home before us.*	
recommends (verb)	presents (itself) pleasantly	*This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself Unto our gentle senses.*	"recommends": Origin of "recommend": Old French recommender. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/recommend#Etymology)
sometime (adverb)	sometimes; at times	*The love that follows us sometime is our trouble, Which still we thank as love.*	"sometime": Origin: an English formation from some + time. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/sometime#Etymology)
hostess (noun)	a woman who receives and entertains guests	*Fair and noble hostess, We are your guest to-night.*	"hostess": Origin: Middle French hostesse; earlier Old French ostesce. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/hostess#Etymology)
coursed (verb)	chased; followed closely	*We coursed him at the heels, and had a purpose To be his purveyor: but he rides well; And his great love, sharp as his spur, hath holp him To his home before us.*	

Discussion questions

1. When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whom does Duncan ask to be taken to at the end of the scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His host, Macbeth: 'Conduct me to mine host: we love him highly.'
2. How does Duncan describe the castle? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It has a pleasant seat and sweet air
3. Which bird does Banquo say nests at the castle? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The martlet
4. Who welcomes Duncan at the gate? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lady Macbeth
5. What does Lady Macbeth say about her household? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Everything they have is the king's to command
6. Why is this scene full of dramatic irony? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The audience knows of the murder plan that the king does not
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene VI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Duncan and Banquo arrive at Inverness and praise the castle's pleasant seat and sweet air, where the martlet nests. Lady Macbeth welcomes the king with elaborate courtesy, saying all she and her household have is his. Duncan asks to be taken to his host, whom he loves highly.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene VI", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene VI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "We coursed him at the heels, and had a purpose To be his purveyor: but he rides well; And his great love, sharp as his spur, hath holp him To his home before us." What does "purveyor" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: purveyor: an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging.

Inferential / analytical

1. How does the martlet image contrast with the raven Lady Macbeth mentioned in Scene V? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Peaceful, trusting nature versus an omen of death; the same castle seen two ways.
2. What does "Act I, Scene VI" suggest about dramatic irony at the castle gate? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the setting in this scene shape what we understand about dramatic irony at the castle gate? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan): Duncan's innocence. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “See, see, our honour’d hostess!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene VI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Duncan and Banquo arrive at Inverness and praise the castle's pleasant seat and sweet air, where the martlet nests. Lady Macbeth welcomes the king with elaborate courtesy, saying all she and her household have is his. Duncan asks to be taken to his host, whom he loves highly.
7. How does “Act I, Scene VI” build on “Act I, Scene V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's elaborate courtesy hides her intent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan): Duncan's innocence. On imagery: The martlet nesting in the castle's walls: an image of peace and trust. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should a director make Lady Macbeth's welcome sound sincere or forced? Defend your choice. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A staging decision justified by the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan): Duncan's innocence. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's elaborate courtesy hides her intent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene VI”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of dramatic irony at the castle gate. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A

judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan): Duncan's innocence. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene VI” treats dramatic irony at the castle gate with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene VII” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan): Duncan's innocence. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about dramatic irony at the castle gate? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 15? “True, worthy Banquo; he is full so valiant, And in his _____ I am fed; It is a banquet to me.”
   A. service
   B. themselves
   C. deserved
   D. commendations

   Key: D (commendations)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth: “All our _____ / In every point twice done and then done double”

   Key: service
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why is this scene full of dramatic irony?
   A. Lady Macbeth confesses
   B. The king suspects the Macbeths
   C. The audience knows of the murder plan that the king does not
   D. Banquo warns the king

   Key: C (The audience knows of the murder plan that the king does not)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Fair and noble hostess, We are your guest to-night.”, what does “hostess” most nearly mean?
   A. formally given the office and crown of king
   B. a woman who receives and entertains guests
   C. a stone for sharpening blades
   D. blows in battle

   Key: B (a woman who receives and entertains guests)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who welcomes Duncan at the gate?
   A. Lady Macbeth
   B. Macbeth
   C. The Porter
   D. Banquo

   Key: A (Lady Macbeth)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “The love that follows us sometime is our trouble, Which still we thank as love.”, what does “sometime” most nearly mean?
   A. announced loudly; proclaimed
   B. bragging
   C. sometimes; at times
   D. flags carried by an army

   Key: C (sometimes; at times)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "We _____ him at the heels, and had a purpose To be his purveyor: but he rides well; And his great love, sharp as his spur, hath holp him To his home before us." Word bank: recommends, sometime, coursed, purveyor
   Key: coursed

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which bird does Banquo say nests at the castle?
   A. The martlet
   B. The raven
   C. The owl
   D. The falcon

   Key: A (The martlet)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "We coursed him at the heels, and had a purpose To be his purveyor: but he rides well; And his great love, sharp as his spur, hath holp him To his home before us.", what does "purveyor" most nearly mean?
   A. an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging
   B. a bold or risky undertaking
   C. to declare guilty
   D. flags carried by an army

   Key: A (an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 7 reveal about the character or situation? "Would thou hadst less deserved, That the proportion both of thanks and payment Might have been mine! only I have left to say, More is thy due than more than all can pay." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 7) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. The words "proportion" and "deserved" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act I, Scene V?
    A. "Thou'rt mad to say it: Is not thy master with him? who, were't so, Would have inform'd for preparation."
    B. "They met me in the day of success: and I have learned by the perfectest report, they have more in them than mortal knowledge."
    C. "Whiles I stood rapt in the wonder of it, came missives from the king, who all-hailed me 'Thane of Cawdor"
    D. "When I burned in desire to question them further, they made themselves air, into which they vanished."

    Key: B ("They met me in the day of success: and I have learned by the perfectest report, they have more in them than mortal knowledge.")

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act I, Scene VI?
    A. "Give me your hand; Conduct me to mine host: we love him highly, And shall continue our graces towards him."
    B. "Herein I teach you How you shall bid God 'ild us for your pains, And thank us for your trouble."
    C. "Enter Duncan, Malcolm, Donalbain, Banquo, Lennox, Macduff, Ross, Angus, and Attendants."

D. “Your servants ever Have theirs, themselves and what is theirs, in compt, To make their audit at your highness’ pleasure, Still to return…”

Key: C (“Enter Duncan, Malcolm, Donalbain, Banquo, Lennox, Macduff, Ross, Angus, and Attendants.”)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Banquo's image of nature and holiness. The evidence is “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo). This develops appearance and reality: a welcoming home that is a death-trap.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene V, paragraph 7 shapes its tone: “Thou’rt mad to say it: Is not thy master with him? who, were’t so, Would have inform’d for preparation.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “preparation” and “inform” (Act I, Scene V, paragraph 7) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. The evidence is “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth). This develops appearance and reality: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. The words “service” and “double” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how appearance and reality develops from Act I, Scene IV to Act I, Scene VI. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Act I, Scene IV, Duncan, the text reads “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” — Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. In Act I, Scene VI, “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan) — Duncan's innocence. A welcoming home that is a death-trap.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth say about her household?

A. They wish he had not come

B. They are too poor to host him

C. Everything they have is the king's to command

D. They will leave for Fife

Key: C (Everything they have is the king's to command)

18. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Duncan ask to be taken to at the end of the scene?
Sample answer: His host, Macbeth: 'Conduct me to mine host: we love him highly.'

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does the martlet image contrast with the raven Lady Macbeth mentioned in Scene V?
Sample answer: Peaceful, trusting nature versus an omen of death; the same castle seen two ways. The evidence is “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo) — Banquo's image of nature and holiness.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: “From hence to Inverness, And bind us further to you.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “further” (Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral.

That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Should a director make Lady Macbeth's welcome sound sincere or forced? Defend your choice.
    Sample answer: A staging decision justified by the text. The evidence is “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan) — Duncan's innocence. This develops appearance and reality: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. He says "this castle hath a pleasant seat," and Banquo describes "the temple-haunting martlet" nesting there, images of peace in the place of murder.
22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene V, paragraph 8: “So please you, it is true: our thane is coming: One of my fellows had the speed of him, Who, almost dead for breath, had _____ more Than would make up his message.” Word bank: missives, dunnest, scarcely, perfectest
    Key: scarcely
23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene VI”? The martlet nesting in the castle's walls: an image of peace and trust.
    A. Point of view
    B. Conflict
    C. Imagery
    D. Hyperbole

    Key: C (Imagery)
24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Banquo's image of nature and holiness. The evidence is “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo). This develops appearance and reality: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. The words “haunting” and “martlet” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says "this castle hath a pleasant seat," and Banquo describes "the temple-haunting martlet" nesting there, images of peace in the place of murder.
25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene VI, Duncan: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly _____ itself”
    Key: recommends
26. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene VI”?
    A. The Witches' riddling world
    B. The tyrant's weakening grip
    C. Nature's revolt against the crime
    D. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

    Key: D (Dramatic irony at the castle gate)
27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene IV, paragraph 8: “The _____ and the loyalty I owe, In doing it, pays itself.” Word bank: service, deserved, commendations, themselves
    Key: service
28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Duncan describe the castle?
    A. It smells of smoke

B. It has a pleasant seat and sweet air

C. It is too small for his men

D. It is dark and cold

Key: B (It has a pleasant seat and sweet air)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo).

Sample answer: He says "this castle hath a pleasant seat," and Banquo describes "the temple-haunting martlet" nesting there, images of peace in the place of murder. The evidence is “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo) — Banquo's image of nature and holiness. This develops appearance and reality: a welcoming home that is a death-trap.

30. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene VI”? Duncan praises the castle's ‘pleasant seat’ and sweet air; the audience knows it is a trap.

A. Allusion

B. Hyperbole

C. Dramatic irony

D. Theme

Key: C (Dramatic irony)

31. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Duncan's innocence. The evidence is “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan). This develops appearance and reality: a welcoming home that is a death-trap.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	7, 17, 4, 5, 18, 2, 8, 6, 11, 12, 19, 13, 20, 14, 15, 21	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	22, 17, 7, 9, 8, 18, 5, 10, 11, 19, 12, 20, 14, 23, 24, 21	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 25, 7, 18, 3, 9, 10, 11, 26, 12, 19, 20, 14, 15, 16, 21	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Senior	27, 18, 7, 2, 28, 5, 10, 11, 12, 19, 20, 29, 30, 15, 21, 16	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
AP	25, 3, 28, 6, 7, 10, 11, 19, 12, 20, 14, 15, 23, 24, 16, 21	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Freshman	1, 22, 7, 4, 6, 10, 11, 19, 12, 20, 14, 15, 23, 21, 24, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	7, 25, 18, 3, 28, 10, 11, 19, 12, 13, 20, 14, 30, 15, 21, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
College Junior	7, 2, 28, 8, 10, 11, 12, 19, 31, 26, 20, 14, 15, 16, 21, 24	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Senior	7, 17, 4, 25, 28, 10, 11, 19, 12, 20, 14, 15, 29, 30, 21, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 2
Graduate / PhD	27, 1, 25, 5, 3, 10, 11, 12, 26, 19, 20, 14, 29, 15, 21, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene VI,” how does Shakespeare show dramatic irony at the castle gate? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene VI, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of dramatic irony at the castle gate? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene VI develops the idea of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene VI suggests about dramatic irony at the castle gate. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act I, Scene VI to complicate the reader's understanding of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of dramatic irony at the castle gate responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of dramatic irony at the castle gate follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene VI and its treatment of dramatic irony at the castle gate. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene VI as evidence for a larger claim about dramatic irony at the castle gate in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene VI as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *We coursed him at the heels, and had a purpose To be his purveyor: but he rides well; And his great love, sharp as his spur, hath holp him To his home before us.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "purveyor" most nearly mean?

   A. chased; followed closely

   B. an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging

   C. sometimes; at times

   D. a woman who receives and entertains guests

2. *See, see, our honour'd hostess! The love that follows us sometime is our trouble, Which still we thank as love. Herein I teach you How you shall bid God 'ild us for your pains, And thank us for your trouble.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene VI"?

   A. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

   B. Life as a tale told by an idiot

   C. The Witches' riddling world

   D. The decision to murder

SAT key: 1. B (an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging); 2. A (Dramatic irony at the castle gate)

Lesson 9: Act I, Scene VII

Focus: the decision to murder

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Act I, Scene VII" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (violence against an infant (image), alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Lady Macbeth says she would have dashed out her nursing baby's brains rather than break such an oath. It is a rhetorical image, not an event; discuss why she chooses it. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…ewest gloss, Not cast aside so soon. Was the hope drunk Wherein you dress'd yourself? hath it s…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: Lady Macbeth uses a shocking image of harming a baby to make a point.
Suggested language: "Why does she choose the most shocking image she can?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Alone during the feast, Macbeth weighs the murder ('If it were done when 'tis done'): Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest and a virtuous ruler, and 'bloody instructions' return to plague the inventor; he has only 'vaulting ambition.' He tells Lady Macbeth they will proceed no further. She attacks his manhood, says she would have dashed out her nursing baby's brains had she sworn to, and lays out the plan to drug the chamberlains and blame them. Macbeth agrees: 'False face must hide what the false heart doth know.'

Background: The soliloquy draws on Christian ideas of judgment ('the life to come') and on the belief that a king's murder upset the whole order of nature and heaven.

Significance: This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because.... Content note before we start: Lady Macbeth uses a shocking image of harming a baby to make a point.
Prompt: Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: she defines manhood as the will to murder.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: chalice — a ceremonial drinking cup; daggers — short knives used as weapons; ingredients — the parts that are mixed together to make something; fitness — suitability; readiness; compose — to make up; to form. "ingredients": Origin of "ingredient": Middle French ingredient; earlier Latin ingrediens. "compose": Origin: Old French composer ("to compose"); earlier Latin componere ("to put together").
Words: chalice: a ceremonial drinking cup · daggers: short knives used as weapons · ingredients: the parts that are mixed together to make something · fitness: suitability; readiness · compose: to make up; to form

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The soliloquy draws on Christian ideas of judgment ('the life to come') and on the belief that a king's murder upset the whole order of nature and heaven. This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible. Soliloquy: "If it were done when 'tis done": Macbeth reasons against the murder: Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest, and virtuous; the only spur is "vaulting ambition." Characterization: Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath. Imagery: Pity "like a naked new-born babe"; ambition as a rider vaulting over the saddle. Watch for blood: Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: "cases / We still have judgment here; that we but teach / Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return / To plague the inventor: this even-handed" (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "When you durst do it, then you were a man" slowly and put it in my own words: When Macbeth wants to abandon the plan, Lady Macbeth tells him that when he dared to do it, then he was a man. Next, craft. I notice she defines manhood as daring to kill, twisting the meaning of the word. The strongest word is "durst": it is the past of "dare," so courage becomes willingness to murder. Then, effect. How does Lady Macbeth attack Macbeth's manhood? My answer: She shames Macbeth into the murder by questioning his manhood; her taunt overcomes his doubts, showing her power over him at this stage.

> *When you durst do it, then you were a man* *(Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "When you durst do it, then you were a man" slowly and put it in my own words: When Macbeth wants to abandon the plan, Lady Macbeth tells him that when he dared to do it, then he was a man. Next, craft. I notice she defines manhood as daring to kill, twisting the meaning of the word. The strongest word is "durst": it is the past of "dare," so courage becomes willingness to murder. Then, effect. How does Lady Macbeth attack Macbeth's manhood? My answer: She shames Macbeth into the murder by questioning his manhood; her taunt overcomes his doubts, showing her power over him at this stage.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Vaulting ambition" pictures a rider jumping too far and falling; it predicts his fall. Masculinity and power. Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected: She defines manhood as the will to murder. (Macbeth admits his only motive.)

> *I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Vaulting ambition" pictures a rider jumping too far and falling; it predicts his fall. Masculinity and power.
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected answer: She defines manhood as the will to murder. (Macbeth admits his only motive.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the decision to murder? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene VII develops the idea of the decision to murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. When the text says "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth), it shows this directly. In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.
Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the decision to murder? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene VII develops the idea of the decision to murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. When the text says "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth), it shows this directly. In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you? Ask: who is more responsible for the murder, Macbeth or Lady Macbeth?
Anchor question: Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you?
Facilitation: Ask: who is more responsible for the murder, Macbeth or Lady Macbeth?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the decision to murder? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. ("When you durst do it, then you were a man", Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the decision to murder? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. ("When you durst do it, then you were a man", Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how soliloquy shapes the decision to murder. Key takeaway: she defines manhood as the will to murder.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** "If it were done when 'tis done": Macbeth reasons against the murder: Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest, and virtuous; the only spur is "vaulting ambition."
- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath.
- **Imagery:** Pity "like a naked new-born babe"; ambition as a rider vaulting over the saddle.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** she defines manhood as the will to murder.

Symbols and motifs

- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: "cases / We still have judgment here; that we but teach / Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return / To plague the inventor: this even-handed" (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth).
- **sleep:** Sleep is innocence and restoration; Macbeth "does murder sleep" and Lady Macbeth walks in hers. In this scene: "Was the hope drunk / Wherein you dress'd yourself? hath it slept since? / And wakes it now, to look so green and pale" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition" (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth) Macbeth admits his only motive.

- "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth) Lady Macbeth's attack.
- "We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we'll not fail" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth) Her resolve.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood.
Evidence: "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth)
Reasoning: In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
chalice (noun)	a ceremonial drinking cup	*But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips.*	
daggers (noun)	short knives used as weapons	*Will it not be received, When we have mark'd with blood those sleepy two Of his own chamber and used their very daggers, That they have done't?*	
ingredients (noun)	the parts that are mixed together to make something	*But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips.*	"ingredients": Origin of "ingredient": Middle French ingredient; earlier Latin ingrediens. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ingredient#Etymology)
fitness (noun)	suitability; readiness	*Nor time nor place Did then adhere, and yet you would make both: They have made themselves, and that their fitness now Does unmake you.*	
compose (verb)	to make up; to form	*Bring forth men-children only; For thy undaunted mettle should compose Nothing but males.*	"compose": Origin: Old French composer ("to compose"); earlier Latin componere ("to put together"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/compose#Etymology)
ornament (noun)	the thing that gives honor or	*Wouldst thou have that Which thou esteem'st the ornament of life, And live*	"ornament": Origin: Old French ornement; earlier Latin ornamentum

	beauty; here, the crown	*a coward in thine own esteem, Letting "I dare not" wait upon "I would,"*	("equipment"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ornament#Etymology)
enterprise (noun)	a bold or risky undertaking	*What beast was't, then, That made you break this enterprise to me?*	"enterprise": Origin: Middle French entreprise. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/enterprise#Etymology)
inventor (noun)	the person who first devised something	*But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips.*	
undaunted (adjective)	fearless; not discouraged	*Bring forth men-children only; For thy undaunted mettle should compose Nothing but males.*	
sticking (adjective)	clinging to; refusing to come off (like blood)	*But screw your courage to the sticking-place, And we'll not fail.*	

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Lady Macbeth tell Macbeth to 'screw' to the sticking-place? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His courage.
2. Which relationships does Macbeth say make the murder doubly wrong? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He is Duncan's kinsman, subject and host
3. What is the only spur Macbeth says he has? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Vaulting ambition

4. What does Macbeth first tell Lady Macbeth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: We will proceed no further in this business
5. How does Lady Macbeth attack Macbeth's resolve? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She calls him a coward and questions his manhood
6. What is the plan for blaming the murder? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Drug the chamberlains and mark them with blood
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene VII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Alone during the feast, Macbeth weighs the murder ('If it were done when 'tis done'): Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest and a virtuous ruler, and 'bloody instructions' return to plague the inventor; he has only 'vaulting ambition.' He tells Lady Macbeth they will proceed no further. She attacks his manhood, says she would have dashed out her nursing baby's brains had she sworn to, and lays…
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene VII", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene VII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our…" What does "chalice" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: chalice: a ceremonial drinking cup.

Inferential / analytical

1. Macbeth imagines Duncan's virtues pleading 'like angels, trumpet-tongued.' What does this image show about his conscience? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: He feels the murder as a cosmic, damnable act that heaven will expose.
2. Why does Lady Macbeth's argument about manhood work when Macbeth's moral reasons were stronger? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: She ties his identity and her love to the deed.
3. What does "Act I, Scene VII" suggest about the decision to murder? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible.
4. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
5. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about the decision to murder? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: "I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition" (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth): Macbeth admits his only motive. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. In the passage that begins “Was the hope drunk Wherein you dress’d yourself?”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene VII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Alone during the feast, Macbeth weighs the murder ('If it were done when 'tis done'): Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest and a virtuous ruler, and 'bloody instructions' return to plague the inventor; he has only 'vaulting ambition.' He tells Lady Macbeth they will proceed no further. She attacks…
8. How does “Act I, Scene VII” build on “Act I, Scene VI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's attack. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth): Her resolve. On characterization: Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Who bears more responsibility for Duncan's murder, Macbeth or Lady Macbeth? Use evidence from I.v and I.vii. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned judgment of shared responsibility.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth): Macbeth admits his only motive. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's attack. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth): Her resolve. On characterization: Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene VII”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the decision to murder. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth): Macbeth admits his only motive. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene VII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's attack. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth): Her resolve. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “I have no spur / To prick the

sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition" (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth): Macbeth admits his only motive. On imagery: Pity "like a naked new-born babe"; ambition as a rider vaulting over the saddle. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Act I, Scene VII" treats the decision to murder with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's attack. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act II, Scene I" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: "We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we'll not fail" (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth): Her resolve. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the decision to murder? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: "I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition" (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth): Macbeth admits his only motive. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the _____: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips." Word bank: inventor, daggers, chalice, ingredients

   Key: inventor

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Bring forth men-children only; For thy undaunted mettle should _____ Nothing but males." Word bank: chalice, daggers,

compose, ingredients

Key: compose

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “What beast was’t, then, That made you break this _____ to me?” Word bank: chalice, enterprise, daggers, ingredients

   Key: enterprise

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the only spur Macbeth says he has?

   A. Revenge
   B. Vaulting ambition
   C. Love for his wife
   D. Fear of the Witches

   Key: B (Vaulting ambition)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth: “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting _____”

   Key: ambition

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which relationships does Macbeth say make the murder doubly wrong?

   A. He is Malcolm's teacher
   B. He is Banquo's friend and brother
   C. He is Duncan's son, heir and doctor
   D. He is Duncan's kinsman, subject and host

   Key: D (He is Duncan's kinsman, subject and host)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Lady Macbeth attack Macbeth's resolve?

   A. She offers to tell the king
   B. She threatens to leave him
   C. She calls him a coward and questions his manhood
   D. She calls on the Witches

   Key: C (She calls him a coward and questions his manhood)

8. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth tell Macbeth to 'screw' to the sticking-place?

   Sample answer: His courage.

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth first tell Lady Macbeth?

   A. Banquo must die first
   B. We will proceed no further in this business
   C. He will kill Duncan at dawn
   D. The deed is done

   Key: B (We will proceed no further in this business)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the plan for blaming the murder?

    A. Blame Malcolm
    B. Blame the Norwegians
    C. Blame Banquo

D. Drug the chamberlains and mark them with blood

Key: D (Drug the chamberlains and mark them with blood)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth: “We fail! / But screw your courage to the _____-place, / And we’ll not fail”

    Key: sticking

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene VII”?

    A. The prophecies and their pull

    B. The decision to murder

    C. The tyrant's end and a new order

    D. The murder and its first guilt

    Key: B (The decision to murder)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Lady Macbeth's attack. The evidence is “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she defines manhood as the will to murder.

14. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Lady Macbeth's argument about manhood work when Macbeth's moral reasons were stronger?

    Sample answer: She ties his identity and her love to the deed. The evidence is “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth) — Lady Macbeth's attack.

15. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Macbeth imagines Duncan's virtues pleading 'like angels, trumpet-tongued.' What does this image show about his conscience?

    Sample answer: He feels the murder as a cosmic, damnable act that heaven will expose. The evidence is “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth) — Macbeth admits his only motive.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth) supports it: In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields. But “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth) complicates it: Macbeth admits his only motive, and its “no” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Will it not be received, When we have mark’d with blood those sleepy two Of his own chamber and used their very daggers, That they have done’t?”, what does “daggers” most nearly mean?

    A. thin lines (of light)

    B. based on guesswork

    C. short knives used as weapons

    D. it seems to me

    Key: C (short knives used as weapons)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act I, Scene VII, paragraph 9? “We will proceed no further in this _____: He hath honour’d me of late; and I have bought Golden opinions from all sorts of people, Which would be worn now in their newest gloss, Not cast aside so soon.”

    A. afeard

    B. chamberlains

    C. tender

    D. business

    Key: D (business)

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act I, Scene VII?

    A. “He’s here in double trust; First, as I am his kinsman and his subject, Strong both against the deed; then, as his host, Who should against…”

    B. “If it were done when ’tis done, then ’twere well It were done quickly”

    C. “Besides, this Duncan Hath borne his faculties so meek, hath been So clear in his great office, that his virtues Will plead like angels,…”

    D. “Enter a Sewer, and divers Servants with dishes and service, and pass over the stage.”

    Key: D (“Enter a Sewer, and divers Servants with dishes and service, and pass over the stage.”)

20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene VII”? If it were done when 'tis done': Macbeth reasons against the murder: Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest, and virtuous; the only spur is ‘vaulting ambition.

    A. Point of view

    B. Foreshadowing

    C. Soliloquy

    D. Personification

    Key: C (Soliloquy)

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act I, Scene VII, paragraph 3 shapes its tone: “If it were done when ’tis done, then ’twere well It were done quickly” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “quickly” (Act I, Scene VII, paragraph 3) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: she defines manhood as the will to murder. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Lady Macbeth's attack. The evidence is “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she defines manhood as the will to murder. The words “durst” and “were” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Nor time nor place Did then adhere, and yet you would make both: They have made themselves, and that their fitness now Does unmake you.”, what does “fitness” most nearly mean?

    A. people who swear oaths

    B. a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming

    C. suitability; readiness

    D. to decide; to settle

    Key: C (suitability; readiness)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Wouldst thou have that Which thou esteem’st the _____ of life, And live a coward in thine own esteem, Letting ‘I dare not’ wait upon ‘I would,’” Word bank: ornament, ingredients, chalice, daggers

    Key: ornament

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act I, Scene VII, paragraph 16 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “Who dares receive it other, As we shall make our griefs and clamour roar Upon his death?” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act I, Scene VII, paragraph 16) develops guilt and conscience: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Its words “clamour” and “receive” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Away, and mock the time with fairest show: False face must hide what the false heart doth know.” (Act I, Scene VII, paragraph 17), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene VII, paragraph 12: “I have given suck, and know How _____ ’tis to love the babe that milks me” Word bank: service, sightless, corporal, tender

    Key: tender

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth).

    Sample answer: In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields. The evidence is “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth) — Lady Macbeth's attack. This develops masculinity and power: she defines manhood as the will to murder.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Who bears more responsibility for Duncan's murder, Macbeth or Lady Macbeth? Use evidence from I.v and I.vii.

    Sample answer: A reasoned judgment of shared responsibility. The evidence is “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth) — Macbeth admits his only motive. This develops masculinity and power: she defines manhood as the will to murder. In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.

29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene VII”? Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath.

    A. Irony

    B. Characterization

    C. Diction / vocabulary

D. Tone / mood

Key: B (Characterization)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act I, Scene VII, paragraph 10 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “Was the hope drunk Wherein you dress’d yourself? hath it slept since?” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Act I, Scene VII, paragraph 10) develops masculinity, power and violence: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Its words “yourself” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Prithee, peace: I dare do all that may become a man; Who dares do more is none.” (Act I, Scene VII, paragraph 11), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene VII, paragraph 2: “Enter a Sewer, and divers Servants with dishes and _____, and pass over the stage.” Word bank: chamberlains, murderer, service, afeard
Key: service

32. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth)
A. His followers obey from fear.
B. Macbeth admits his only motive.
C. He knows it is imaginary.
D. Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight.
Key: B (Macbeth admits his only motive.)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how masculinity and power develops from Act I, Scene V to Act I, Scene VII. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth, the text reads “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way”, which shows her judgment of her husband. In Act I, Scene VII, “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth) — Macbeth admits his only motive. She defines manhood as the will to murder.

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze the word choice in “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Her resolve. The evidence is “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she defines manhood as the will to murder. The words “sticking” and “courage” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Macbeth admits his only motive. The evidence is “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she defines manhood as the will to murder. The words “ambition” and “intent” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.

36. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Macbeth admits his only motive. The evidence is “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth).

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 4, analysis 0, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 6, 9, 1, 8, 11, 10, 4, 18, 5, 19, 14, 15, 20, 21, 22	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	9, 1, 4, 23, 24, 10, 5, 6, 3, 19, 15, 14, 12, 21, 25, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 1, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 6, 2, 3, 17, 9, 23, 26, 19, 14, 12, 15, 21, 27, 28, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Senior	6, 9, 17, 23, 3, 18, 26, 5, 15, 14, 19, 29, 21, 22, 30, 28	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 3
AP	17, 31, 18, 24, 19, 15, 32, 14, 21, 29, 22, 30, 25, 16, 28, 33	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 6
College Freshman	24, 2, 17, 15, 14, 19, 32, 29, 21, 34, 33, 25, 30, 22, 28, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 6
College Sophomore	6, 1, 23, 24, 15, 19, 14, 21, 29, 22, 35, 25, 33, 16, 28, 30	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 7
College Junior	2, 24, 17, 19, 15, 32, 14, 34, 29, 27, 21, 30, 28, 16, 25, 33	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	2, 7, 24, 18, 19, 12, 15, 36, 14, 27, 21, 25, 33, 28, 30, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	23, 6, 31, 11, 19, 15, 14, 29, 21, 27, 30, 16, 33, 35, 25, 28	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene VII,” how does Shakespeare show the decision to murder? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene VII, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the decision to murder? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene VII develops the idea of the decision to murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene VII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the decision to murder. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene VII suggests about the decision to murder. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act I, Scene VII to complicate the reader's understanding of the decision to murder. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene VII within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the decision to murder responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene VII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the decision to murder follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene VII and its treatment of the decision to murder. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene VII as evidence for a larger claim about the decision to murder in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene VII as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the decision to murder. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips.*

As used in the text, what does the word "ingredients" most nearly mean?

A. clinging to; refusing to come off (like blood)

B. the person who first devised something

C. fearless; not discouraged

D. the parts that are mixed together to make something

2. *Was the hope drunk Wherein you dress'd yourself? hath it slept since? And wakes it now, to look so green and pale At what it did so freely? From this time Such I account thy love. Art thou afeard To be the same in thine own act and valour As thou art in desire? Wouldst thou have that Which thou esteem'st the ornament of life, And live a coward in thine own esteem, Letting "I dare not" wait upon "I would," Like the poor cat i' the adage?*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene VII"?

A. The last false confidence

B. The decision to murder

C. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

D. The dagger of the mind

SAT key: 1. D (the parts that are mixed together to make something); 2. B (The decision to murder)

Lesson 10: Act II, Scene I

Focus: the dagger of the mind

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Act II, Scene I" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…Banquo and Fleance. Go bid thy mistress, when my drink is ready, She strike upon the bell. Get…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

After midnight Banquo, unable to sleep, tells Fleance of 'cursed thoughts' and gives Macbeth a diamond from the king for Lady Macbeth. Banquo mentions dreaming of the Witches; Macbeth claims he does not think of them and hints at future honor if Banquo will 'cleave to my consent'; Banquo agrees only if he keeps his allegiance clear. Alone, Macbeth sees a dagger in the air leading him to Duncan, wonders if it is 'a dagger of the mind', and goes when the bell rings: 'Hear it not, Duncan; for it is a knell.'

Background: Plays at the Globe were performed in daylight, so night had to be created by words: references to darkness, torches and the bell signal the hour.

Significance: The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, a pattern the play repeats with Banquo's ghost.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: dudgeon — the handle of a dagger; allegiance — loyalty owed to a ruler; husbandry — thrift; careful saving; palpable — able to be touched or felt; augment — to increase. “allegiance”: Origin: Anglo-Norman alegaunce. “husbandry”: Origin: an English formation from husband + -ry. “palpable”: Origin: Middle French palpable; earlier Latin palpābilis. “augment”: Origin: Middle French augmenter; earlier Old French augmenter.
Words: dudgeon: the handle of a dagger · allegiance: loyalty owed to a ruler · husbandry: thrift; careful saving · palpable: able to be touched or felt · augment: to increase

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Plays at the Globe were performed in daylight, so night had to be created by words: references to darkness, torches and the bell signal the hour. The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, a pattern the play repeats with Banquo's ghost. Soliloquy: The dagger speech: Macbeth sees a dagger "of the mind," then real blood on it; he cannot tell imagination from reality. Dialogue: Banquo admits dreaming of the weird sisters; Macbeth lies ("I think not of them") and hints at reward for support. Imagery: Night, witchcraft, Tarquin's "ravishing strides": the world of the murder. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “earth, / Hear not my steps, which way they walk, for fear / Thy very stones prate of my whereabout, / And take the present” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” slowly and put it in my own words: Alone before the murder, Macbeth sees a dagger floating in the air, its handle toward his hand. Next, craft. I notice the question he asks himself, which shows he cannot tell what is real. The strongest word is “dagger”: it is the weapon he is about to use, now appearing as a vision. Then, effect. What does the dagger vision show about Macbeth's mind? My answer: His mind is already guilty and disturbed; the dagger leads him toward Duncan's room, as if his imagination is pulling him into the crime.

> *Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand* (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” slowly and put it in my own words: Alone before the murder, Macbeth sees a dagger floating in the air, its handle toward his hand. Next, craft. I notice the question he asks himself, which shows he cannot tell what is real. The strongest word is “dagger”: it is the weapon he is about to use, now appearing as a vision. Then, effect. What does the dagger vision show about Macbeth's mind? My answer: His mind is already guilty and disturbed; the dagger leads him toward Duncan's room, as if his imagination is pulling him into the crime.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Heat-oppressed brain" means a feverish mind: the vision is guilt. Expected link: guilt and conscience. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected: Guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. (He knows it is imaginary.)

> *A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain* (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Heat-oppressed brain" means a feverish mind: the vision is guilt. Expected link: guilt and conscience.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected answer: Guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. (He knows it is imaginary.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for soliloquy, dialogue (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the dagger of the mind? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of the dagger of the mind. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. When the text says "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth), it shows this directly. He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done."
Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, dialogue (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the dagger of the mind? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of the dagger of the mind. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. When the text says "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth), it shows this directly. He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there? Ask: should a production show the dagger? Argue from the text.
Anchor question: Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there?
Facilitation: Ask: should a production show the dagger? Argue from the text.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the dagger of the mind? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. (“A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain”, Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the dagger of the mind? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. (“A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain”, Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how soliloquy shapes the dagger of the mind. Key takeaway: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** The dagger speech: Macbeth sees a dagger "of the mind," then real blood on it; he cannot tell imagination from reality.
- **Dialogue:** Banquo admits dreaming of the weird sisters; Macbeth lies ("I think not of them") and hints at reward for support.
- **Imagery:** Night, witchcraft, Tarquin's "ravishing strides": the world of the murder.

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “earth, / Hear not my steps, which way they walk, for fear / Thy very stones prate of my whereabout, / And take the present” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “What, sir, not yet at rest? The king’s a-bed: / He hath been in unusual pleasure, and / Sent forth great” (Act II, Scene I, Banquo).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) The hallucination.
- "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) He knows it is imaginary.
- "I go, and it is done; the bell invites me" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) Decision.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills.
Evidence: "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth)
Reasoning: He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
dudgeon (noun)	the handle of a dagger	*Mine eyes are made the fools o' the other senses, Or else worth all the rest; I see thee still, And on thy blade and dudgeon gouts of blood, Which was not so before.*	
allegiance (noun)	loyalty owed to a ruler	*So I lose none In seeking to augment it, but still keep My bosom franchised and allegiance clear, I shall be counsell'd.*	"allegiance": Origin: Anglo-Norman alegaunce. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/allegiance#Etymology)
husbandry (noun)	thrift; careful saving	*There's husbandry in heaven; Their candles are all out.*	"husbandry": Origin: an English formation from husband + -ry. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/husbandry#Etymology)
palpable (adjective)	able to be touched or felt	*I see thee yet, in form as palpable As this which now I draw.*	"palpable": Origin: Middle French palpable; earlier Latin palpābilis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/palpable#Etymology)
augment (verb)	to increase	*So I lose none In seeking to augment it, but still keep My bosom franchised and allegiance clear, I shall be counsell'd.*	"augment": Origin: Middle French augmenter; earlier Old French augmenter. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/augment#Etymology)

whereabout (noun)	the place where someone is	*Thou sure and firm-set earth, Hear not my steps, which way they walk, for fear Thy very stones prate of my whereabout, And take the present horror from the time, Which now suits with it.*	
largess (noun)	generous gifts of money	*The king's a-bed: He hath been in unusual pleasure, and Sent forth great largess to your offices.*	
measureless (adjective)	without limit	*This diamond he greets your wife withal, By the name of most kind hostess; and shut up In measureless content.*	
invites (verb)	calls (someone) to come	*I go, and it is done; the bell invites me.*	
summons (noun)	a call to come or act	*A heavy summons lies like lead upon me, And yet I would not sleep: merciful powers, Restrain in me the cursed thoughts that nature Gives way to in repose!*	

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Macbeth say the bell is to Duncan? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A knell that summons him to heaven or to hell.
2. Why can Banquo not sleep? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He is troubled by cursed thoughts
3. What gift does Banquo pass on from Duncan to Lady Macbeth? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A diamond

4. What does Macbeth see before him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A dagger leading him toward Duncan's chamber
5. Under what condition will Banquo support Macbeth? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: If he loses no honor and keeps his allegiance clear
6. What signal tells Macbeth to act? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A bell
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: After midnight Banquo, unable to sleep, tells Fleance of 'cursed thoughts' and gives Macbeth a diamond from the king for Lady Macbeth. Banquo mentions dreaming of the Witches; Macbeth claims he does not think of them and hints at future honor if Banquo will 'cleave to my consent'; Banquo agrees only if he keeps his allegiance clear. Alone, Macbeth sees a dagger in the air leading him to Duncan,…
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Mine eyes are made the fools o' the other senses, Or else worth all the rest; I see thee still, And on thy blade and dudgeon gouts of blood, Which was not so before." What does "dudgeon" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: dudgeon: the handle of a dagger.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macbeth ask 'Is this a dagger which I see before me'? What does his uncertainty reveal? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: His mind is overheated by guilt; he cannot tell imagination from reality.
2. What does "Act II, Scene I" suggest about the dagger of the mind? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, a pattern the play repeats with Banquo's ghost.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the dagger of the mind? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Hold, take my sword.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: After midnight Banquo, unable to sleep, tells Fleance of 'cursed thoughts' and gives Macbeth a diamond from the king for Lady Macbeth. Banquo mentions dreaming of the Witches; Macbeth claims he does not think of them and hints at future honor if Banquo will 'cleave to my consent'; Banquo agrees…
7. How does “Act II, Scene I” build on “Act I, Scene VII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): He knows it is imaginary. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): Decision. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with appearance versus reality? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should the dagger be shown on stage, or left invisible? Which choice better serves the play? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A staging argument tied to the open question of the supernatural.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): He knows it is imaginary. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, a pattern the play repeats with Banquo's ghost.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): Decision. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the dagger of the mind. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): He knows it is imaginary. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): Decision. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria

and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): He knows it is imaginary. On imagery: Night, witchcraft, Tarquin's "ravishing strides": the world of the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene I” treats the dagger of the mind with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): Decision. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the dagger of the mind? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth): He knows it is imaginary. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth see before him?

   A. The Witches

   B. A dagger leading him toward Duncan's chamber

   C. Banquo's ghost

D. A crown in the air

Key: B (A dagger leading him toward Duncan's chamber)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene I, Macbeth: "Is this a _____ which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand"

   Key: dagger

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Mine eyes are made the fools o' the other senses, Or else worth all the rest; I see thee still, And on thy blade and dudgeon gouts of blood, Which was not so before.", what does "dudgeon" most nearly mean?

   A. birds of the crow family

   B. without equal

   C. the handle of a dagger

   D. offenders

   Key: C (the handle of a dagger)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "This diamond he greets your wife withal, By the name of most kind hostess; and shut up In _____ content." Word bank: measureless, dudgeon, husbandry, allegiance

   Key: measureless

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "There's husbandry in heaven; Their candles are all out.", what does "husbandry" most nearly mean?

   A. judgments; opinions

   B. thrift; careful saving

   C. kinsmen; relatives (here, Duncan's sons)

   D. that hunts mice

   Key: B (thrift; careful saving)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Thou sure and firm-set earth, Hear not my steps, which way they walk, for fear Thy very stones prate of my _____, And take the present horror from the time, Which now suits with it." Word bank: dudgeon, husbandry, whereabout, allegiance

   Key: whereabout

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "I see thee yet, in form as palpable As this which now I draw.", what does "palpable" most nearly mean?

   A. containers

   B. stubborn and self-willed

   C. able to be touched or felt

   D. a trap for catching birds

   Key: C (able to be touched or felt)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What gift does Banquo pass on from Duncan to Lady Macbeth?

   A. A sword

   B. A diamond

   C. A letter

D. A crown

Key: B (A diamond)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say the bell is to Duncan?
   Sample answer: A knell that summons him to heaven or to hell.
10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The king's a-bed: He hath been in unusual pleasure, and Sent forth great _____ to your offices." Word bank: largess, dudgeon, husbandry, allegiance
    Key: largess
11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why can Banquo not sleep?
    A. He is guarding the gate
    B. He is sick
    C. He hears the Witches singing
    D. He is troubled by cursed thoughts

    Key: D (He is troubled by cursed thoughts)
12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Macbeth ask 'Is this a dagger which I see before me'? What does his uncertainty reveal?
    Sample answer: His mind is overheated by guilt; he cannot tell imagination from reality. The evidence is "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) — The hallucination.
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The hallucination. The evidence is "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "I go, and it is done; the bell invites me" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Decision. The evidence is "I go, and it is done; the bell invites me" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. The words "invites" and "done" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in "Act II, Scene I"? Banquo admits dreaming of the weird sisters; Macbeth lies ('I think not of them') and hints at reward for support.
    A. Conflict
    B. Metaphor
    C. Dialogue
    D. Theme

    Key: C (Dialogue)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Should the dagger be shown on stage, or left invisible? Which choice better serves the play?
    Sample answer: A staging argument tied to the open question of the supernatural. The evidence is "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) — The hallucination. This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, /

Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done.".

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “So I lose none In seeking to _____ it, but still keep My bosom franchised and allegiance clear, I shall be counsell’d.” Word bank: augment, dudgeon, husbandry, allegiance

    Key: augment

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What signal tells Macbeth to act?

    A. A knock at the gate

    B. A bell

    C. An owl's scream

    D. A trumpet

    Key: B (A bell)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Under what condition will Banquo support Macbeth?

    A. If he is made Thane of Cawdor

    B. If Malcolm agrees

    C. If Fleance becomes king now

    D. If he loses no honor and keeps his allegiance clear

    Key: D (If he loses no honor and keeps his allegiance clear)

20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

    A. Fate and free will

    B. Appearance versus reality

    C. Ambition and its costs

    D. Guilt and conscience

    Key: D (Guilt and conscience)

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene I”? The dagger speech: Macbeth sees a dagger ‘of the mind,’ then real blood on it; he cannot tell imagination from reality.

    A. Plot

    B. Simile

    C. Soliloquy

    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: C (Soliloquy)

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: He knows it is imaginary. The evidence is “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. The words “oppressed” and “creation” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and

changing either would soften the effect. He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done.".

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene I, Macbeth: “I go, and it is done; the bell _____ me”

    Key: invites

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene I, paragraph 2: “Enter Banquo, and Fleance _____ a torch before him.” Word bank: sisters, bearing, threat, business

    Key: bearing

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act II, Scene I, paragraph 20 reveal about the character or situation? “Now o’er the one half-world Nature seems dead, and wicked dreams abuse The curtain’d sleep” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act II, Scene I, paragraph 20) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. The words “curtain” and “dreams” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act II, Scene I?

    A. “I think not of them: Yet, when we can entreat an hour to serve, We would spend it in some words upon that business, If you would grant the…”

    B. “If you shall cleave to my consent, when ’tis, It shall make honour for you.”

    C. “Go bid thy mistress, when my drink is ready, She strike upon the bell.”

    D. “I dreamt last night of the three weird sisters: To you they have show’d some truth.”

    Key: D (“I dreamt last night of the three weird sisters: To you they have show’d some truth.”)

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene I”?

    A. The guilt that will not wash away

    B. The apparitions and false security

    C. Suspicion spoken through irony

    D. The dagger of the mind

    Key: D (The dagger of the mind)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth).

    Sample answer: He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done.". The evidence is “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth), which shows he knows it is imaginary. This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act II, Scene I, paragraph 14 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “I think not of them: Yet, when we can entreat an hour to serve, We would spend it in some words upon that business, If you would grant the time.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act II, Scene I, paragraph 14) develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Its words “business” and “entreat” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Go

bid thy mistress, when my drink is ready, She strike upon the bell." (Act II, Scene I, paragraph 20), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene I, Macbeth: "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-_____ brain"

    Key: oppressed

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act II, Scene I, paragraph 20? "There's no such thing: It is the bloody _____ which informs Thus to mine eyes."

    A. bearing

    B. business

    C. consent

    D. sisters

    Key: B (business)

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how guilt and conscience develops from Act I, Scene VII to Act II, Scene I. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth, the text reads "I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition" — Macbeth admits his only motive. In Act II, Scene I, "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) — The hallucination. Guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The hallucination. The evidence is "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. The words "toward" and "before" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done.".

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: He knows it is imaginary. The evidence is "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	4, 8, 5, 17, 6, 18, 19, 10, 2, 1, 12, 13, 14, 20, 21, 22	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	19, 5, 8, 23, 24, 11, 4, 2, 25, 12, 26, 27, 28, 20, 16, 29	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Junior	23, 10, 30, 18, 2, 17, 31, 3, 19, 26, 12, 25, 27, 20, 32, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 1, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 2, 23, 5, 7, 9, 18, 4, 25, 12, 26, 20, 21, 33, 32, 29	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 3
AP	23, 1, 11, 17, 9, 31, 25, 26, 34, 12, 20, 15, 32, 16, 29, 33	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 4

College Freshman	6, 7, 3, 8, 10, 17, 26, 25, 12, 27, 34, 20, 16, 32, 33, 29	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 1, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	31, 9, 23, 7, 10, 6, 26, 13, 25, 12, 28, 20, 15, 16, 32, 29	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Junior	10, 6, 5, 2, 3, 31, 26, 12, 25, 27, 20, 33, 32, 16, 22, 29	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 1, synthesis 5
College Senior	17, 6, 2, 18, 4, 26, 12, 25, 13, 14, 20, 21, 32, 22, 16, 29	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	6, 4, 3, 8, 9, 31, 26, 25, 13, 12, 14, 21, 20, 29, 32, 16	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the dagger of the mind? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the dagger of the mind? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of the dagger of the mind. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the dagger of the mind. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene I suggests about the dagger of the mind. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act II, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the dagger of the mind. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the dagger of the mind responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the dagger of the mind follows or

bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene I and its treatment of the dagger of the mind. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the dagger of the mind in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the dagger of the mind. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *There's husbandry in heaven; Their candles are all out.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "husbandry" most nearly mean?

   A. thrift; careful saving

   B. calls (someone) to come

   C. without limit

   D. a call to come or act

2. *Hold, take my sword. There's husbandry in heaven; Their candles are all out. Take thee that too. A heavy summons lies like lead upon me, And yet I would not sleep: merciful powers, Restrain in me the cursed thoughts that nature Gives way to in repose!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene I"?

   A. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

   B. The moving wood

   C. Nature's revolt against the crime

   D. The dagger of the mind

SAT key: 1. A (thrift; careful saving); 2. D (The dagger of the mind)

Lesson 11: Act II, Scene II

Focus: the murder and its first guilt

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act II, Scene II” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (murder, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Duncan's murder happens offstage; the scene shows blood and guilt. Allow students to discuss the aftermath without dwelling on the act. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…me. Enter Lady Macbeth. That which hath made them drunk hath made me bold; What hath quench’d t…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: A murder has just happened offstage.
Suggested language: “What does each character notice first, and why?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Lady Macbeth waits, saying she would have killed Duncan herself had he not resembled her father as he slept. Macbeth returns from the murder with bloody hands, haunted that he could not say 'Amen' and that a voice cried 'Macbeth does murder sleep.' He has carried the daggers away; he refuses to return, so she takes them back and smears the grooms with blood. Knocking sounds at the gate; Macbeth says all great Neptune's ocean could not wash the blood from his hand, and wishes the knocking could wake Duncan.

Background: The murder happens offstage; Shakespeare shows its aftermath rather than the act. Blood, sleep and hands become the play's key image clusters.

Significance: The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line sets up the sleepwalking scene, where water no longer clears anything.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because.... Content note before we start: A murder has just happened offstage.
Prompt: Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: surfeited — overfed; here, drunk; nightgown — a dressing gown worn over night clothes; resembled — looked like; nourisher — something that feeds and sustains; watchers — people who stay awake. “surfeited”: Origin of “surfeit”: Anglo-Norman surfet. “resembled”: Origin of “resemble”: Anglo-Norman resembler.
Words: surfeited: overfed; here, drunk · nightgown: a dressing gown worn over night clothes · resembled: looked like · nourisher: something that feeds and sustains · watchers: people who stay awake

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The murder happens offstage; Shakespeare shows its aftermath rather than the act. Blood, sleep and hands become the play's key image clusters. The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line sets up the sleepwalking scene, where water no longer clears anything. Dialogue: Short, broken lines between Macbeth and Lady Macbeth after the murder show panic. Imagery: Blood on hands; "Macbeth does murder sleep"; "all great Neptune's ocean." Characterization: Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “they had seen me with these hangman’s hands. / Listening their fear, I could not say “Amen,” / When they did say “God bless” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” slowly and put it in my own words: After the murder, Macbeth says he heard a voice cry that Macbeth has murdered sleep. Next, craft. I notice "sleep" repeated, and personified as a victim. The strongest word is “murder”: Macbeth uses it of sleep itself, so he has killed peace of mind. Then, effect. What does the voice crying "Sleep no more!" mean? My answer: The voice crying "Sleep no more!" means that Macbeth's guilt will deny him rest; sleeplessness haunts both Macbeths, and Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking later shows the same punishment.

> *Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep* (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” slowly and put it in my own words: After the murder, Macbeth says he heard a voice cry that Macbeth has murdered sleep. Next, craft. I notice "sleep" repeated, and personified as a victim. The strongest word is “murder”: Macbeth uses it of sleep itself, so he has killed peace of mind. Then, effect. What does the voice crying "Sleep no more!" mean? My answer: The voice crying "Sleep no more!" means that Macbeth's guilt will deny him rest; sleeplessness haunts both Macbeths, and Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking later shows the same punishment.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hyperbole: an entire ocean cannot clean the blood. Lady Macbeth's "little water" is dramatic irony: she will try to wash her hands in her sleep. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." (Hyperbole of guilt.)

> *Will all great Neptune's ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand* (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Hyperbole: an entire ocean cannot clean the blood. Lady Macbeth's "little water" is dramatic irony: she will try to wash her hands in her sleep.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected answer: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." (Hyperbole of guilt.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dialogue, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the murder and its first guilt? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the murder and its first guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. When the text says "A little water clears us of this deed" (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth), it shows this directly. He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking.
Task: Annotate the scene for dialogue, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the murder and its first guilt? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the murder and its first guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. When the text says "A little water clears us of this deed" (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth), it shows this directly. He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong? Ask: why can't Macbeth say "Amen"? What does that show about him?
Anchor question: Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong?
Facilitation: Ask: why can't Macbeth say "Amen"? What does that show about him?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the murder and its first guilt? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. ("A little water clears us of this deed", Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the murder and its first guilt? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. ("A little water clears us of this deed", Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dialogue shapes the murder and its first guilt. Key takeaway: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dialogue:** Short, broken lines between Macbeth and Lady Macbeth after the murder show panic.
- **Imagery:** Blood on hands; "Macbeth does murder sleep"; "all great Neptune's ocean."
- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror.

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "they had seen me with these hangman's hands. / Listening their fear, I could not say "Amen," / When they did say "God bless" (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "Who was it that thus cried? Why, worthy thane, / You do unbend your noble strength, to think / So brainsickly of" (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Methought I heard a voice cry "Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep" (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) Sleep as innocence destroyed.
- "Will all great Neptune's ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand" (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) Hyperbole of guilt.
- "A little water clears us of this deed" (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse.
Evidence: "A little water clears us of this deed" (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth)
Reasoning: He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
surfeited (adjective)	overfed; here, drunk	*He is about it: The doors are open; and the surfeited grooms Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg'd their possets, That death and nature do contend about them, Whether they live or die.*	"surfeited": Origin of "surfeit": Anglo-Norman surfet. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/surfeit#Etymology)
nightgown (noun)	a dressing gown worn over night clothes	*Get on your nightgown, lest occasion call us, And show us to be watchers.*	
resembled (verb)	looked like	*Had he not resembled My father as he slept, I had done't.*	"resembled": Origin of "resemble": Anglo-Norman resembler. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/resemble#Etymology)
nourisher (noun)	something that feeds and sustains	*Macbeth does murder sleep," the innocent sleep, Sleep that knits up the ravell'd sleave of care, The death of each day's life, sore labour's bath, Balm of hurt minds, great nature's second course, Chief nourisher in life's feast—*	
watchers (noun)	people who stay awake	*Get on your nightgown, lest occasion call us, And show us to be watchers.*	
multitudinous (adjective)			

	vast; made up of countless waves	*No, this my hand will rather The multitudinous seas in incarnadine, Making the green one red.*	
constancy (noun)	firmness of purpose	*Your constancy Hath left you unattended.*	
knocking (noun)	repeated striking on a door	*I hear a knocking At the south entry: retire we to our chamber: A little water clears us of this deed: How easy is it, then!*	

Discussion questions

1. Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who carries the daggers back to Duncan's chamber? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lady Macbeth.
2. Why did Lady Macbeth not kill Duncan herself? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He looked like her father as he slept
3. What word could Macbeth not say? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Amen
4. What voice does Macbeth say he heard? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Sleep no more! Macbeth does murder sleep
5. What mistake does Macbeth make with the daggers? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He brings them away with him
6. What does Lady Macbeth say will clear them of the deed? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A little water
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lady Macbeth waits, saying she would have killed Duncan herself had he not resembled her father as he slept. Macbeth returns from the murder with bloody hands, haunted that he could not say 'Amen' and that a voice cried 'Macbeth does murder sleep.' He has carried the daggers away; he refuses to return, so she takes them back and smears the grooms with blood. Knocking sounds at the gate; Macbeth…

8. Who is on stage in “Act II, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act II, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “He is about it: The doors are open; and the surfeited grooms Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg’d their possets, That death and nature do contend about them, Whether they live or die.” What does “surfeited” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: surfeited: overfed; here, drunk.

Inferential / analytical

1. Macbeth says his hand would rather turn the green sea red ('the multitudinous seas incarnadine'). How does this answer Lady Macbeth's 'A little water clears us'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: He knows the guilt is spiritual and limitless; she treats it as a stain.
2. What does “Act II, Scene II” suggest about the murder and its first guilt? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line sets up the sleepwalking scene, where water no longer clears anything.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the symbolism in this scene shape what we understand about the murder and its first guilt? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth): Sleep as innocence destroyed. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “That which hath made them drunk hath made me bold; What hath quench’d them hath given me fire.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Lady Macbeth waits, saying she would have killed Duncan herself had he not resembled her father as he slept. Macbeth returns from the murder with bloody hands, haunted that he could not say 'Amen' and that a voice cried 'Macbeth does murder sleep.' He has carried the daggers away; he refuses to…
7. How does “Act II, Scene II” build on “Act II, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth): Hyperbole of guilt. Theme link:

Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth): Sleep as innocence destroyed. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Why might Shakespeare keep the murder offstage? Evaluate the effect compared with showing it. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Judgment about offstage violence and the audience's imagination.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth): Hyperbole of guilt. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line sets up the sleepwalking scene, where water no longer clears anything.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth): Sleep as innocence destroyed. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the murder and its first guilt. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth): Hyperbole of guilt. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth): Sleep as innocence destroyed. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth): Hyperbole of guilt. On imagery: Blood on hands; "Macbeth does murder sleep"; "all great Neptune's ocean." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene II” treats the murder and its first guilt with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s ·

RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth): Sleep as innocence destroyed. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the murder and its first guilt? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth): Hyperbole of guilt. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth say will clear them of the deed?

    A. A prayer

    B. A confession

    C. The Witches' charm

    D. A little water

    Key: D (A little water)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “No, this my hand will rather The _____ seas in incarnadine, Making the green one red.” Word bank: nightgown, multitudinous, surfeited, resembled

    Key: multitudinous

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What mistake does Macbeth make with the daggers?

    A. He throws them in the moat

B. He leaves them in Duncan's body

C. He loses them

D. He brings them away with him

Key: D (He brings them away with him)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth: "A _____ water clears us of this deed"

   Key: little

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Your _____ Hath left you unattended." Word bank: nightgown, surfeited, constancy, resembled

   Key: constancy

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "He is about it: The doors are open; and the surfeited grooms Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg'd their possets, That death and nature do contend about them, Whether they live or die.", what does "surfeited" most nearly mean?

   A. sweet-smelling liquids

   B. strongest; ruling over the rest

   C. full of pity; compassionate

   D. overfed; here, drunk

   Key: D (overfed; here, drunk)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Macbeth does murder sleep,' the innocent sleep, Sleep that knits up the ravell'd sleave of care, The death of each day's life, sore labour's bath, Balm of hurt minds, great nature's second course, Chief nourisher in…", what does "nourisher" most nearly mean?

   A. dangerous

   B. people who held a position earlier

   C. something that feeds and sustains

   D. calls (someone) to come

   Key: C (something that feeds and sustains)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Get on your nightgown, lest occasion call us, And show us to be _____." Word bank: surfeited, watchers, nightgown, resembled

   Key: watchers

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, Macbeth: "Methought I heard a voice cry 'Sleep no more! / Macbeth does _____ sleep"

   Key: murder

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What voice does Macbeth say he heard?

    A. Banquo's children shall be kings

    B. Sleep no more! Macbeth does murder sleep

    C. All hail, Macbeth

    D. Beware Macduff

    Key: B (Sleep no more! Macbeth does murder sleep)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I hear a _____ At the south entry: retire we to our chamber: A little water clears us of this deed: How easy is it, then!"

Word bank: resembled, knocking, nightgown, surfeited

Key: knocking

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hyperbole of guilt. The evidence is “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.".

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Macbeth says his hand would rather turn the green sea red ('the multitudinous seas incarnadine'). How does this answer Lady Macbeth's 'A little water clears us'?

    Sample answer: He knows the guilt is spiritual and limitless; she treats it as a stain. The evidence is “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) — Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Macbeth cannot say ‘Amen’; he will ‘sleep no more.’

    A. Ambition and its costs

    B. Fate and free will

    C. Appearance versus reality

    D. Guilt and conscience

    Key: D (Guilt and conscience)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene II”? Short, broken lines between Macbeth and Lady Macbeth after the murder show panic.

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Symbolism

    C. Alliteration

    D. Dialogue

    Key: D (Dialogue)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how guilt and conscience develops from Act II, Scene I to Act II, Scene II. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act II, Scene I, Macbeth, the text reads “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” — The hallucination. In Act II, Scene II, “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) — Sleep as innocence destroyed. Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.".

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 33: “To know my deed, ’twere best not know _____.” Word bank: myself, colour, daggers, childhood

    Key: myself

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 26: “Still it cried ‘Sleep no more!’ to all the house: ‘Glamis hath murder’d sleep, and _____ Cawdor Shall sleep no more; Macbeth shall sleep no more.’” Word bank: blessing, therefore, colour, sleepy

    Key: therefore

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What word could Macbeth not say?

    A. Amen

    B. Goodbye

C. Murder

D. King

Key: A (Amen)

20. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who carries the daggers back to Duncan's chamber?
Sample answer: Lady Macbeth.

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 3 reveal about the character or situation? “It was the owl that shriek’d, the fatal bellman, Which gives the stern’st good-night.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (Act II, Scene II, paragraph 3) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". The words “bellman” and “shriek” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene II”?

A. The tyrant's end and a new order

B. The murder of the innocent

C. The murder and its first guilt

D. The Witches' riddling world

Key: C (The murder and its first guilt)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. The evidence is “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". The words “little” and “clears” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 18 shapes its tone: “There’s one did laugh in’s sleep, and one cried ‘Murder!’ That they did wake each other: I stood and heard them: But they did say their prayers, and address’d them Again to sleep.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “address” and “prayers” (Act II, Scene II, paragraph 18) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) supports it: He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking. But “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) complicates it: the line (Sleep as innocence destroyed) shows the same issue from another side, and its “no” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 3: “That which hath made them drunk hath made me bold; What hath _____’d them hath given me fire.” Word bank:

afraid, daggers, quench, foolish

Key: quench

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 17? “A _____ thought, to say a sorry sight.”

    A. myself

    B. therefore

    C. hangman

    D. foolish

    Key: D (foolish)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth).

    Sample answer: He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking. The evidence is “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) — Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.".

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 29 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “If he do bleed, I’ll gild the faces of the grooms withal; For it must seem their guilt.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act II, Scene II, paragraph 29) develops masculinity, power and violence: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". Its words “withal” and “grooms” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “What hands are here? ha! they pluck out mine eyes.” (Act II, Scene II, paragraph 30), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 27 shapes its tone: “Why did you bring these daggers from the place?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “daggers” (Act II, Scene II, paragraph 27) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “Had he not resembled My father as he slept, I had done’t.”, what does “resembled” most nearly mean?

    A. looked like

    B. reward or repayment

    C. a planner; one who devises

    D. checked; held back

    Key: A (looked like)

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Hyperbole of guilt. The evidence is “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". The words “blood” and “great” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the

effect. He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking.

33. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Sleep as innocence destroyed. The evidence is “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.".

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth)

    A. Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic.

    B. Graphic violence praised as service.

    C. He knows it is imaginary.

    D. He shuts her out.

    Key: A (Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic.)

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why might Shakespeare keep the murder offstage? Evaluate the effect compared with showing it.

    Sample answer: Judgment about offstage violence and the audience's imagination. The evidence is “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) — Sleep as innocence destroyed. This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking.

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth)

    A. Her judgment of her husband.

    B. Sleep as innocence destroyed.

    C. Kingship without security means nothing.

    D. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

    Key: B (Sleep as innocence destroyed.)

37. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Why did Lady Macbeth not kill Duncan herself?

    A. She was afraid of the guards

    B. She heard a noise

    C. Macbeth forbade it

    D. He looked like her father as he slept

    Key: D (He looked like her father as he slept)

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Sleep as innocence destroyed. The evidence is “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will

"sleep no more.". The words “murder” and “voice” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	5, 17, 18, 19, 7, 6, 20, 3, 4, 21, 13, 22, 23, 24, 14, 25	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 26, 5, 27, 6, 2, 3, 11, 12, 21, 13, 28, 24, 14, 29, 25	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	10, 1, 18, 11, 3, 17, 19, 21, 12, 13, 24, 23, 30, 15, 29, 16	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	5, 2, 27, 3, 19, 18, 31, 21, 13, 24, 14, 28, 30, 25, 32, 29	recall 7, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	8, 2, 19, 22, 33, 34, 13, 21, 14, 24, 30, 25, 16, 29, 35, 32	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Freshman	4, 2, 27, 13, 12, 34, 36, 21, 30, 14, 24, 15, 35, 16, 29, 25	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	18, 8, 37, 3, 22, 21, 13, 24, 14, 28, 30, 38, 29, 35, 16, 25	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	17, 1, 8, 27, 21, 14, 15, 24, 28, 30, 16, 38, 29, 32, 35, 25	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	7, 8, 18, 31, 12, 22, 21, 13, 30, 14, 23, 24, 29, 25, 16, 35	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	9, 5, 1, 17, 22, 21, 13, 12, 34, 30, 14, 24, 25, 35, 16, 29	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show the murder and its first guilt? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the murder and its first guilt? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the murder and its first guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the murder and its first guilt. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene II suggests about the murder and its first guilt. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act II, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the murder and its first guilt. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the murder and its first guilt responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the murder and its first guilt follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene II and its treatment of the murder and its first guilt. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the murder and its first guilt in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the murder and its first guilt. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Had he not resembled My father as he slept, I had done't.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "resembled" most nearly mean?

   A. looked like

   B. repeated striking on a door

   C. firmness of purpose

   D. vast; made up of countless waves

2. *That which hath made them drunk hath made me bold; What hath quench'd them hath given me fire. Hark! Peace! It was the owl that shriek'd, the fatal bellman, Which gives the stern'st good-night. He is about it: The doors are open; and the surfeited grooms Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg'd their possets, That death and nature do contend about them, Whether they live or die.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene II"?

   A. Lady Macbeth's resolve

B. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

C. Suspicion spoken through irony

D. The murder and its first guilt

SAT key: 1. A (looked like); 2. D (The murder and its first guilt)

Lesson 12: Act II, Scene III

Focus: the discovery of the murder

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Act II, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide (joke), sexual innuendo, alcohol, murder (discovered), violence): The Porter jokes about 'a farmer, that hanged himself on the expectation of plenty' and about drink, which 'provokes the desire, but it takes away the performance' (lechery). Gloss the innuendo briefly; do not have students perform it. Then Duncan's body is discovered and Macbeth kills the grooms. Use the safe-messaging script for the suicide joke.
Student preview: This scene has a joke about suicide, crude drinking jokes, and the discovery of a murder. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “Why might Shakespeare put a comic scene right after the murder?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

A drunken Porter imagines himself porter of hell gate, joking about a farmer, an 'equivocator' and a tailor, before opening to Macduff and Lennox. Lennox describes an unruly night of storms and screams. Macduff discovers Duncan's body ('Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!'). Macbeth reveals he has killed the chamberlains, claiming fury and love; Lady Macbeth faints. Banquo vows to fight 'treasonous malice.' Malcolm and Donalbain secretly flee to England and Ireland, fearing 'daggers in men's smiles.'

Background: The Porter's 'equivocator' is widely read as an allusion to the Jesuit Henry Garnet, executed in 1606 after the Gunpowder Plot, who defended misleading answers under oath.

Significance: Comic relief deepens the horror: the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because.... Content note before we start: This scene has a joke about suicide, crude drinking jokes, and the discovery of a murder. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: primrose — pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure); napkins — handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat); bonfire — a large outdoor fire; masterpiece — a supreme piece of work; sacrilegious — violating something holy. "napkins": Origin of "napkin": an English formation from nape + -kin.
Words: primrose: pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure) · napkins: handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat) · bonfire: a large outdoor fire · masterpiece: a supreme piece of work · sacrilegious: violating something holy

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Porter's 'equivocator' is widely read as an allusion to the Jesuit Henry Garnet, executed in 1606 after the Gunpowder Plot, who defended misleading answers under oath. Comic relief deepens the horror: the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them. Characterization: The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary. Dramatic irony: Macbeth plays the shocked host; Lady Macbeth faints (real or feigned?). Plot: Macduff discovers the body; Macbeth kills the grooms; Malcolm and Donalbain flee. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "Is the king stirring, worthy thane" (Act II, Scene III, Macduff).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale" slowly and put it in my own words: The drunken Porter imagines welcoming an equivocator to hell, someone who could swear on both sides of the scales. Next, craft. I notice the comic tone, which follows the murder with a joke about lying. The strongest word is "equivocator": it means someone who speaks double meanings to deceive. Then, effect. What is the Porter joking about when he describes an equivocator? My answer: The Porter is joking about an equivocator, someone who swears to both sides and lies under oath; the joke links to the Gunpowder Plot trials and to the play's deceptive language, since the witches equivocate with Macbeth.

> *an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale* (Act II, Scene III, Porter)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale" slowly and put it in my own words: The drunken Porter imagines welcoming an equivocator to hell, someone who could swear on both sides of the scales. Next, craft. I notice the comic tone, which follows the murder with a joke about lying. The strongest word is "equivocator": it means someone who speaks double meanings to deceive. Then, effect. What is the Porter joking about when he describes an equivocator? My answer: The Porter is joking about an equivocator, someone who swears to both sides and lies under oath; the joke links to the Gunpowder Plot trials and to the play's deceptive language, since the witches equivocate with Macbeth.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The Porter is joking, but the joke is accurate; equivocation (double-meaning) is how the witches and Macbeth speak. Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality? Expected: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. (The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder.)

> *Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate* (Act II, Scene III, Porter)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The Porter is joking, but the joke is accurate; equivocation (double-meaning) is how the witches and Macbeth speak.
Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality?
Expected answer: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. (The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the discovery of the murder? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of the discovery of the murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. When the text says "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, Porter), it shows this directly. He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the discovery of the murder? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of the discovery of the murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. When the text says "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, Porter), it shows this directly. He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event? Ask: why place comedy right after the murder? Try reading De Quincey's idea that the knocking returns us to the human world.
Anchor question: Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event?
Facilitation: Ask: why place comedy right after the murder? Try reading De Quincey's idea that the knocking returns us to the human world.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the discovery of the murder? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. ("Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate", Act II, Scene III, Porter). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the discovery of the murder? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. ("Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate", Act II, Scene III, Porter). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the discovery of the murder. Key takeaway: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary.
- **Dramatic irony:** Macbeth plays the shocked host; Lady Macbeth faints (real or feigned?).
- **Plot:** Macduff discovers the body; Macbeth kills the grooms; Malcolm and Donalbain flee.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Is the king stirring, worthy thane” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff).
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: “not know’t: / The spring, the head, the fountain of your blood / Is stopp’d; the very source of it is stopp’d” (Act II, Scene III, Macbeth).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter) The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder.
- “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter) The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious.
- “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff) Macduff's discovery.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell.
Evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter)
Reasoning: He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
primrose (adjective)	pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure)	*I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire.*	
napkins (noun)	handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat)	*Here's a farmer, that hanged himself on the expectation of plenty: come in time; have napkins enow about you; here you'll sweat for't.*	"napkins": Origin of "napkin": an English formation from nape + -kin. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/napkin#Etymology)
bonfire (noun)	a large outdoor fire	*I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire.*	
masterpiece (noun)	a supreme piece of work	*Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!*	
sacrilegious (adjective)	violating something holy	*Most sacrilegious murder hath broke ope The Lord's anointed temple, and stole thence The life o' the building!*	
prithee (interjection)	please (from "I pray thee")	*Dear Duff, I prithee, contradict thyself, And say it is not so.*	
provoke (verb)	to bring on; to cause	*What three things does drink especially provoke?*	
readiness (noun)	the state of being dressed and armed	*Let's briefly put on manly readiness, And meet i' the hall together.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15,

16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Lennox report about the night? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chimneys blown down, lamentings heard in the air, strange screams of death; an unruly night.
2. Whom does the Porter pretend to be? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The porter of hell gate
3. Who discovers Duncan's body? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Macduff
4. What has Macbeth done to the chamberlains? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Killed them, claiming fury
5. Where do Malcolm and Donalbain flee? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: England and Ireland
6. What does Donalbain say there are in men's smiles? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Daggers
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A drunken Porter imagines himself porter of hell gate, joking about a farmer, an 'equivocator' and a tailor, before opening to Macduff and Lennox. Lennox describes an unruly night of storms and screams. Macduff discovers Duncan's body ('Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!'). Macbeth reveals he has killed the chamberlains, claiming fury and love; Lady Macbeth faints. Banquo vows to fight…
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire." What does "primrose" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: primrose: pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure).

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Lady Macbeth faint at the moment Macbeth explains killing the grooms? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Real shock or a deliberate distraction; the text allows both.
2. What does "Act II, Scene III" suggest about the discovery of the murder? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Comic relief deepens the horror: the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them.

3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about the discovery of the murder? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter): The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Marry, sir, nose-painting, sleep, and urine.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A drunken Porter imagines himself porter of hell gate, joking about a farmer, an 'equivocator' and a tailor, before opening to Macduff and Lennox. Lennox describes an unruly night of storms and screams. Macduff discovers Duncan's body ('Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!'). Macbeth reveals he…
7. How does “Act II, Scene III” build on “Act II, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter): The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's discovery. On characterization: The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell.

Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter): The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. On plot: Macduff discovers the body; Macbeth kills the grooms; Malcolm and Donalbain flee. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Do Malcolm and Donalbain act wisely or cowardly by fleeing? Defend your answer. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluation of the princes' choice and its consequences.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter): The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Comic relief deepens the horror: the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's discovery. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter): The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. On characterization: The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the discovery of the murder. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter): The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1,

RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's discovery. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter): The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter): The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene III” treats the discovery of the murder with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's discovery. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter): The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the discovery of the murder? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III,

Porter): The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “I’ll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire.”, what does “primrose” most nearly mean?

   A. admitting (a crime)

   B. pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure)

   C. bravery and skill in battle

   D. armor

   Key: B (pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure))

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!”, what does “masterpiece” most nearly mean?

   A. a loud rattling noise

   B. bold deeds

   C. a supreme piece of work

   D. a bold or risky undertaking

   Key: C (a supreme piece of work)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Most _____ murder hath broke ope The Lord’s anointed temple, and stole thence The life o’ the building!” Word bank: bonfire, sacrilegious, primrose, napkins

   Key: sacrilegious

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “What three things does drink especially _____?” Word bank: bonfire, primrose, napkins, provoke

   Key: provoke

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who discovers Duncan's body?

   A. Malcolm

   B. Banquo

   C. Lennox

   D. Macduff

   Key: D (Macduff)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Let’s briefly put on manly _____, And meet i’ the hall together.” Word bank: primrose, napkins, readiness, bonfire
   Key: readiness
7. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lennox report about the night?
   Sample answer: Chimneys blown down, lamentings heard in the air, strange screams of death; an unruly night.
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Here’s a farmer, that hanged himself on the expectation of plenty: come in time; have napkins enow about you; here you’ll sweat for’t.”, what does “napkins” most nearly mean?
   A. faults; wrongdoings
   B. bragging
   C. handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat)
   D. a disordered or diseased state

   Key: C (handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat))
9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III, Porter: “an _____, that could swear in both the scales against either scale”
   Key: equivocator
10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does the Porter pretend to be?
    A. A witch
    B. A king
    C. A soldier
    D. The porter of hell gate

    Key: D (The porter of hell gate)
11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has Macbeth done to the chamberlains?
    A. Killed them, claiming fury
    B. Arrested them
    C. Let them go
    D. Questioned them

    Key: A (Killed them, claiming fury)
12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. The evidence is “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter).
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. The evidence is “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter).

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene III"?

    A. A marriage drifting apart

    B. Life as a tale told by an idiot

    C. The discovery of the murder

    D. The prophecies and their pull

    Key: C (The discovery of the murder)

15. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why might Lady Macbeth faint at the moment Macbeth explains killing the grooms?

    Sample answer: Real shock or a deliberate distraction; the text allows both. The evidence is "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, Porter), which shows the drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how appearance and reality develops from Act I, Scene VI to Act II, Scene III. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act I, Scene VI, Duncan, the text reads "This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself" — Duncan's innocence. In Act II, Scene III, "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, Porter), which shows the drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Dear Duff, I _____, contradict thyself, And say it is not so." Word bank: prithee, napkins, bonfire, primrose

    Key: prithee

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III, Porter: "Here's a _____ indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate"

    Key: knocking

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 55? "Why do we hold our tongues, That most may claim this _____ for ours?"

    A. argument

    B. distracted

    C. repetition

    D. warrant

    Key: A (argument)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 5: "Was it so late, _____, ere you went to bed, That you do lie so late?" Word bank: friend, countenance, repetition, argument

    Key: friend

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 27 reveal about the character or situation? "My young remembrance cannot parallel A fellow to it." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 27) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. The words "remembrance" and "parallel" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act II, Scene III?

    A. “My young remembrance cannot parallel A fellow to it.”

    B. “He did command me to call timely on him: I have almost slipp’d the hour.”

    C. “I know this is a joyful trouble to you; But yet ’tis one.”

    D. “I’ll make so bold to call, For ’tis my limited service.”

    Key: B (“He did command me to call timely on him: I have almost slipp’d the hour.”)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 52 shapes its tone: “Here lay Duncan, His silver skin laced with his golden blood; And his gash’d stabs look’d like a breach in nature For ruin’s wasteful entrance: there, the murderers, Steep’d in the colours of their trade, their daggers Unmannerly breech’d…” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “murderers” and “entrance” (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 52) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 43 shapes its tone: “Had I but died an hour before this chance, I had lived a blessed time; for, from this instant, There’s nothing serious in mortality: All is but toys: renown and grace is dead; The wine of life is drawn, and the mere lees Is left this vault…” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “mortality” and “instant” (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 43) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene III”? The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an ‘equivocator’ among others: comic relief that is also commentary.

    A. Irony

    B. Characterization

    C. Symbolism

    D. Alliteration

    Key: B (Characterization)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. The evidence is “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter). This develops appearance and reality: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. The words “knocking” and “indeed” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 22? “I’ll make so bold to call, For ’tis my _____ service.”

    A. repetition

    B. distracted

    C. limited

D. requited

Key: C (limited)

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “I’ll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire.”, what does “bonfire” most nearly mean?

A. lit the way for; guided

B. to change

C. thin lines (of light)

D. a large outdoor fire

Key: D (a large outdoor fire)

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where do Malcolm and Donalbain flee?

A. Norway and France

B. England and Ireland

C. Scone and Colmekill

D. Fife and Forres

Key: B (England and Ireland)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. The evidence is “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter). This develops appearance and reality: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. The words “equivocator” and “against” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 64: “To Ireland, I; our _____ fortune Shall keep us both the safer: where we are, There’s daggers in men’s smiles: the near in blood, The nearer bloody.” Word bank: friend, command, repetition, separated

Key: separated

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III, Macduff: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot _____ nor name thee”

Key: conceive

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 13 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “Our knocking has awaked him; here he comes.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 13) develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Its words “knocking” and “awaked” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I know this is a joyful trouble to you; But yet ’tis one.” (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 20), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 65 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “This murderous shaft that’s shot Hath not yet lighted, and our safest way Is to avoid the aim.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 65) develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Its words “murderous” and “lighted” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Lechery, sir, it provokes, and unprovokes; it provokes the desire, but it takes away the performance: therefore, much…” (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 8), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Donalbain say there are in men's smiles?

    A. Daggers

    B. Tears

    C. Prayers

    D. Lies

    Key: A (Daggers)

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, Porter)

    A. The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder.

    B. Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought.

    C. Sleep as innocence destroyed.

    D. Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic.

    Key: A (The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder.)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Macduff's discovery. The evidence is “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, Macduff). This develops appearance and reality: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. The words “conceive” and “horror” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 57 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “Nor our strong sorrow Upon the foot of motion.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 57) develops masculinity, power and violence: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Its words “motion” and “strong” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “And when we have our naked frailties hid, That suffer in exposure, let us meet, And question this most bloody piece of…” (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 58), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Do Malcolm and Donalbain act wisely or cowardly by fleeing? Defend your answer.

    Sample answer: An evaluation of the princes' choice and its consequences. The evidence is “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter), which shows the Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. This develops appearance and reality: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth.

40. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 37: “O gentle lady, ’Tis not for you to hear what I can speak: The _____, in a woman’s ear,

Would murder as it fell." Word bank: argument, countenance, repetition, requited

Key: repetition

41. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in "Act II, Scene III"? Macbeth plays the shocked host; Lady Macbeth faints (real or feigned?).

    A. Symbolism

    B. Diction / vocabulary

    C. Dramatic irony

    D. Alliteration

    Key: C (Dramatic irony)

42. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Claim: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, Porter).

    Sample answer: He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth. The evidence is "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, Porter), which shows the drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. This develops appearance and reality: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 4, analysis 0, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 5, 18, 1, 11, 2, 19, 20, 7, 15, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	5, 17, 10, 2, 4, 27, 28, 29, 22, 15, 21, 23, 25, 24, 30, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	31, 5, 10, 2, 32, 7, 11, 15, 21, 14, 22, 13, 23, 24, 33, 30	recall 7, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Senior	20, 28, 31, 29, 19, 17, 21, 15, 12, 22, 14, 23, 24, 16, 34, 33	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 3
AP	17, 35, 3, 14, 12, 22, 21, 36, 24, 23, 37, 33, 38, 16, 39, 34	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Freshman	19, 40, 5, 3, 36, 22, 15, 24, 37, 23, 34, 16, 33, 39, 30, 38	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 6
College Sophomore	11, 9, 3, 10, 22, 21, 24, 41, 37, 23, 39, 34, 38, 33, 16, 26	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 6
College Junior	28, 4, 3, 22, 14, 15, 36, 12, 23, 24, 37, 39, 16, 34, 38, 33	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Senior	35, 3, 17, 5, 14, 22, 24, 42, 37, 23, 16, 34, 38, 39, 30, 33	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	8, 3, 27, 40, 12, 21, 22, 42, 41, 23, 24, 34, 39, 16, 38, 33	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show the discovery of the murder? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the discovery of the murder? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of the discovery of the murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the discovery of the murder. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene III suggests about the discovery of the murder. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act II, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the discovery of the murder. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the discovery of the murder responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the discovery of the murder follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene III and its treatment of the discovery of the murder. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about the discovery of the murder in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the discovery of the murder. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "bonfire" most nearly mean?

   A. to bring on; to cause

   B. the state of being dressed and armed

   C. a large outdoor fire

   D. please (from "I pray thee")

2. *Marry, sir, nose-painting, sleep, and urine. Lechery, sir, it provokes, and unprovokes; it provokes the desire, but it takes away the performance: therefore, much drink may be said to be an equivocator with lechery: it makes him, and it mars him; it sets him on, and it takes him off; it persuades him, and disheartens him; makes him stand to, and not stand to; in conclusion, equivocates him in a sleep, and, giving him the lie, leaves him.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene III"?

   A. The apparitions and false security

   B. The guilt that will not wash away

   C. Lady Macbeth's resolve

   D. The discovery of the murder

SAT key: 1. C (a large outdoor fire); 2. D (The discovery of the murder)

Lesson 13: Act II, Scene IV

Focus: nature's revolt against the crime

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act II, Scene IV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Ross and an Old Man describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by a 'mousing owl', and Duncan's horses breaking loose and eating each other. Macduff reports that the princes are suspected of bribing the grooms, that Macbeth has been named king and has gone to Scone to be invested, and that Duncan's body has been carried to Colmekill. Macduff will not go to Scone but home to Fife.

Background: The idea of a 'great chain of being' held that a king's murder disordered nature; Holinshed's chronicle supplied the omens of the horses and the darkness.

Significance: The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: storehouse — a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place; trifled — made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison; predecessors — people who held a position earlier; invested — formally given the office and crown of king; mousing — that hunts mice. “trifled”: Origin of “trifle”: possibly Old French trufle (“mockery”).
Words: storehouse: a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place · trifled: made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison · predecessors: people who held a position earlier · invested: formally given the office and crown of king · mousing: that hunts mice

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The idea of a 'great chain of being' held that a king's murder disordered nature; Holinshed's chronicle supplied the omens of the horses and the darkness. The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance. Setting: An Old Man and Ross describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl, Duncan's horses eating each other. Imagery: Nature in revolt mirrors the moral disorder. Characterization: Macduff refuses to attend the coronation at Scone: the first sign of resistance. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "They were suborn'd: / Malcolm and Donalbain, the king's two sons, / Are stol'n away and fled; which puts upon them" (Act II, Scene IV, Macduff).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" slowly and put it in my own words: Ross says that by the clock it is day, yet dark night strangles the sun. Next, craft. I notice the violent verb "strangles," applied to night killing daylight. The strongest word is "strangles": it makes the darkness a murderer, echoing Duncan's death. Then, effect. What does Ross notice about the unnatural darkness? My answer: Ross notices that the unnatural darkness covers the day after the king's murder; nature itself seems disordered, which shows that the crime has upset the whole order of the world.

> *by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp (Act II, Scene IV, Ross)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" slowly and put it in my own words: Ross says that by the clock it is day, yet dark night strangles the sun. Next, craft. I notice the violent verb "strangles," applied to night killing daylight. The strongest word is "strangles": it makes the darkness a murderer, echoing Duncan's death. Then, effect. What does Ross notice about the unnatural darkness? My answer: Ross notices that the unnatural darkness covers the day after the king's murder; nature itself seems disordered, which shows that the crime has upset the whole order of the world.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The falcon is the king, the owl Macbeth. It shows the belief in a divine order (the "great chain of being"). Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: The cosmic order reacts to a human crime. (Symbol of regicide.)

> *A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The falcon is the king, the owl Macbeth. It shows the belief in a divine order (the "great chain of being").
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: The cosmic order reacts to a human crime. (Symbol of regicide.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for setting, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of nature's revolt against the crime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. When the text says “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross), it shows this directly. Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

Task: Annotate the scene for setting, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of nature's revolt against the crime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. When the text says “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross), it shows this directly. Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does? Ask: would a modern audience believe these signs? How should a production stage them?

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Facilitation: Ask: would a modern audience believe these signs? How should a production stage them?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. ("by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp", Act II, Scene IV, Ross). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. ("by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp", Act II, Scene IV, Ross). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes nature's revolt against the crime. Key takeaway: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** An Old Man and Ross describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl, Duncan's horses eating each other.
- **Imagery:** Nature in revolt mirrors the moral disorder.
- **Characterization:** Macduff refuses to attend the coronation at Scone: the first sign of resistance.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "They were suborn'd: / Malcolm and Donalbain, the king's two sons, / Are stol'n away and fled; which puts upon them" (Act II, Scene IV, Macduff).
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: "seest, the heavens, as troubled with man's act, / Threaten his bloody stage: by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross) Darkness by day.
- "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man) Symbol of regicide.
- "Tis said they eat each other" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man) Duncan's horses.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe.
Evidence: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross)
Reasoning: Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
storehouse (noun)	a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place	*Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones.*	
trifled (verb)	made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison	*Threescore and ten I can remember well: Within the volume of which time I have seen Hours dreadful and things strange; but this sore night Hath trifled former knowings.*	"trifled": Origin of "trifle": possibly Old French trufle ("mockery"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/trifle#Etymology)
predecessors (noun)	people who held a position earlier	*Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones.*	
invested (verb)	formally given the office and crown of king	*He is already named, and gone to Scone To be invested.*	
mousing (adjective)	that hunts mice	*On Tuesday last, A falcon, towering in her pride of place, Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd.*	
benison (noun)	a blessing	*God's benison go with you; and with those That would make good of bad, and friends of foes!*	
minions (noun)	darlings; the finest of their kind	*And Duncan's horses—a thing most strange and certain— Beauteous and swift, the minions of their race, Turn'd wild in nature, broke their stalls, flung*	

		out, Contending 'gainst obedience, as they would make War with mankind.	
towering (adjective)	soaring high	*On Tuesday last, A falcon, towering in her pride of place, Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd.*	
sovereignty (noun)	the power and rank of a king	*Then 'tis most like The sovereignty will fall upon Macbeth.*	
unnatural (adjective)	against the order of nature	*'Tis unnatural, Even like the deed that's done.*	"unnatural": Origin: an English formation from un- + natural. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/unnatural#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What strange thing has happened to the daylight? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dark night strangles the travelling lamp: it is dark by day.
2. What killed the falcon? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A mousing owl
3. What did Duncan's horses do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Broke loose and ate each other
4. Who is suspected of the murder now? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Malcolm and Donalbain, who fled
5. Where has Macbeth gone to be crowned? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Scone
6. Where will Macduff go instead? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Home to Fife
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Ross and an Old Man describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by a 'mousing owl', and Duncan's horses breaking loose and eating each other. Macduff

reports that the princes are suspected of bribing the grooms, that Macbeth has been named king and has gone to Scone to be invested, and that Duncan's body has been carried to Colmekill. Macduff will not go to Scone but home to Fife.

8. Who is on stage in “Act II, Scene IV”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act II, Scene IV” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones.” What does “storehouse” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: storehouse: a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does the owl killing the falcon symbolize? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: A lower creature killing a higher one: Macbeth killing his king.
2. What does “Act II, Scene IV” suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the symbolism in this scene shape what we understand about nature's revolt against the crime? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross): Darkness by day. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Ah, good father, Thou seest, the heavens, as troubled with man’s act, Threaten his bloody stage: by the clock, ’tis day, And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp: Is’t…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Ross and an Old Man describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by a 'mousing owl', and Duncan's horses breaking loose and eating each other. Macduff reports that the princes are suspected of bribing the grooms, that Macbeth has been named king and has gone to Scone to be invested,…
7. How does “Act II, Scene IV” build on “Act II, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man): Symbol of regicide. Theme

link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “Tis said they eat each other” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man): Duncan's horses. On characterization: Macduff refuses to attend the coronation at Scone: the first sign of resistance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross): Darkness by day. On setting: An Old Man and Ross describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl, Duncan's horses eating each other. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Macduff's decision not to attend the coronation is small but important. How brave is it? Explain. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment about quiet resistance.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man): Symbol of regicide. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “Tis said they eat each other” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man): Duncan's horses. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and

evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross): Darkness by day. On characterization: Macduff refuses to attend the coronation at Scone: the first sign of resistance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of nature's revolt against the crime. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man): Symbol of regicide. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “Tis said they eat each other” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man): Duncan's horses. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross): Darkness by day. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man): Symbol of regicide. On imagery: Nature in revolt mirrors the moral disorder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene IV” treats nature's revolt against the crime with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “Tis said they eat each other” (Act II,

Scene IV, Old Man): Duncan's horses. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act III, Scene I" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross): Darkness by day. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about nature's revolt against the crime? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man): Symbol of regicide. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is suspected of the murder now?
   A. The Witches
   B. Malcolm and Donalbain, who fled
   C. Macduff
   D. Banquo

   Key: B (Malcolm and Donalbain, who fled)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "He is already named, and gone to Scone To be invested.", what does "invested" most nearly mean?
   A. showing good judgment
   B. formally given the office and crown of king
   C. exactly the same
   D. sick

   Key: B (formally given the office and crown of king)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where has Macbeth gone to be crowned?

   A. Fife

   B. Inverness

   C. Forres

   D. Scone

   Key: D (Scone)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "And Duncan's horses—a thing most strange and certain— Beauteous and swift, the _____ of their race, Turn'd wild in nature, broke their stalls, flung out, Contending 'gainst obedience, as they would make War with mankind." Word bank: storehouse, predecessors, trifled, minions

   Key: minions

5. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What strange thing has happened to the daylight?

   Sample answer: Dark night strangles the travelling lamp: it is dark by day.

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene IV, Old Man: "A falcon, _____ in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd"

   Key: towering

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did Duncan's horses do?

   A. Broke loose and ate each other

   B. Died in the stable

   C. Ran to England

   D. Stood still all night

   Key: A (Broke loose and ate each other)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "On Tuesday last, A falcon, _____ in her pride of place, Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd." Word bank: storehouse, trifled, predecessors, towering

   Key: towering

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Threescore and ten I can remember well: Within the volume of which time I have seen Hours dreadful and things strange; but this sore night Hath trifled former knowings.", what does "trifled" most nearly mean?

   A. made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison

   B. the use of double meanings to mislead

   C. to put (a sword) back in its case

   D. without limit

   Key: A (made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "God's _____ go with you; and with those That would make good of bad, and friends of foes!" Word bank: predecessors, trifled, storehouse, benison

    Key: benison

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where will Macduff go instead?

    A. To England immediately

    B. Home to Fife

C. To Scone

D. To Ireland

Key: B (Home to Fife)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does the owl killing the falcon symbolize?
Sample answer: A lower creature killing a higher one: Macbeth killing his king. The evidence is "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man) — Symbol of regicide.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Symbol of regicide. The evidence is "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man).

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "Tis said they eat each other" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Duncan's horses. The evidence is "Tis said they eat each other" (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man). This develops fate and free will: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. The words "other" and "they" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

A. Guilt and conscience

B. Fate and free will

C. Appearance versus reality

D. Ambition and its costs

Key: B (Fate and free will)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how fate and free will develops from Act I, Scene III to Act II, Scene IV. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Act I, Scene III, Macbeth, the text reads "So foul and fair a day I have not seen" — Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. In Act II, Scene IV, "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, Ross) — Darkness by day. The cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene IV, Ross: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the _____ lamp"
Key: travelling

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones.", what does "predecessors" most nearly mean?

A. supernatural; beyond the physical world

B. people or things that move someone to act (here, Macduff's family)

C. blows in battle

D. people who held a position earlier

Key: D (people who held a position earlier)

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene IV"?

A. Insecurity on the throne

B. Defiance and despair

C. Nature's revolt against the crime

D. The tyrant's end and a new order

Key: C (Nature's revolt against the crime)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 34? "As from your graves rise up, and walk like sprites, To _____ this horror!"

A. requited

B. countenance

C. warrant

D. carried

Key: B (countenance)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "On Tuesday last, A falcon, towering in her pride of place, Was by a _____ owl hawk'd at and kill'd." Word bank: predecessors, storehouse, trifled, mousing

Key: mousing

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act II, Scene II?

A. "I laid their daggers ready; He could not miss 'em."

B. "There's one did laugh in's sleep, and one cried 'Murder!' That they did wake each other: I stood and heard them: But they did say their…"

C. "I heard the owl scream and the crickets cry."

D. "A foolish thought, to say a sorry sight."

Key: A ("I laid their daggers ready; He could not miss 'em.")

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 50 reveal about the character or situation? "O, yet I do repent me of my fury, That I did kill them." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 50) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. The words "repent" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act II, Scene III?

A. "Was it so late, friend, ere you went to bed, That you do lie so late?"

B. "Our knocking has awaked him; here he comes."

C. "That it did, sir, i' the very throat on me: but I requited him for his lie; and, I think, being too strong for him, though he took up my…"

D. "I believe drink gave thee the lie last night."

Key: A ("Was it so late, friend, ere you went to bed, That you do lie so late?")

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act II, Scene IV?

A. "Thriftless ambition, that wilt ravin up Thine own life's means!"

B. "They did so, to the amazement of mine eyes That look'd upon't."

C. "Is't known who did this more than bloody deed?"

D. “They were suborn’d: Malcolm and Donalbain, the king’s two sons, Are stol’n away and fled; which puts upon them Suspicion of the deed.”

Key: B (“They did so, to the amazement of mine eyes That look’d upon’t.”)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 28 shapes its tone: “I’ll go no more: I am afraid to think what I have done; Look on’t again I dare not.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “afraid” (Act II, Scene II, paragraph 28) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 9 shapes its tone: “I believe drink gave thee the lie last night.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “believe” (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 9) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 63 shapes its tone: “Let’s not consort with them: To show an unfelt sorrow is an office Which the false man does easy.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “consort” and “office” (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 63) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 9 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “I heard the owl scream and the crickets cry.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Act II, Scene II, paragraph 9) develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". Its words “crickets” and “scream” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “There’s one did laugh in’s sleep, and one cried ‘Murder!’ That they did wake each other: I stood and heard them: But…” (Act II, Scene II, paragraph 18), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Symbol of regicide. The evidence is “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man). This develops fate and free will: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. The words “towering” and “mousing” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 52: “Who can be wise, amazed, _____ and furious, Loyal and neutral, in a moment?” Word bank: yourselves, limited, temperate, command
Key: temperate

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What killed the falcon?

A. A hawk

B. A mousing owl

C. The storm

D. A hunter

Key: B (A mousing owl)

33. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does this passage from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 23 reveal about the character or situation? “These deeds must not be thought After these ways; so, it will make us mad.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (Act II, Scene II, paragraph 23) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". The words “thought” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 56 shapes its tone: “What should be spoken here, where our fate, Hid in an auger-hole, may rush, and seize us?” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “spoken” and “should” (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 56) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 36 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “What’s the business, That such a hideous trumpet calls to parley The sleepers of the house? speak, speak!” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 36) develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Its words “sleepers” and “business” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Had I but died an hour before this chance, I had lived a blessed time; for, from this instant, There’s nothing serious…” (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 43), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 32? “My hands are of your _____; but I shame To wear a heart so white.”

A. colour

B. therefore

C. hangman

D. foolish

Key: A (colour)

37. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 5: “I laid their _____ ready; He could not miss ’em.” Word bank: myself, daggers, foolish, witness
Key: daggers

38. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 22? “I had most need of _____, and ‘Amen’ Stuck in my throat.”

A. blessing

B. foolish

C. witness

D. therefore

Key: A (blessing)

39. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 27: “They must lie there: go carry them; and smear The _____ grooms with blood.” Word bank: sleepy, therefore, quench, myself

    Key: sleepy

40. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Darkness by day. The evidence is “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross). This develops fate and free will: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

41. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene IV”? An Old Man and Ross describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl, Duncan's horses eating each other.

    A. Structure

    B. Setting

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Simile

    Key: B (Setting)

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act II, Scene IV, paragraph 23 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “Lest our old robes sit easier than our new!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act II, Scene IV, paragraph 23) develops guilt and conscience: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Its words “easier” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Is’t known who did this more than bloody deed?” (Act II, Scene IV, paragraph 12), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

43. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act II, Scene III, paragraph 25 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “The night has been unruly: where we lay, Our chimneys were blown down; and, as they say, Lamentings heard i’ the air; strange screams of death, And prophesying with accents terrible Of dire combustion and confused events New hatch’d to the…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 25) develops masculinity, power and violence: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Its words “prophesying” and “combustion” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “My young remembrance cannot parallel A fellow to it.” (Act II, Scene III, paragraph 27), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

44. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act II, Scene II, paragraph 32 shapes its tone: “Be not lost So poorly in your thoughts.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “thoughts” and “poorly” (Act II, Scene II, paragraph 32) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

45. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene IV”? Nature in revolt mirrors the moral disorder.

    A. Conflict

B. Allusion

C. Imagery

D. Foreshadowing

Key: C (Imagery)

46. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Macduff's decision not to attend the coronation is small but important. How brave is it? Explain.

Sample answer: A judgment about quiet resistance: Darkness by day. The evidence is “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross). This develops fate and free will: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

47. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Darkness by day. The evidence is “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross). This develops fate and free will: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. The words “travelling” and “strangles” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	2, 17, 3, 18, 6, 5, 9, 8, 1, 7, 13, 12, 19, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	20, 7, 21, 10, 17, 2, 22, 23, 24, 25, 12, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	31, 32, 4, 5, 21, 33, 22, 24, 23, 19, 26, 34, 14, 15, 35, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	36, 37, 38, 39, 22, 24, 25, 40, 12, 28, 34, 15, 41, 29, 16, 42	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	32, 18, 6, 10, 23, 25, 13, 26, 27, 34, 14, 15, 29, 35, 43, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	39, 10, 7, 22, 24, 25, 40, 44, 27, 34, 15, 14, 29, 43, 42, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	39, 21, 33, 22, 24, 25, 26, 44, 45, 14, 15, 29, 35, 30, 46, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	36, 8, 10, 32, 22, 26, 44, 27, 14, 15, 29, 43, 35, 42, 16, 46	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	10, 21, 32, 24, 25, 26, 44, 34, 27, 15, 29, 43, 35, 42, 16, 46	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	18, 10, 4, 32, 7, 26, 44, 45, 29, 35, 43, 30, 42, 16, 47, 46	

		recall 5, inference 0, analysis 3, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene IV,” how does Shakespeare show nature's revolt against the crime? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of nature's revolt against the crime? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of nature's revolt against the crime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of nature's revolt against the crime. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene IV suggests about nature's revolt against the crime. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act II, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of nature's revolt against the crime. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of nature's revolt against the crime responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of nature's revolt against the crime follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene IV and its treatment of

nature's revolt against the crime. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about nature's revolt against the crime in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of nature's revolt against the crime. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “predecessors” most nearly mean?

   A. the power and rank of a king

   B. soaring high

   C. people who held a position earlier

   D. against the order of nature

2. *Ah, good father, Thou seest, the heavens, as troubled with man’s act, Threaten his bloody stage: by the clock, ’tis day, And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp: Is’t night’s predominance, or the day’s shame, That darkness does the face of earth entomb, When living light should kiss it?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene IV”?

   A. Defiance and despair

   B. Nature's revolt against the crime

   C. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

   D. The moving wood

SAT key: 1. C (people who held a position earlier); 2. B (Nature's revolt against the crime)

Lesson 14: Act III, Scene I

Focus: insecurity on the throne

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act III, Scene I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Banquo suspects Macbeth 'play'dst most foully' for the crown but hopes the prophecy for his own line will also come true. Macbeth, now king, invites Banquo to the feast and learns he will ride out with Fleance. Alone, Macbeth says 'To be thus is nothing; but to be safely thus': Banquo's royal nature and the prophecy of his heirs torment him, since he holds a 'fruitless crown.' He persuades two murderers that Banquo is their enemy and hires them to kill Banquo and Fleance.

Background: Because James I claimed descent from Banquo, Shakespeare makes Banquo noble, departing from Holinshed, where Banquo helps kill Duncan.

Significance: Getting the crown has not ended Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition because....
Prompt: Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: buffets — blows; hard knocks; predominant — strongest; ruling over the rest; parricide — the murder of one's father; disasters — misfortunes; rebuked — checked; held back. “parricide”: Origin: possibly Middle French parricide; earlier Latin parricīda. “disasters”: Origin of “disaster”: Middle French desastre; earlier Latin astrum (“star”).
Words: buffets: blows; hard knocks · predominant: strongest; ruling over the rest · parricide: the murder of one's father · disasters: misfortunes · rebuked: checked; held back

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Because James I claimed descent from Banquo, Shakespeare makes Banquo noble, departing from Holinshed, where Banquo helps kill Duncan. Getting the crown has not ended Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him. Soliloquy: "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus": Macbeth fears Banquo and his heirs. Characterization: Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood. Imagery: "Fruitless crown" and "barren sceptre": he has no heir. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Cawdor, Glamis, all, / As the weird women promised, and, I fear, / Thou play'dst most foully for't: yet it was said / It should" (Act III, Scene I, Banquo).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus" slowly and put it in my own words: Macbeth says that being king is nothing unless he is safely king. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between "thus" and "safely thus." The strongest word is "safely": it shows his new anxiety about keeping power. Then, effect. Why is being king not enough for Macbeth? My answer: Being king is not enough for Macbeth because he is not safe; his crown brings fear, not peace, so he decides to kill Banquo, whose descendants the witches said would be kings.

> *To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus* (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus" slowly and put it in my own words: Macbeth says that being king is nothing unless he is safely king. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between "thus" and "safely thus." The strongest word is "safely": it shows his new anxiety about keeping power. Then, effect. Why is being king not enough for Macbeth? My answer: Being king is not enough for Macbeth because he is not safe; his crown brings fear, not peace, so he decides to kill Banquo, whose descendants the witches said would be kings.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Fruitless" and "barren" mean childless: Macbeth gained the crown for Banquo's sons. Ambition. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition? Expected: Ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. (Childlessness.)

> *Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe* (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Fruitless" and "barren" mean childless: Macbeth gained the crown for Banquo's sons. Ambition.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition?
Expected answer: Ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. (Childlessness.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about insecurity on the throne? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of insecurity on the throne. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. When the text says “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth), it shows this directly. He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.

Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about insecurity on the throne? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of insecurity on the throne. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. When the text says “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth), it shows this directly. He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy? Compare how Macbeth persuades the murderers with how Lady Macbeth persuaded him.

Anchor question: Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy?

Facilitation: Compare how Macbeth persuades the murderers with how Lady Macbeth persuaded him.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about insecurity on the throne? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. (“To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus”, Act III, Scene I, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about insecurity on the throne? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. (“To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus”, Act III, Scene I, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how soliloquy shapes insecurity on the throne. Key takeaway: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus": Macbeth fears Banquo and his heirs.
- **Characterization:** Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood.
- **Imagery:** "Fruitless crown" and "barren sceptre": he has no heir.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition:** ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Cawdor, Glamis, all, / As the weird women promised, and, I fear, / Thou play’dst most foully for’t: yet it was said / It should” (Act III, Scene I, Banquo).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Thou hast it now: king, Cawdor, Glamis, all, / As the weird women promised, and, I fear” (Act III, Scene I, Banquo).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth) Kingship without security means nothing.
- “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth) Childlessness.
- “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth) Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder.
Evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth)
Reasoning: He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
buffets (noun)	blows; hard knocks	*I am one, my liege, Whom the vile blows and buffets of the world Have so incensed that I am reckless what I do to spite the world.*	
predominant (adjective)	strongest; ruling over the rest	*Do you find Your patience so predominant in your nature That you can let this go?*	
parricide (noun)	the murder of one's father	*We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.*	"parricide": Origin: possibly Middle French parricide; earlier Latin parricīda. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/parricide#Etymology)
disasters (noun)	misfortunes	*And I another So weary with disasters, tugg'd with fortune, That I would set my lie on any chance, To mend it, or be rid on't.*	"disasters": Origin of "disaster": Middle French desastre; earlier Latin astrum ("star"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disaster#Etymology)
rebuked (verb)	checked; held back	*There is none but he Whose being I do fear: and, under him, My Genius is rebuked; as, it is said, Mark Antony's was by Caesar.*	
confessing (verb)	admitting (a crime)	*We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.*	
oracles (noun)	people or spirits who give prophecies	*If there come truth from them— As upon thee, Macbeth, their speeches shine— Why, by the verities on thee made good, May they not be my oracles as well, And set me up in hope?*	"oracles": Origin of "oracle": Old French oracle; earlier Latin ōrāculum. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/oracle#Etymology)
cousins (noun)	kinsmen; relatives (here, Duncan's sons)	*We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.*	

manhood (noun)	adulthood as a man	*Now, if you have a station in the file, / Not i' the worst rank of manhood, say't;*	
gracious (adjective)	kind and good	*For Banquo's issue have I filed my mind; / For them the gracious Duncan have I murder'd;*	

Discussion questions

1. Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Complete Macbeth's line: 'To be thus is nothing…' [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: '…but to be safely thus.'
2. What does Banquo suspect? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That Macbeth played most foully for the crown
3. What does Macbeth ask about Banquo's afternoon? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Whether he rides, how far, and whether Fleance goes with him
4. What does Macbeth call his crown? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A fruitless crown
5. Whom does Macbeth hire the murderers to kill? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Banquo and Fleance
6. How does Macbeth persuade the murderers? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He tells them Banquo caused their misfortunes
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Banquo suspects Macbeth 'play'dst most foully' for the crown but hopes the prophecy for his own line will also come true. Macbeth, now king, invites Banquo to the feast and learns he will ride out with Fleance. Alone, Macbeth says 'To be thus is nothing; but to be safely thus': Banquo's royal nature and the prophecy of his heirs torment him, since he holds a 'fruitless crown.' He persuades two…
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I am one, my liege, Whom the vile blows and buffets of the world Have so incensed that I am reckless what I do to spite the world.” What does “buffets” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: buffets: blows; hard knocks.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macbeth not tell Lady Macbeth about the plan to kill Banquo? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He is growing independent in crime and isolated from her.
2. What does “Act III, Scene I” suggest about insecurity on the throne? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Getting the crown has not ended Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about insecurity on the throne? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Kingship without security means nothing. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Thou hast it now: king, Cawdor, Glamis, all, As the weird women promised, and, I fear, Thou play’dst most foully for’t: yet it was said It should not stand in thy posterity, But…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Banquo suspects Macbeth 'play'dst most foully' for the crown but hopes the prophecy for his own line will also come true. Macbeth, now king, invites Banquo to the feast and learns he will ride out with Fleance. Alone, Macbeth says 'To be thus is nothing; but to be safely thus': Banquo's royal…
7. How does “Act III, Scene I” build on “Act II, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Childlessness. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. On characterization: Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Kingship without security means nothing. On imagery: "Fruitless crown" and "barren sceptre": he has no heir. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Banquo partly guilty for keeping silent about his suspicions? Argue for or against. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment about complicity through silence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Childlessness. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Getting the crown has not ended Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Kingship without security means nothing. On characterization: Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of insecurity on the throne. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Childlessness. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Kingship without security means nothing. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Childlessness. On characterization: Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act III, Scene I” treats insecurity on the throne with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment

justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Kingship without security means nothing. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about insecurity on the throne? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth): Childlessness. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 35? “Acquaint you with the _____ spy o’ the time, The moment on’t”

    A. command

    B. perfect

    C. society

    D. innocent

    Key: B (perfect)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Macbeth hire the murderers to kill?

    A. Lennox

    B. Macduff and his family

    C. Banquo and Fleance

    D. Malcolm

    Key: C (Banquo and Fleance)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “There is none but he Whose being I do fear: and, under him, My Genius is _____; as, it is said, Mark Antony’s was by Caesar.” Word bank: parricide, predominant, buffets, rebuked

    Key: rebuked

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, Macbeth: "Ay, in the _____ ye go for men"

   Key: catalogue

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Banquo suspect?

   A. That Macduff is a traitor

   B. That the Witches lied

   C. That Macbeth played most foully for the crown

   D. That Malcolm killed Duncan

   Key: C (That Macbeth played most foully for the crown)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 23: "Know That it was he in the times past which held you So under fortune, which you thought had been Our _____ self" Word bank: perfect, innocent, borrower, without

   Key: innocent

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "I am one, my liege, Whom the vile blows and buffets of the world Have so incensed that I am reckless what I do to spite the world.", what does "buffets" most nearly mean?

   A. repeated striking on a door

   B. to stir up or set on fire (a desire)

   C. blows; hard knocks

   D. causing forgetfulness

   Key: C (blows; hard knocks)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "If there come truth from them— As upon thee, Macbeth, their speeches shine— Why, by the verities on thee made good, May they not be my _____ as well, And set me up in hope?" Word bank: buffets, parricide, oracles, predominant

   Key: oracles

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 12? "As far, my lord, as will fill up the time 'Twixt this and supper: go not my horse the better, I must become a _____ of the night For a dark hour or twain."

   A. innocent

   B. posterity

   C. without

   D. borrower

   Key: D (borrower)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Do you find Your patience so predominant in your nature That you can let this go?", what does "predominant" most nearly mean?

    A. strongest; ruling over the rest

    B. invisible

    C. supernatural; beyond the physical world

    D. worries

Key: A (strongest; ruling over the rest)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 17 reveal about the character or situation? “Sirrah, a word with you: attend those men Our pleasure?” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 17) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The words “pleasure” and “attend” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Macbeth not tell Lady Macbeth about the plan to kill Banquo?

    Sample answer: He is growing independent in crime and isolated from her. The evidence is “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth) — Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act III, Scene I?

    A. “Hie you to horse: adieu, Till you return at night.”

    B. “We should have else desired your good advice, Which still hath been both grave and prosperous, In this day’s council; but we’ll take…”

    C. “As far, my lord, as will fill up the time ’Twixt this and supper: go not my horse the better, I must become a borrower of the night For a…”

    D. “Let your highness Command upon me; to the which my duties Are with a most indissoluble tie For ever knit.”

    Key: D (“Let your highness Command upon me; to the which my duties Are with a most indissoluble tie For ever knit.”)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth).

    Sample answer: He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line. The evidence is “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth) — Kingship without security means nothing. This develops ambition: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. The evidence is “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops ambition: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The words “catalogue” and “for” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Banquo partly guilty for keeping silent about his suspicions? Argue for or against.

    Sample answer: A judgment about complicity through silence. The evidence is “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth) — Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. This develops ambition: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth ask about Banquo's afternoon?

    A. Whether he has seen the Witches

    B. Whether he will visit England

    C. Whether he rides, how far, and whether Fleance goes with him

D. Whether he will stay at court

Key: C (Whether he rides, how far, and whether Fleance goes with him)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth call his crown?

A. A heavy burden

B. A fruitless crown

C. A golden round

D. A stolen jewel

Key: B (A fruitless crown)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, Macbeth: "Upon my head they placed a _____ crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe"

Key: fruitless

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Macbeth persuade the murderers?

A. He offers them the crown

B. He says the Witches command it

C. He tells them Banquo caused their misfortunes

D. He threatens their families

Key: C (He tells them Banquo caused their misfortunes)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, Macbeth: "To be thus is _____; / But to be safely thus"

Key: nothing

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in "Act III, Scene I"? 'To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus': Macbeth fears Banquo and his heirs.

A. Soliloquy

B. Point of view

C. Foreshadowing

D. Setting

Key: A (Soliloquy)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 35 shapes its tone: "Within this hour at most I will advise you where to plant yourselves" Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "yourselves" and "advise" (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 35) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not _____ Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly." Word bank: confessing, parricide, predominant, buffets

Key: confessing

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 25 shapes its tone: "I did so, and went further, which is now Our point of second meeting." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “meeting” and “further” (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 25) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how ambition develops from Act I, Scene II to Act III, Scene I. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act I, Scene II, Sergeant, the text reads “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name”, which shows the play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. In Act III, Scene I, “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth) — Kingship without security means nothing. Ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime.
27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 11 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “We should have else desired your good advice, Which still hath been both grave and prosperous, In this day’s council; but we’ll take to-morrow.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 11) develops guilt and conscience: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Its words “prosperous” and “desired” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Hie you to horse: adieu, Till you return at night.” (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 15), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.
28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “We hear, our bloody _____ are bestow’d In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.” Word bank: parricide, buffets, cousins, predominant
    Key: cousins
29. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 3: “Thou hast it now: king, Cawdor, Glamis, all, As the weird women promised, and, I fear, Thou play’dst most foully for’t: yet it was said It should not stand in thy _____, But that myself should be the root and father Of many kings.” Word bank: posterity, indissoluble, innocent, unbecoming
    Key: posterity
30. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Childlessness. The evidence is “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops ambition: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime.
31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene I”? Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood.
    A. Characterization
    B. Metaphor
    C. Setting
    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: A (Characterization)
32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Kingship without security means nothing. The evidence is “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus”

(Act III, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops ambition: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The words “nothing” and “safely” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow’d In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of…”, what does “parricide” most nearly mean?

    A. the murder of one's father

    B. blows; hard knocks

    C. misfortunes

    D. strongest; ruling over the rest

    Key: A (the murder of one's father)

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene I”?

    A. Insecurity on the throne

    B. The apparitions and false security

    C. The guilt that will not wash away

    D. The tyrant's weakening grip

    Key: A (Insecurity on the throne)

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth)

    A. Graphic violence praised as service.

    B. Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight.

    C. The chant; trochaic rhythm.

    D. Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood.

    Key: D (Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood.)

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth)

    A. Macduff's redefinition of manhood.

    B. Kingship without security means nothing.

    C. Banquo's image of nature and holiness.

    D. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

    Key: B (Kingship without security means nothing.)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Childlessness. The evidence is “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops ambition: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The words “fruitless” and “sceptre” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.

38. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] In the line "And I another So weary with disasters, tugg'd with fortune, That I would set my lie on any chance, To mend it, or be rid on't.", what does "disasters" most nearly mean?

    A. the murder of one's father

    B. blows; hard knocks

    C. misfortunes

    D. strongest; ruling over the rest

    Key: C (misfortunes)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	7, 17, 4, 18, 19, 20, 5, 21, 10, 13, 12, 11, 15, 22, 23, 16	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	10, 1, 19, 7, 17, 4, 24, 5, 12, 11, 13, 25, 15, 22, 26, 27	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	28, 1, 29, 5, 4, 20, 13, 11, 30, 12, 25, 15, 23, 31, 16, 32	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 5, 17, 24, 3, 11, 30, 12, 13, 23, 25, 15, 14, 27, 26, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	29, 33, 8, 21, 13, 11, 30, 34, 35, 36, 12, 23, 25, 26, 16, 27	recall 4, inference 7, analysis 2, synthesis 3
College Freshman	21, 3, 9, 17, 12, 11, 13, 25, 15, 23, 14, 22, 16, 27, 37, 26	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	29, 38, 20, 10, 24, 35, 34, 13, 12, 11, 36, 23, 25, 27, 26, 16	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 2, synthesis 3
College Junior	6, 29, 4, 20, 30, 12, 35, 13, 11, 31, 25, 23, 16, 26, 27, 32	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Senior	3, 1, 17, 18, 8, 13, 11, 12, 22, 25, 23, 15, 27, 16, 26, 32	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	29, 3, 1, 10, 11, 12, 30, 13, 23, 31, 15, 25, 14, 16, 27, 26	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act III, Scene I," how does Shakespeare show insecurity on the throne? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of insecurity on the throne? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of insecurity on the throne. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of insecurity on the throne. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene I suggests about insecurity on the throne. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act III, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of insecurity on the throne. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of insecurity on the throne responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of insecurity on the throne follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene I and its treatment of insecurity on the throne. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about insecurity on the throne in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of insecurity on the throne. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "parricide" most nearly mean?

   A. kind and good

   B. adulthood as a man

   C. the murder of one's father

   D. kinsmen; relatives (here, Duncan's sons)

2. *Thou hast it now: king, Cawdor, Glamis, all, As the weird women promised, and, I fear, Thou play'dst most foully for't: yet it was said It should not stand in thy posterity, But that myself should be the root and father Of many kings. If there come truth from them— As upon thee, Macbeth, their speeches shine— Why, by the verities on thee made good, May they not be my oracles as well, And set me up in hope? But hush! no more.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene I"?

   A. Insecurity on the throne

   B. The moving wood

   C. The army reveals itself

   D. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

SAT key: 1. C (the murder of one's father); 2. A (Insecurity on the throne)

Lesson 15: Act III, Scene II

Focus: a marriage drifting apart

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act III, Scene II” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Lady Macbeth admits 'Nought's had, all's spent, where our desire is got without content.' She urges Macbeth to stop brooding. He says they have 'scotch'd the snake, not kill'd it,' that terrible dreams shake them nightly, and that Duncan in his grave sleeps well. 'O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!' He hints at 'a deed of dreadful note' but tells her to 'be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck,' and calls on 'seeling night' to hide it.

Background: To 'seel' was a falconer's term for stitching shut a young hawk's eyes to tame it; Macbeth asks night to blind the day.

Significance: The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *How can a shared secret change a relationship? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....*
> **Prompt:** How can a shared secret change a relationship?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent."

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: applaud — to praise; cloister — a covered walkway; here, dark enclosed places where bats fly; yawning — drowsy; pitiful — full of pity; compassionate; invisible — that cannot be seen. “applaud”: Origin: Latin applaudere.*
> **Words:** applaud: to praise · cloister: a covered walkway; here, dark enclosed places where bats fly · yawning: drowsy · pitiful: full of pity; compassionate · invisible: that cannot be seen

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
To 'seel' was a falconer's term for stitching shut a young hawk's eyes to tame it; Macbeth asks night to blind the day. The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime. Characterization: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy. Imagery: "O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!" and invocations of night. Structure: The marriage reverses: he now leads; she follows. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "the worlds suffer, / Ere we will eat our meal in fear and sleep / In the affliction of these terrible dreams / That shake" (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content" slowly and put it in my own words: Lady Macbeth says nothing is gained and everything is spent when desire is achieved without contentment. Next, craft. I notice the balanced, rhyming phrasing that sounds like a sad proverb. The strongest word is "content": it means peace of mind, which their crime has destroyed. Then, effect. What does Lady Macbeth realize about their success? My answer: She realizes their ambition has brought only unhappiness; the line shows her early regret, though she hides it from Macbeth.

> *Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content* (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content" slowly and put it in my own words: Lady Macbeth says nothing is gained and everything is spent when desire is achieved without contentment. Next, craft. I notice the balanced, rhyming phrasing that sounds like a sad proverb. The strongest word is "content": it means peace of mind, which their crime has destroyed. Then, effect. What does Lady Macbeth realize about their success? My answer: She realizes their ambition has brought only unhappiness; the line shows her early regret, though she hides it from Macbeth.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The rhyming couplet shows emptiness; "chuck" is affectionate but excludes her. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected: Both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." (He shuts her out.)

> *Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck* (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The rhyming couplet shows emptiness; "chuck" is affectionate but excludes her.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected answer: Both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." (He shuts her out.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a marriage drifting apart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of a marriage drifting apart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. When the text says “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth), it shows this directly. She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a marriage drifting apart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of a marriage drifting apart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. When the text says “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth), it shows this directly. She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How can a shared secret change a relationship? Ask: is Macbeth protecting his wife or isolating her?
Anchor question: How can a shared secret change a relationship?
Facilitation: Ask: is Macbeth protecting his wife or isolating her?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a marriage drifting apart? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. (“Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck”, Act III, Scene II, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a marriage drifting apart? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. (“Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck”, Act III, Scene II, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes a marriage drifting apart. Key takeaway: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy.
- **Imagery:** "O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!" and invocations of night.
- **Structure:** The marriage reverses: he now leads; she follows.

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “the worlds suffer, / Ere we will eat our meal in fear and sleep / In the affliction of these terrible dreams / That shake” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Say to the king, I would attend his leisure / For a few words” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) Lady Macbeth's despair.
- “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth) Torment.
- “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth) He shuts her out.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide.
Evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth)
Reasoning: She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
applaud (verb)	to praise	*Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck, Till thou applaud the deed.*	“applaud”: Origin: Latin applaudere. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/applaud#Etymology)

cloister (noun)	a covered walkway; here, dark enclosed places where bats fly	*There's comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister'd flight, ere to black Hecate's summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night's yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.*	
yawning (adjective)	drowsy	*There's comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister'd flight, ere to black Hecate's summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night's yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.*	
pitiful (adjective)	full of pity; compassionate	*Come, seeling night, Scarf up the tender eye of pitiful day; And with thy bloody and invisible hand Cancel and tear to pieces that great bond Which keeps me pale!*	
invisible (adjective)	that cannot be seen	*Come, seeling night, Scarf up the tender eye of pitiful day; And with thy bloody and invisible hand Cancel and tear to pieces that great bond Which keeps me pale!*	
leisure (noun)	a convenient time	*Say to the king, I would attend his leisure For a few words.*	
assailable (adjective)	able to be attacked	*There's comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister'd flight, ere to black Hecate's summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night's yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.*	
thickens (verb)	grows dim	*Light thickens; and the crow Makes wing to the rooky wood: Good things of day begin to droop and drowse; Whiles night's black agents to their preys do rouse.*	
scorpions (noun)	stinging creatures (an image of torment)	*O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!*	
doubtful (adjective)	full of fear and uncertainty	*Nought's had, all's spent, Where our desire is got without content: 'Tis safer to be that which we destroy Than by destruction dwell in doubtful joy.*	"doubtful": Origin: an English formation from doubt + -ful. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/doubtful#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. How can a shared secret change a relationship?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Macbeth call his wife in this scene that shows tenderness? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: 'Dear wife' and 'dearest chuck.'
2. What does Lady Macbeth mean by 'Nought's had, all's spent'? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They have gained nothing that brings content
3. What does Macbeth say they have done to the snake? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Scotched it, not killed it
4. What is Macbeth's mind full of? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Scorpions
5. Who does Macbeth say sleeps well? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Duncan in his grave
6. What does Macbeth tell his wife about the coming deed? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Be innocent of the knowledge until she can applaud it
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act III, Scene II” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lady Macbeth admits 'Nought's had, all's spent, where our desire is got without content.' She urges Macbeth to stop brooding. He says they have 'scotch'd the snake, not kill'd it,' that terrible dreams shake them nightly, and that Duncan in his grave sleeps well. 'O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!' He hints at 'a deed of dreadful note' but tells her to 'be innocent of the knowledge,…
8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck, Till thou applaud the deed.” What does “applaud” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: applaud: to praise.

Inferential / analytical

1. Lady Macbeth says 'what's done is done' here; in V.i she says 'What's done cannot be undone.' How has the meaning changed? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Here she tries to control regret; later the same idea becomes despair.
2. What does “Act III, Scene II” suggest about a marriage drifting apart? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about a marriage drifting apart? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's despair. On characterization: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “There’s comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister’d flight, ere to black Hecate’s summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Lady Macbeth admits 'Nought's had, all's spent, where our desire is got without content.' She urges Macbeth to stop brooding. He says they have 'scotch'd the snake, not kill'd it,' that terrible dreams shake them nightly, and that Duncan in his grave sleeps well. 'O, full of scorpions is my mind,…
7. How does “Act III, Scene II” build on “Act III, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth): Torment. On structure: The marriage reverses: he now leads; she follows. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth): He shuts her out. On characterization: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be

innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “How can a shared secret change a relationship?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with appearance versus reality? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's despair. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Macbeth protecting his wife by keeping her ignorant, or shutting her out? Argue your view. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment about the marriage with evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth): Torment. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth): He shuts her out. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's despair. On characterization: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of a marriage drifting apart. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the

marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth): Torment. On structure: The marriage reverses: he now leads; she follows. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth): He shuts her out. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's despair. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth): Torment. On imagery: "O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!" and invocations of night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene II” treats a marriage drifting apart with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth): He shuts her out. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth): Lady Macbeth's despair. Theme link: both are unhappy:

"Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a marriage drifting apart? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth): Torment. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 3: “Thou hast it now: king, Cawdor, Glamis, all, As the weird women promised, and, I fear, Thou play’dst most foully for’t: yet it was said It should not stand in thy _____, But that myself should be the root and father Of many kings.” Word bank: posterity, indissoluble, innocent, unbecoming
    Key: posterity
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 35? “Acquaint you with the _____ spy o’ the time, The moment on’t”
    A. command
    B. perfect
    C. society
    D. innocent
    Key: B (perfect)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Say to the king, I would attend his _____ For a few words.” Word bank: leisure, applaud, yawning, cloister
    Key: leisure
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene II, Macbeth: “O, full of _____ is my mind, dear wife”
    Key: scorpions
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “There’s comfort yet; they are _____; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister’d flight, ere to black Hecate’s summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night’s yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.” Word bank: assailable, cloister, yawning, applaud
    Key: assailable
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth mean by 'Nought's had, all's spent'?
    A. The feast is over

B. The war is lost

C. They have lost all their money

D. They have gained nothing that brings content

Key: D (They have gained nothing that brings content)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got _____ content”

   Key: without

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is Macbeth's mind full of?

   A. Scorpions

   B. Ghosts

   C. Daggers

   D. Flowers

   Key: A (Scorpions)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene II, paragraph 9: “How now, my lord! why do you keep alone, Of sorriest fancies your _____ making, Using those thoughts which should indeed have died With them they think on?” Word bank: flattering, themselves, domestic, companions

   Key: companions

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act II, Scene IV, paragraph 12 reveal about the character or situation? “Is’t known who did this more than bloody deed?” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act II, Scene IV, paragraph 12) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. The words “bloody” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act III, Scene I?

    A. “Hie you to horse: adieu, Till you return at night.”

    B. “We should have else desired your good advice, Which still hath been both grave and prosperous, In this day’s council; but we’ll take…”

    C. “As far, my lord, as will fill up the time ’Twixt this and supper: go not my horse the better, I must become a borrower of the night For a…”

    D. “Let your highness Command upon me; to the which my duties Are with a most indissoluble tie For ever knit.”

    Key: D (“Let your highness Command upon me; to the which my duties Are with a most indissoluble tie For ever knit.”)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Torment. The evidence is “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent.".

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act III, Scene II?

    A. “Thou know’st that Banquo, and his Fleance, lives.”

    B. “Come on; Gentle my lord, sleek o’er your rugged looks; Be bright and jovial among your guests to-night.”

C. “Duncan is in his grave; After life’s fitful fever he sleeps well; Treason has done his worst: nor steel, nor poison, Malice domestic,…”

D. “Unsafe the while, that we Must lave our honours in these flattering streams, And make our faces vizards to our hearts, Disguising what they…”

Key: C (“Duncan is in his grave; After life’s fitful fever he sleeps well; Treason has done his worst: nor steel, nor poison, Malice domestic,…”)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 35 shapes its tone: “Within this hour at most I will advise you where to plant yourselves” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “yourselves” and “advise” (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 35) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 25 shapes its tone: “I did so, and went further, which is now Our point of second meeting.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “meeting” and “further” (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 25) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth) supports it: She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder. But “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) complicates it: the line (Lady Macbeth's despair) shows the same issue from another side, and its “without” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene II, Macbeth: “Be innocent of the _____, dearest chuck”
    Key: knowledge

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Light _____; and the crow Makes wing to the rooky wood: Good things of day begin to droop and drowse; Whiles night’s black agents to their preys do rouse.” Word bank: applaud, thickens, cloister, yawning
    Key: thickens

19. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth call his wife in this scene that shows tenderness?
    Sample answer: 'Dear wife' and 'dearest chuck.'

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Come, seeling night, Scarf up the tender eye of pitiful day; And with thy bloody and _____ hand Cancel and tear to pieces that great bond Which keeps me pale!” Word bank: applaud, invisible, yawning, cloister
    Key: invisible

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say they have done to the snake?

    A. Scotched it, not killed it

B. Charmed it

C. Killed it completely

D. Fed it

Key: A (Scotched it, not killed it)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Lady Macbeth says 'what's done is done' here; in V.i she says 'What's done cannot be undone.' How has the meaning changed?
Sample answer: Here she tries to control regret; later the same idea becomes despair. The evidence is “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) — Lady Macbeth's despair.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: He shuts her out. The evidence is “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent.". The words “knowledge” and “innocent” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene II”? ‘O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!’ and invocations of night.

A. Imagery

B. Foreshadowing

C. Irony

D. Hyperbole

Key: A (Imagery)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Both are unhappy: ‘Nought's had, all's spent.’

A. Ambition and its costs

B. Guilt and conscience

C. Fate and free will

D. Appearance versus reality

Key: B (Guilt and conscience)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how guilt and conscience develops from Act II, Scene II to Act III, Scene II. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Act II, Scene II, Macbeth, the text reads “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” — Sleep as innocence destroyed. In Act III, Scene II, “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) — Lady Macbeth's despair. Both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent.".

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 12? “As far, my lord, as will fill up the time ’Twixt this and supper: go not my horse the better, I must become a _____ of the night For a dark hour or twain.”

A. innocent

B. posterity

C. without

D. borrower

Key: D (borrower)

28. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 17 reveal about the character or situation? “Sirrah, a word with you: attend those men Our pleasure?” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 17) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The words “pleasure” and “attend” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.
29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene II”? Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan (‘Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck’); she now seems uneasy.
    A. Setting
    B. Irony
    C. Alliteration
    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)
30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 11 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “We should have else desired your good advice, Which still hath been both grave and prosperous, In this day’s council; but we’ll take to-morrow.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 11) develops guilt and conscience: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Its words “prosperous” and “desired” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Hie you to horse: adieu, Till you return at night.” (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 15), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.
31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Macbeth protecting his wife by keeping her ignorant, or shutting her out? Argue your view.
    Sample answer: A judgment about the marriage with evidence. The evidence is “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth), which shows he shuts her out. This develops guilt and conscience: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent.". She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.
32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 23: “Know That it was he in the times past which held you So under fortune, which you thought had been Our _____ self” Word bank: perfect, innocent, borrower, without
    Key: innocent
33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who does Macbeth say sleeps well?
    A. Duncan in his grave
    B. The Witches
    C. Malcolm in England
    D. Banquo

    Key: A (Duncan in his grave)
34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene II”?
    A. A marriage drifting apart
    B. The tyrant's weakening grip

C. Insecurity on the throne

D. The cast and world of the play

Key: A (A marriage drifting apart)

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth).
Sample answer: She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder. The evidence is “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth), which shows he shuts her out. This develops guilt and conscience: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent.".

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act III, Scene II, paragraph 11 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “Come on; Gentle my lord, sleek o’er your rugged looks; Be bright and jovial among your guests to-night.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Act III, Scene II, paragraph 11) develops guilt and conscience: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent.". Its words “jovial” and “bright” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Thou know’st that Banquo, and his Fleance, lives.” (Act III, Scene II, paragraph 14), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

37. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macbeth tell his wife about the coming deed?

A. Do it herself

B. Tell Banquo

C. Be innocent of the knowledge until she can applaud it

D. Help him plan it

Key: C (Be innocent of the knowledge until she can applaud it)

38. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Lady Macbeth's despair. The evidence is “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent.".

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth)

A. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

B. Kingship without security means nothing.

C. Malcolm as an obstacle.

D. He shuts her out.

Key: D (He shuts her out.)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Lady Macbeth's despair. The evidence is “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent.". The words “without” and “content” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either

would soften the effect. She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Torment. The evidence is “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent.". The words “scorpions” and “wife” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 4, 8, 17, 5, 18, 19, 6, 20, 21, 22, 12, 23, 24, 25, 26	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	27, 3, 21, 20, 6, 19, 10, 11, 28, 22, 13, 29, 25, 23, 30, 31	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	32, 1, 21, 8, 33, 10, 11, 12, 22, 34, 15, 14, 35, 25, 16, 36	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	32, 37, 6, 20, 10, 11, 28, 13, 34, 15, 14, 25, 23, 30, 31, 36	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 17, 37, 38, 22, 13, 12, 15, 14, 25, 24, 23, 30, 26, 16, 31	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	3, 17, 8, 10, 11, 39, 22, 15, 14, 25, 24, 36, 40, 31, 41, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	20, 3, 10, 11, 13, 12, 39, 15, 14, 24, 25, 30, 26, 36, 16, 31	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	32, 6, 3, 10, 28, 22, 39, 15, 14, 25, 24, 30, 36, 31, 16, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	3, 20, 28, 11, 39, 34, 15, 14, 25, 30, 31, 41, 16, 36, 40, 26	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	5, 3, 10, 11, 22, 39, 14, 15, 24, 25, 30, 31, 16, 26, 40, 36	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show a marriage drifting apart? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of a marriage drifting apart? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of a marriage drifting apart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence,

and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of a marriage drifting apart. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene II suggests about a marriage drifting apart. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act III, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of a marriage drifting apart. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of a marriage drifting apart responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of a marriage drifting apart follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene II and its treatment of a marriage drifting apart. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about a marriage drifting apart in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of a marriage drifting apart. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *There's comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister'd flight, ere to black Hecate's summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night's yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "yawning" most nearly mean?

   A. stinging creatures (an image of torment)
   B. grows dim
   C. drowsy
   D. full of fear and uncertainty

2. *There's comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister'd flight, ere to black Hecate's summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night's yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene II"?

   A. Insecurity on the throne
   B. A marriage drifting apart
   C. Suspicion spoken through irony
   D. The murder and its first guilt

SAT key: 1. C (drowsy); 2. B (A marriage drifting apart)

Lesson 16: Act III, Scene III

Focus: Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in “Act III, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (murder, violence): Banquo is murdered on stage; Fleance escapes. Keep the focus on Macbeth's fear of Banquo's line, not on the violence.
Student preview: A character is murdered in this scene.
Suggested language: “Why does Macbeth want Fleance dead too?”

Teacher only · spoilers

At dusk a mysterious Third Murderer joins the first two. Banquo and Fleance approach on foot from the palace gate with a torch. The murderers attack and kill Banquo, who cries to Fleance to fly and avenge him. The light is struck out and Fleance escapes. The murderers go to report how much is done.

Background: The identity of the Third Murderer is never explained; some productions make him Macbeth himself, Ross or Seyton, showing Macbeth's distrust even of his hired men.

Significance: Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because.... Content note before we start: A character is murdered in this scene.
Prompt: Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Four key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: delivers — reports; tells; mistrust — suspicion; streaks — thin lines (of light); expectation — the list of guests who are expected. “delivers”: Origin of “deliver”: Old French delivrer. “mistrust”: Origin: an English formation from mis- + trust.
Words: delivers: reports; tells · mistrust: suspicion · streaks: thin lines (of light) · expectation: the list of guests who are expected

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The identity of the Third Murderer is never explained; some productions make him Macbeth himself, Ross or Seyton, showing Macbeth's distrust even of his hired men. Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail. Plot: Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes. Imagery: Dusk, a torch put out. Irony: The prophecy about Banquo's heirs survives in Fleance. Watch for darkness and light: Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder. In this scene: "Within. Give us a light there, ho" (Act III, Scene III, Banquo).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" slowly and put it in my own words: The First Murderer says the west still glimmers with streaks of day. Next, craft. I notice the gentle, poetic description from a hired killer. The strongest word is "glimmers": it shows the last light before darkness, as Banquo's life is about to end. Then, effect. Why does the murderer describe the fading light? My answer: The fading light marks Banquo's death; the beauty of the line contrasts with the violence to come.

> *The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" slowly and put it in my own words: The First Murderer says the west still glimmers with streaks of day. Next, craft. I notice the gentle, poetic description from a hired killer. The strongest word is "glimmers": it shows the last light before darkness, as Banquo's life is about to end. Then, effect. Why does the murderer describe the fading light? My answer: The fading light marks Banquo's death; the beauty of the line contrasts with the violence to come.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Banquo's last words. Look at the craft: Dusk, a torch put out. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. (Banquo's last words.)

> *O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly (Act III, Scene III, Banquo)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Banquo's last words. Look at the craft: Dusk, a torch put out.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. (Banquo's last words.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for plot, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. When the text says "O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, Banquo), it shows this directly. Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair."
Task: Annotate the scene for plot, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. When the text says "O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, Banquo), it shows this directly. Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved? Ask: who is the third murderer? Discuss the theories, and why Shakespeare may have left it open.
Anchor question: Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved?
Facilitation: Ask: who is the third murderer? Discuss the theories, and why Shakespeare may have left it open.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. ("O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly", Act III, Scene III, Banquo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. ("O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly", Act III, Scene III, Banquo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Key takeaway: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes.
- **Imagery:** Dusk, a torch put out.
- **Irony:** The prophecy about Banquo's heirs survives in Fleance.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

Symbols and motifs

- **darkness and light:** Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder. In this scene: “Within. Give us a light there, ho” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer) Twilight setting.
- “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo) Banquo's last words.
- “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer) The murderers' failure.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold.
Evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo)
Reasoning: Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
delivers (verb)	reports; tells	*He needs not our mistrust, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just.*	“delivers”: Origin of “deliver”: Old French delivrer. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/deliver#Etymology)
	suspicion		

mistrust (noun)		*He needs not our mistrust, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just.*	"mistrust": Origin: an English formation from mis- + trust. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/mistrust#Etymology)
streaks (noun)	thin lines (of light)	*The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day: Now spurs the lated traveller apace To gain the timely inn; and near approaches The subject of our watch.*	
expectation (noun)	the list of guests who are expected	*Then 'tis he: the rest That are within the note of expectation Already are i' the court.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What happens to the light at the moment of the attack? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The torch is struck out ('Who did strike out the light?').
2. Who joins the first two murderers? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A Third Murderer
3. What time of day is it? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dusk, as the last light fades
4. What does Banquo tell Fleance? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Fly, good Fleance, fly
5. What happens to Fleance? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He escapes
6. What does the Third Murderer say about the result? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: There's but one down; the son is fled
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At dusk a mysterious Third Murderer joins the first two.

Banquo and Fleance approach on foot from the palace gate with a torch. The murderers attack and kill Banquo, who cries to Fleance to fly and avenge him. The light is struck out and Fleance escapes. The murderers go to report how much is done.

8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “He needs not our mistrust, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just.” What does “delivers” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: delivers: reports; tells.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Macbeth have sent a Third Murderer without telling the others? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He no longer trusts anyone, even his own agents.
2. What does “Act III, Scene III” suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer): Twilight setting. On irony: The prophecy about Banquo's heirs survives in Fleance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Then stand with us.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: At dusk a mysterious Third Murderer joins the first two. Banquo and Fleance approach on foot from the palace gate with a torch. The murderers attack and kill Banquo, who cries to Fleance to fly and avenge him. The light is struck out and Fleance escapes. The murderers go to report how much is done.
7. How does “Act III, Scene III” build on “Act III, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer): The murderers' failure. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer): Twilight setting. On plot: Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Whom would you cast as the Third Murderer in a production, and why? Defend with clues from the play. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A justified interpretive staging choice.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer): The murderers' failure. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer): Twilight setting. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer): The murderers' failure. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer): Twilight setting. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene III” treats Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer): The murderers' failure. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act III, Scene IV" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer): Twilight setting. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: "O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, Banquo): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens to Fleance?

   A. He escapes

   B. He is captured

   C. He is wounded and taken to Macbeth

   D. He is killed

   Key: A (He escapes)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Banquo tell Fleance?

   A. Fly, good Fleance, fly

   B. Fight beside me

   C. Hide in the castle

   D. Go to England with Macduff

   Key: A (Fly, good Fleance, fly)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who joins the first two murderers?

   A. Lennox

   B. Lady Macbeth

   C. A Third Murderer

   D. Macbeth openly

Key: C (A Third Murderer)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He needs not our mistrust, since he _____ Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just." Word bank: expectation, delivers, mistrust, streaks

   Key: delivers

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Then 'tis he: the rest That are within the note of expectation Already are i' the court.", what does "expectation" most nearly mean?

   A. darlings; the finest of their kind

   B. forced; acting against their will

   C. showing good judgment

   D. the list of guests who are expected

   Key: D (the list of guests who are expected)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He needs not our _____, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just." Word bank: delivers, streaks, mistrust, expectation

   Key: mistrust

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer: "We have lost / Best half of our _____"

   Key: affair

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What time of day is it?

   A. Dusk, as the last light fades

   B. Midday at the feast

   C. Noon

   D. Dawn

   Key: A (Dusk, as the last light fades)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene III, Banquo: "O, _____! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly"

   Key: treachery

10. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens to the light at the moment of the attack?

    Sample answer: The torch is struck out ('Who did strike out the light?').

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, Banquo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Banquo's last words. The evidence is "O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, Banquo). This develops fate and free will: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why might Macbeth have sent a Third Murderer without telling the others?

    Sample answer: He no longer trusts anyone, even his own agents. The evidence is "We have lost / Best half of our affair" (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer) — The murderers' failure.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Twilight setting. The evidence is “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer). This develops fate and free will: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene III”? Dusk, a torch put out.

    A. Characterization

    B. Imagery

    C. Allusion

    D. Point of view

    Key: B (Imagery)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

    A. Appearance versus reality

    B. Ambition and its costs

    C. Guilt and conscience

    D. Fate and free will

    Key: D (Fate and free will)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how fate and free will develops from Act II, Scene IV to Act III, Scene III. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act II, Scene IV, Ross, the text reads “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” — Darkness by day. In Act III, Scene III, “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer) — Twilight setting. Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene III, First Murderer: “The west yet _____ with some streaks of day”

    Key: glimmers

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Third Murderer say about the result?

    A. There's but one down; the son is fled

    B. Both are dead

    C. They killed the wrong man

    D. Banquo escaped

    Key: A (There's but one down; the son is fled)

19. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene III”? Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes.

    A. Plot

    B. Simile

    C. Setting

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: A (Plot)

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo).

Sample answer: Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair.". The evidence is “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo) — Banquo's last words. This develops fate and free will: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 35? “Acquaint you with the _____ spy o’ the time, The moment on’t”

    A. command

    B. perfect

    C. society

    D. innocent

    Key: B (perfect)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 3: “Thou hast it now: king, Cawdor, Glamis, all, As the weird women promised, and, I fear, Thou play’dst most foully for’t: yet it was said It should not stand in thy _____, But that myself should be the root and father Of many kings.” Word bank: posterity, indissoluble, innocent, unbecoming

    Key: posterity

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act III, Scene I?

    A. “Hie you to horse: adieu, Till you return at night.”

    B. “We should have else desired your good advice, Which still hath been both grave and prosperous, In this day’s council; but we’ll take…”

    C. “As far, my lord, as will fill up the time ’Twixt this and supper: go not my horse the better, I must become a borrower of the night For a…”

    D. “Let your highness Command upon me; to the which my duties Are with a most indissoluble tie For ever knit.”

    Key: D (“Let your highness Command upon me; to the which my duties Are with a most indissoluble tie For ever knit.”)

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 17 reveal about the character or situation? “Sirrah, a word with you: attend those men Our pleasure?” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 17) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The words “pleasure” and “attend” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act III, Scene II?

    A. “Things without all remedy Should be without regard: what’s done is done.”

    B. “But let the frame of things disjoint, both the worlds suffer, Ere we will eat our meal in fear and sleep In the affliction of these…”

    C. “How now, my lord! why do you keep alone, Of sorriest fancies your companions making, Using those thoughts which should indeed have died…”

    D. “We have scotch’d the snake, not kill’d it: She’ll close and be herself, whilst our poor malice Remains in danger of her former tooth.”

    Key: C (“How now, my lord! why do you keep alone, Of sorriest fancies your companions making, Using those thoughts which should indeed have died…”)

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene III"?

    A. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

    B. Life as a tale told by an idiot

    C. The cast and world of the play

    D. The tyrant's end and a new order

    Key: A (Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape)

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act III, Scene III?

    A. "But who did bid thee join with us?"

    B. "There's but one down; the son is fled."

    C. "Almost a mile: but he does usually, So all men do, from hence to the palace gate Make it their walk."

    D. "Well, let's away, and say how much is done."

    Key: A ("But who did bid thee join with us?")

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 35 shapes its tone: "Within this hour at most I will advise you where to plant yourselves" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "yourselves" and "advise" (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 35) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene II, paragraph 10 shapes its tone: "But let the frame of things disjoint, both the worlds suffer, Ere we will eat our meal in fear and sleep In the affliction of these terrible dreams That shake us nightly" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "affliction" and "terrible" (Act III, Scene II, paragraph 10) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Whom would you cast as the Third Murderer in a production, and why? Defend with clues from the play.

    Sample answer: A justified interpretive staging choice: Twilight setting. The evidence is "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer). This develops fate and free will: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair.".

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Twilight setting. The evidence is "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer). This develops fate and free will: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. The words "glimmers" and "streaks" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair.".

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 25 shapes its tone: "I did so, and went further, which is now Our point of second meeting." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “meeting” and “further” (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 25) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Banquo's last words. The evidence is “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo). This develops fate and free will: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. The words “treachery” and “good” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair.".
34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 11 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “We should have else desired your good advice, Which still hath been both grave and prosperous, In this day’s council; but we’ll take to-morrow.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 11) develops guilt and conscience: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Its words “prosperous” and “desired” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Hie you to horse: adieu, Till you return at night.” (Act III, Scene I, paragraph 15), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.
35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 23: “Know That it was he in the times past which held you So under fortune, which you thought had been Our _____ self” Word bank: perfect, innocent, borrower, without
    Key: innocent
36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which word completes this sentence from Act III, Scene I, paragraph 12? “As far, my lord, as will fill up the time ’Twixt this and supper: go not my horse the better, I must become a _____ of the night For a dark hour or twain.”
    A. innocent
    B. posterity
    C. without
    D. borrower

    Key: D (borrower)
37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The murderers' failure. The evidence is “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer). This develops fate and free will: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. The words “affair” and “half” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 1, 5, 9, 2, 10, 6, 3, 4, 13, 12, 19, 20, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	21, 22, 17, 9, 1, 7, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 20, 30, 31	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2

HS Junior	6, 17, 9, 10, 8, 24, 26, 13, 27, 12, 28, 32, 29, 15, 33, 30	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	4, 5, 10, 6, 24, 23, 25, 12, 27, 28, 32, 29, 14, 34, 30, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	35, 1, 6, 23, 25, 27, 12, 32, 28, 29, 14, 20, 15, 34, 16, 30	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 3
College Freshman	35, 6, 8, 24, 23, 13, 12, 32, 28, 29, 20, 19, 15, 34, 30, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	9, 17, 24, 23, 25, 13, 12, 26, 28, 32, 29, 15, 34, 30, 16, 33	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	36, 6, 17, 24, 25, 26, 28, 32, 29, 37, 15, 34, 33, 31, 16, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	6, 17, 25, 27, 12, 28, 32, 29, 20, 19, 15, 37, 34, 30, 31, 16	recall 2, inference 3, analysis 7, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	9, 6, 24, 23, 25, 11, 26, 28, 32, 29, 15, 37, 34, 30, 16, 31	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene III suggests about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act III, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene III and its treatment of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *He needs not our mistrust, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “delivers” most nearly mean?

   A. suspicion

   B. the list of guests who are expected

   C. thin lines (of light)

   D. reports; tells

2. *Then stand with us. The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day: Now spurs the lated traveller apace To gain the timely inn; and near approaches The subject of our watch.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene III”?

   A. The decision to murder

   B. Life as a tale told by an idiot

   C. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

   D. The dagger of the mind

SAT key: 1. D (reports; tells); 2. C (Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape)

Lesson 17: Act III, Scene IV

Focus: the ghost at the banquet

Objective: Students will analyze how symbolism develops in "Act III, Scene IV" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…l sit i' the midst: Be large in mirth; anon we'll drink a measure The table round. Approaching…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

At the state banquet a Murderer tells Macbeth that Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped. When Macbeth wishes Banquo were present, Banquo's ghost sits in his place, seen only by Macbeth, who cries 'Thou canst not say I did it.' Lady Macbeth explains it as a fit he has had since youth and scolds him ('Are you a man?'). The ghost returns; the feast breaks up in disorder. Afterwards Macbeth says 'blood will have blood,' notes that Macduff refused to come, and resolves to visit the Witches: 'I am in blood stepp'd in so far…'

Background: Elizabethan audiences debated whether ghosts were spirits of the dead or devils in disguise; the play never settles whether this ghost is real.

Significance: The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: choughs — birds of the crow family; enrages — makes (someone) furious; grandam — a grandmother; nonpareil — someone without equal; displaced — driven out. “displaced”: Origin of “displace”: Middle French desplacer.
Words: choughs: birds of the crow family · enrages: makes (someone) furious · grandam: a grandmother · nonpareil: someone without equal · displaced: driven out

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Elizabethan audiences debated whether ghosts were spirits of the dead or devils in disguise; the play never settles whether this ghost is real. The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control. Dramatic irony: Macbeth wishes Banquo were present; the ghost takes his seat. Characterization: Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him. Imagery: "It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood." Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “O proper stuff! / This is the very painting of your fear: / This is the air-drawn dagger which, you said, / Led you to” (Act III, Scene IV, Lady Macbeth).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” slowly and put it in my own words: Seeing Banquo's ghost at the feast, Macbeth cries that the ghost cannot say he did it, and tells it not to shake its bloody hair at him. Next, craft. I notice that his denial actually reveals his guilt. The strongest word is “gory”: it describes the ghost's bloody hair, a sign of murder. Then, effect. What does Macbeth say to Banquo's ghost? My answer: Macbeth tells Banquo's ghost that he cannot say Macbeth did it and must not shake his bloody hair at him; his outburst before the lords exposes his guilt and the feast falls apart.

> *Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me* (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” slowly and put it in my own words: Seeing Banquo's ghost at the feast, Macbeth cries that the ghost cannot say he did it, and tells it not to shake its bloody hair at him. Next, craft. I notice that his denial actually reveals his guilt. The strongest word is “gory”: it describes the ghost's bloody hair, a sign of murder. Then, effect. What does Macbeth say to Banquo's ghost? My answer: Macbeth tells Banquo's ghost that he cannot say Macbeth did it and must not shake his bloody hair at him; his outburst before the lords exposes his guilt and the feast falls apart.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The river of blood image: halfway across, he keeps going. Guilt becomes hardness. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected: Guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. (Violence breeds violence.)

> *It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood* (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The river of blood image: halfway across, he keeps going. Guilt becomes hardness.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected answer: Guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. (Violence breeds violence.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the ghost at the banquet? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of the ghost at the banquet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. When the text says “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth), it shows this directly. He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.
Task: Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the ghost at the banquet? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of the ghost at the banquet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. When the text says “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth), it shows this directly. He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong? Ask: should the ghost be visible to the audience? What changes if not?
Anchor question: What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong?
Facilitation: Ask: should the ghost be visible to the audience? What changes if not?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the ghost at the banquet? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. (“Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me”, Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the ghost at the banquet? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. (“Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me”, Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes the ghost at the banquet. Key takeaway: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Macbeth wishes Banquo were present; the ghost takes his seat.
- **Characterization:** Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him.
- **Imagery:** "It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood."

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “O proper stuff! / This is the very painting of your fear: / This is the air-drawn dagger which, you said, / Led you to” (Act III, Scene IV, Lady Macbeth).
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: “drink a measure / The table round. Approaching the door. There’s blood on thy face” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) Macbeth to the ghost.
- "It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) Violence breeds violence.
- "I am in blood / Stepp'd in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o'er" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) Macbeth chooses to go on.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back.
Evidence: "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth)
Reasoning: He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
choughs (noun)	birds of the crow family	*It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood: Stones have been known to move and trees to speak; Augurs and understood relations have By magot-pies and choughs and rooks brought forth The secret'st man of blood.*	
enrages (verb)	makes (someone) furious	*I pray you, speak not; he grows worse and worse; Question enrages him.*	
grandam (noun)	a grandmother	*O, these flaws and starts, Impostors to true fear, would well become A woman's story at a winter's fire, Authorized by her grandam.*	
nonpareil (noun)	someone without equal	*Thou art the best o' the cut-throats: yet he's good That did the like for Fleance: if thou didst it, Thou art the nonpareil.*	
displaced (verb)	driven out	*You have displaced the mirth, broke the good meeting, With most admired disorder.*	"displaced": Origin of "displace": Middle French desplacer. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/displace#Etymology)
betimes (adverb)	early	*I will to-morrow, And betimes I will, to the weird sisters: More shall they*	

		speak; for now I am bent to know, By the worst means, the worst.	
monuments (noun)	tombs	*If charnel-houses and our graves must send Those that we bury back, our monuments Shall be the maws of kites.*	"monuments": Origin of "monument": Old French monument; earlier Latin monumentum ("memorial"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/monument#Etymology)
admired (adjective)	causing wonder; astonishing	*You have displaced the mirth, broke the good meeting, With most admired disorder.*	

Discussion questions

1. What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Complete Macbeth's words to the ghost: 'Thou canst not say…' [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: '…I did it: never shake thy gory locks at me.'
2. What news does the Murderer bring? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped
3. Who can see Banquo's ghost? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Only Macbeth
4. How does Lady Macbeth explain Macbeth's behavior? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He has had such fits since his youth
5. What does Macbeth say blood will have? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Blood
6. Which thane refused to come at Macbeth's bidding? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Macduff
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At the state banquet a Murderer tells Macbeth that Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped. When Macbeth wishes Banquo were present, Banquo's ghost sits in his place, seen only by Macbeth, who cries 'Thou canst not say I did it.' Lady Macbeth explains it as a fit he has had since youth and scolds him ('Are you a man?'). The ghost returns; the feast breaks up in disorder. Afterwards Macbeth says 'blood…

8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene IV”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene IV” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood: Stones have been known to move and trees to speak; Augurs and understood relations have By magot-pies and choughs and rooks brought forth The secret’st man of blood.” What does “choughs” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: choughs: birds of the crow family.

Inferential / analytical

1. 'I am in blood stepp'd in so far that, should I wade no more, returning were as tedious as go o'er.' What does this image show about Macbeth's choices now? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: He feels going back is as hard as going on; he chooses more violence.
2. What does “Act III, Scene IV” suggest about the ghost at the banquet? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control.
3. Find one example of symbolism in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the ghost at the banquet? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth to the ghost. On characterization: Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “O proper stuff!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: At the state banquet a Murderer tells Macbeth that Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped. When Macbeth wishes Banquo were present, Banquo's ghost sits in his place, seen only by Macbeth, who cries 'Thou canst not say I did it.' Lady Macbeth explains it as a fit he has had since youth and scolds him…
7. How does “Act III, Scene IV” build on “Act III, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made

visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth chooses to go on. On characterization: Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth to the ghost. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should the ghost be played by an actor or left empty? Which choice better shows Macbeth's mind? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A staging argument tied to the question of the supernatural.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth chooses to go on. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth to the ghost. On characterization: Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the ghost at the banquet. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth chooses to go on. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth to the ghost. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the symbolism in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene IV” treats the ghost at the banquet with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth chooses to go on. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Macbeth to the ghost. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the ghost at the banquet? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Macbeth's words to the ghost: 'Thou canst not say…' Sample answer: '…I did it: never shake thy gory locks at me.'
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which thane refused to come at Macbeth's bidding?

   A. Lennox
   B. Angus
   C. Macduff
   D. Ross

   Key: C (Macduff)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Thou art the best o' the cut-throats: yet he's good That did the like for Fleance: if thou didst it, Thou art the nonpareil.", what does "nonpareil" most nearly mean?

   A. dangerous

   B. someone without equal

   C. deadened; numb as if dead

   D. sometimes; at times

   Key: B (someone without equal)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "O, these flaws and starts, Impostors to true fear, would well become A woman's story at a winter's fire, Authorized by her grandam.", what does "grandam" most nearly mean?

   A. the handle of a dagger

   B. a grandmother

   C. a male relative

   D. tiny; like a dwarf

   Key: B (a grandmother)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "You have _____ the mirth, broke the good meeting, With most admired disorder." Word bank: enrages, choughs, displaced, grandam

   Key: displaced

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "If charnel-houses and our graves must send Those that we bury back, our _____ Shall be the maws of kites." Word bank: grandam, choughs, enrages, monuments

   Key: monuments

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What news does the Murderer bring?

   A. Both are dead

   B. Fleance is captured

   C. Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped

   D. Banquo escaped

   Key: C (Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who can see Banquo's ghost?

   A. Everyone at the table

   B. Only Macbeth

   C. Lady Macbeth

   D. Lennox and Ross

   Key: B (Only Macbeth)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I will tomorrow, And _____ I will, to the weird sisters: More shall they speak; for now I am bent to know, By the worst means, the worst." Word bank: grandam, enrages, choughs, betimes

   Key: betimes

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “You have displaced the mirth, broke the good meeting, With most _____ disorder.” Word bank: enrages, choughs, admired, grandam

    Key: admired

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Macbeth to the ghost. The evidence is “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] 'I am in blood stepp'd in so far that, should I wade no more, returning were as tedious as go o'er.' What does this image show about Macbeth's choices now?

    Sample answer: He feels going back is as hard as going on; he chooses more violence. The evidence is “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) — Macbeth chooses to go on.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Violence breeds violence. The evidence is “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene IV”?

    A. The tyrant's end and a new order
    B. Nature's revolt against the crime
    C. The ghost at the banquet
    D. The guilt that will not wash away

    Key: C (The ghost at the banquet)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

    A. Guilt and conscience
    B. Appearance versus reality
    C. Ambition and its costs
    D. Fate and free will

    Key: A (Guilt and conscience)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Should the ghost be played by an actor or left empty? Which choice better shows Macbeth's mind?

    Sample answer: A staging argument tied to the question of the supernatural. The evidence is “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) — Macbeth to the ghost. This develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 14? “Then comes my fit again: I had else been perfect, Whole as the marble, founded as the rock,

As broad and general as the casing air: But now I am cabin'd, cribb'd, _____, bound in To saucy doubts and fears."

A. confined
B. infirmity
C. friends
D. speculation

Key: A (confined)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Lady Macbeth explain Macbeth's behavior?

A. He has had such fits since his youth
B. He has seen the Witches
C. He is drunk
D. He is ill with fever

Key: A (He has had such fits since his youth)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say blood will have?

A. Blood
B. Mercy
C. Justice from heaven
D. Peace

Key: A (Blood)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 19: "The Ghost of Banquo _____, and sits in Macbeth's place." Word bank: absence, confined, speculation, enters

Key: enters

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth: "I am in blood / Stepp'd in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as _____ as go o'er"

Key: tedious

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 3 reveal about the character or situation? "You know your own degrees; sit down: at first And last the hearty welcome." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 3) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The words "degrees" and "welcome" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 44 reveal about the character or situation? "What man dare, I dare: Approach thou like the rugged Russian bear, The arm'd rhinoceros, or the Hyrcan tiger; Take any shape but that, and my firm nerves Shall never tremble: or be alive again, And dare me to the desert with thy sword; If…" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 44) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The words "rhinoceros" and "trembling" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: "My lord, his throat is cut; that I did for him." Pick two words and

explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “throat” (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 53 shapes its tone: “How say’st thou, that Macduff denies his person At our great bidding?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “bidding” and “denies” (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 53) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Macbeth to the ghost. The evidence is “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The words “canst” and “locks” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “I pray you, speak not; he grows worse and worse; Question enrages him.”, what does “enrages” most nearly mean?

    A. acts of betraying one's king or country

    B. a supreme piece of work

    C. makes (someone) furious

    D. people who swear oaths

    Key: C (makes (someone) furious)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth).

    Sample answer: He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on. The evidence is “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) — Macbeth to the ghost. This develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene IV”? Macbeth wishes Banquo were present; the ghost takes his seat.

    A. Plot

    B. Symbolism

    C. Dramatic irony

    D. Personification

    Key: C (Dramatic irony)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 30 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “Sit, worthy friends: my lord is often thus, And hath been from his youth: pray you, keep seat; The fit is momentary; upon a thought He will again be well:

if much you note him, You shall offend him and extend his passion: Feed, and regard…" Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 30) develops masculinity, power and violence: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Its words "momentary" and "friends" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Blood hath been shed ere now, i' the olden time, Ere human statute purged the gentle weal; Ay, and since too, murders…" (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 37), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) supports it: He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on. But "I am in blood / Stepp'd in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o'er" (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) complicates it: Macbeth chooses to go on, and its "no" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 18 shapes its tone: "Now, good digestion wait on appetite, And health on both!" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "digestion" and "appetite" (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 18) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 39 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: "Come, love and health to all; Then I'll sit down." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 39) develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Its words "health" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Avaunt! and quit my sight! let the earth hide thee!" (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 42), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 5: "Ourself will mingle with _____, And play the humble host." Word bank: enters, absence, society, speculation

    Key: society

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 39? "I drink to the _____ joy o' the whole table, And to our dear friend Banquo, whom we miss; Would he were here! to all, and him, we thirst, And all to all."

    A. society

    B. ceremony

    C. general

    D. confined

    Key: C (general)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene IV”? Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him.

    A. Diction / vocabulary

    B. Simile

    C. Tone / mood

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how guilt and conscience develops from Act III, Scene II to Act III, Scene IV. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth, the text reads “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” — Lady Macbeth's despair. In Act III, Scene IV, “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) — Macbeth to the ghost. Guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

38. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth)

    A. Macbeth chooses to go on.

    B. The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious.

    C. Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won."

    D. The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder.

    Key: A (Macbeth chooses to go on.)

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth)

    A. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

    B. Her judgment of her husband.

    C. Macbeth to the ghost.

    D. Sleep as innocence destroyed.

    Key: C (Macbeth to the ghost.)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Violence breeds violence. The evidence is “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The words “blood” and “will” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.

41. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Macbeth chooses to go on. The evidence is “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible;

Macbeth resolves to wade on. The words "tedious" and "should" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

42. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 52: "Almost at odds with _____, which is which." Word bank: ceremony, serpent, infirmity, morning
Key: morning

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 4, analysis 1, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 6, 18, 10, 19, 20, 5, 21, 22, 12, 23, 14, 24, 15, 25, 26	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	20, 7, 21, 6, 17, 27, 19, 13, 22, 12, 23, 24, 28, 29, 30, 31	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	20, 8, 18, 17, 5, 7, 23, 22, 12, 14, 15, 32, 25, 24, 33, 31	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	34, 17, 4, 35, 20, 12, 22, 23, 13, 24, 25, 36, 15, 37, 30, 33	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	10, 2, 5, 13, 38, 12, 39, 24, 32, 36, 25, 15, 30, 37, 16, 33	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	5, 7, 35, 9, 22, 23, 12, 29, 32, 15, 24, 25, 40, 30, 31, 37	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	9, 3, 5, 7, 22, 14, 41, 28, 15, 32, 24, 40, 33, 31, 30, 16	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	42, 5, 7, 8, 14, 15, 32, 24, 28, 25, 37, 16, 30, 33, 31, 40	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	3, 5, 9, 7, 29, 41, 25, 24, 15, 32, 16, 37, 33, 30, 31, 26	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	5, 9, 39, 38, 22, 12, 32, 24, 29, 15, 25, 31, 33, 30, 37, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act III, Scene IV," how does Shakespeare show the ghost at the banquet? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the ghost at the banquet? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of the ghost at the banquet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of the ghost at the banquet. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene IV suggests about the ghost at the banquet. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's symbolism and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses symbolism in Act III, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of the ghost at the banquet. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the ghost at the banquet responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the ghost at the banquet follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene IV and its treatment of the ghost at the banquet. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's symbolism and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about the ghost at the banquet in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the ghost at the banquet. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *O, these flaws and starts, Impostors to true fear, would well become A woman's story at a winter's fire, Authorized by her grandam.*

As used in the text, what does the word "grandam" most nearly mean?

A. causing wonder; astonishing

B. early

C. tombs

D. a grandmother

2. *O proper stuff! This is the very painting of your fear: This is the air-drawn dagger which, you said, Led you to Duncan. O, these flaws and starts, Impostors to true fear, would well become A woman's story at a winter's fire, Authorized by her grandam. Shame itself! Why do you make such faces? When all's done, You look but on a stool.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene IV"?

A. The ghost at the banquet

B. The murder of the innocent

C. The Witches' riddling world

D. The moving wood

SAT key: 1. D (a grandmother); 2. A (The ghost at the banquet)

Lesson 18: Act III, Scene V

Focus: Hecate and the machinery of fate

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act III, Scene V (Hecate and the machinery of fate) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.3

Teacher only · spoilers

Hecate angrily scolds the Witches, 'beldams' who are 'saucy and overbold,' for trading with Macbeth in riddles without her, for a 'wayward son' who loves for his own ends. She orders them to meet her at the pit of Acheron in the morning, where Macbeth will come to know his destiny, and plans illusions that will draw him on to his confusion. 'Security is mortals' chiefest enemy.'

Background: Most editors think this scene (in rhyming tetrameter and calling for a song found in Thomas Middleton's play The Witch) was added after Shakespeare's death, perhaps for a revival.

Significance: Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy."

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Most editors think this scene (in rhyming tetrameter and calling for a song found in Thomas Middleton's play The Witch) was added after Shakespeare's death, perhaps for a revival. Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions. Characterization: Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence). Structure: The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton. Diction / vocabulary: Rhyming tetrameter like the witches'. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "scorn death, and bear / He hopes 'bove wisdom, grace and fear: / And you all know, security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy. Music and" (Act III, Scene V, Hecate).

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Hecate and the machinery of fate. Key takeaway: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy."*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence).
- **Structure:** The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Rhyming tetrameter like the witches'.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “scorn death, and bear / He hopes ’bove wisdom, grace and fear: / And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy. Music and” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate).
- **darkness and light:** Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder. In this scene: “and every thing beside. / I am for the air; this night I’ll spend / Unto a dismal and a fatal end: / Great business” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) Overconfidence.
- “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) Hecate's complaint.
- “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence.
Evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate)
Reasoning: She says "security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" and that Macbeth will "spurn fate, scorn death."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	Word history

	Definition (in this sentence)		
overbold (adjective)	too bold; presumptuous	*Have I not reason, beldams as you are, Saucy and overbold?*	"overbold": Origin: an English formation from over- + bold. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/overbold#Etymology)
wayward (adjective)	stubborn and self-willed	*And, which is worse, all you have done Hath been but for a wayward son, Spiteful and wrathful, who, as others do, Loves for his own ends, not for you.*	
riddles (noun)	puzzling questions with hidden answers	*How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?*	
traffic (verb)	to deal or trade with	*How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?*	"traffic": Origin: possibly Middle French trafique. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/traffic#Etymology)
vessels (noun)	containers	*But make amends now: get you gone, And at the pit of Acheron Meet me i' the morning: thither he Will come to know his destiny: Your vessels and your spells provide, Your charms and every thing beside.*	
beldams (noun)	hags; spiteful old women	*Have I not reason, beldams as you are, Saucy and overbold?*	
angerly (adverb)	angrily	*Why, how now, Hecate! you look angerly.*	"angerly": Origin: an English formation from anger + -ly. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/angerly#Etymology)
sprites (noun)	spirits; ghosts	*And that distill'd by magic sleights / Shall raise such artificial sprites*	
contriver (noun)	a planner; one who devises	*How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was*	

		never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?	
wrathful (adjective)	full of anger	*And, which is worse, all you have done Hath been but for a wayward son, Spiteful and wrathful, who, as others do, Loves for his own ends, not for you.*	

Discussion questions

1. Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Hecate call the Witches when she scolds them? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Beldams, saucy and overbold.
2. Why is Hecate angry with the Witches? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They dealt with Macbeth without her
3. What does Hecate call Macbeth? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A wayward son
4. Where will they meet in the morning? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The pit of Acheron
5. What does Hecate say is mortals' chiefest enemy? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Security, or overconfidence
6. What will Hecate use to draw Macbeth on? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Illusions raised by magic
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hecate angrily scolds the Witches, 'beldams' who are 'saucy and overbold,' for trading with Macbeth in riddles without her, for a 'wayward son' who loves for his own ends. She orders them to meet her at the pit of Acheron in the morning, where Macbeth will come to know his destiny, and plans illusions that will draw him on to his confusion. 'Security is mortals' chiefest enemy.'
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene V” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Have I not reason, beldams as you are, Saucy and overbold?” What does “overbold” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: overbold: too bold; presumptuous.

Inferential / analytical

1. How does the verse of this scene differ from the rest of the play, and why does that matter to editors? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Rhyming tetrameter and songs suggest a later addition, probably by Middleton.
2. What does “Act III, Scene V” suggest about Hecate and the machinery of fate? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the foreshadowing in this scene shape what we understand about Hecate and the machinery of fate? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Overconfidence. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “A Heath.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hecate angrily scolds the Witches, 'beldams' who are 'saucy and overbold,' for trading with Macbeth in riddles without her, for a 'wayward son' who loves for his own ends. She orders them to meet her at the pit of Acheron in the morning, where Macbeth will come to know his destiny, and plans…
7. How does “Act III, Scene V” build on “Act III, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Hecate's complaint. On structure: The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own

overconfidence. Useful evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. On characterization: Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Overconfidence. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. If this scene was not written by Shakespeare, should productions cut it? Argue for keeping or cutting it. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment balancing authorship and dramatic effect.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Hecate's complaint. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Overconfidence. On characterization: Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Hecate and the machinery of fate. [DOK 4 ·

thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Hecate's complaint. On structure: The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Overconfidence. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Hecate's complaint. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene V” treats Hecate and the machinery of fate with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene VI” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Overconfidence. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Hecate and the machinery of fate? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Hecate's complaint. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 39? “I drink to the _____ joy o’ the whole table, And to our dear friend Banquo, whom we miss; Would he were here! to all, and him, we thirst, And all to all.”

    A. society

    B. ceremony

    C. general

    D. confined

    Key: C (general)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 5: “Ourself will mingle with _____, And play the humble host.” Word bank: enters, absence, society, speculation
    Key: society

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Have I not reason, beldams as you are, Saucy and overbold?”, what does “overbold” most nearly mean?

    A. lit the way for; guided

    B. a strong desire for power or success

    C. too bold; presumptuous

    D. announced loudly; proclaimed

    Key: C (too bold; presumptuous)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “And, which is worse, all you have done Hath been but for a wayward son, Spiteful and wrathful, who, as others do, Loves for his own ends, not for you.”, what does “wayward” most nearly mean?

    A. dangerous

    B. showing good judgment

    C. stubborn and self-willed

D. a tingling feeling

Key: C (stubborn and self-willed)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?", what does "riddles" most nearly mean?

   A. puzzling questions with hidden answers

   B. failure to show thanks

   C. that hunts mice

   D. to scold; to reproach

   Key: A (puzzling questions with hidden answers)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene V, Hecate: "And you all know, _____ / Is mortals' chiefest enemy"

   Key: security

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hecate say is mortals' chiefest enemy?

   A. Love

   B. Security, or overconfidence

   C. Time

   D. Fear

   Key: B (Security, or overconfidence)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Have I not reason, _____ as you are, Saucy and overbold?" Word bank: wayward, overbold, riddles, beldams

   Key: beldams

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why is Hecate angry with the Witches?

   A. They killed Banquo

   B. They dealt with Macbeth without her

   C. They lied to Macbeth

   D. They left Scotland

   Key: B (They dealt with Macbeth without her)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act III, Scene III?

    A. "But who did bid thee join with us?"

    B. "There's but one down; the son is fled."

    C. "Almost a mile: but he does usually, So all men do, from hence to the palace gate Make it their walk."

    D. "Well, let's away, and say how much is done."

    Key: A ("But who did bid thee join with us?")

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 44 reveal about the character or situation? "What man dare, I dare: Approach thou like the rugged Russian bear, The arm'd rhinoceros, or the Hyrcan tiger; Take any shape but that, and my firm nerves Shall never tremble: or be alive again, And dare me to the desert with thy sword; If…" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 44) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: guilt

made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The words “rhinoceros” and “trembling” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 3 reveal about the character or situation? “You know your own degrees; sit down: at first And last the hearty welcome.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 3) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The words “degrees” and “welcome” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene V”?

    A. Dramatic irony at the castle gate
    B. The discovery of the murder
    C. Hecate and the machinery of fate
    D. The ghost at the banquet

    Key: C (Hecate and the machinery of fate)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 53 shapes its tone: “How say’st thou, that Macduff denies his person At our great bidding?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “bidding” and “denies” (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 53) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hecate says security is ‘mortals' chiefest enemy.’

    A. Guilt and conscience
    B. Fate and free will
    C. Ambition and its costs
    D. Appearance versus reality

    Key: B (Fate and free will)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 30 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “Sit, worthy friends: my lord is often thus, And hath been from his youth: pray you, keep seat; The fit is momentary; upon a thought He will again be well: if much you note him, You shall offend him and extend his passion: Feed, and regard…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 30) develops masculinity, power and violence: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Its words “momentary” and “friends” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Blood hath been shed ere now, i’ the olden time, Ere human statute purged the gentle weal; Ay, and since too, murders…” (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 37), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where will they meet in the morning?

    A. The English court
    B. Birnam Wood
    C. The pit of Acheron

D. Inverness castle

Key: C (The pit of Acheron)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “And that distill’d by magic sleights / Shall raise such artificial _____” Word bank: sprites, overbold, riddles, wayward
Key: sprites

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What will Hecate use to draw Macbeth on?

A. An army

B. Poison

C. A letter

D. Illusions raised by magic

Key: D (Illusions raised by magic)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Why, how now, Hecate! you look _____.” Word bank: overbold, angerly, wayward, riddles
Key: angerly

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Hecate's complaint. The evidence is “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate). This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.".

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does the verse of this scene differ from the rest of the play, and why does that matter to editors?
Sample answer: Rhyming tetrameter and songs suggest a later addition, probably by Middleton. The evidence is “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) — Overconfidence.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate).
Sample answer: She says "security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" and that Macbeth will "spurn fate, scorn death.". The evidence is “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate), which shows her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.".

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene V”? Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through ‘security’ (overconfidence).

A. Characterization

B. Tone / mood

C. Alliteration

D. Symbolism

Key: A (Characterization)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Overconfidence. The evidence is “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate). This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.". The words “security” and

"chiefest" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She says "security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" and that Macbeth will "spurn fate, scorn death.".

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "But make amends now: get you gone, And at the pit of Acheron Meet me i' the morning: thither he Will come to know his destiny: Your _____ and your spells provide, Your charms and every thing beside." Word bank: overbold, wayward, vessels, riddles

    Key: vessels

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hecate call Macbeth?

    A. A noble king

    B. A brave soldier

    C. A wayward son

    D. An innocent man

    Key: C (A wayward son)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 18 shapes its tone: "Now, good digestion wait on appetite, And health on both!" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "digestion" and "appetite" (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 18) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear" (Act III, Scene V, Hecate). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. The evidence is "He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear" (Act III, Scene V, Hecate). This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.". The words "scorn" and "death" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] If this scene was not written by Shakespeare, should productions cut it? Argue for keeping or cutting it.

    Sample answer: A judgment balancing authorship and dramatic effect. The evidence is "He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear" (Act III, Scene V, Hecate), which shows her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.". She says "security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" and that Macbeth will "spurn fate, scorn death.".

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 14? "Then comes my fit again: I had else been perfect, Whole as the marble, founded as the rock, As broad and general as the casing air: But now I am cabin'd, cribb'd, _____, bound in To saucy doubts and fears."

    A. confined

    B. infirmity

    C. friends

    D. speculation

    Key: A (confined)

32. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "And you all know, security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) Answer in two or three sentences with one

detail.

Sample answer: Overconfidence. The evidence is “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate). This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.".

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: “My lord, his throat is cut; that I did for him.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “throat” (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene V”? The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton.

    A. Alliteration

    B. Metaphor

    C. Irony

    D. Structure

    Key: D (Structure)

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 39 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “Come, love and health to all; Then I’ll sit down.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 39) develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Its words “health” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Avaunt! and quit my sight! let the earth hide thee!” (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 42), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how fate and free will develops from Act III, Scene III to Act III, Scene V. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act III, Scene III, First Murderer, the text reads “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” — Twilight setting. In Act III, Scene V, “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) — Overconfidence. Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.".

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Hecate's complaint. The evidence is “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate). This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.". The words “overbold” and “and” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She says "security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" and that Macbeth will "spurn fate, scorn death.".

38. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 19: “The Ghost of Banquo _____, and sits in Macbeth’s place.” Word bank: absence, confined, speculation, enters

    Key: enters

39. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In the line “How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all

harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?", what does "traffic" most nearly mean?

A. stubborn and self-willed

B. too bold; presumptuous

C. puzzling questions with hidden answers

D. to deal or trade with

Key: D (to deal or trade with)

40. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? "He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear" (Act III, Scene V, Hecate)

A. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

B. Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless.

C. Banquo's image of nature and holiness.

D. He shuts her out.

Key: B (Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless.)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 5, 4, 9, 6, 18, 8, 19, 7, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 15, 25	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	1, 26, 9, 20, 4, 27, 17, 10, 11, 12, 22, 28, 29, 24, 25, 30	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	31, 26, 17, 27, 8, 10, 12, 32, 21, 22, 28, 14, 33, 29, 16, 30	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 4, 18, 8, 10, 11, 32, 22, 21, 33, 14, 34, 29, 35, 30, 36	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 6, 7, 26, 10, 12, 22, 28, 33, 14, 23, 24, 37, 36, 25, 30	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	38, 9, 26, 10, 11, 21, 22, 14, 33, 29, 24, 15, 35, 16, 36, 30	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	31, 20, 26, 10, 12, 21, 33, 28, 14, 15, 23, 34, 16, 35, 30, 36	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 4
College Junior	6, 39, 26, 10, 22, 33, 28, 14, 15, 23, 24, 35, 16, 36, 37, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Senior	26, 8, 10, 11, 40, 32, 22, 14, 33, 28, 24, 15, 35, 16, 36, 30	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	2, 26, 9, 10, 22, 33, 14, 28, 29, 24, 15, 35, 16, 30, 36, 25	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show Hecate and the machinery of fate? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Hecate and the machinery of fate? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene V develops the idea of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene V suggests about Hecate and the machinery of fate. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act III, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Hecate and the machinery of fate responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Hecate and the machinery of fate follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene V and its treatment of Hecate and the machinery of fate. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about Hecate and the machinery of fate in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "riddles" most nearly mean?

   A. full of anger

   B. a planner; one who devises

   C. puzzling questions with hidden answers

   D. spirits; ghosts

2. *A Heath.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene V"?

   A. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

   B. The dagger of the mind

   C. The tyrant's end and a new order

   D. Hecate and the machinery of fate

SAT key: 1. C (puzzling questions with hidden answers); 2. D (Hecate and the machinery of fate)

Lesson 19: Act III, Scene VI

Focus: suspicion spoken through irony

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "Act III, Scene VI" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…the two delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and thralls of sleep? Was not that nobl…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Lennox, speaking with heavy irony, lists the 'convenient' deaths and flights: how the 'right-valiant' Banquo walked too late, how Fleance must have killed his father because he fled, how wisely Macbeth killed the grooms. A Lord reports that Malcolm lives at the English court of the holy King Edward, that Macduff has gone to ask Edward to rouse Northumberland and Siward, and that Macbeth prepares for war.

Background: Edward the Confessor (reigned 1042 to 1066) was revered as a saintly king; contrasting him with Macbeth sets holy kingship against tyranny.

Significance: Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: speech must be guarded under tyranny.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: delinquents — offenders; bestows — lodges (himself); places; interpret — to explain the meaning of; accursed — under a curse; caution — a warning; care to avoid danger. “delinquents”: Origin of “delinquent”: Middle French délinquant; earlier Latin delinquens. “interpret”: Origin: probably Old French enterpreter; earlier Latin interpretor (“to explain”). “caution”: Origin: Old French caution (“security”); earlier Latin cautiō.
Words: delinquents: offenders · bestows: lodges (himself); places · interpret: to explain the meaning of · accursed: under a curse · caution: a warning; care to avoid danger

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Edward the Confessor (reigned 1042 to 1066) was revered as a saintly king; contrasting him with Macbeth sets holy kingship against tyranny. Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony. Irony: Lennox speaks sarcastically about Duncan and Banquo's "deaths," exposing Macbeth's guilt. Characterization: Macduff has gone to England to seek help. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “high respect: thither Macduff / Is gone to pray the holy king, upon his aid / To wake Northumberland and warlike Siward: / That, by” (Act III, Scene VI, Lord).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “Things have been strangely borne” slowly and put it in my own words: Talking with another lord, Lennox remarks that things have been strangely managed since Duncan's death. Next, craft. I notice his ironic understatement: he praises Macbeth on the surface while hinting at guilt underneath. The strongest word is “strangely”: it hints at suspicion without making an accusation that could get him killed. Then, effect. What is Lennox really saying when he calls events "strangely borne"? My answer: When Lennox calls events "strangely borne," he is really saying Macbeth arranged the murders of Duncan and Banquo; his careful sarcasm shows that the thanes now distrust Macbeth but fear to speak openly.

> *Things have been strangely borne (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “Things have been strangely borne” slowly and put it in my own words: Talking with another lord, Lennox remarks that things have been strangely managed since Duncan's death. Next, craft. I notice his ironic understatement: he praises Macbeth on the surface while hinting at guilt underneath. The strongest word is “strangely”: it hints at suspicion without making an accusation that could get him killed. Then, effect. What is Lennox really saying when he calls events "strangely borne"? My answer: When Lennox calls events "strangely borne," he is really saying Macbeth arranged the murders of Duncan and Banquo; his careful sarcasm shows that the thanes now distrust Macbeth but fear to speak openly.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Marry" means indeed; Lennox mocks the official story. Appearance and reality. Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality? Expected: Speech must be guarded under tyranny. (Irony.)

> *The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead* (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Marry" means indeed; Lennox mocks the official story. Appearance and reality.
Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality?
Expected answer: Speech must be guarded under tyranny. (Irony.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene VI develops the idea of suspicion spoken through irony. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. When the text says "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox), it shows this directly. He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.
Task: Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene VI develops the idea of suspicion spoken through irony. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. When the text says "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox), it shows this directly. He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power? Ask: when do people speak in irony instead of directly?
Anchor question: Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power?
Facilitation: Ask: when do people speak in irony instead of directly?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. ("The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead", Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. ("The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead", Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes suspicion spoken through irony. Key takeaway: speech must be guarded under tyranny.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Lennox speaks sarcastically about Duncan and Banquo's "deaths," exposing Macbeth's guilt.
- **Characterization:** Macduff has gone to England to seek help.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** speech must be guarded under tyranny.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "high respect: thither Macduff / Is gone to pray the holy king, upon his aid / To wake Northumberland and warlike Siward: / That, by" (Act III, Scene VI, Lord).
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: "sleep to our nights, / Free from our feasts and banquets bloody knives, / Do faithful homage and receive free honours: / All which we" (Act III, Scene VI, Lord).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) Irony.
- "Things have been strangely borne" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) Understatement.
- "this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) Scotland under tyranny.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly.
Evidence: "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox)
Reasoning: He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
delinquents (noun)	offenders	*How it did grieve Macbeth! did he not straight In pious rage the two delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and thralls of sleep?*	"delinquents": Origin of "delinquent": Middle French délinquant; earlier Latin delinquens. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/delinquent#Etymology)
bestows (verb)	lodges (himself); places	*But, peace! for from broad words and 'cause he fail'd His presence at the tyrant's feast, I hear Macduff lives in disgrace: sir, can you tell Where he bestows himself?*	
interpret (verb)	to explain the meaning of	*My former speeches have but hit your thoughts, Which can interpret further: only, I say, Things have been strangely borne.*	"interpret": Origin: probably Old French enterpreter; earlier Latin interpretor ("to explain"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/interpret#Etymology)
accursed (adjective)	under a curse	*Some holy angel Fly to the court of England and unfold His message ere he come, that a swift blessing May soon return to this our suffering country Under a hand accursed!*	
caution (noun)	a warning; care to avoid danger	*And that well might Advise him to a caution, to hold what distance His wisdom can provide.*	"caution": Origin: Old French caution ("security"); earlier Latin cautiō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/caution#Etymology)
thralls (noun)	slaves; captives	*How it did grieve Macbeth! did he not straight In pious rage the two delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and thralls of sleep?*	
monstrous (adjective)	horrible; unnatural	*Who cannot want the thought how monstrous It was for Malcolm and for Donalbain To kill their gracious father? damned fact!*	"monstrous": Origin: Old French monstrueuse; earlier Latin mōnstrōsus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/monstrous#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whom does Lennox say Fleance must have killed, since he fled? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His father, Banquo (said ironically).
2. How does Lennox speak about the recent deaths? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: With irony, hinting that Macbeth is guilty
3. Where is Malcolm living? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At the English court of King Edward
4. Where has Macduff gone? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To England to seek help
5. Whom does Macduff hope Edward will rouse? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Northumberland and warlike Siward
6. How do Lennox and the Lord now refer to Macbeth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: As a tyrant
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene VI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lennox, speaking with heavy irony, lists the 'convenient' deaths and flights: how the 'right-valiant' Banquo walked too late, how Fleance must have killed his father because he fled, how wisely Macbeth killed the grooms. A Lord reports that Malcolm lives at the English court of the holy King Edward, that Macduff has gone to ask Edward to rouse Northumberland and Siward, and that Macbeth prepares…
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene VI", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene VI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "How it did grieve Macbeth! did he not straight In pious rage the two delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and thralls of sleep?" What does "delinquents" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: delinquents: offenders.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Lennox never say directly that Macbeth is a murderer? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Speaking openly under a tyrant is dangerous; irony protects him.
2. What does “Act III, Scene VI” suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about suspicion spoken through irony? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Irony. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “And that well might Advise him to a caution, to hold what distance His wisdom can provide.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene VI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Lennox, speaking with heavy irony, lists the 'convenient' deaths and flights: how the 'right-valiant' Banquo walked too late, how Fleance must have killed his father because he fled, how wisely Macbeth killed the grooms. A Lord reports that Malcolm lives at the English court of the holy King…
7. How does “Act III, Scene VI” build on “Act III, Scene V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Understatement. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Scotland under tyranny. On characterization: Macduff has gone to England to seek help. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Irony. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is irony a form of courage or a way of avoiding risk? Judge Lennox. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment about indirect resistance.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: "Things have been strangely borne" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Understatement. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: "this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Scotland under tyranny. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Irony. On characterization: Macduff has gone to England to seek help. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing "Act III, Scene VI". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of suspicion spoken through irony. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: "Things have been strangely borne" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox):

Understatement. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Scotland under tyranny. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Irony. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Understatement. On irony: Lennox speaks sarcastically about Duncan and Banquo's "deaths," exposing Macbeth's guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene VI” treats suspicion spoken through irony with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Scotland under tyranny. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Irony. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about suspicion spoken through irony? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox): Understatement. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene VI, Lennox: “this our _____ country / Under a hand accursed”
    Key: suffering
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “But, peace! for from broad words and ’cause he fail’d His presence at the tyrant’s feast, I hear Macduff lives in disgrace: sir, can you tell Where he bestows himself?”, what does “bestows” most nearly mean?
    A. lodges (himself); places
    B. the person who first devised something
    C. thrift; careful saving
    D. judgments; opinions

    Key: A (lodges (himself); places)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where has Macduff gone?
    A. To England to seek help
    B. To fight in Ireland
    C. To Inverness
    D. To Scone

    Key: A (To England to seek help)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “How it did grieve Macbeth! did he not straight In pious rage the two delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and _____ of sleep?” Word bank: delinquents, interpret, bestows, thralls
    Key: thralls
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Lennox speak about the recent deaths?
    A. With grief and no suspicion
    B. In a letter to Malcolm
    C. With irony, hinting that Macbeth is guilty
    D. With praise for Macbeth

Key: C (With irony, hinting that Macbeth is guilty)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “My former speeches have but hit your thoughts, Which can interpret further: only, I say, Things have been strangely borne.”, what does “interpret” most nearly mean?

   A. without limit

   B. forced; acting against their will

   C. sweet-smelling liquids

   D. to explain the meaning of

   Key: D (to explain the meaning of)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Who cannot want the thought how _____ It was for Malcolm and for Donalbain To kill their gracious father? damned fact!” Word bank: bestows, monstrous, delinquents, interpret

   Key: monstrous

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene VI, Lennox: “The _____ Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead”

   Key: gracious

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where is Malcolm living?

   A. In Fife

   B. In Ireland

   C. In Norway

   D. At the English court of King Edward

   Key: D (At the English court of King Edward)

10. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Lennox say Fleance must have killed, since he fled?

    Sample answer: His father, Banquo (said ironically).

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Irony. The evidence is “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Lennox never say directly that Macbeth is a murderer?

    Sample answer: Speaking openly under a tyrant is dangerous; irony protects him. The evidence is “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox).

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Understatement. The evidence is “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene VI”? Lennox speaks sarcastically about Duncan and Banquo's ‘deaths,’ exposing Macbeth's guilt.

    A. Irony

B. Alliteration

C. Plot

D. Theme

Key: A (Irony)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Scotland under tyranny. The evidence is “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny. The words “suffering” and “accursed” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is irony a form of courage or a way of avoiding risk? Judge Lennox.
Sample answer: A judgment about indirect resistance: Irony. The evidence is “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny. He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do Lennox and the Lord now refer to Macbeth?

A. As a saint

B. As a stranger

C. As a weak king

D. As a tyrant

Key: D (As a tyrant)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “And that well might Advise him to a _____, to hold what distance His wisdom can provide.” Word bank: bestows, caution, delinquents, interpret
Key: caution

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Some holy angel Fly to the court of England and unfold His message ere he come, that a swift blessing May soon return to this our suffering country Under a hand accursed!”, what does “accursed” most nearly mean?

A. under a curse

B. to deceive; to blind

C. makes (someone) furious

D. staying; lingering

Key: A (under a curse)

20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene VI”? Macduff has gone to England to seek help.

A. Simile

B. Diction / vocabulary

C. Characterization

D. Hyperbole

Key: C (Characterization)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 14? “Then comes my fit again: I had else been perfect, Whole as the marble, founded as the rock,

As broad and general as the casing air: But now I am cabin'd, cribb'd, _____, bound in To saucy doubts and fears."

A. confined

B. infirmity

C. friends

D. speculation

Key: A (confined)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 5: "Ourself will mingle with _____, And play the humble host." Word bank: enters, absence, society, speculation

Key: society

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 44 reveal about the character or situation? "What man dare, I dare: Approach thou like the rugged Russian bear, The arm'd rhinoceros, or the Hyrcan tiger; Take any shape but that, and my firm nerves Shall never tremble: or be alive again, And dare me to the desert with thy sword; If…" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 44) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The words "rhinoceros" and "trembling" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 3 reveal about the character or situation? "You know your own degrees; sit down: at first And last the hearty welcome." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 3) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The words "degrees" and "welcome" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act III, Scene VI?

A. "Ay, and wisely too; For 'twould have anger'd any heart alive To hear the men deny't."

B. "That, by the help of these—with Him above To ratify the work—we may again Give to our tables meat, sleep to our nights, Free from our…"

C. "The son of Duncan, From whom this tyrant holds the due of birth, Lives in the English court, and is received Of the most pious Edward with…"

D. "So that, I say, He has borne all things well: and I do think That had he Duncan's sons under his key—As, an't please heaven, he shall…"

Key: A ("Ay, and wisely too; For 'twould have anger'd any heart alive To hear the men deny't.")

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: "My lord, his throat is cut; that I did for him." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "throat" (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox).

Sample answer: He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses. The evidence is “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) — Irony. This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 30 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “Sit, worthy friends: my lord is often thus, And hath been from his youth: pray you, keep seat; The fit is momentary; upon a thought He will again be well: if much you note him, You shall offend him and extend his passion: Feed, and regard…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 30) develops masculinity, power and violence: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Its words “momentary” and “friends” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Blood hath been shed ere now, i’ the olden time, Ere human statute purged the gentle weal; Ay, and since too, murders…” (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 37), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how appearance and reality develops from Act II, Scene III to Act III, Scene VI. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act II, Scene III, Porter, the text reads “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate”, which shows the drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. In Act III, Scene VI, “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) — Irony. Speech must be guarded under tyranny.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 52: “Almost at odds with _____, which is which.” Word bank: ceremony, serpent, infirmity, morning

    Key: morning

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene VI”?

    A. The guilt that will not wash away

    B. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

    C. The tyrant's end and a new order

    D. Suspicion spoken through irony

    Key: D (Suspicion spoken through irony)

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 18 shapes its tone: “Now, good digestion wait on appetite, And health on both!” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “digestion” and “appetite” (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 18) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 53 shapes its tone: “How say’st thou, that Macduff denies his person At our great bidding?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “bidding” and “denies” (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 53) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Understatement. The evidence is “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny. The words “strangely” and “borne” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 39? “I drink to the _____ joy o’ the whole table, And to our dear friend Banquo, whom we miss; Would he were here! to all, and him, we thirst, And all to all.”

    A. society

    B. ceremony

    C. general

    D. confined

    Key: C (general)

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 39 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “Come, love and health to all; Then I’ll sit down.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 39) develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Its words “health” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Avaunt! and quit my sight! let the earth hide thee!” (Act III, Scene IV, paragraph 42), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Irony. The evidence is “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny. The words “gracious” and “pitied” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	4, 6, 7, 3, 8, 17, 18, 9, 1, 19, 11, 13, 12, 20, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	21, 22, 19, 17, 9, 6, 1, 23, 24, 12, 25, 26, 15, 27, 28, 29	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	30, 19, 8, 18, 2, 23, 24, 31, 25, 12, 32, 33, 27, 15, 28, 34	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	35, 30, 3, 1, 7, 24, 23, 12, 25, 33, 32, 26, 20, 36, 29, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	22, 7, 3, 5, 23, 25, 12, 33, 32, 26, 15, 20, 28, 36, 29, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	5, 18, 4, 9, 24, 12, 25, 33, 26, 32, 14, 15, 28, 36, 29, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
	2, 19, 18, 7, 25, 12, 32, 33, 15, 27, 14, 28, 36, 29, 34, 16	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5

College Sophomore		
College Junior	3, 18, 7, 5, 9, 24, 26, 32, 33, 15, 20, 36, 28, 16, 37, 29	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	4, 18, 5, 9, 23, 25, 12, 26, 33, 32, 14, 36, 28, 29, 34, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	17, 18, 4, 5, 23, 24, 25, 32, 26, 15, 20, 36, 28, 34, 29, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act III, Scene VI," how does Shakespeare show suspicion spoken through irony? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene VI, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of suspicion spoken through irony? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene VI develops the idea of suspicion spoken through irony. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of suspicion spoken through irony. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene VI suggests about suspicion spoken through irony. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act III, Scene VI to complicate the reader's understanding of suspicion spoken through irony. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of suspicion spoken through irony responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of suspicion spoken through irony follows

or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene VI and its treatment of suspicion spoken through irony. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene VI as evidence for a larger claim about suspicion spoken through irony in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene VI as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of suspicion spoken through irony. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *My former speeches have but hit your thoughts, Which can interpret further: only, I say, Things have been strangely borne.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “interpret” most nearly mean?

   A. a warning; care to avoid danger

   B. slaves; captives

   C. to explain the meaning of

   D. horrible; unnatural

2. *And that well might Advise him to a caution, to hold what distance His wisdom can provide. Some holy angel Fly to the court of England and unfold His message ere he come, that a swift blessing May soon return to this our suffering country Under a hand accursed!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene VI”?

   A. Suspicion spoken through irony

   B. Lady Macbeth's resolve

   C. The murder of the innocent

   D. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

SAT key: 1. C (to explain the meaning of); 2. A (Suspicion spoken through irony)

Lesson 20: Act IV, Scene I

Focus: the apparitions and false security

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in “Act IV, Scene I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (antisemitic and ethnic slurs (period language), infanticide imagery): The witches' recipe includes 'Liver of blaspheming Jew', 'Nose of Turk and Tartar's lips' and 'Finger of birth-strangled babe / Ditch-deliver'd by a drab'. Name the antisemitic and ethnic othering as period prejudice that marks the brew as evil by association; decide in advance that these lines are not performed or read aloud for effect, and discuss why the play links outsiders with evil.
Student preview: This scene includes period antisemitic and ethnic slurs and an image of a murdered newborn.
Suggested language: “What does the recipe show about who the play treats as 'other'?”

Teacher only · spoilers

The Witches brew their potion ('Double, double toil and trouble'). Macbeth demands answers. Three apparitions warn him to beware Macduff (an armed head), tell him none of woman born shall harm him (a bloody child), and that he will never be vanquished until Great Birnam Wood comes to high Dunsinane Hill (a child crowned, with a tree in his hand). He then sees a show of eight kings followed by Banquo's ghost, the last king holding a glass. Learning from Lennox that Macduff has fled to England, Macbeth vows to seize Fife and kill his wife and children.

Background: The line of eight kings honors the Stuart ancestors of James I; the glass (mirror) may have reflected King James himself if he watched a performance.

Significance: Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.'

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because.... Content note before we start: This scene includes period antisemitic and ethnic slurs and an image of a murdered newborn.
Prompt: Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: scepters — rods carried by kings as a sign of power; pricking — a tingling feeling; vanquish — to defeat completely; exploits — bold deeds; boasting — bragging. “vanquish”: Origin: Middle English venquysshen; earlier Old French veincre. “exploits”: Origin of “exploit”: Old French esploit.
Words: scepters: rods carried by kings as a sign of power · pricking: a tingling feeling · vanquish: to defeat completely · exploits: bold deeds · boasting: bragging

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The line of eight kings honors the Stuart ancestors of James I; the glass (mirror) may have reflected King James himself if he watched a performance. Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.' Imagery: The cauldron's recipe ("Eye of newt, and toe of frog"): grotesque catalogue of body parts. Structure: Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle. Dramatic irony: The audience can guess the tricks (a man not "of woman born," the wood that moves); Macbeth cannot. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “art, for thy good caution, thanks; / Thou hast harp’d my fear aright: but one word more” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” slowly and put it in my own words: Around the cauldron, the witches chant "double, double toil and trouble; fire burn and cauldron bubble." Next, craft. I notice the strong four-beat rhythm and rhyme, unlike the play's usual blank verse, which marks it as a spell. The strongest word is “cauldron”: it is the pot where their horrible ingredients brew, the source of the visions they will show. Then, effect. What mood does the witches' chant create as Macbeth comes to them? My answer: The chant creates a supernatural, threatening mood; Macbeth now seeks the witches himself, and the prophecies they brew will give him false confidence.

> *Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble* (Act IV, Scene I, All)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” slowly and put it in my own words: Around the cauldron, the witches chant "double, double toil and trouble; fire burn and cauldron bubble." Next, craft. I notice the strong four-beat rhythm and rhyme, unlike the play's usual blank verse, which marks it as a spell. The strongest word is “cauldron”: it is the pot where their horrible ingredients brew, the source of the visions they will show. Then, effect. What mood does the witches' chant create as Macbeth comes to them? My answer: The chant creates a supernatural, threatening mood; Macbeth now seeks the witches himself, and the prophecies they brew will give him false confidence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Firstlings" means first-born; he will act on impulse. Equivocation and fate. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: The riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. (The equivocal prophecy.)

> *none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Firstlings" means first-born; he will act on impulse. Equivocation and fate.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: The riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. (The equivocal prophecy.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for imagery, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the apparitions and false security? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the apparitions and false security. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. When the text says “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition), it shows this directly. Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.
Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the apparitions and false security? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the apparitions and false security. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. When the text says “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition), it shows this directly. Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it? Ask: why does Macbeth kill Macduff's family if he believes he is safe?
Anchor question: Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Macbeth kill Macduff's family if he believes he is safe?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the apparitions and false security? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. (“none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth”, Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the apparitions and false security? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. (“none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth”, Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the apparitions and false security. Key takeaway: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The cauldron's recipe ("Eye of newt, and toe of frog"): grotesque catalogue of body parts.
- **Structure:** Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle.
- **Dramatic irony:** The audience can guess the tricks (a man not "of woman born," the wood that moves); Macbeth cannot.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “art, for thy good caution, thanks; / Thou hast harp’d my fear aright: but one word more” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Macbeth! Macbeth! Macbeth! beware Macduff; / Beware the thane of Fife. Dismiss me. Enough. Descends” (Act IV, Scene I, First Apparition).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, All) The chant; trochaic rhythm.
- "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition) The equivocal prophecy.
- "The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand" (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth) Macbeth will act without thought.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime.
Evidence: "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition)
Reasoning: Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
scepters (noun)	rods carried by kings as a sign of power	*I'll see no more: And yet the eighth appears, who bears a glass Which shows me many more; and some I see That two-fold balls and treble scepters carry: Horrible sight!*	
pricking (noun)	a tingling feeling	*By the pricking of my thumbs, Something wicked this way comes.*	
vanquish (verb)	to defeat completely	*Be lion-mettled, proud; and take no care Who chafes, who frets, or where conspirers are: Macbeth shall never vanquish'd be until Great Birnam wood to high Dunsinane hill Shall come against him.*	"vanquish": Origin: Middle English venquysshen; earlier Old French veincre. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/vanquish#Etymology)
exploits (noun)	bold deeds	*Time, thou anticipatest my dread exploits: The flighty purpose never is o'ertook Unless the deed go with it: from this moment The very firstlings of my heart shall be The firstlings of my hand.*	"exploits": Origin of "exploit": Old French esploit. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/exploit#Etymology)
boasting (noun)	bragging	*No boasting like a fool; This deed I'll do before this purpose cool.*	
impress (verb)	to force into service; also, to cut into or mark	*That will never be: Who can impress the forest, bid the tree Unfix his earth-bound root?*	
brinded (adjective)	streaked; tabby	*Thrice the brinded cat hath mew'd.*	

amazedly (adverb)	in a stunned way	*Ay, sir, all this is so: but why Stands Macbeth thus amazedly?*	
firstlings (noun)	first impulses	*Time, thou anticipatest my dread exploits: The flighty purpose never is o'ertook Unless the deed go with it: from this moment The very firstlings of my heart shall be The firstlings of my hand.*	
mettled (adjective)	spirited; courageous (lion-mettled: brave as a lion)	*Be lion-mettled, proud; and take no care Who chafes, who frets, or where conspirers are: Macbeth shall never vanquish'd be until Great Birnam wood to high Dunsinane hill Shall come against him.*	

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the Second Witch say just before Macbeth enters? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: 'By the pricking of my thumbs, something wicked this way comes.'
2. What does the first apparition, an armed head, warn? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Beware Macduff
3. What does the bloody child say? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: None of woman born shall harm Macbeth
4. Until what happens will Macbeth never be vanquished? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Birnam Wood comes to Dunsinane
5. What does the show of eight kings reveal? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Banquo's descendants will rule
6. What does Macbeth decide after hearing Macduff has fled? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To kill Macduff's wife and children
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Witches brew their potion ('Double, double toil and

trouble'). Macbeth demands answers. Three apparitions warn him to beware Macduff (an armed head), tell him none of woman born shall harm him (a bloody child), and that he will never be vanquished until Great Birnam Wood comes to high Dunsinane Hill (a child crowned, with a tree in his hand). He then sees a show of eight kings followed by…

8. Who is on stage in “Act IV, Scene I”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act IV, Scene I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I’ll see no more: And yet the eighth appears, who bears a glass Which shows me many more; and some I see That two-fold balls and treble scepters carry: Horrible sight!” What does “scepters” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: scepters: rods carried by kings as a sign of power.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macbeth feel safe after the apparitions, even though the first one warned him? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: He trusts the reassuring riddles and ignores the warning: overconfidence.
2. What does Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family show about how his violence has changed? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: It is now reflexive and pointless, aimed at the innocent.
3. What does “Act IV, Scene I” suggest about the apparitions and false security? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.'
4. Find one example of foreshadowing in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
5. How does the symbolism in this scene shape what we understand about the apparitions and false security? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins “That will never be: Who can impress the forest, bid the tree Unfix his earth-bound root?”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The Witches brew their potion ('Double, double toil and trouble'). Macbeth demands answers. Three apparitions warn him to beware Macduff (an armed head), tell him none of woman born shall harm him (a bloody child), and that he will never be vanquished until Great Birnam Wood comes to high Dunsinane…

8. How does “Act IV, Scene I” build on “Act III, Scene VI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition): The equivocal prophecy. On structure: Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth): Macbeth will act without thought. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Are the Witches' prophecies lies? Argue whether deceiving with literal truth is worse than lying. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment about deception through literal truth.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.'” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition): The equivocal prophecy. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth): Macbeth will act without thought. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the apparitions and false security. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All): The chant; trochaic rhythm. On structure: Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition): The equivocal prophecy. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth): Macbeth will act without thought. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the foreshadowing in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene I” treats the apparitions and false security with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition): The equivocal prophecy. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth): Macbeth will act without thought. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the apparitions and false security? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the first apparition, an armed head, warn?

   A. Beware Macduff

   B. Trust Lady Macbeth

   C. Beware Banquo

   D. Fear no man

   Key: A (Beware Macduff)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Be lion-mettled, proud; and take no care Who chafes, who frets, or where conspirers are: Macbeth shall never vanquish’d be until Great Birnam wood to high Dunsinane hill Shall come against him.”, what does “vanquish” most nearly mean?

   A. to defeat completely

   B. the handle of a dagger

   C. without equal

D. formally given the office and crown of king

Key: A (to defeat completely)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "I'll see no more: And yet the eighth appears, who bears a glass Which shows me many more; and some I see That two-fold balls and treble scepters carry: Horrible sight!", what does "scepters" most nearly mean?

   A. rods carried by kings as a sign of power

   B. actions; things done

   C. the nuts of the chestnut tree

   D. to explain the meaning of

   Key: A (rods carried by kings as a sign of power)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "That will never be: Who can _____ the forest, bid the tree Unfix his earth-bound root?" Word bank: scepters, pricking, impress, vanquish

   Key: impress

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Ay, sir, all this is so: but why Stands Macbeth thus _____?" Word bank: pricking, vanquish, scepters, amazedly

   Key: amazedly

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Thrice the _____ cat hath mew'd." Word bank: vanquish, scepters, brinded, pricking

   Key: brinded

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth: "The very _____ of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand"

   Key: firstlings

8. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Second Witch say just before Macbeth enters?

   Sample answer: 'By the pricking of my thumbs, something wicked this way comes.'

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Time, thou anticipatest my dread exploits: The flighty purpose never is o'ertook Unless the deed go with it: from this moment The very firstlings of my heart shall be The firstlings of my hand.", what does "exploits" most nearly mean?

   A. bold deeds

   B. announced loudly; proclaimed

   C. fearless; not discouraged

   D. actions; things done

   Key: A (bold deeds)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the bloody child say?

    A. Macduff is dead

    B. Fleance will be king

    C. Macbeth will die tonight

    D. None of woman born shall harm Macbeth

    Key: D (None of woman born shall harm Macbeth)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the show of eight kings reveal?

    A. Duncan's line is ended

    B. England will conquer Scotland

    C. Banquo's descendants will rule

    D. Macbeth's sons will rule

    Key: C (Banquo's descendants will rule)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Macbeth feel safe after the apparitions, even though the first one warned him?

    Sample answer: He trusts the reassuring riddles and ignores the warning: overconfidence. The evidence is “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All), which shows the chant; trochaic rhythm.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family show about how his violence has changed?

    Sample answer: It is now reflexive and pointless, aimed at the innocent. The evidence is “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All), which shows the chant; trochaic rhythm.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Macbeth will act without thought. The evidence is “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. The words “firstlings” and “shall” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The riddles give Macbeth ‘security,’ and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

    A. Fate and free will

    B. Guilt and conscience

    C. Appearance versus reality

    D. Ambition and its costs

    Key: A (Fate and free will)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how fate and free will develops from Act III, Scene V to Act IV, Scene I. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act III, Scene V, Hecate, the text reads “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” — Overconfidence. In Act IV, Scene I, “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All), which shows the chant; trochaic rhythm. The riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Until what happens will Macbeth never be vanquished?

    A. Banquo returns

    B. Malcolm returns

    C. Birnam Wood comes to Dunsinane

    D. The sun sets at noon

    Key: C (Birnam Wood comes to Dunsinane)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth decide after hearing Macduff has fled?

    A. To pardon Macduff

    B. To give up the crown

    C. To follow him to England

    D. To kill Macduff's wife and children

    Key: D (To kill Macduff's wife and children)

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene I"?

    A. Hecate and the machinery of fate

    B. The ghost at the banquet

    C. The apparitions and false security

    D. Lady Macbeth's resolve

    Key: C (The apparitions and false security)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, All) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The chant; trochaic rhythm. The evidence is "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, All). This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The equivocal prophecy. The evidence is "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition). This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. The words "woman" and "born" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "By the pricking of my thumbs, Something wicked this way comes.", what does "pricking" most nearly mean?

    A. dangerous

    B. a greeting

    C. a tingling feeling

    D. spirits; ghosts

    Key: C (a tingling feeling)

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The equivocal prophecy. The evidence is "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition). This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in "Act IV, Scene I"? Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle.

    A. Simile

    B. Structure

    C. Setting

    D. Personification

    Key: B (Structure)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Are the Witches' prophecies lies? Argue whether deceiving with literal truth is worse than lying.

    Sample answer: A judgment about deception through literal truth. The evidence is "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, All), which shows the chant; trochaic rhythm. This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene I, All: "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and _____ bubble"

    Key: cauldron

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act IV, Scene I, paragraph 52? "Let this _____ hour Stand aye accursed in the calendar!"

    A. crowned

    B. satisfied

    C. murderer

    D. pernicious

    Key: D (pernicious)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act IV, Scene I?

    A. "How now, you secret, black, and midnight hags!"

    B. "Pour in sow's blood, that hath eaten Her nine farrow; grease that's sweaten From the murderer's gibbet throw Into the flame."

    C. "Come, high or low; Thyself and office deftly show!"

    D. "Say, if thou'dst rather hear it from our mouths, Or from our masters?"

    Key: A ("How now, you secret, black, and midnight hags!")

29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does this passage from Act IV, Scene I, paragraph 23 reveal about the character or situation? "Say, if thou'dst rather hear it from our mouths, Or from our masters?" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act IV, Scene I, paragraph 23) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. The words "masters" and "mouths" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act IV, Scene I, paragraph 44 shapes its tone: "Why sinks that cauldron? and what noise is this?" Pick two words

and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “cauldron” (Act IV, Scene I, paragraph 44) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act IV, Scene I, paragraph 32 shapes its tone: “He will not be commanded: here’s another, More potent than the first.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “commanded” and “another” (Act IV, Scene I, paragraph 32) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act IV, Scene I, paragraph 10 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “Scale of dragon, tooth of wolf, Witches’ mummy, maw and gulf Of the ravin’d salt-sea shark, Root of hemlock digg’d i’ the dark, Liver of blaspheming Jew, Gall of goat, and slips of yew Sliver’d in the moon’s eclipse, Nose of Turk and…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act IV, Scene I, paragraph 10) develops guilt and conscience: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Its words “ingredients” and “blaspheming” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I commend your pains; And every one shall share i’ the gains: And now about the cauldron sing, Live elves and fairies…” (Act IV, Scene I, paragraph 14), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

33. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “No _____ like a fool; This deed I’ll do before this purpose cool.” Word bank: scepters, vanquish, boasting, pricking

    Key: boasting

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene I”? The cauldron's recipe (‘Eye of newt, and toe of frog’): grotesque catalogue of body parts.

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Imagery

    C. Alliteration

    D. Conflict

    Key: B (Imagery)

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The chant; trochaic rhythm. The evidence is “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All). This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. The words “cauldron” and “trouble” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth)

    A. Macbeth will act without thought.

B. The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious.

C. Echo of "what's done is done."

D. Graphic violence praised as service.

Key: A (Macbeth will act without thought.)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition).

Sample answer: Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family. The evidence is “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition) — The equivocal prophecy. This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

38. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which word completes this sentence from Act IV, Scene I, paragraph 25? “Pour in sow’s blood, that hath eaten Her nine farrow; grease that’s sweaten From the _____’s gibbet throw Into the flame.”

A. thought

B. murderer

C. galloping

D. shadows

Key: B (murderer)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	7, 11, 17, 6, 5, 18, 4, 3, 1, 13, 19, 12, 20, 15, 14, 21	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 7, 10, 22, 3, 5, 1, 12, 20, 13, 23, 15, 24, 14, 16, 25	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	6, 26, 27, 2, 10, 28, 13, 19, 29, 12, 15, 14, 30, 31, 16, 32	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	1, 5, 33, 8, 28, 29, 12, 13, 23, 34, 30, 31, 15, 16, 35, 32	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	26, 6, 8, 19, 13, 12, 36, 29, 28, 37, 31, 15, 30, 32, 25, 16	recall 3, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Freshman	33, 4, 2, 12, 29, 28, 13, 31, 37, 30, 15, 24, 14, 16, 25, 32	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	33, 4, 27, 13, 19, 12, 29, 28, 15, 31, 30, 14, 32, 21, 16, 25	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	33, 4, 38, 28, 29, 12, 13, 14, 30, 34, 31, 15, 16, 32, 21, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Senior	33, 4, 1, 36, 23, 28, 12, 29, 13, 34, 15, 30, 31, 25, 32, 16	recall 3, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3
Graduate / PhD	4, 1, 33, 20, 29, 28, 12, 24, 15, 31, 30, 37, 14, 16, 32, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the apparitions and false security? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the apparitions and false security? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the apparitions and false security. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the apparitions and false security. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene I suggests about the apparitions and false security. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's foreshadowing and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses foreshadowing in Act IV, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the apparitions and false security. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the apparitions and false security responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the apparitions and false security follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene I and its treatment of the apparitions and false security. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's foreshadowing and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the apparitions and false security in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the apparitions and false security. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Be lion-mettled, proud; and take no care Who chafes, who frets, or where conspirers are: Macbeth shall never vanquish'd be until Great Birnam wood to high Dunsinane hill Shall come against him.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "vanquish" most nearly mean?

   A. in a stunned way

   B. spirited; courageous (lion-mettled: brave as a lion)

   C. first impulses

   D. to defeat completely

2. *That will never be: Who can impress the forest, bid the tree Unfix his earth-bound root? Sweet bodements! good! Rebellion's head, rise never till the wood Of Birnam rise, and our high-placed Macbeth Shall live the lease of nature, pay his breath To time and mortal custom. Yet my heart Throbs to know one thing: tell me, if your art Can tell so much: shall Banquo's issue ever Reign in this kingdom?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene I"?

   A. The cast and world of the play

   B. The dagger of the mind

   C. The apparitions and false security

   D. The discovery of the murder

SAT key: 1. D (to defeat completely); 2. C (The apparitions and false security)

Lesson 21: Act IV, Scene II

Focus: the murder of the innocent

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "Act IV, Scene II" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (murder of a child, violence against a mother, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): A child is stabbed on stage and his mother pursued by murderers. Some students may have experienced violence or loss; allow a pass on reading aloud and consider presenting the moment in summary. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…never fear the net nor lime, The pitfall nor the gin. Why should I, mother? Poor birds they…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This scene shows a child and his mother attacked by murderers.
Suggested language: "What does this scene show about what Macbeth has become?"

Teacher only · spoilers

At Fife, Lady Macduff tells Ross that her husband's flight was madness and that he loves them not; Ross defends him as wise and leaves. She tells her son his father is dead and a traitor; the clever boy banters that the liars and swearers are enough to beat the honest men and hang them up. A messenger warns her to flee. Murderers enter, call Macduff a traitor, and stab the boy ('He has kill'd me, mother'); she runs out crying 'Murder!' and is pursued.

Background: The scene is one of very few in Shakespeare to show a child killed on stage. It is the moment many audiences turn wholly against Macbeth.

Significance: The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because.... Content note before we start: This scene shows a child and his mother attacked by murderers.
Prompt: Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: pitfall — a trap for catching birds; diminutive — tiny; smallest; laudable — praiseworthy; methinks — it seems to me; swearers — people who swear oaths. "laudable": Origin: Old French laudable; earlier Latin laudabilis. "swearers": Origin of "swearer": an English formation from swear + -er.
Words: pitfall: a trap for catching birds · diminutive: tiny; smallest · laudable: praiseworthy · methinks: it seems to me · swearers: people who swear oaths

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The scene is one of very few in Shakespeare to show a child killed on stage. It is the moment many audiences turn wholly against Macbeth. The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family. Characterization: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave. Dramatic irony: A messenger warns them too late; murderers arrive. Structure: The only domestic scene in the play: innocence slaughtered. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "You know not / Whether it was his wisdom or his fear" (Act IV, Scene II, Ross).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch" slowly and put it in my own words: Lady Macduff tells Ross that Macduff does not love his family, since he fled and left them unprotected. Next, craft. I notice the bitter comparison she goes on to make with a small bird that fights to protect its nest. The strongest word is "natural": it means the instinctive love that makes even animals defend their young. Then, effect. Why does Lady Macduff say her husband lacks "the natural touch"? My answer: Lady Macduff says her husband lacks "the natural touch" because he fled and left his family unprotected, unlike even a small bird; she does not know he went to raise an army, which makes the coming murder more painful.

> *He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch" slowly and put it in my own words: Lady Macduff tells Ross that Macduff does not love his family, since he fled and left them unprotected. Next, craft. I notice the bitter comparison she goes on to make with a small bird that fights to protect its nest. The strongest word is "natural": it means the instinctive love that makes even animals defend their young. Then, effect. Why does Lady Macduff say her husband lacks "the natural touch"? My answer: Lady Macduff says her husband lacks "the natural touch" because he fled and left his family unprotected, unlike even a small bird; she does not know he went to raise an army, which makes the coming murder more painful.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The child's joke is true in Macbeth's Scotland: the liars rule. Masculinity and power. Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." (The son's wit.)

> *Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them (Act IV, Scene II, Son)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The child's joke is true in Macbeth's Scotland: the liars rule. Masculinity and power.
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected answer: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." (The son's wit.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the murder of the innocent? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of the murder of the innocent. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. When the text says “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son), it shows this directly. The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the murder of the innocent? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of the murder of the innocent. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. When the text says “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son), it shows this directly. The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause? Content note: a child is killed on stage. Ask how staging choices affect the audience.
Anchor question: Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause?
Facilitation: Content note: a child is killed on stage. Ask how staging choices affect the audience.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the murder of the innocent? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. ("Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them", Act IV, Scene II, Son). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the murder of the innocent? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. ("Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them", Act IV, Scene II, Son). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the murder of the innocent. Key takeaway: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave.
- **Dramatic irony:** A messenger warns them too late; murderers arrive.
- **Structure:** The only domestic scene in the play: innocence slaughtered.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "You know not / Whether it was his wisdom or his fear" (Act IV, Scene II, Ross).
- **equivocation:** "Fair is foul": appearances and words that mean two things, from the witches to the Porter to the prophecies. In this scene: "Bless you, fair dame! I am not to you known, / Though in your state" (Act IV, Scene II, Messenger).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch" (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff) Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight.

- "Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them" (Act IV, Scene II, Son) The son's wit.
- "He has kill'd me, mother" (Act IV, Scene II, Son) The son's death.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny.
Evidence: "Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them" (Act IV, Scene II, Son)
Reasoning: The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
pitfall (noun)	a trap for catching birds	*Poor bird! thou'ldst never fear the net nor lime, The pitfall nor the gin.*	
diminutive (adjective)	tiny; smallest	*He loves us not; He wants the natural touch: for the poor wren, The most diminutive of birds, will fight, Her young ones in her nest, against the owl.*	
laudable (adjective)	praiseworthy	*But I remember now I am in this earthly world; where to do harm Is often laudable, to do good sometime Accounted dangerous folly: why then, alas, Do I put up that womanly defence, To say I have done no harm?*	"laudable": Origin: Old French laudable; earlier Latin laudabilis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/laudable#Etymology)
methinks (verb)	it seems to me	*To fright you thus, methinks, I am too savage; To do worse to you were fell cruelty, Which is too nigh your person.*	
swearers (noun)	people who swear oaths	*Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them.*	"swearers": Origin of "swearer": an English formation from swear + -er. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/swearer#Etymology)
fatherless (adjective)	without a father	*Father'd he is, and yet he's fatherless.*	
discomfort (noun)	distress; embarrassment	*I am so much a fool, should I stay longer, It would be my disgrace and your discomfort: I take my leave at once.*	"discomfort": Origin: Anglo-Norman descomforter. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/discomfort#Etymology)

womanly (adjective)	typical of a woman (in the period's view)	*But I remember now I am in this earthly world; where to do harm Is often laudable, to do good sometime Accounted dangerous folly: why then, alas, Do I put up that womanly defence, To say I have done no harm?*	
judicious (adjective)	showing good judgment	*My dearest coz, I pray you, school yourself: but for your husband, He is noble, wise, judicious, and best knows The fits o' the season.*	"judicious": Origin: French judicieux; earlier Latin iudico. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/judicious#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the son say about liars and swearers? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They are fools: there are enough of them to beat the honest men and hang them up.
2. What does Lady Macduff think of her husband's flight? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It was madness, and he loves his family not
3. Who visits her and then leaves? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Ross
4. What does she tell her son about his father? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That he is dead and a traitor
5. What happens to the son? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The murderers kill him
6. Who warns her to flee? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: An unnamed messenger
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At Fife, Lady Macduff tells Ross that her husband's flight was madness and that he loves them not; Ross defends him as wise and leaves. She tells her son his father is dead and a traitor; the clever boy banters that the liars and swearers are enough to beat the honest men and hang them up. A messenger warns her to flee. Murderers enter, call Macduff a traitor, and stab the boy ('He has kill'd me,…

8. Who is on stage in “Act IV, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act IV, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Poor bird! thou'ldst never fear the net nor lime, The pitfall nor the gin.” What does “pitfall” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: pitfall: a trap for catching birds.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Shakespeare give the boy such clever, funny lines just before his death? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: It makes him vivid and the loss more painful: innocence against tyranny.
2. What does “Act IV, Scene II” suggest about the murder of the innocent? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the murder of the innocent? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. On characterization: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Wisdom!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: At Fife, Lady Macduff tells Ross that her husband's flight was madness and that he loves them not; Ross defends him as wise and leaves. She tells her son his father is dead and a traitor; the clever boy banters that the liars and swearers are enough to beat the honest men and hang them up. A…
7. How does “Act IV, Scene II” build on “Act IV, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son): The son's wit. On structure: The only domestic scene in the play: innocence slaughtered. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, Son): The son's death. On characterization: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should this scene be staged in full or with the violence offstage? Defend your choice, considering the audience. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A staging judgment balancing impact and care.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son): The son's wit. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, Son): The son's death. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene

II, Lady Macduff): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. On characterization: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the murder of the innocent. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son): The son's wit. On structure: The only domestic scene in the play: innocence slaughtered. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, Son): The son's death. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son): The son's wit. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene II” treats the murder of the innocent with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, Son): The son's death. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the murder of the innocent? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son): The son's wit. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I am so much a fool, should I stay longer, It would be my disgrace and your _____: I take my leave at once.” Word bank: laudable, discomfort, pitfall, diminutive

   Key: discomfort
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who warns her to flee?

   A. Macbeth

   B. Macduff

   C. Malcolm

   D. An unnamed messenger

   Key: D (An unnamed messenger)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff: “He loves us not; / He wants the _____ touch”

   Key: natural
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens to the son?

   A. He escapes to England

   B. He kills a murderer

   C. The murderers kill him

   D. He is taken prisoner

Key: C (The murderers kill him)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "But I remember now I am in this earthly world; where to do harm Is often laudable, to do good sometime Accounted dangerous folly: why then, alas, Do I put up that _____ defence, To say I have done no harm?"
   Word bank: laudable, pitfall, womanly, diminutive
   Key: womanly
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Then the liars and _____ are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them." Word bank: diminutive, laudable, pitfall, swearers
   Key: swearers
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Poor bird! thou'ldst never fear the net nor lime, The pitfall nor the gin.", what does "pitfall" most nearly mean?
   A. a trap for catching birds
   B. able to be attacked
   C. birds of the crow family
   D. announced loudly; proclaimed
   Key: A (a trap for catching birds)
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act IV, Scene II, paragraph 27? "Every one that does so is a _____, and must be hanged."
   A. twenty
   B. wisdom
   C. traitor
   D. father
   Key: C (traitor)
9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Father'd he is, and yet he's _____." Word bank: pitfall, fatherless, laudable, diminutive
   Key: fatherless
10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does she tell her son about his father?
    A. That he is dead and a traitor
    B. That he will return tonight
    C. That he is in prison
    D. That he is king
    Key: A (That he is dead and a traitor)
11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act IV, Scene II?
    A. "Sirrah, your father's dead: And what will you do now?"
    B. "What had he done, to make him fly the land?"
    C. "He had none: His flight was madness: when our actions do not, Our fears do make us traitors."
    D. "You know not Whether it was his wisdom or his fear."
    Key: B ("What had he done, to make him fly the land?")

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The son's wit. The evidence is “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son).

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Shakespeare give the boy such clever, funny lines just before his death?

    Sample answer: It makes him vivid and the loss more painful: innocence against tyranny. The evidence is “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son) — The son's wit.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, Son). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The son's death. The evidence is “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, Son). This develops masculinity and power: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.". The words “mother” and “kill” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act IV, Scene II, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: “Sirrah, your father’s dead: And what will you do now?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “father” (Act IV, Scene II, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how masculinity and power develops from Act I, Scene VII to Act IV, Scene II. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth, the text reads “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” — Macbeth admits his only motive. In Act IV, Scene II, “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff) — Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.".

17. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the son say about liars and swearers?

    Sample answer: They are fools: there are enough of them to beat the honest men and hang them up.

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who visits her and then leaves?

    A. Banquo's ghost
    B. Malcolm
    C. Ross
    D. Lennox

    Key: C (Ross)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macduff think of her husband's flight?

    A. It was wise and brave
    B. It was a trick
    C. It was madness, and he loves his family not
    D. It was ordered by the king

    Key: C (It was madness, and he loves his family not)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “To fright you thus, methinks, I am too savage; To do worse to you were fell cruelty, Which is too nigh your person.”, what does “methinks” most nearly mean?

    A. please (from "I pray thee")

    B. an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging

    C. it seems to me

    D. to defeat completely

    Key: C (it seems to me)

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene II”? A messenger warns them too late; murderers arrive.

    A. Simile

    B. Allusion

    C. Theme

    D. Dramatic irony

    Key: D (Dramatic irony)

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene II”?

    A. The murder of the innocent

    B. The guilt that will not wash away

    C. The discovery of the murder

    D. Life as a tale told by an idiot

    Key: A (The murder of the innocent)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son) supports it: The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother.". But “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff) complicates it: Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene II, Son: “Then the liars and _____ are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them”

    Key: swearers

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene II”? Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave.

    A. Simile

    B. Setting

    C. Personification

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son).
    Sample answer: The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother.". The evidence is “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son) — The son's wit. This develops masculinity and power: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.".

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Should this scene be staged in full or with the violence offstage? Defend your choice, considering the audience.
    Sample answer: A staging judgment balancing impact and care. The evidence is “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son) — The son's wit. This develops masculinity and power: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.". The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother.".

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene II, paragraph 6: “You know not Whether it was his _____ or his fear.” Word bank: wisdom, father, traitor, unsanctified
    Key: wisdom

29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. The evidence is “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff). This develops masculinity and power: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.".

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act IV, Scene II, paragraph 21 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “Thou speak’st with all thy wit; and yet, i’ faith, With wit enough for thee.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Act IV, Scene II, paragraph 21) develops masculinity, power and violence: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.". Its words “enough” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “And must they all be hanged that swear and lie?” (Act IV, Scene II, paragraph 28), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The son's wit. The evidence is “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son). This develops masculinity and power: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.". The words “swearers” and “honest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother.".

32. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff)
    A. Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight.
    B. The play's motto: moral values inverted.
    C. Malcolm as an obstacle.

D. Sleep as innocence destroyed.

Key: A (Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight.)

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In the line "But I remember now I am in this earthly world; where to do harm Is often laudable, to do good sometime Accounted dangerous folly: why then, alas, Do I put up that womanly defence, To say I have done no harm?", what does "laudable" most nearly mean?

A. praiseworthy

B. it seems to me

C. a trap for catching birds

D. tiny; smallest

Key: A (praiseworthy)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 5, 8, 9, 3, 18, 4, 19, 10, 20, 11, 13, 21, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	1, 9, 19, 10, 2, 4, 7, 20, 11, 13, 12, 22, 15, 14, 16, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Junior	19, 3, 1, 17, 24, 4, 2, 5, 13, 11, 15, 25, 14, 26, 23, 27	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 4, 20, 28, 9, 1, 5, 13, 11, 29, 21, 15, 14, 30, 27, 31	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 3
AP	18, 5, 1, 24, 17, 32, 13, 11, 12, 14, 15, 25, 23, 16, 30, 27	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Freshman	6, 2, 10, 7, 19, 9, 22, 11, 13, 14, 15, 26, 16, 30, 23, 27	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	17, 4, 7, 9, 5, 29, 11, 13, 15, 14, 21, 16, 27, 31, 23, 30	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Junior	9, 3, 33, 19, 20, 8, 11, 13, 14, 25, 15, 31, 27, 16, 30, 23	recall 6, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Senior	9, 3, 10, 7, 20, 2, 12, 11, 13, 14, 25, 15, 27, 16, 30, 23	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	10, 7, 6, 8, 3, 9, 11, 13, 14, 26, 15, 25, 30, 27, 16, 23	recall 6, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act IV, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show the murder of the innocent? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the murder of the innocent? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of the murder of the innocent. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the murder of the innocent. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene II suggests about the murder of the innocent. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act IV, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the murder of the innocent. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the murder of the innocent responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the murder of the innocent follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene II and its treatment of the murder of the innocent. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the murder of the innocent in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the murder of the innocent. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *But I remember now I am in this earthly world; where to do harm Is often laudable, to do good sometime Accounted dangerous folly: why then, alas, Do I put up that womanly defence, To say I have done no harm?*

As used in the text, what does the word "laudable" most nearly mean?

A. typical of a woman (in the period's view)

B. distress; embarrassment

C. showing good judgment

D. praiseworthy

2. *Wisdom! to leave his wife, to leave his babes, His mansion and his titles in a place From whence himself does fly? He loves us not; He wants the natural touch: for the poor wren, The most diminutive of birds, will fight, Her young ones in her nest, against the owl. All is the fear and nothing is the love; As little is the wisdom, where the flight So runs against all reason.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene II"?

A. The murder of the innocent

B. The murder and its first guilt

C. The Witches' riddling world

D. The tyrant's end and a new order

SAT key: 1. D (praiseworthy); 2. A (The murder of the innocent)

Lesson 22: Act IV, Scene III

Focus: testing loyalty and the cost of grief

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act IV, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (grief for murdered family): Macduff learns his wife and children were killed. Give space for the emotion of the scene; the focus is grief and what strength means.
Student preview: A father learns his family has been killed.
Suggested language: “What does Macduff mean by 'I must also feel it as a man'?”

Teacher only · spoilers

In England, Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and without any of the 'king-becoming graces.' When Macduff despairs ('O Scotland, Scotland!'), Malcolm reveals it was a test and that old Siward with ten thousand men is ready. A Doctor describes King Edward healing the sick by touch. Ross arrives and, after hesitating, tells Macduff his wife and children have been slaughtered. Macduff asks 'All my pretty ones?' and, told to 'dispute it like a man,' answers 'I shall do so; but I must also feel it as a man.' He vows to face Macbeth.

Background: The 'king's evil' (scrofula) was believed to be cured by a monarch's touch; James I continued the ceremony. The scene contrasts a healing king with a destroying one.

Significance: The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because.... Content note before we start: A father learns his family has been killed.
Prompt: What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: transpose — to change; hoodwink — to deceive; to blind; rawness — haste that leaves people unprotected; demerits — faults; wrongdoings; whetstone — a stone for sharpening blades. “transpose”: Origin: Old French transposer; earlier Latin trānspositus. “hoodwink”: Origin: an English formation from hood + wink. “demerits”: Origin of “demerit”: Old French desmerite; earlier Latin dēmeritum.
Words: transpose: to change · hoodwink: to deceive; to blind · rawness: haste that leaves people unprotected · demerits: faults; wrongdoings · whetstone: a stone for sharpening blades

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The 'king's evil' (scrofula) was believed to be cured by a monarch's touch; James I continued the ceremony. The scene contrasts a healing king with a destroying one. The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii. Dialogue: Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and vicious; Macduff's despair proves his loyalty. Characterization: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Structure: The long scene in England sets up the counterforce. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Be not offended: / I speak not as in absolute fear of you. / I think our country sinks beneath the yoke; / It” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” slowly and put it in my own words: Told his wife and children were killed, Macduff asks again and again whether all his pretty ones are dead. Next, craft. I notice the repeated "all," and the broken questions, which show shock and disbelief. The strongest word is “all”: it shows the totality of his loss, which he cannot take in. Then, effect. What does Macduff's reaction to the news show? My answer: Macduff's reaction to the news, repeating "all," shows a grief so complete that Malcolm's call to fight it like a man seems cold; Macduff vows to face Macbeth himself, setting up their final fight.

> *All my pretty ones? / Did you say all* (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” slowly and put it in my own words: Told his wife and children were killed, Macduff asks again and again whether all his pretty ones are dead. Next, craft. I notice the repeated "all," and the broken questions, which show shock and disbelief. The strongest word is “all”: it shows the totality of his loss, which he cannot take in. Then, effect. What does Macduff's reaction to the news show? My answer: Macduff's reaction to the news, repeating "all," shows a grief so complete that Malcolm's call to fight it like a man seems cold; Macduff vows to face Macbeth himself, setting up their final fight.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Malcolm's advice. Look at the craft: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." (Malcolm's advice.)

> *Dispute it like a man (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Malcolm's advice. Look at the craft: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children."
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected answer: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." (Malcolm's advice.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. When the text says "Dispute it like a man" (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm), it shows this directly. Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man."
Task: Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. When the text says "Dispute it like a man" (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm), it shows this directly. Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed? Compare this with Lady Macbeth's "When you durst do it, then you were a man."
Anchor question: What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed?
Facilitation: Compare this with Lady Macbeth's "When you durst do it, then you were a man."

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. ("Dispute it like a man", Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. ("Dispute it like a man", Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dialogue shapes testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Key takeaway: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dialogue:** Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and vicious; Macduff's despair proves his loyalty.
- **Characterization:** Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children."
- **Structure:** The long scene in England sets up the counterforce.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Be not offended: / I speak not as in absolute fear of you. / I think our country sinks beneath the yoke; / It" (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "England. Before the King's palace" (Act IV, Scene III).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "All my pretty ones? / Did you say all" (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff) Macduff's grief.
- "Dispute it like a man" (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm) Malcolm's advice.
- "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man" (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff) Macduff's redefinition of manhood.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness.
Evidence: "Dispute it like a man" (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm)
Reasoning: Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
transpose (verb)	to change	*But I shall crave your pardon; That which you are my thoughts cannot transpose: Angels are bright still, though the brightest fell: Though all things foul would wear the brows of grace, Yet grace must still look so.*	"transpose": Origin: Old French transposer; earlier Latin trānspositus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/transpose#Etymology)
hoodwink (verb)	to deceive; to blind	*But fear not yet To take upon you what is yours: you may Convey your pleasures in a spacious plenty, And yet seem cold, the time you may so hoodwink.*	"hoodwink": Origin: an English formation from hood + wink. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/hoodwink#Etymology)
rawness (noun)	haste that leaves people unprotected	*Why in that rawness left you wife and child, Those precious motives, those strong knots of love, Without leave-taking?*	
demerits (noun)	faults; wrongdoings	*Sinful Macduff, They were all struck for thee! naught that I am, Not for their own demerits, but for mine, Fell slaughter on their souls.*	"demerits": Origin of "demerit": Old French desmerite; earlier Latin dēmeritum. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/demerit#Etymology)
whetstone (noun)	a stone for sharpening blades	*Be this the whetstone of your sword: let grief Convert to anger; blunt not the heart, enrage it.*	
lowliness (noun)	humility	*But I have none: the king-becoming graces, As justice, verity, temperance, stableness, Bounty, perseverance, mercy, lowliness, Devotion, patience, courage, fortitude, I have no relish of them, but abound In the division of each several crime, Acting it many ways.*	
blisters (verb)	raises sores on (an image of disgust)	*This tyrant, whose sole name blisters our tongues, Was once thought honest: you have loved him well: He hath not touch'd you yet.*	

niggard (noun)	a miser; one who holds back	*But not a niggard of your speech: how goes't?*	
grafted (adjective)	firmly planted; fixed deep	*It is myself I mean: in whom I know All the particulars of vice so grafted That, when they shall be open'd, black Macbeth Will seem as pure as snow, and the poor state Esteem him as a lamb, being compared With my confineless harms.*	
motives (noun)	people or things that move someone to act (here, Macduff's family)	*Why in that rawness left you wife and child, Those precious motives, those strong knots of love, Without leave-taking?*	

Discussion questions

1. What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Macduff vow at the end of the scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To bring Macbeth within his sword's length, 'front to front.'
2. Why does Malcolm pretend to be wicked? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To test whether Macduff is loyal or Macbeth's agent
3. What does King Edward do for the sick? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Heals them by touch
4. What news does Ross bring Macduff? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His wife and children have been slaughtered
5. How does Macduff answer the call to 'dispute it like a man'? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He must also feel it as a man
6. How many men does Malcolm say Siward has? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Ten thousand
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In England, Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and without any of the 'king-becoming graces.' When Macduff despairs ('O Scotland, Scotland!'), Malcolm

reveals it was a test and that old Siward with ten thousand men is ready. A Doctor describes King Edward healing the sick by touch. Ross arrives and, after hesitating, tells Macduff his wife and children have been slaughtered…

8. Who is on stage in “Act IV, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act IV, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “But I shall crave your pardon; That which you are my thoughts cannot transpose: Angels are bright still, though the brightest fell: Though all things foul would wear the brows of grace, Yet grace must still look so.” What does “transpose” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: transpose: to change.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Ross hesitate before telling Macduff the news? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He fears the pain it will cause and perhaps the blame for Macduff's absence.
2. What does “Act IV, Scene III” suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's grief. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “What I believe I'll wail, What know believe, and what I can redress, As I shall find the time to friend, I will.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: In England, Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and without any of the 'king-becoming graces.' When Macduff despairs ('O Scotland, Scotland!'), Malcolm reveals it was a test and that old Siward with ten thousand men is ready. A Doctor describes King Edward healing the sick by…
7. How does “Act IV, Scene III” build on “Act IV, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the

Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm): Malcolm's advice. On structure: The long scene in England sets up the counterforce. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. On characterization: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's grief. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Malcolm's test fair to Macduff? Is it a sign that Malcolm will be a good king? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluation of Malcolm's caution and its cost.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm): Malcolm's advice. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and

evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's grief. On characterization: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm): Malcolm's advice. On structure: The long scene in England sets up the counterforce. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's grief. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm): Malcolm's advice. On characterization: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene III” treats testing loyalty and the cost of grief with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as

a man" (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act V, Scene I" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: "All my pretty ones? / Did you say all" (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff): Macduff's grief. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: "Dispute it like a man" (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm): Malcolm's advice. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff vow at the end of the scene?
   Sample answer: To bring Macbeth within his sword's length, 'front to front.'
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "But not a _____ of your speech: how goes't?" Word bank: rawness, hoodwink, transpose, niggard
   Key: niggard
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene III, Macduff: "All my _____ ones? / Did you say all"
   Key: pretty
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "But I shall crave your pardon; That which you are my thoughts cannot transpose: Angels are bright still, though the brightest fell: Though all things foul would wear the brows of grace, Yet grace must still look so.", what does "transpose" most nearly mean?
   A. rods carried by kings as a sign of power
   B. to change
   C. paid out (money)
   D. without limit

Key: B (to change)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Sinful Macduff, They were all struck for thee! naught that I am, Not for their own demerits, but for mine, Fell slaughter on their souls.”, what does “demerits” most nearly mean?

   A. to catch up with

   B. faults; wrongdoings

   C. under a curse

   D. loyalty owed to a ruler

   Key: B (faults; wrongdoings)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “But fear not yet To take upon you what is yours: you may Convey your pleasures in a spacious plenty, And yet seem cold, the time you may so hoodwink.”, what does “hoodwink” most nearly mean?

   A. the parts that are mixed together to make something

   B. strongest; ruling over the rest

   C. diseased; corrupted

   D. to deceive; to blind

   Key: D (to deceive; to blind)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does King Edward do for the sick?

   A. Banishes them

   B. Prays for Macbeth

   C. Heals them by touch

   D. Builds hospitals

   Key: C (Heals them by touch)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Macduff answer the call to 'dispute it like a man'?

   A. He will forgive Macbeth

   B. He must also feel it as a man

   C. He will never weep

   D. He will return home to bury them

   Key: B (He must also feel it as a man)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Be this the _____ of your sword: let grief Convert to anger; blunt not the heart, enrage it.” Word bank: rawness, whetstone, hoodwink, transpose

   Key: whetstone

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How many men does Malcolm say Siward has?

    A. Three thousand

    B. Ten thousand

    C. Forty thousand

    D. One hundred

    Key: B (Ten thousand)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Malcolm pretend to be wicked?

    A. To protect Fleance

    B. Because he is afraid to rule

    C. To trick Siward

    D. To test whether Macduff is loyal or Macbeth's agent

    Key: D (To test whether Macduff is loyal or Macbeth's agent)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Ross hesitate before telling Macduff the news?
    Sample answer: He fears the pain it will cause and perhaps the blame for Macduff's absence. The evidence is “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff) — Macduff's redefinition of manhood.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Macduff's grief. The evidence is “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff). This develops masculinity and power: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.".

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene III”? Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: ‘He has no children.’

    A. Alliteration

    B. Tone / mood

    C. Characterization

    D. Theme

    Key: C (Characterization)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm).
    Sample answer: Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man.". The evidence is “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm) — Malcolm's advice. This develops masculinity and power: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.".

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Malcolm's test fair to Macduff? Is it a sign that Malcolm will be a good king? Argue.
    Sample answer: An evaluation of Malcolm's caution and its cost. The evidence is “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm) — Malcolm's advice. This develops masculinity and power: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man.".

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What news does Ross bring Macduff?

    A. Scotland has surrendered

    B. Lady Macbeth is mad

    C. Macbeth is dead

    D. His wife and children have been slaughtered

    Key: D (His wife and children have been slaughtered)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 3: “Let us seek out some _____ shade, and there Weep our sad bosoms empty.” Word bank: quickly, desolate, general, comfort

    Key: desolate

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 51? “Would I could answer This _____ with the like!”

    A. interdiction

    B. blessings

    C. children

    D. comfort

    Key: D (comfort)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 17 reveal about the character or situation? “With this there grows In my most ill-composed affection such A stanchless avarice that, were I king, I should cut off the nobles for their lands, Desire his jewels and this other’s house: And my more-having would be as a sauce To make me…” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 17) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The words “stanchless” and “affection” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act IV, Scene III?

    A. “Not in the legions Of horrid hell can come a devil more damn’d In evils to top Macbeth.”

    B. “If such a one be fit to govern, speak: I am as I have spoken.”

    C. “O nation miserable, With an untitled tyrant bloody-scepter’d, When shalt thou see thy wholesome days again, Since that the truest issue of…”

    D. “Thy royal father Was a most sainted king: the queen that bore thee, Oftener upon her knees than on her feet, Died every day she lived.”

    Key: A (“Not in the legions Of horrid hell can come a devil more damn’d In evils to top Macbeth.”)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 22 shapes its tone: “Thy royal father Was a most sainted king: the queen that bore thee, Oftener upon her knees than on her feet, Died every day she lived.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “sainted” and “father” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 22) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 68 shapes its tone: “But, gentle heavens, Cut short all intermission; front to front Bring thou this fiend of Scotland and myself; Within my sword’s length set him; if he ’scape, Heaven forgive him too!” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “intermission” and “forgive” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 68) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene III”? Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and vicious; Macduff's despair proves his loyalty.

    A. Dialogue

    B. Metaphor

C. Irony

D. Tone / mood

Key: A (Dialogue)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm) supports it: Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man.". But “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff) complicates it: the line (Macduff's redefinition of manhood) shows the same issue from another side, and its “But” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Malcolm's advice. The evidence is “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm). This develops masculinity and power: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.".

27. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 50 reveal about the character or situation? “Be’t their comfort We are coming thither: gracious England hath Lent us good Siward and ten thousand men; An older and a better soldier none That Christendom gives out.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 50) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The words “thousand” and “gracious” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Macduff's redefinition of manhood. The evidence is “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff). This develops masculinity and power: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The words “shall” and “feel” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 55 shapes its tone: “Let not your ears despise my tongue for ever, Which shall possess them with the heaviest sound That ever yet they heard.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “heaviest” and “despise” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 55) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how masculinity and power develops from Act IV, Scene II to Act IV, Scene III. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff, the text reads “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” — Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. In Act IV, Scene III, “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff) — Macduff's grief. "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.".

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “Why in that rawness left you wife and child, Those precious motives, those strong knots of love, Without leave-taking?”, what does “rawness” most nearly mean?

A. soaring high

B. driven out

C. haste that leaves people unprotected

D. failure to show thanks

Key: C (haste that leaves people unprotected)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “This tyrant, whose sole name _____ our tongues, Was once thought honest: you have loved him well: He hath not touch’d you yet.” Word bank: hoodwink, rawness, transpose, blisters

Key: blisters

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 30 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “How he solicits heaven, Himself best knows: but strangely-visited people, All swoln and ulcerous, pitiful to the eye, The mere despair of surgery, he cures, Hanging a golden stamp about their necks, Put on with holy prayers: and ’tis…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 30) develops masculinity, power and violence: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". Its words “benediction” and “succeeding” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “My countryman; but yet I know him not.” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 33), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Macduff's grief. The evidence is “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff). This develops masculinity and power: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The words “pretty” and “ones” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man.".

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 22? “O nation miserable, With an untitled tyrant bloody-scepter’d, When shalt thou see thy wholesome days again, Since that the truest issue of thy throne By his own _____ stands accursed, And does blaspheme his breed?”

A. quickly

B. interdiction

C. surprised

D. blessings

Key: B (interdiction)

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene III”?

A. Lady Macbeth's resolve

B. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief

C. Suspicion spoken through irony

D. The apparitions and false security

Key: B (Testing loyalty and the cost of grief)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 23 shapes its tone: “Macduff, this noble passion, Child of integrity, hath from my soul Wiped the black scruples, reconciled my thoughts To thy good truth and honour.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “reconciled” and “integrity” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 23) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 39 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “O, relation Too nice, and yet too true!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 39) develops guilt and conscience: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". Its words “relation” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The tyrant has not batter’d at their peace?” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 46), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

39. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But I have none: the king-becoming graces, As justice, verity, temperance, stableness, Bounty, perseverance, mercy, _____, Devotion, patience, courage, fortitude, I have no relish of them, but abound In the division of each several crime, Acting it many ways.” Word bank: transpose, hoodwink, rawness, lowliness

    Key: lowliness

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 11 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “Be not offended: I speak not as in absolute fear of you.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 11) develops guilt and conscience: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". Its words “offended” and “absolute” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I think our country sinks beneath the yoke; It weeps, it bleeds; and each new day a gash Is added to her wounds: I…” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 11), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

41. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff)

    A. Macduff's redefinition of manhood.
    B. The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil.
    C. Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).
    D. Macbeth will act without thought.

    Key: A (Macduff's redefinition of manhood.)

42. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 57: “Your castle is _____; your wife and babes Savagely slaughter’d: to relate the manner, Were, on the quarry of these murder’d deer, To add the death of you.” Word bank: surprised, strangers, general, interdiction

    Key: surprised

43. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Malcolm's advice. The evidence is “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm). This develops

masculinity and power: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The words “like” and “man” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man.".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 3, 17, 4, 18, 19, 10, 9, 20, 21, 12, 13, 22, 23, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	18, 17, 9, 6, 7, 1, 26, 12, 20, 21, 27, 28, 22, 29, 25, 30	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	7, 10, 31, 5, 9, 32, 20, 21, 12, 27, 23, 15, 14, 28, 33, 34	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	35, 32, 19, 18, 27, 21, 20, 36, 12, 37, 28, 29, 22, 25, 30, 38	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	5, 10, 7, 9, 39, 13, 36, 28, 15, 23, 37, 29, 25, 30, 33, 40	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	11, 9, 3, 20, 21, 41, 12, 24, 15, 29, 22, 37, 25, 30, 16, 38	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	18, 42, 11, 7, 26, 41, 23, 29, 37, 14, 22, 33, 25, 38, 16, 40	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	35, 11, 9, 39, 7, 21, 22, 29, 23, 28, 40, 30, 34, 16, 33, 43	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 6
College Senior	17, 9, 39, 11, 36, 21, 22, 37, 23, 29, 33, 38, 30, 40, 16, 25	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	6, 9, 39, 11, 41, 20, 12, 14, 22, 37, 33, 40, 25, 38, 30, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of testing loyalty and the cost of grief? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene III suggests about testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act IV, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of testing loyalty and the cost of grief responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of testing loyalty and the cost of grief follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene III and its treatment of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about testing loyalty and the cost of grief in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Why in that rawness left you wife and child, Those precious motives, those strong knots of love, Without leave-taking?*

As used in the text, what does the word "rawness" most nearly mean?

A. haste that leaves people unprotected

B. firmly planted; fixed deep

C. people or things that move someone to act (here, Macduff's family)

D. a miser; one who holds back

2. *What I believe I'll wail, What know believe, and what I can redress, As I shall find the time to friend, I will. What you have spoke, it may be so perchance. This tyrant, whose sole name blisters our tongues, Was once thought honest: you have loved him well: He hath not touch'd you yet. I am young; but something You may deserve of him through me, and wisdom To offer up a weak poor innocent lamb To appease an angry god.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene III"?

A. The moving wood

B. The army reveals itself

C. The discovery of the murder

D. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief

SAT key: 1. A (haste that leaves people unprotected); 2. D (Testing loyalty and the cost of grief)

Lesson 23: Act V, Scene I

Focus: the guilt that will not wash away

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act V, Scene I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide (mentioned in lesson text)): This lesson mentions suicide or self-harm. Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol.
Student preview: This lesson mentions suicide.
Suggested language:
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

A Doctor and a Gentlewoman watch Lady Macbeth sleepwalk with a taper; she has light by her continually, by her own command. She rubs her hands as if washing them ('Out, damned spot!'), recalls the murder of Duncan ('who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him?'), Lady Macduff ('The Thane of Fife had a wife: where is she now?') and Banquo, and says 'What's done cannot be undone.' The Doctor says she needs 'the divine' more than the physician.

Background: Lady Macbeth speaks in prose here, though earlier she spoke commanding verse; prose often marks madness or loss of control in Shakespeare.

Significance: The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because.... If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: what she suppressed now speaks.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: discharge — to unload; to pour out; troubles — worries; whisperings — rumors spoken quietly; sweeten — to make smell pleasant; perfumes — sweet-smelling liquids. “troubles”: Origin of “trouble”: Old French troubler; earlier Latin turbula (“disorderly group”).
Words: discharge: to unload; to pour out · troubles: worries · whisperings: rumors spoken quietly · sweeten: to make smell pleasant · perfumes: sweet-smelling liquids

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Lady Macbeth speaks in prose here, though earlier she spoke commanding verse; prose often marks madness or loss of control in Shakespeare. The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments. Characterization: Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose. Structure: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Imagery: Blood, the smell of blood, "all the perfumes of Arabia." Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Dunsinane. Anteroom in the castle” (Act V, Scene I).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “Out, damned spot! out, I say” slowly and put it in my own words: Sleepwalking, Lady Macbeth tries to rub away an imaginary spot of blood from her hand. Next, craft. I notice the frantic commands, "Out, damned spot! out, I say," spoken to something that is not there. The strongest word is “spot”: the tiny stain stands for guilt she cannot wash away. Then, effect. What does Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking show about her? My answer: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking shows that she is broken by guilt; the woman who said "a little water clears us of this deed" now reveals in her sleep what her waking self hid.

> *Out, damned spot! out, I say* *(Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “Out, damned spot! out, I say” slowly and put it in my own words: Sleepwalking, Lady Macbeth tries to rub away an imaginary spot of blood from her hand. Next, craft. I notice the frantic commands, "Out, damned spot! out, I say," spoken to something that is not there. The strongest word is “spot”: the tiny stain stands for guilt she cannot wash away. Then, effect. What does Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking show about her? My answer: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking shows that she is broken by guilt; the woman who said "a little water clears us of this deed" now reveals in her sleep what her waking self hid.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Echoes Macbeth's ocean. Look at the craft: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected: What she suppressed now speaks. (Echoes Macbeth's ocean.)

> *Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Echoes Macbeth's ocean. Look at the craft: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected answer: What she suppressed now speaks. (Echoes Macbeth's ocean.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of the guilt that will not wash away. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. When the text says "Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand" (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth), it shows this directly. She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of the guilt that will not wash away. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. When the text says "Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand" (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth), it shows this directly. She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it? Content note: mental breakdown and implied suicide later. Ask what the Doctor and Gentlewoman add as witnesses.
Anchor question: Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it?
Facilitation: Content note: mental breakdown and implied suicide later. Ask what the Doctor and Gentlewoman add as witnesses.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. ("Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand", Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. ("Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand", Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the guilt that will not wash away. Key takeaway: what she suppressed now speaks.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose.
- **Structure:** She speaks prose; her verse control is gone.
- **Imagery:** Blood, the smell of blood, "all the perfumes of Arabia."

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** what she suppressed now speaks.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Dunsinane. Ante-room in the castle" (Act V, Scene I).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: "The thane of Fife had a wife: where is she now?—What, will these" (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Out, damned spot! out, I say" (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth) Guilt as stain.

- “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth) Echoes Macbeth's ocean.
- “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth) Echo of "what's done is done."

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away.
Evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth)
Reasoning: She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
discharge (verb)	to unload; to pour out	*Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.*	
troubles (noun)	worries	*Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.*	“troubles”: Origin of “trouble”: Old French troubler; earlier Latin turbula (“disorderly group”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/trouble#Etymology)
whisperings (noun)	rumors spoken quietly	*Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.*	
sweeten (verb)	to make smell pleasant	*Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand.*	
perfumes (noun)	sweet-smelling liquids	*Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand.*	
performances (noun)	actions; things done	*In this slumbery agitation, besides her walking and other actual*	

		performances, what, at any time, have you heard her say?	
perturbation (noun)	a disturbance; upset	*A great perturbation in nature, to receive at once the benefit of sleep, and do the effects of watching!*	
infected (adjective)	diseased; corrupted	*Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.*	"infected": Origin of "infect": Middle French infect; earlier Latin infectus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/infect#Etymology)
annoyance (noun)	harm; injury	*Look after her; Remove from her the means of all annoyance, And still keep eyes upon her.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who watches Lady Macbeth sleepwalk? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A Doctor of Physic and a Waiting-Gentlewoman.
2. What does Lady Macbeth do while sleepwalking? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Rubs her hands as if washing them
3. What does she keep by her continually? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A light
4. Whom does she mean by 'The Thane of Fife had a wife'? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lady Macduff
5. What does she say about what's done? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It cannot be undone
6. What does the Doctor say she needs more than a physician? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The divine (a priest)

7. Retell the three most important events of “Act V, Scene I” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A Doctor and a Gentlewoman watch Lady Macbeth sleepwalk with a taper; she has light by her continually, by her own command. She rubs her hands as if washing them ('Out, damned spot!'), recalls the murder of Duncan ('who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him?'), Lady Macduff ('The Thane of Fife had a wife: where is she now?') and Banquo, and says 'What's done cannot be…
8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene I”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act V, Scene I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.” What does “discharge” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: discharge: to unload; to pour out.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Lady Macbeth now need a light, when in Act I she called for 'thick night'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Darkness, once her ally, now terrifies her: guilt has reversed her.
2. What does “Act V, Scene I” suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the symbolism in this scene shape what we understand about the guilt that will not wash away? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Guilt as stain. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A Doctor and a Gentlewoman watch Lady Macbeth sleepwalk with a taper; she has light by her continually, by her own command. She rubs her hands as if washing them ('Out, damned spot!'), recalls the murder of Duncan ('who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him?'), Lady…

7. How does “Act V, Scene I” build on “Act IV, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. On structure: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Echo of "what's done is done." On characterization: Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Guilt as stain. On structure: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the sleepwalking scene a punishment, a confession or a cry for help? Defend your reading. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An interpretive judgment with evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Echo of "what's done is done." Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Guilt as stain. On characterization: Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the guilt that will not wash away. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. On structure: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Echo of "what's done is done." Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Guilt as stain. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. On imagery: Blood, the smell of blood, "all the perfumes of Arabia." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene I” treats the guilt that will not wash away with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s ·

RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Echo of "what's done is done." Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Guilt as stain. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the guilt that will not wash away? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who watches Lady Macbeth sleepwalk?
   Sample answer: A Doctor of Physic and a Waiting-Gentlewoman.
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does she say about what's done?

   A. It was Banquo's fault

   B. It must be done again

   C. It was a dream

   D. It cannot be undone

   Key: D (It cannot be undone)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth: “Out, _____ spot! out, I say”
   Key: damned
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the _____ of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand.” Word bank: troubles,

perfumes, discharge, whisperings

Key: perfumes

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "A great _____ in nature, to receive at once the benefit of sleep, and do the effects of watching!" Word bank: discharge, whisperings, perturbation, troubles

   Key: perturbation

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth do while sleepwalking?

   A. Sharpens a dagger
   B. Writes letters to Macbeth
   C. Rubs her hands as if washing them
   D. Sings with the Witches

   Key: C (Rubs her hands as if washing them)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does she mean by 'The Thane of Fife had a wife'?

   A. Herself
   B. Lady Macduff
   C. Hecate
   D. The Gentlewoman

   Key: B (Lady Macduff)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Doctor say she needs more than a physician?

   A. A soldier
   B. Her husband
   C. The divine (a priest)
   D. More sleep

   Key: C (The divine (a priest))

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: _____ minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician." Word bank: infected, whisperings, discharge, troubles

   Key: infected

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does she keep by her continually?

    A. A light
    B. A crown
    C. A letter
    D. A dagger

    Key: A (A light)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "In this slumbery agitation, besides her walking and other actual _____, what, at any time, have you heard her say?" Word bank: discharge, performances, troubles, whisperings

    Key: performances

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Lady Macbeth now need a light, when in Act I she called for 'thick night'?
    Sample answer: Darkness, once her ally, now terrifies her: guilt has reversed her. The evidence is “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth) — Guilt as stain.
13. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Echo of "what's done is done.". The evidence is “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: what she suppressed now speaks. The words “cannot” and “undone” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene I”? Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose.
    A. Theme
    B. Allusion
    C. Characterization
    D. Simile

    Key: C (Characterization)
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? What she suppressed now speaks.
    A. Ambition and its costs
    B. Fate and free will
    C. Guilt and conscience
    D. Appearance versus reality

    Key: C (Guilt and conscience)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how guilt and conscience develops from Act III, Scene IV to Act V, Scene I. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth, the text reads “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” — Macbeth to the ghost. In Act V, Scene I, “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth) — Guilt as stain. What she suppressed now speaks.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the _____ of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand”
    Key: perfumes
18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Guilt as stain. The evidence is “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: what she suppressed now speaks.
19. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene I”?
    A. The guilt that will not wash away
    B. The ghost at the banquet
    C. Suspicion spoken through irony
    D. The army reveals itself

Key: A (The guilt that will not wash away)

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is the sleepwalking scene a punishment, a confession or a cry for help? Defend your reading.

    Sample answer: An interpretive judgment with evidence: Echoes Macbeth's ocean. The evidence is “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: what she suppressed now speaks. She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand.".

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene I, paragraph 4: “Since his majesty went into the field, I have seen her rise from her bed, throw her nightgown upon her, unlock her closet, take forth paper, fold it, write upon’t, read it, _____ seal it, and again return to bed” Word bank: afterwards, accustomed, should, nightgown

    Key: afterwards

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act V, Scene I?

    A. “Enter a Doctor of Physic and a Waiting-Gentlewoman.”

    B. “Since his majesty went into the field, I have seen her rise from her bed, throw her nightgown upon her, unlock her closet, take forth…”

    C. “That, sir, which I will not report after her.”

    D. “I have two nights watched with you, but can perceive no truth in your report.”

    Key: A (“Enter a Doctor of Physic and a Waiting-Gentlewoman.”)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act V, Scene I, paragraph 6 shapes its tone: “That, sir, which I will not report after her.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “report” (Act V, Scene I, paragraph 6) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: what she suppressed now speaks. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act V, Scene I, paragraph 29 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “This disease is beyond my practice: yet I have known those which have walked in their sleep who have died holily in their beds.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act V, Scene I, paragraph 29) develops guilt and conscience: what she suppressed now speaks. Its words “practice” and “disease” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “To bed, to bed! there’s knocking at the gate: come, come, come, come, give me your hand.” (Act V, Scene I, paragraph 32), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene I, paragraph 26: “I would not have such a heart in my bosom for the _____ of the whole body.” Word bank: account, dignity, afterwards, amazed

    Key: dignity

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Guilt as stain. The evidence is “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: what she suppressed now speaks. The words “damned” and “spot” carry that meaning: they are the

charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand.".

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act V, Scene I, paragraph 16? “It is an _____ action with her, to seem thus washing her hands: I have known her continue in this a quarter of an hour.”

    A. amazed

    B. accustomed

    C. asleep

    D. dignity

    Key: B (accustomed)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth)

    A. Paradox: every battle is lost by someone.

    B. Kingship without security means nothing.

    C. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

    D. Echo of "what's done is done."

    Key: D (Echo of "what's done is done.")

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act V, Scene I, paragraph 18 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “Hark! she speaks: I will set down what comes from her, to satisfy my remembrance the more strongly.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act V, Scene I, paragraph 18) develops masculinity, power and violence: what she suppressed now speaks. Its words “remembrance” and “strongly” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The thane of Fife had a wife: where is she now?—What, will these hands ne’er be clean?—No more o’ that, my lord, no…” (Act V, Scene I, paragraph 21), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

30. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene I”? She speaks prose; her verse control is gone.

    A. Simile

    B. Structure

    C. Symbolism

    D. Metaphor

    Key: B (Structure)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Echoes Macbeth's ocean. The evidence is “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: what she suppressed now speaks. The words “perfumes” and “sweeten” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand.".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix

Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	11, 9, 3, 5, 17, 10, 8, 1, 6, 7, 18, 19, 12, 15, 13, 20	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	6, 17, 5, 21, 11, 8, 2, 10, 12, 22, 19, 15, 23, 13, 16, 24	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	10, 7, 25, 21, 8, 6, 5, 2, 12, 22, 19, 13, 15, 23, 20, 26	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 5, 9, 7, 27, 17, 6, 22, 12, 19, 13, 23, 15, 26, 20, 24	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 3
AP	25, 1, 8, 10, 21, 22, 28, 12, 15, 23, 14, 29, 24, 16, 26, 20	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Freshman	21, 2, 4, 7, 27, 12, 22, 18, 14, 13, 15, 23, 29, 24, 16, 20	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	4, 10, 2, 3, 27, 22, 12, 23, 15, 30, 13, 16, 26, 24, 29, 20	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	8, 1, 10, 21, 3, 12, 22, 28, 19, 23, 15, 24, 29, 16, 26, 20	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 5
College Senior	11, 10, 21, 6, 5, 22, 12, 19, 23, 13, 15, 29, 20, 26, 24, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	11, 8, 25, 7, 28, 22, 12, 18, 15, 23, 30, 29, 31, 24, 20, 16	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the guilt that will not wash away? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the guilt that will not wash away? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of the guilt that will not wash away. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the guilt that will not wash away. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene I suggests about the guilt that will not wash away. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act V, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the guilt that will not wash away. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the guilt that will not wash away responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the guilt that will not wash away follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene I and its treatment of the guilt that will not wash away. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the guilt that will not wash away in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the guilt that will not wash away. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “whisperings” most nearly mean?

   A. a disturbance; upset

   B. harm; injury

   C. diseased; corrupted

   D. rumors spoken quietly

2. *Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician. God, God forgive us all! Look after her; Remove from her the means of all annoyance, And still keep eyes upon her. So, good night: My mind she has mated, and amazed my sight. I think, but dare not speak.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene I"?

A. The discovery of the murder

B. Defiance and despair

C. The guilt that will not wash away

D. The ghost at the banquet

SAT key: 1. D (rumors spoken quietly); 2. C (The guilt that will not wash away)

Lesson 24: Act V, Scene II

Focus: the tyrant's weakening grip

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act V, Scene II (the tyrant's weakening grip) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Scottish thanes (Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox) march to join Malcolm's English power near Birnam Wood. They say Macbeth strongly fortifies Dunsinane; some call him mad, and those he commands 'move only in command, nothing in love.' Angus says Macbeth's title hangs loose about him 'like a giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief.' They march to give their blood as medicine to purge their sick country.

Background: Images of clothing that does not fit Macbeth recur through the play ('borrow'd robes' in I.iii); here they end in contempt.

Significance: Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition because....
Prompt: How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the stolen title does not fit.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Images of clothing that does not fit Macbeth recur through the play ('borrow'd robes' in I.iii); here they end in contempt. Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland. Imagery: Clothing imagery: Macbeth's title hangs "loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief." Characterization: Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "The country near Dunsinane" (Act V, Scene II).

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the tyrant's weakening grip. Key takeaway: the stolen title does not fit.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** Clothing imagery: Macbeth's title hangs "loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief."
- **Characterization:** Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition:** the stolen title does not fit.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “The country near Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene II).
- **clothing:** Borrowed and ill-fitting robes show Macbeth as a man in a role that does not suit him. In this scene: “in command, / Nothing in love: now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish” (Act V, Scene II, Angus).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus) Clothing imagery.
- “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus) His followers obey from fear.
- “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus) Guilt.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole.
Evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus)
Reasoning: Angus says his title hangs "like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief," and his soldiers "move only in command, / Nothing in love."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
revolts (noun)	rebellions	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does*	“revolts”: Origin of “revolt”: possibly French révolter; earlier Latin revolvō (“roll back”). (Liber et Libri origin note,

		he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.	https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/revolt#Etymology)
distemper (noun)	a disordered or diseased state	*Great Dunsinane he strongly fortifies: Some say he's mad; others that lesser hate him Do call it valiant fury: but, for certain, He cannot buckle his distemper'd cause Within the belt of rule.*	"distemper": Origin: Old French destemprer; earlier Latin distemperare. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/distemper#Etymology)
upbraid (verb)	to scold; to reproach	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	
mortified (adjective)	deadened; numb as if dead	*The English power is near, led on by Malcolm, His uncle Siward and the good Macduff: Revenges burn in them; for their dear causes Would to the bleeding and the grim alarm Excite the mortified man.*	
condemn (verb)	to declare guilty	*Who then shall blame His pester'd senses to recoil and start, When all that is within him does condemn Itself for being there?*	
commands (verb)	gives orders to	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	
dwarfish (adjective)	tiny; like a dwarf	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	
minutely (adjective)	happening every minute	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	

Discussion questions

1. How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.

3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which thanes appear in this scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox.
2. Near where will the thanes meet the English army? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Birnam Wood
3. How do Macbeth's followers obey him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Only in command, nothing in love
4. What image does Angus use for Macbeth's title? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief
5. What is Macbeth doing at Dunsinane? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Strongly fortifying it
6. What do the thanes want to do for their country? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Purge it, like medicine for a sick body
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Scottish thanes (Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox) march to join Malcolm's English power near Birnam Wood. They say Macbeth strongly fortifies Dunsinane; some call him mad, and those he commands 'move only in command, nothing in love.' Angus says Macbeth's title hangs loose about him 'like a giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief.' They march to give their blood as medicine to purge their sick…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a…" What does "revolts" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: revolts: rebellions.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does the clothing image suggest about Macbeth's right to rule? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: He is small inside a role that does not fit; the crown is stolen.

2. What does “Act V, Scene II” suggest about the tyrant's weakening grip? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the tyrant's weakening grip? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): Clothing imagery. On characterization: Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Scottish thanes (Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox) march to join Malcolm's English power near Birnam Wood. They say Macbeth strongly fortifies Dunsinane; some call him mad, and those he commands 'move only in command, nothing in love.' Angus says Macbeth's title hangs loose about him 'like a…
7. How does “Act V, Scene II” build on “Act V, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): His followers obey from fear. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): Guilt. On characterization: Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): Clothing imagery. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Are the thanes heroes for changing sides now, or late opportunists? Judge them. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment about timing and loyalty.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): His followers obey from fear. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): Guilt. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): Clothing imagery. On characterization: Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the tyrant's weakening grip. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): His followers obey from fear. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title

he stole. Useful evidence: “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): Guilt. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): Clothing imagery. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): His followers obey from fear. On imagery: Clothing imagery: Macbeth's title hangs "loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene II” treats the tyrant's weakening grip with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): Guilt. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): Clothing imagery. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the tyrant's weakening grip? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus): His followers obey from fear. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is Macbeth doing at Dunsinane?

   A. Holding a feast

   B. Strongly fortifying it

   C. Praying

   D. Abandoning it

   Key: B (Strongly fortifying it)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Great Dunsinane he strongly fortifies: Some say he's mad; others that lesser hate him Do call it valiant fury: but, for certain, He cannot buckle his distemper'd cause Within the belt of rule.", what does "distemper" most nearly mean?

   A. lit the way for; guided

   B. deserving hatred

   C. a disordered or diseased state

   D. rumors spoken quietly

   Key: C (a disordered or diseased state)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene II, Angus: "Those he _____ move only in command, / Nothing in love"

   Key: commands

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now _____ revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief." Word bank: minutely, upbraid, revolts, distemper

   Key: minutely

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Who then shall blame His pester'd senses to recoil and start, When all that is within him does _____ Itself for being there?" Word bank: upbraid, distemper, revolts, condemn

   Key: condemn

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do Macbeth's followers obey him?

   A. Only in command, nothing in love

   B. Not at all

   C. Only for money

   D. Out of love and loyalty

   Key: A (Only in command, nothing in love)

7. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which thanes appear in this scene?
   Sample answer: Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox.
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What image does Angus use for Macbeth's title?
   A. A falling star
   B. A broken sword
   C. A crown of thorns
   D. A giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief

   Key: D (A giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief)
9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Near where will the thanes meet the English army?
   A. Inverness
   B. Birnam Wood
   C. Forres
   D. Scone

   Key: B (Birnam Wood)
10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "The English power is near, led on by Malcolm, His uncle Siward and the good Macduff: Revenges burn in them; for their dear causes Would to the bleeding and the grim alarm Excite the mortified man.", what does "mortified" most nearly mean?
    A. diseased; corrupted
    B. a grandmother
    C. deadened; numb as if dead
    D. stinging creatures (an image of torment)

    Key: C (deadened; numb as if dead)
11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the thanes want to do for their country?
    A. Sell it to England
    B. Leave it
    C. Purge it, like medicine for a sick body
    D. Divide it

    Key: C (Purge it, like medicine for a sick body)
12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does the clothing image suggest about Macbeth's right to rule?
    Sample answer: He is small inside a role that does not fit; the crown is stolen. The evidence is "now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief" (Act V, Scene II, Angus) — Clothing imagery.
13. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Act V, Scene II"? Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march.
    A. Personification
    B. Characterization
    C. Diction / vocabulary
    D. Irony

    Key: B (Characterization)

14. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how ambition develops from Act III, Scene I to Act V, Scene II. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act III, Scene I, Macbeth, the text reads “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” — Kingship without security means nothing. In Act V, Scene II, “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus) — Clothing imagery. The stolen title does not fit.

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Clothing imagery. The evidence is “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus). This develops ambition: the stolen title does not fit. The words “dwarfish” and “title” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Angus says his title hangs "like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief," and his soldiers "move only in command, / Nothing in love.".

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Are the thanes heroes for changing sides now, or late opportunists? Judge them.
    Sample answer: A judgment about timing and loyalty. The evidence is “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, Angus) — Clothing imagery. This develops ambition: the stolen title does not fit. Angus says his title hangs "like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief," and his soldiers "move only in command, / Nothing in love.".

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 3: “Let us seek out some _____ shade, and there Weep our sad bosoms empty.” Word bank: quickly, desolate, general, comfort
    Key: desolate

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 22? “O nation miserable, With an untitled tyrant bloody-scepter’d, When shalt thou see thy wholesome days again, Since that the truest issue of thy throne By his own _____ stands accursed, And does blaspheme his breed?”
    A. quickly
    B. interdiction
    C. surprised
    D. blessings
    Key: B (interdiction)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 50 reveal about the character or situation? “Be’t their comfort We are coming thither: gracious England hath Lent us good Siward and ten thousand men; An older and a better soldier none That Christendom gives out.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 50) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The words “thousand” and “gracious” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act V, Scene I?
    A. “This is her very guise; and, upon my life, fast asleep.”
    B. “Neither to you nor any one; having no witness to confirm my speech.”

C. “You may to me: and ’tis most meet you should.”

D. “Why, it stood by her: she has light by her continually; ’tis her command.”

Key: C (“You may to me: and ’tis most meet you should.”)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: His followers obey from fear. The evidence is “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus). This develops ambition: the stolen title does not fit.

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene II”?

A. The Witches' riddling world

B. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

C. The tyrant's end and a new order

D. The tyrant's weakening grip

Key: D (The tyrant's weakening grip)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 55 shapes its tone: “Let not your ears despise my tongue for ever, Which shall possess them with the heaviest sound That ever yet they heard.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “heaviest” and “despise” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 55) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 22 shapes its tone: “Thy royal father Was a most sainted king: the queen that bore thee, Oftener upon her knees than on her feet, Died every day she lived.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “sainted” and “father” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 22) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 23 shapes its tone: “Macduff, this noble passion, Child of integrity, hath from my soul Wiped the black scruples, reconciled my thoughts To thy good truth and honour.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “reconciled” and “integrity” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 23) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act V, Scene I, paragraph 8 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “Neither to you nor any one; having no witness to confirm my speech.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Act V, Scene I, paragraph 8) develops guilt and conscience: what she suppressed now speaks. Its words “confirm” and “witness” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Why, it stood by her: she has light by her continually; ’tis her command.” (Act V, Scene I, paragraph 12), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 51? "Would I could answer This _____ with the like!"

    A. interdiction

    B. blessings

    C. children

    D. comfort

    Key: D (comfort)

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene I, paragraph 19: "What need we fear who knows it, when none can call our power to _____?—Yet who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him." Word bank: accustomed, should, asleep, account

    Key: account

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act V, Scene I, paragraph 7? "You may to me: and 'tis most meet you _____."

    A. dignity

    B. should

    C. asleep

    D. nightgown

    Key: B (should)

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a _____ thief." Word bank: upbraid, revolts, distemper, dwarfish

    Key: dwarfish

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act IV, Scene III?

    A. "Not in the legions Of horrid hell can come a devil more damn'd In evils to top Macbeth."

    B. "If such a one be fit to govern, speak: I am as I have spoken."

    C. "O nation miserable, With an untitled tyrant bloody-scepter'd, When shalt thou see thy wholesome days again, Since that the truest issue of…"

    D. "Thy royal father Was a most sainted king: the queen that bore thee, Oftener upon her knees than on her feet, Died every day she lived."

    Key: A ("Not in the legions Of horrid hell can come a devil more damn'd In evils to top Macbeth.")

32. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief" (Act V, Scene II, Angus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Clothing imagery. The evidence is "now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief" (Act V, Scene II, Angus).

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 68 shapes its tone: "But, gentle heavens, Cut short all intermission; front to front Bring thou this fiend of Scotland and myself; Within my sword's length set him; if he 'scape, Heaven forgive him too!" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "intermission" and "forgive" (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 68) make the tone heavy and

deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and free will: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act V, Scene I, paragraph 32 shapes its tone: “To bed, to bed! there’s knocking at the gate: come, come, come, come, give me your hand.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “knocking” (Act V, Scene I, paragraph 32) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: what she suppressed now speaks. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene II, Angus: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a _____ thief”
    Key: dwarfish

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act V, Scene II?
    A. “Well, march we on, To give obedience where ’tis truly owed: Meet we the medicine of the sickly weal, And with him pour we in our country’s…”
    B. “Who knows if Donalbain be with his brother?”
    C. “For certain, sir, he is not: I have a file Of all the gentry: there is Siward’s son, And many unrough youths that even now Protest their…”
    D. “Near Birnam wood Shall we well meet them; that way are they coming.”

    Key: D (“Near Birnam wood Shall we well meet them; that way are they coming.”)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus).
    Sample answer: Angus says his title hangs "like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief," and his soldiers "move only in command, / Nothing in love.". The evidence is “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus), which shows his followers obey from fear. This develops ambition: the stolen title does not fit.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 11 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “Be not offended: I speak not as in absolute fear of you.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 11) develops guilt and conscience: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". Its words “offended” and “absolute” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I think our country sinks beneath the yoke; It weeps, it bleeds; and each new day a gash Is added to her wounds: I…” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 11), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

39. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he _____ move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe Upon a dwarfish thief.” Word bank: distemper, upbraid, revolts, commands
    Key: commands

40. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 17 reveal about the character or situation? “With this there grows In my most ill-composed affection such A stanchless avarice that, were I king, I should cut off the nobles for their lands, Desire his jewels and this other’s house: And my more-having would be as a sauce To make me…” Answer in two or three sentences

with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 17) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The words “stanchless” and “affection” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

41. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does this passage from Act V, Scene I, paragraph 21 reveal about the character or situation? “The thane of Fife had a wife: where is she now?—What, will these hands ne’er be clean?—No more o’ that, my lord, no more o’ that: you mar all with this starting.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act V, Scene I, paragraph 21) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: what she suppressed now speaks. The words “starting” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 30 to the story's treatment of masculinity, power and violence: “How he solicits heaven, Himself best knows: but strangely-visited people, All swoln and ulcerous, pitiful to the eye, The mere despair of surgery, he cures, Hanging a golden stamp about their necks, Put on with holy prayers: and ’tis…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 30) develops masculinity, power and violence: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". Its words “benediction” and “succeeding” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “My countryman; but yet I know him not.” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 33), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating masculinity, power and violence as central.

43. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 39 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “O, relation Too nice, and yet too true!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 39) develops guilt and conscience: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". Its words “relation” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The tyrant has not batter’d at their peace?” (Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 46), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

44. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene III, paragraph 57: “Your castle is _____; your wife and babes Savagely slaughter’d: to relate the manner, Were, on the quarry of these murder’d deer, To add the death of you.” Word bank: surprised, strangers, general, interdiction

    Key: surprised

45. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze the word choice in “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Guilt. The evidence is “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus). This develops ambition: the stolen title does not fit. The words “sticking” and “murders” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

46. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: His followers obey from fear. The evidence is “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in

love" (Act V, Scene II, Angus). This develops ambition: the stolen title does not fit. The words "commands" and "command" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Angus says his title hangs "like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief," and his soldiers "move only in command, / Nothing in love.".

47. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in "Act V, Scene II"? Clothing this device: Macbeth's title hangs 'loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief.'

    A. Point of view

    B. Theme

    C. Structure

    D. Imagery

    Key: D (Imagery)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 1, analysis 1, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	17, 18, 7, 2, 8, 11, 3, 9, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	27, 28, 29, 11, 1, 30, 31, 20, 32, 12, 21, 24, 33, 34, 14, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	28, 29, 9, 3, 35, 19, 31, 36, 12, 22, 23, 33, 34, 37, 38, 26	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 9, 39, 6, 40, 19, 41, 36, 12, 24, 33, 34, 13, 42, 38, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	27, 5, 35, 31, 41, 20, 36, 23, 33, 24, 34, 13, 43, 42, 26, 14	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	44, 18, 28, 40, 31, 20, 36, 33, 24, 25, 23, 45, 42, 38, 14, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	44, 17, 9, 6, 20, 36, 25, 23, 33, 24, 34, 42, 38, 16, 46, 15	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	28, 1, 5, 9, 6, 22, 23, 25, 24, 34, 42, 43, 26, 14, 46, 16	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 6
College Senior	10, 5, 30, 9, 36, 22, 33, 23, 25, 38, 42, 43, 26, 16, 46, 14	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	27, 5, 30, 9, 6, 41, 33, 24, 23, 47, 38, 42, 43, 26, 16, 14	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show the tyrant's weakening grip? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the tyrant's weakening grip? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the tyrant's weakening grip. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the tyrant's weakening grip. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene II suggests about the tyrant's weakening grip. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act V, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the tyrant's weakening grip. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the tyrant's weakening grip responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the tyrant's weakening grip follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene II and its treatment of the tyrant's weakening grip. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the tyrant's weakening grip in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the tyrant's weakening grip. Position your reading

within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "upbraid" most nearly mean?

   A. gives orders to
   B. to scold; to reproach
   C. happening every minute
   D. tiny; like a dwarf

2. *Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene II"?

   A. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief
   B. The murder and its first guilt
   C. The Witches' riddling world
   D. The tyrant's weakening grip

SAT key: 1. B (to scold; to reproach); 2. D (The tyrant's weakening grip)

Lesson 25: Act V, Scene III

Focus: defiance and despair

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act V, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Macbeth, trusting the prophecies, refuses to fear the fleeing thanes or 'the boy Malcolm.' He curses a pale servant who reports ten thousand English soldiers. Aside, he says he has lived long enough: his way of life is fallen 'into the sear, the yellow leaf,' without honor, love, obedience or troops of friends. He insists on putting on his armor. He asks the Doctor to 'minister to a mind diseased'; the Doctor says the patient must minister to himself. 'Throw physic to the dogs; I'll none of it.'

Background: Seyton, Macbeth's last attendant, has a name that sounds like 'Satan' to many readers and directors.

Significance: Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....
Prompt: Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: antidote — a remedy that counteracts a poison; epicures — people devoted to luxury and fine food; oblivious — causing forgetfulness; diseased — sick; perilous — dangerous. “oblivious”: Origin: Latin oblīviōsus (“forgetful”).
Words: antidote: a remedy that counteracts a poison · epicures: people devoted to luxury and fine food · oblivious: causing forgetfulness · diseased: sick · perilous: dangerous

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Seyton, Macbeth's last attendant, has a name that sounds like 'Satan' to many readers and directors. Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt. Characterization: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf." Soliloquy: He longs for "honour, love, obedience, troops of friends." Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Dunsinane. A room in the castle" (Act V, Scene III).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased" slowly and put it in my own words: Macbeth asks the doctor whether he can treat a diseased mind and pluck a sorrow from the memory. Next, craft. I notice the medical language of "minister" and "diseased," applied to guilt and grief. The strongest word is "diseased": it treats a guilty conscience like an illness of the body. Then, effect. What is Macbeth asking the doctor to do for his wife, and for himself? My answer: Macbeth knows medicine cannot cure guilt; when the doctor says the patient must minister to herself, Macbeth's angry reply shows he is also speaking about his own mind.

> *Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased* (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased" slowly and put it in my own words: Macbeth asks the doctor whether he can treat a diseased mind and pluck a sorrow from the memory. Next, craft. I notice the medical language of "minister" and "diseased," applied to guilt and grief. The strongest word is "diseased": it treats a guilty conscience like an illness of the body. Then, effect. What is Macbeth asking the doctor to do for his wife, and for himself? My answer: Macbeth knows medicine cannot cure guilt; when the doctor says the patient must minister to herself, Macbeth's angry reply shows he is also speaking about his own mind.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Autumn leaf = old age without companions. Guilt. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected: He asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." (Autumn imagery.)

> *I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf* (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Autumn leaf = old age without companions. Guilt.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected answer: He asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." (Autumn imagery.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, soliloquy (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about defiance and despair? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of defiance and despair. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. When the text says “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth), it shows this directly. He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, soliloquy (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about defiance and despair? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of defiance and despair. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. When the text says “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth), it shows this directly. He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside? Ask: do we pity Macbeth here?
Anchor question: Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside?
Facilitation: Ask: do we pity Macbeth here?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about defiance and despair? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. (“Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased”, Act V, Scene III, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about defiance and despair? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. (“Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased”, Act V, Scene III, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes defiance and despair. Key takeaway: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf."
- **Soliloquy:** He longs for "honour, love, obedience, troops of friends."

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Dunsinane. A room in the castle” (Act V, Scene III).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) Autumn imagery.
- “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) Guilt as disease.
- “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) Defiance.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him.
Evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth)
Reasoning: He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
antidote (noun)	a remedy that counteracts a poison	*Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*	
epicures (noun)	people devoted to luxury and fine food	*Then fly, false thanes, And mingle with the English epicures: The mind I sway by and the*	

		heart I bear Shall never sag with doubt nor shake with fear.	
oblivious (adjective)	causing forgetfulness	*Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*	"oblivious": Origin: Latin oblīviōsus ("forgetful"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/oblivious#Etymology)
diseased (adjective)	sick	*Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*	
perilous (adjective)	dangerous	*Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*	
preparation (noun)	forces made ready	*Ay, my good lord; your royal preparation Makes us hear something.*	
pronounced (verb)	declared	*The spirits that know All mortal consequences have pronounced me thus: "Fear not, Macbeth; no man that's born of woman Shall e'er have power upon thee."*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who is Macbeth's attendant who brings his armor? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Seyton.
2. Why does Macbeth say he will not fear Malcolm? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Malcolm was born of woman
3. What season image does Macbeth use for his life? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The sear, the yellow leaf (autumn)
4. What does Macbeth say he cannot look to have in old age? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Honour, love, obedience, troops of friends
5. What does Macbeth ask the Doctor? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To minister to a mind diseased
6. What does the Doctor reply? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The patient must minister to himself
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act V, Scene III” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Macbeth, trusting the prophecies, refuses to fear the fleeing thanes or 'the boy Malcolm.' He curses a pale servant who reports ten thousand English soldiers. Aside, he says he has lived long enough: his way of life is fallen 'into the sear, the yellow leaf,' without honor, love, obedience or troops of friends. He insists on putting on his armor. He asks the Doctor to 'minister to a mind…
8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act V, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff’d bosom of that perilous stuff Which…” What does “antidote” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: antidote: a remedy that counteracts a poison.

Inferential / analytical

1. Macbeth asks the Doctor to cure his wife, then says 'Throw physic to the dogs.' What does this shift reveal? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: He knows no medicine can cure guilt, his or hers.
2. What does “Act V, Scene III” suggest about defiance and despair? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about defiance and despair? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how

others react to them.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Autumn imagery. On characterization: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Bring me no more reports; let them fly all: Till Birnam wood remove to Dunsinane, I cannot taint with fear.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Macbeth, trusting the prophecies, refuses to fear the fleeing thanes or 'the boy Malcolm.' He curses a pale servant who reports ten thousand English soldiers. Aside, he says he has lived long enough: his way of life is fallen 'into the sear, the yellow leaf,' without honor, love, obedience or…
7. How does “Act V, Scene III” build on “Act V, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Defiance. On characterization: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with appearance versus reality? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Autumn imagery. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does Macbeth's self-awareness here make him more tragic or less sympathetic? Explain. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment about tragic recognition.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Defiance. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Autumn imagery. On characterization: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of defiance and despair. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Defiance. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Autumn imagery. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene III” treats defiance and despair with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Defiance. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Autumn imagery. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about defiance and despair? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is Macbeth's attendant who brings his armor?
   Sample answer: Seyton.
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The spirits that know All mortal consequences have _____ me thus: 'Fear not, Macbeth; no man that's born of woman Shall e'er have power upon thee.'" Word bank: pronounced, oblivious, epicures, antidote
   Key: pronounced
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene III, Macbeth: "I have lived long _____: my way of life / Is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf"
   Key: enough
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say he cannot look to have in old age?
   A. A son and heir
   B. Gold, land and horses
   C. Honour, love, obedience, troops of friends
   D. Sleep and food

   Key: C (Honour, love, obedience, troops of friends)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Doctor reply?
   A. She should go to England
   B. The patient must minister to himself
   C. She will recover by morning
   D. He can cure her with herbs

   Key: B (The patient must minister to himself)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Macbeth say he will not fear Malcolm?
   A. Malcolm was born of woman
   B. Malcolm is a coward
   C. Malcolm has no army
   D. Malcolm is in Ireland

   Key: A (Malcolm was born of woman)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth ask the Doctor?
   A. To poison Malcolm
   B. To minister to a mind diseased
   C. To read the stars
   D. To bring the Witches

   Key: B (To minister to a mind diseased)
8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Ay, my good lord; your royal _____ Makes us hear something." Word bank: oblivious, preparation, antidote, epicures
   Key: preparation

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Then fly, false thanes, And mingle with the English epicures: The mind I sway by and the heart I bear Shall never sag with doubt nor shake with fear.”, what does “epicures” most nearly mean?

    A. repeated striking on a door

    B. to deceive; to blind

    C. people devoted to luxury and fine food

    D. announced loudly; proclaimed

    Key: C (people devoted to luxury and fine food)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What season image does Macbeth use for his life?

    A. The sear, the yellow leaf (autumn)

    B. High summer

    C. Early spring

    D. Frozen winter

    Key: A (The sear, the yellow leaf (autumn))

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene III, Macbeth: “Canst thou not _____ to a mind diseased”

    Key: minister

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Macbeth asks the Doctor to cure his wife, then says 'Throw physic to the dogs.' What does this shift reveal?

    Sample answer: He knows no medicine can cure guilt, his or hers. The evidence is “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) — Guilt as disease.

13. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene III”? Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant (‘cream-faced loon’), speaks of his ‘way of life’ fallen ‘into the sear, the yellow leaf.’

    A. Characterization

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Theme

    D. Symbolism

    Key: A (Characterization)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? He asks the Doctor to ‘minister to a mind diseased.’

    A. Ambition and its costs

    B. Fate and free will

    C. Guilt and conscience

    D. Appearance versus reality

    Key: C (Guilt and conscience)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Defiance. The evidence is “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth). This

develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". The words “flesh” and “bones” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how guilt and conscience develops from Act V, Scene I to Act V, Scene III. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth, the text reads “Out, damned spot! out, I say” — Guilt as stain. In Act V, Scene III, “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) — Autumn imagery. He asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.".

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act V, Scene III, paragraph 22? “Throw _____ to the dogs; I’ll none of it.”
    A. afraid
    B. disseat
    C. physic
    D. reports

    Key: C (physic)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act V, Scene III?
    A. “Seyton!—I am sick at heart, When I behold—Seyton, I say!—This push Will cheer me ever, or disseat me now.”
    B. “All is confirm’d, my lord, which was reported.”
    C. “Not so sick, my lord, As she is troubled with thick coming fancies, That keep her from her rest.”
    D. “Send out more horses; skirr the country round; Hang those that talk of fear.”

    Key: A (“Seyton!—I am sick at heart, When I behold—Seyton, I say!—This push Will cheer me ever, or disseat me now.”)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act V, Scene III, paragraph 25 reveal about the character or situation? “Were I from Dunsinane away and clear, Profit again should hardly draw me here.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Act V, Scene III, paragraph 25) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". The words “hardly” and “should” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Autumn imagery. The evidence is “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". The words “enough” and “yellow” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.".

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene III”?
    A. The ghost at the banquet
    B. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior
    C. Nature's revolt against the crime
    D. Defiance and despair

Key: D (Defiance and despair)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene III, paragraph 3: “Bring me no more _____; let them fly all: Till Birnam wood remove to Dunsinane, I cannot taint with fear.” Word bank: afraid, disseat, physic, reports

    Key: reports

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff’d bosom of that _____ stuff Which weighs upon the heart?” Word bank: perilous, epicures, oblivious, antidote

    Key: perilous

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Autumn imagery. The evidence is “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.".

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act V, Scene III, paragraph 15 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “All is confirm’d, my lord, which was reported.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act V, Scene III, paragraph 15) develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". Its words “reported” and “confirm” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Not so sick, my lord, As she is troubled with thick coming fancies, That keep her from her rest.” (Act V, Scene III, paragraph 19), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does Macbeth's self-awareness here make him more tragic or less sympathetic? Explain.

    Sample answer: A judgment about tragic recognition: Guilt as disease. The evidence is “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.".

27. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Guilt as disease. The evidence is “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.".

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene III”? He longs for ‘honour, love, obedience, troops of friends.’

    A. Soliloquy

    B. Foreshadowing

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Structure

    Key: A (Soliloquy)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Guilt as disease. The evidence is “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". The words “diseased” and “minister” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.".
30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Claim: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth).
    Sample answer: He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". The evidence is “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) — Guilt as disease. This develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 8, 1, 9, 10, 2, 4, 11, 17, 18, 12, 19, 15, 14, 13, 20	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 7, 5, 10, 11, 17, 2, 6, 18, 21, 12, 19, 14, 15, 20, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Junior	5, 2, 22, 23, 1, 10, 6, 24, 18, 19, 12, 21, 14, 15, 25, 16	recall 7, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 8, 7, 6, 9, 5, 4, 19, 12, 18, 15, 14, 13, 16, 26, 20	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 3
AP	8, 17, 11, 2, 5, 23, 12, 21, 19, 24, 18, 14, 15, 16, 26, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 3
College Freshman	2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 27, 24, 12, 19, 18, 14, 15, 13, 25, 26, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	5, 10, 7, 3, 22, 8, 12, 18, 19, 14, 28, 15, 16, 26, 20, 25	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Junior	2, 8, 1, 4, 7, 27, 18, 12, 19, 15, 14, 28, 20, 16, 25, 26	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Senior	10, 11, 8, 7, 22, 21, 18, 19, 12, 14, 15, 29, 20, 26, 25, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	8, 1, 4, 11, 7, 12, 19, 18, 21, 14, 30, 15, 26, 20, 16, 25	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show defiance and despair? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of defiance and despair? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of defiance and despair. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and

explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of defiance and despair. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene III suggests about defiance and despair. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act V, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of defiance and despair. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of defiance and despair responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of defiance and despair follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene III and its treatment of defiance and despair. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about defiance and despair in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of defiance and despair. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "oblivious" most nearly mean?

   A. causing forgetfulness
   B. forces made ready
   C. declared
   D. dangerous

2. *Bring me no more reports; let them fly all: Till Birnam wood remove to Dunsinane, I cannot taint with fear. What's the boy Malcolm? Was he not born of woman? The spirits that know All mortal consequences have pronounced me thus: "Fear not, Macbeth; no man that's born of woman Shall e'er have power upon thee." Then fly, false thanes, And mingle with the English epicures: The mind I sway by and the heart I bear Shall never sag with doubt nor shake with fear.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene III"?

   A. Suspicion spoken through irony
   B. Defiance and despair
   C. The Witches' riddling world
   D. The cast and world of the play

SAT key: 1. A (causing forgetfulness); 2. B (Defiance and despair)

Lesson 26: Act V, Scene IV

Focus: the moving wood

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act V, Scene IV (the moving wood) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Near Birnam Wood, Malcolm orders every soldier to cut down a bough and carry it before him to hide the army's numbers from Macbeth's scouts. Siward reports that Macbeth will wait for a siege at Dunsinane; Malcolm notes that many have revolted and only 'constrained things whose hearts are absent too' serve him. Macduff and Siward urge action over speculation.

Background: Camouflage with branches appears in medieval chronicle tales; Shakespeare uses it to fulfil the apparition's riddle literally.

Significance: A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Camouflage with branches appears in medieval chronicle tales; Shakespeare uses it to fulfil the apparition's riddle literally. A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined. Plot: Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers. Dramatic irony: The audience sees the prophecy being fulfilled by human strategy. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Country near Birnam wood" (Act V, Scene IV).

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes the moving wood. Key takeaway: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers.
- **Dramatic irony:** The audience sees the prophecy being fulfilled by human strategy.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Country near Birnam wood” (Act V, Scene IV).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) Malcolm's order.
- “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) The strategy.
- “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, Siward) Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action.
Evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm)
Reasoning: Malcolm orders "every soldier hew him down a bough," to "shadow / The numbers of our host."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
soldiership (noun)	military skill	*Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership.*	
censures (noun)	judgments; opinions	*Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership.*	“censures”: Origin of “censure”: Latin censūra (“censor's office or assessment”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/censure#Etymology)
	bedrooms		

chambers (noun)		*Cousins, I hope the days are near at hand That chambers will be safe.*	
arbitrate (verb)	to decide; to settle	*Thoughts speculative their unsure hopes relate, But certain issue strokes must arbitrate: Towards which advance the war.*	
speculative (adjective)	based on guesswork	*Thoughts speculative their unsure hopes relate, But certain issue strokes must arbitrate: Towards which advance the war.*	"speculative": Origin: Old French speculatif; earlier Late Latin speculativus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/speculative#Etymology)
constrained (adjective)	forced; acting against their will	*'Tis his main hope: For where there is advantage to be given, Both more and less have given him the revolt, And none serve with him but constrained things Whose hearts are absent too.*	
strokes (noun)	blows in battle	*Thoughts speculative their unsure hopes relate, But certain issue strokes must arbitrate: Towards which advance the war.*	
discovery (noun)	scouting; spying out	*Let every soldier hew him down a bough And bear't before him: thereby shall we shadow The numbers of our host and make discovery Err in report of us.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Near which wood does the army gather? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Birnam Wood.

2. What does Malcolm order each soldier to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cut down a bough and carry it
3. Why does he give this order? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To hide the size of the army
4. Which prophecy does this begin to fulfil? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Birnam Wood coming to Dunsinane
5. Who still serves Macbeth, according to Malcolm? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Constrained things whose hearts are absent
6. What do Macduff and Siward urge? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Action rather than speculation
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Near Birnam Wood, Malcolm orders every soldier to cut down a bough and carry it before him to hide the army's numbers from Macbeth's scouts. Siward reports that Macbeth will wait for a siege at Dunsinane; Malcolm notes that many have revolted and only 'constrained things whose hearts are absent too' serve him. Macduff and Siward urge action over speculation.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership." What does "soldiership" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: soldiership: military skill.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is it ironic that the trick is Malcolm's ordinary military plan? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: The 'impossible' sign Macbeth trusted is achieved by simple strategy.
2. What does "Act V, Scene IV" suggest about the moving wood? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined.
3. Find one example of foreshadowing in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about the moving wood? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear't before him" (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm): Malcolm's order. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “The time approaches That will with due decision make us know What we shall say we have and what we owe.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Near Birnam Wood, Malcolm orders every soldier to cut down a bough and carry it before him to hide the army's numbers from Macbeth's scouts. Siward reports that Macbeth will wait for a siege at Dunsinane; Malcolm notes that many have revolted and only 'constrained things whose hearts are absent…
7. How does “Act V, Scene IV” build on “Act V, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, Siward): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm): Malcolm's order. On plot: Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the fulfilment of the prophecy make Malcolm a tool of fate or a free agent? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment on fate and free will.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “thereby shall we shadow / The

numbers of our host" (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: "A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane" (Act V, Scene IV, Siward): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear't before him" (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm): Malcolm's order. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Act V, Scene IV". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the moving wood. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host" (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "Act V, Scene IV": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane" (Act V, Scene IV, Siward): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear't before him" (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm): Malcolm's order. Theme link: prophecy

fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the foreshadowing in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene IV” treats the moving wood with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, Siward): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm): Malcolm's order. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the moving wood? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act V, Scene III, paragraph 22? “Throw _____ to the dogs; I’ll none of it.”

   A. afraid

   B. disseat

   C. physic

   D. reports

   Key: C (physic)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Cousins, I hope the days are near at hand That chambers will be safe.”, what does “chambers” most nearly mean?

   A. actions; things done

   B. a remedy that counteracts a poison

   C. bedrooms

   D. to change

   Key: C (bedrooms)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm: “Let every _____ hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him”

   Key: soldier

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does he give this order?

   A. To scare the Witches

   B. To make fires

   C. To hide the size of the army

   D. To build a bridge

   Key: C (To hide the size of the army)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who still serves Macbeth, according to Malcolm?

   A. The Witches

   B. Ten thousand English soldiers

   C. His loyal thanes

   D. Constrained things whose hearts are absent

   Key: D (Constrained things whose hearts are absent)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do Macduff and Siward urge?

   A. Action rather than speculation

   B. Waiting for winter

   C. Negotiation with Macbeth

   D. Retreat to England

   Key: A (Action rather than speculation)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Malcolm order each soldier to do?

   A. March at night without torches

   B. Hide in the trees

C. Burn the wood

D. Cut down a bough and carry it

Key: D (Cut down a bough and carry it)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene IV, Siward: “the _____ tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane”

   Key: confident

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm: “_____ shall we shadow / The numbers of our host”

   Key: thereby

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act V, Scene II?

    A. “Well, march we on, To give obedience where ’tis truly owed: Meet we the medicine of the sickly weal, And with him pour we in our country’s…”

    B. “Who knows if Donalbain be with his brother?”

    C. “For certain, sir, he is not: I have a file Of all the gentry: there is Siward’s son, And many unrough youths that even now Protest their…”

    D. “Near Birnam wood Shall we well meet them; that way are they coming.”

    Key: D (“Near Birnam wood Shall we well meet them; that way are they coming.”)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act V, Scene III, paragraph 25 reveal about the character or situation? “Were I from Dunsinane away and clear, Profit again should hardly draw me here.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act V, Scene III, paragraph 25) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". The words “hardly” and “should” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act V, Scene III?

    A. “Seyton!—I am sick at heart, When I behold—Seyton, I say!—This push Will cheer me ever, or disseat me now.”

    B. “All is confirm’d, my lord, which was reported.”

    C. “Not so sick, my lord, As she is troubled with thick coming fancies, That keep her from her rest.”

    D. “Send out more horses; skirr the country round; Hang those that talk of fear.”

    Key: A (“Seyton!—I am sick at heart, When I behold—Seyton, I say!—This push Will cheer me ever, or disseat me now.”)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why is it ironic that the trick is Malcolm's ordinary military plan?

    Sample answer: The 'impossible' sign Macbeth trusted is achieved by simple strategy. The evidence is “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) — The strategy.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

    A. Fate and free will

    B. Ambition and its costs

    C. Appearance versus reality

    D. Guilt and conscience

    Key: A (Fate and free will)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene IV”? The audience sees the prophecy being fulfilled by human strategy.

    A. Structure

    B. Theme

    C. Dramatic irony

    D. Setting

    Key: C (Dramatic irony)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act V, Scene III, paragraph 15 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “All is confirm’d, my lord, which was reported.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Act V, Scene III, paragraph 15) develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". Its words “reported” and “confirm” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Not so sick, my lord, As she is troubled with thick coming fancies, That keep her from her rest.” (Act V, Scene III, paragraph 19), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which prophecy does this begin to fulfil?

    A. Beware Macduff

    B. Birnam Wood coming to Dunsinane

    C. None of woman born

    D. Banquo's heirs as kings

    Key: B (Birnam Wood coming to Dunsinane)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “’Tis his main hope: For where there is advantage to be given, Both more and less have given him the revolt, And none serve with him but _____ things Whose hearts are absent too.” Word bank: soldiership, censures, constrained, chambers

    Key: constrained

19. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Near which wood does the army gather?

    Sample answer: Birnam Wood.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Malcolm's order. The evidence is “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm). This develops fate and free will: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The strategy. The evidence is “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm). This develops fate and free will: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, Siward). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. The evidence is “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, Siward). This develops fate and free will: prophecy fulfilled

through practical choices. The words “confident” and “tyrant” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Does the fulfilment of the prophecy make Malcolm a tool of fate or a free agent? Argue.
    Sample answer: A judgment on fate and free will. The evidence is “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) — Malcolm's order. This develops fate and free will: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Malcolm orders "every soldier hew him down a bough," to "shadow / The numbers of our host.".

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Thoughts _____ their unsure hopes relate, But certain issue strokes must arbitrate: Towards which advance the war.”
    Word bank: censures, chambers, soldiership, speculative
    Key: speculative

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership.”, what does “censures” most nearly mean?
    A. judgments; opinions
    B. a convenient time
    C. to make up; to form
    D. to praise
    Key: A (judgments; opinions)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene IV”? Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers.
    A. Imagery
    B. Irony
    C. Plot
    D. Hyperbole
    Key: C (Plot)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how fate and free will develops from Act IV, Scene I to Act V, Scene IV. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act IV, Scene I, All, the text reads “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble”, which shows the chant; trochaic rhythm. In Act V, Scene IV, “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) — Malcolm's order. Prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Thoughts speculative their unsure hopes relate, But certain issue _____ must arbitrate: Towards which advance the war.” Word bank: censures, strokes, soldiership, chambers
    Key: strokes

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough And bear’t before him: thereby shall we shadow The numbers of our host and make _____ Err in report of us.” Word bank: discovery, chambers, censures, soldiership
    Key: discovery

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership.”, what does “soldiership” most nearly mean?
    A. military skill

B. a greeting

C. large guns that fire heavy shot

D. bodily; of the body

Key: A (military skill)

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene IV"?

A. Insecurity on the throne

B. The ghost at the banquet

C. The moving wood

D. The guilt that will not wash away

Key: C (The moving wood)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene III, paragraph 3: "Bring me no more _____; let them fly all: Till Birnam wood remove to Dunsinane, I cannot taint with fear." Word bank: afraid, disseat, physic, reports

Key: reports

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host" (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The strategy. The evidence is "thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host" (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm). This develops fate and free will: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. The words "numbers" and "thereby" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Malcolm orders "every soldier hew him down a bough," to "shadow / The numbers of our host.".

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? "the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane" (Act V, Scene IV, Siward)

A. Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight.

B. Her judgment of her husband.

C. Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls.

D. The opening question: a world of storm and repetition.

Key: C (Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls.)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 8, 7, 17, 5, 2, 18, 19, 10, 12, 20, 21, 14, 15, 22, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	24, 8, 18, 25, 4, 7, 10, 12, 11, 20, 13, 26, 14, 22, 23, 27	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 28, 29, 18, 2, 30, 17, 10, 12, 11, 31, 13, 14, 22, 16, 23	recall 7, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Senior	1, 32, 4, 3, 6, 25, 10, 12, 11, 13, 31, 22, 14, 16, 23, 27	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 3
AP	32, 1, 24, 17, 19, 10, 12, 11, 13, 22, 14, 26, 16, 33, 23, 27	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Freshman	18, 24, 2, 17, 28, 10, 11, 12, 31, 13, 21, 22, 14, 16, 27, 23	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 2, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	1, 24, 18, 4, 17, 10, 12, 11, 21, 34, 13, 31, 14, 16, 23, 27	recall 5, inference 7, analysis 1, synthesis 3

College Junior	24, 18, 2, 17, 10, 11, 12, 31, 20, 13, 22, 14, 16, 27, 23, 33	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 2, synthesis 4
College Senior	1, 24, 18, 2, 25, 10, 11, 12, 21, 31, 13, 14, 22, 16, 23, 27	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 2, synthesis 3
Graduate / PhD	1, 3, 30, 5, 24, 10, 11, 12, 13, 20, 14, 22, 26, 16, 23, 27	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene IV," how does Shakespeare show the moving wood? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the moving wood? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene IV develops the idea of the moving wood. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the moving wood. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene IV suggests about the moving wood. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's foreshadowing and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses foreshadowing in Act V, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of the moving wood. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the moving wood responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the moving wood follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene IV and its treatment of the moving wood. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's foreshadowing and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about the moving wood in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the moving wood. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Cousins, I hope the days are near at hand That chambers will be safe.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “chambers” most nearly mean?

   A. blows in battle

   B. scouting; spying out

   C. forced; acting against their will

   D. bedrooms

2. *The time approaches That will with due decision make us know What we shall say we have and what we owe. Thoughts speculative their unsure hopes relate, But certain issue strokes must arbitrate: Towards which advance the war. Exeunt, marching.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene IV”?

   A. The army reveals itself

   B. Lady Macbeth's resolve

   C. The moving wood

   D. The dagger of the mind

SAT key: 1. D (bedrooms); 2. C (The moving wood)

Lesson 27: Act V, Scene V

Focus: life as a tale told by an idiot

Objective: Students will analyze how metaphor develops in "Act V, Scene V" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…r, There is nor flying hence nor tarrying here. I gin to be aweary of the sun, And wish the e…").
Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Macbeth orders banners hung on the outward walls, boasting his castle will laugh a siege to scorn. A cry of women is heard; he says he has almost forgotten the taste of fears. Seyton reports 'The queen, my lord, is dead.' Macbeth replies 'She should have died hereafter' and speaks of 'To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow': life is 'a walking shadow, a poor player,' a tale 'told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, signifying nothing.' A messenger reports that Birnam Wood seems to move. Macbeth begins to doubt 'the equivocation of the fiend that lies like truth' and goes out to fight: 'At least we'll die with harness on our back.'

Background: Comparing life to a stage play was a commonplace in Shakespeare's theater; here an actor speaks of life as a part that means nothing.

Significance: The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: meaninglessness.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: yesterdays — past days; equivocation — the use of double meanings to mislead; tarrying — staying; lingering; harness — armor; lighted — lit the way for; guided. "equivocation": Origin: Old French equivocation; earlier Late Latin aequivocus ("ambiguous").
Words: yesterdays: past days · equivocation: the use of double meanings to mislead · tarrying: staying; lingering · harness: armor · lighted: lit the way for; guided

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Comparing life to a stage play was a commonplace in Shakespeare's theater; here an actor speaks of life as a part that means nothing. The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom. Soliloquy: "Tomorrow, and tomorrow, and tomorrow": Macbeth's response to his wife's death. Imagery: Life as a "brief candle," "a walking shadow," "a poor player," "a tale / Told by an idiot." Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Dunsinane. Within the castle" (Act V, Scene V).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "She should have died hereafter" slowly and put it in my own words: Told that the queen is dead, Macbeth says she should have died hereafter, at a later time. Next, craft. I notice the flat, tired tone, with no cry of grief. The strongest word is "hereafter": it means later, as if her death simply came at a bad moment. Then, effect. What does Macbeth's response to his wife's death show? My answer: Macbeth's response to his wife's death, that she should have died hereafter, shows that he has become numb; his following speech shows that life now seems meaningless to him.

> *She should have died hereafter* (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "She should have died hereafter" slowly and put it in my own words: Told that the queen is dead, Macbeth says she should have died hereafter, at a later time. Next, craft. I notice the flat, tired tone, with no cry of grief. The strongest word is "hereafter": it means later, as if her death simply came at a bad moment. Then, effect. What does Macbeth's response to his wife's death show? My answer: Macbeth's response to his wife's death, that she should have died hereafter, shows that he has become numb; his following speech shows that life now seems meaningless to him.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The metaphors (candle, shadow, player, tale) all suggest brevity and emptiness. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: Meaninglessness. (Meaninglessness.)

> *it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing* (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The metaphors (candle, shadow, player, tale) all suggest brevity and emptiness.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: Meaninglessness. (Meaninglessness.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for soliloquy, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of life as a tale told by an idiot. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of metaphor and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. When the text says "it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing" (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth), it shows this directly. Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing."
Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of life as a tale told by an idiot. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of metaphor and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. When the text says "it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing" (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth), it shows this directly. Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing."

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none? Ask: is this Shakespeare's view or Macbeth's?
Anchor question: What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none?
Facilitation: Ask: is this Shakespeare's view or Macbeth's?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. (“it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing”, Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. (“it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing”, Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how soliloquy shapes life as a tale told by an idiot. Key takeaway: meaninglessness.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** "Tomorrow, and tomorrow, and tomorrow": Macbeth's response to his wife's death.
- **Imagery:** Life as a "brief candle," "a walking shadow," "a poor player," "a tale / Told by an idiot."

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** meaninglessness.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Dunsinane. Within the castle” (Act V, Scene V).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) His response.
- “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) Time.
- “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) Meaninglessness.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning.
Evidence: "it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing" (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth)
Reasoning: Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
yesterdays (noun)	past days	*To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.*	
equivocation (noun)	the use of double meanings to mislead	*I pull in resolution, and begin To doubt the equivocation of the fiend That lies like truth: "Fear not, till Birnam wood Do come to Dunsinane:" and now a wood Comes toward Dunsinane.*	"equivocation": Origin: Old French equivocation; earlier Late Latin aequivocus ("ambiguous"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/equivocation#Etymology)
tarrying (verb)	staying; lingering	*If this which he avouches does appear, There is nor flying hence nor tarrying here.*	
harness (noun)	armor	*At least we'll die with harness on our back.*	
lighted (verb)	lit the way for; guided	*To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.*	

Discussion questions

1. What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none?
2. Where does metaphor appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20,

21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Macbeth say life signifies, at the end of the speech? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Nothing: a tale told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, signifying nothing.
2. What does Seyton report? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The queen is dead
3. How does Macbeth first respond to his wife's death? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She should have died hereafter
4. What does Macbeth compare life to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A walking shadow and a poor player
5. What does the messenger see? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Birnam Wood beginning to move
6. How does Macbeth say he will die? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: With harness (armor) on his back
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Macbeth orders banners hung on the outward walls, boasting his castle will laugh a siege to scorn. A cry of women is heard; he says he has almost forgotten the taste of fears. Seyton reports 'The queen, my lord, is dead.' Macbeth replies 'She should have died hereafter' and speaks of 'To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow': life is 'a walking shadow, a poor player,' a tale 'told by an idiot,…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene V" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death." What does "yesterdays" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: yesterdays: past days.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macbeth react so flatly to his wife's death? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: He has 'supp'd full with horrors'; feeling itself has been numbed by crime.
2. What does Macbeth mean by 'the equivocation of the fiend that lies like truth'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: He realizes the Witches' words were true only in a deceptive sense.
3. What does "Act V, Scene V" suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom.
4. Find one example of metaphor in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for direct comparisons that call one thing another.

5. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about life as a tale told by an idiot? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins “She should have died hereafter; There would have been a time for such a word.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Macbeth orders banners hung on the outward walls, boasting his castle will laugh a siege to scorn. A cry of women is heard; he says he has almost forgotten the taste of fears. Seyton reports 'The queen, my lord, is dead.' Macbeth replies 'She should have died hereafter' and speaks of 'To-morrow,…
8. How does “Act V, Scene V” build on “Act V, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): Time. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): Meaninglessness. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is 'To-morrow, and to-morrow' the play's message or only Macbeth's? Argue with evidence from the ending. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment distinguishing character and work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): Time. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): Meaninglessness. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of life as a tale told by an idiot. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): Time. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): Meaninglessness. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the metaphor in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene V” treats life as a tale told by an idiot with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): Time. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene VI” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): Meaninglessness. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about life as a tale told by an idiot? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Metaphor:** look for direct comparisons that call one thing another (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “If this which he avouches does appear, There is nor flying hence nor tarrying here.”, what does “tarrying” most nearly mean?

   A. announced loudly; proclaimed

   B. a loud rattling noise

   C. rebellions

   D. staying; lingering

   Key: D (staying; lingering)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth compare life to?

   A. A garden and a storm

   B. A river and a sea

   C. A battle and a crown

   D. A walking shadow and a poor player

   Key: D (A walking shadow and a poor player)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "I pull in resolution, and begin To doubt the equivocation of the fiend That lies like truth: 'Fear not, till Birnam wood Do come to Dunsinane:' and now a wood Comes toward Dunsinane.", what does "equivocation" most nearly mean?

   A. a dressing gown worn over night clothes

   B. the use of double meanings to mislead

   C. freaks shown for money

   D. early

   Key: B (the use of double meanings to mislead)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the messenger see?

   A. Macduff's army retreating

   B. The Witches flying

   C. A comet

   D. Birnam Wood beginning to move

   Key: D (Birnam Wood beginning to move)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Macbeth first respond to his wife's death?

   A. She should have died hereafter

   B. He blames Malcolm

   C. He weeps and faints

   D. He laughs

   Key: A (She should have died hereafter)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Seyton report?

   A. The queen is dead

   B. Banquo's ghost has returned

   C. Malcolm has surrendered

   D. The Witches are at the gate

   Key: A (The queen is dead)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have _____ fools The way to dusty death." Word bank: tarrying, lighted, yesterdays, equivocation

   Key: lighted

8. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say life signifies, at the end of the speech?

   Sample answer: Nothing: a tale told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, signifying nothing.

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene V, Macbeth: “To-_____, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day”

   Key: morrow

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Macbeth say he will die?

    A. With harness (armor) on his back

    B. In his bed

    C. In exile

    D. By his own hand

    Key: A (With harness (armor) on his back)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene V, Macbeth: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying _____”

    Key: nothing

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Macbeth mean by 'the equivocation of the fiend that lies like truth'?

    Sample answer: He realizes the Witches' words were true only in a deceptive sense. The evidence is “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) — Meaninglessness.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Macbeth react so flatly to his wife's death?

    Sample answer: He has 'supp'd full with horrors'; feeling itself has been numbed by crime. The evidence is “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) — Meaninglessness.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Meaninglessness.

    A. Fate and free will

    B. Guilt and conscience

    C. Ambition and its costs

    D. Appearance versus reality

    Key: A (Fate and free will)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene V”? ‘Tomorrow, and tomorrow, and tomorrow’: Macbeth's response to his wife's death.

    A. Symbolism

    B. Allusion

    C. Irony

    D. Soliloquy

    Key: D (Soliloquy)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: His response. The evidence is “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness. The words “hereafter” and “should” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing.".

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “At least we’ll die with harness on our back.”, what does “harness” most nearly mean?

    A. freaks shown for money

    B. bodies or forms

    C. a blessing

    D. armor

    Key: D (armor)

18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: His response. The evidence is “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness.

19. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene V”? Life as a ‘brief candle,’ ‘a walking shadow,’ ‘a poor player,’ ‘a tale / Told by an idiot.’

    A. Hyperbole

    B. Irony

    C. Point of view

    D. Imagery

    Key: D (Imagery)

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is 'To-morrow, and to-morrow' the play's message or only Macbeth's? Argue with evidence from the ending.

    Sample answer: A judgment distinguishing character and work. The evidence is “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) — Time. This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness. Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing.".

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene V, paragraph 2: “Enter Macbeth, Seyton, and Soldiers, with drum and _____.” Word bank: quickly, methought, colours, famine

    Key: colours

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act V, Scene III, paragraph 5 reveal about the character or situation? “The devil damn thee black, thou cream-faced loon!” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act V, Scene III, paragraph 5) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". The words its wording are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act V, Scene V, paragraph 3 reveal about the character or situation? “Were they not forced with those that should be ours, We might have met them dareful, beard to beard, And beat them backward home.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act V, Scene V, paragraph 3) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: meaninglessness. The words “backward” and “dareful” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act V, Scene III, paragraph 19 shapes its tone: “Not so sick, my lord, As she is troubled with thick coming fancies, That keep her from her rest.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “troubled” and “fancies” (Act V, Scene III, paragraph 19) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how fate and free will develops from Act V, Scene IV to Act V, Scene V. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm, the text reads “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” — Malcolm's order. In Act V, Scene V, “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) — His response. Meaninglessness.

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene V”?
A. A marriage drifting apart
B. The dagger of the mind
C. The murder of the innocent
D. Life as a tale told by an idiot
Key: D (Life as a tale told by an idiot)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act V, Scene V, paragraph 16 shapes its tone: “Let me endure your wrath, if’t be not so: Within this three mile may you see it coming; I say, a moving grove.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “endure” and “moving” (Act V, Scene V, paragraph 16) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: meaninglessness. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act V, Scene V, paragraph 17? “If thou speak’st false, Upon the next tree shalt thou hang alive, Till _____ cling thee: if thy speech be sooth, I care not if thou dost for me as much.”
A. methought
B. colours
C. famine
D. quickly
Key: C (famine)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth).
Sample answer: Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing.". The evidence is “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) — Meaninglessness. This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act V, Scene III, paragraph 11? “Seyton!—I am sick at heart, When I behold—Seyton, I say!—This push Will cheer me ever, or _____ me now.”
A. physic
B. afraid
C. disseat

D. country

Key: C (disseat)

31. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Time. The evidence is “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Meaninglessness. The evidence is “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness. The words “nothing” and “sound” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

33. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene III, paragraph 24: “I will not be _____ of death and bane, Till Birnam forest come to Dunsinane.” Word bank: afraid, physic, reports, country
    Key: afraid

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Time. The evidence is “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness. The words “morrow” and “petty” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing.".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 1, 5, 17, 2, 11, 4, 8, 7, 10, 12, 18, 13, 19, 14, 20	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 3, 10, 21, 8, 1, 4, 22, 23, 13, 12, 24, 14, 19, 25, 20	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	7, 4, 2, 8, 9, 3, 22, 23, 12, 26, 13, 24, 27, 14, 20, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 28, 6, 21, 8, 22, 12, 13, 23, 24, 15, 29, 14, 16, 25, 20	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	30, 9, 11, 2, 22, 26, 31, 12, 13, 23, 24, 14, 27, 25, 20, 16	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Freshman	21, 1, 2, 3, 7, 22, 12, 26, 23, 18, 13, 24, 14, 27, 20, 25	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 2
College Sophomore	10, 7, 21, 5, 22, 12, 23, 13, 24, 27, 14, 32, 15, 20, 25, 16	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 3
College Junior	9, 17, 28, 21, 2, 22, 18, 13, 12, 26, 23, 24, 27, 14, 20, 25	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 2
College Senior	7, 21, 28, 6, 22, 13, 23, 18, 26, 12, 24, 29, 27, 14, 25, 20	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 2
Graduate / PhD	33, 6, 5, 9, 22, 23, 26, 13, 12, 24, 27, 14, 29, 25, 34, 20	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show life as a tale told by an idiot? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the metaphor you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of life as a tale told by an idiot? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the metaphor in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of life as a tale told by an idiot. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of metaphor and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its metaphor shape the reader's understanding of life as a tale told by an idiot. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene V suggests about life as a tale told by an idiot. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's metaphor and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses metaphor in Act V, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of life as a tale told by an idiot. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of life as a tale told by an idiot responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of life as a tale told by an idiot follows or bends those conventions, using the metaphor as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene V and its treatment of life as a tale told by an idiot. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's metaphor and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about life as a tale told by an idiot in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of life as a tale told by an idiot. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “yesterdays” most nearly mean?

   A. staying; lingering

   B. past days

   C. armor

   D. lit the way for; guided

2. *She should have died hereafter; There would have been a time for such a word. To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death. Out, out, brief candle! Life’s but a walking shadow, a poor player That struts and frets his hour upon the stage And then is heard no more: it is a tale Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, Signifying nothing.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene V”?

   A. The cast and world of the play

   B. The army reveals itself

   C. The discovery of the murder

   D. Life as a tale told by an idiot

SAT key: 1. B (past days); 2. D (Life as a tale told by an idiot)

Lesson 28: Act V, Scene VI

Focus: the army reveals itself

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act V, Scene VI (the army reveals itself) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.3

Teacher only · spoilers

Before Dunsinane, Malcolm orders the soldiers to throw down their 'leavy screens' and show themselves as they are. His uncle Siward and Siward's son will lead the first battle; Malcolm and Macduff will do the rest. Macduff calls for all the trumpets to sound, 'those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.'

Background: Short battle scenes with alarums (trumpet calls) and quick exits created the impression of a large battle on a bare stage.

Significance: The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....*
> **Prompt:** Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the prophecy is fulfilled.

> **8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)**
> Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
> *Short battle scenes with alarums (trumpet calls) and quick exits created the impression of a large battle on a bare stage. The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality. Plot: Malcolm's army throws down its branches and attacks. Structure: A brief scene that speeds the action. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "Dunsinane. Before the castle" (Act V, Scene VI).*

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes the army reveals itself. Key takeaway: the prophecy is fulfilled.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Malcolm's army throws down its branches and attacks.
- **Structure:** A brief scene that speeds the action.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the prophecy is fulfilled.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “Dunsinane. Before the castle” (Act V, Scene VI).
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour and becomes the mark of guilt that cannot be washed away. In this scene: “trumpets speak; give them all breath, / Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death. Exeunt” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm) Malcolm's command.
- “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff) Battle.
- “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff) The trumpets.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true.
Evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm)
Reasoning: Malcolm orders "your leavy screens throw down" and the trumpets become "harbingers of blood and death."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
screens (noun)	coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army)	*Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are.*	
clamorous (adjective)	loud and noisy	*Make all our trumpets speak; give them all breath, Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.*	“clamorous”: Origin: an English formation from clamor + -ous. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/clamorous#Etymology)

trumpets (noun)	brass instruments sounded in battle	*Make all our trumpets speak; give them all breath, Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Malcolm call Siward in this scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: 'Worthy uncle.'
2. What does Malcolm order the soldiers to throw down? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Their leafy screens
3. Who will lead the first battle? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Siward and his son
4. What does Macduff call the trumpets? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Clamorous harbingers of blood and death
5. Where does this scene take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Before Dunsinane castle
6. What is the main effect of the short battle scenes? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Speed and the sense of a large battle
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene VI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Before Dunsinane, Malcolm orders the soldiers to throw down their 'leavy screens' and show themselves as they are. His uncle Siward and Siward's son will lead the first battle; Malcolm and Macduff will do the rest. Macduff calls for all the trumpets to sound, 'those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.'
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene VI", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene VI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are.” What does “screens” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: screens: coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army).

Inferential / analytical

1. How does dropping the 'leavy screens' connect to the theme of appearance and reality? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Disguise ends; truth is revealed as the tyrant is confronted.
2. What does “Act V, Scene VI” suggest about the army reveals itself? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the imagery in this scene shape what we understand about the army reveals itself? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm): Malcolm's command. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene VI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Before Dunsinane, Malcolm orders the soldiers to throw down their 'leavy screens' and show themselves as they are. His uncle Siward and Siward's son will lead the first battle; Malcolm and Macduff will do the rest. Macduff calls for all the trumpets to sound, 'those clamorous harbingers of blood…
7. How does “Act V, Scene VI” build on “Act V, Scene V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff): Battle. On structure: A brief scene that speeds the action. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff): The trumpets. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm): Malcolm's command. On structure: A brief scene that speeds the action. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. If you staged this scene, how would you make a handful of actors feel like an army? Explain. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative staging solution with rationale.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff): Battle. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff): The trumpets. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm): Malcolm's command. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene VI”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the army reveals itself. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff): Battle. On structure: A brief scene that speeds the action. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff): The trumpets. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm): Malcolm's command. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff): Battle. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene VI” treats the army reveals itself with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff): The trumpets. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene VII” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm): Malcolm's command. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the army reveals itself? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff): Battle. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)

- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Now near enough: your leavy _____ throw down, And show like those you are." Word bank: clamorous, trumpets, screens
   Key: screens
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the main effect of the short battle scenes?
   A. A comic interlude
   B. A long pause before the end
   C. A flashback
   D. Speed and the sense of a large battle
   Key: D (Speed and the sense of a large battle)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Make all our trumpets speak; give them all breath, Those _____ harbingers of blood and death." Word bank: trumpets, clamorous, screens
   Key: clamorous
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Malcolm order the soldiers to throw down?
   A. Their weapons
   B. Their leafy screens
   C. Their banners
   D. Their armor
   Key: B (Their leafy screens)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does this scene take place?
   A. In England
   B. At Inverness
   C. Before Dunsinane castle
   D. In Birnam Wood
   Key: C (Before Dunsinane castle)
6. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Malcolm call Siward in this scene?
   Sample answer: 'Worthy uncle.'
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff call the trumpets?
   A. Clamorous harbingers of blood and death
   B. Voices of heaven
   C. Sweet music of peace
   D. The Witches' songs
   Key: A (Clamorous harbingers of blood and death)
8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene VI, Macduff: "Those clamorous _____ of blood and death"
   Key: harbingers

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who will lead the first battle?

   A. Siward and his son

   B. Macduff alone

   C. Lennox

   D. Malcolm

   Key: A (Siward and his son)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does dropping the 'leavy screens' connect to the theme of appearance and reality?

    Sample answer: Disguise ends; truth is revealed as the tyrant is confronted. The evidence is “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff) — The trumpets. This develops fate and free will: the prophecy is fulfilled.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene VI”?

    A. The army reveals itself

    B. The decision to murder

    C. The last false confidence

    D. The dagger of the mind

    Key: A (The army reveals itself)

12. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm).

    Sample answer: Malcolm orders "your leavy screens throw down" and the trumpets become "harbingers of blood and death.". The evidence is “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm) — Malcolm's command. This develops fate and free will: the prophecy is fulfilled.

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The trumpets. The evidence is “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy is fulfilled. The words “harbingers” and “clamorous” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The prophecy is fulfilled.

    A. Ambition and its costs

    B. Fate and free will

    C. Appearance versus reality

    D. Guilt and conscience

    Key: B (Fate and free will)

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how fate and free will develops from Act V, Scene V to Act V, Scene VI. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act V, Scene V, Macbeth, the text reads “She should have died hereafter” — His response. In Act V, Scene VI, “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm) — Malcolm's command. The prophecy is fulfilled.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] If you staged this scene, how would you make a handful of actors feel like an army? Explain.

    Sample answer: A creative staging solution with rationale. The evidence is “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff) — Battle. This develops fate and free will: the prophecy is fulfilled. Malcolm orders "your leavy screens throw down" and the trumpets become "harbingers of blood and death.".

17. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene VI”? Malcolm's army throws down its branches and attacks.

    A. Imagery

    B. Simile

    C. Symbolism

    D. Plot

    Key: D (Plot)

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Malcolm's command. The evidence is “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy is fulfilled. The words “screens” and “leavy” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Malcolm orders "your leavy screens throw down" and the trumpets become "harbingers of blood and death.".

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene V, paragraph 2: “Enter Macbeth, Seyton, and Soldiers, with drum and _____.” Word bank: quickly, methought, colours, famine

    Key: colours

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Act V, Scene V, paragraph 3 reveal about the character or situation? “Were they not forced with those that should be ours, We might have met them dareful, beard to beard, And beat them backward home.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Act V, Scene V, paragraph 3) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: meaninglessness. The words “backward” and “dareful” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Malcolm's command. The evidence is “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy is fulfilled.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Act V, Scene V, paragraph 16 shapes its tone: “Let me endure your wrath, if’t be not so: Within this three mile may you see it coming; I say, a moving grove.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “endure” and “moving” (Act V, Scene V, paragraph 16) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to appearance versus reality: meaninglessness. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act V, Scene V, paragraph 17? “If thou speak’st false, Upon the next tree shalt thou hang alive, Till _____ cling thee: if thy speech be sooth, I care not if thou dost for me as much.”

    A. methought

    B. colours

    C. famine

    D. quickly

    Key: C (famine)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene VI”? A brief scene that speeds the action.

    A. Structure

    B. Symbolism

    C. Theme

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: A (Structure)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Battle. The evidence is “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy is fulfilled. The words “trumpets” and “speak” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Malcolm orders "your leavy screens throw down" and the trumpets become "harbingers of blood and death.".

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Battle. The evidence is “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy is fulfilled.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Freshman	8, 7, 2, 1, 4, 3, 9, 6, 5, 10, 13, 17, 14, 18, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	19, 1, 2, 6, 4, 3, 5, 7, 20, 10, 21, 22, 13, 14, 16, 15	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	19, 3, 2, 5, 1, 7, 9, 20, 10, 11, 21, 22, 14, 13, 16, 15	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Senior	19, 23, 1, 8, 7, 3, 9, 5, 20, 10, 22, 13, 12, 14, 16, 15	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 2
AP	8, 1, 6, 2, 4, 7, 20, 10, 22, 24, 14, 12, 13, 25, 16, 15	recall 6, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 3
College Freshman	19, 5, 8, 4, 6, 1, 20, 11, 10, 22, 12, 13, 14, 16, 15, 25	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	1, 2, 7, 6, 3, 4, 9, 20, 10, 11, 22, 13, 14, 15, 16, 18	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Junior	19, 23, 9, 1, 7, 2, 20, 10, 26, 11, 22, 13, 14, 16, 15, 18	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Senior	23, 19, 6, 8, 1, 9, 2, 20, 10, 11, 21, 22, 13, 14, 16, 15	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
Graduate / PhD	23, 19, 5, 1, 8, 6, 20, 11, 26, 10, 22, 13, 14, 15, 16, 18	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene VI,” how does Shakespeare show the army reveals itself? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene VI, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the army reveals itself? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene VI develops the idea of the army reveals itself. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the army reveals itself. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene VI suggests about the army reveals itself. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act V, Scene VI to complicate the reader's understanding of the army reveals itself. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the army reveals itself responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the army reveals itself follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene VI and its treatment of the army reveals itself. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene VI as evidence for a larger claim about the army reveals itself in Macbeth. Connect close reading of

the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene VI as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the army reveals itself. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are. You, worthy uncle, Shall, with my cousin, your right-noble son, Lead our first battle: worthy Macduff and we Shall take upon's what else remains to do, According to our order.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene VI"?

   A. The apparitions and false security

   B. The murder of the innocent

   C. The murder and its first guilt

   D. The army reveals itself

SAT key: 1. D (The army reveals itself)

Lesson 29: Act V, Scene VII

Focus: the last false confidence

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Act V, Scene VII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (violence, death in combat): Young Siward is killed by Macbeth on stage.
Student preview: A young soldier is killed in this scene.
Suggested language: “What does this language show about the speaker?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Macbeth, 'tied to a stake' like a baited bear, still fears no man born of woman. He kills Young Siward in single combat and scorns swords 'brandish'd by man that's of a woman born.' Macduff enters seeking only Macbeth, refusing to strike at hired kerns. Siward tells Malcolm the castle is 'gently render'd' and that some of the tyrant's men fight on their side.

Background: Bear-baiting (a bear chained to a stake and attacked by dogs) was a popular entertainment near the Globe; Macbeth's image makes him both fierce and trapped.

Significance: Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because.... Content note before we start: A young soldier is killed in this scene.
Prompt: Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: false security.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: professes — declares; clatter — a loud rattling noise; hateful — deserving hatred; bruited — announced loudly; proclaimed; sheathe — to put (a sword) back in its case. “clatter”: Origin: Middle English clatren.
Words: professes: declares · clatter: a loud rattling noise · hateful: deserving hatred · bruited: announced loudly; proclaimed · sheathe: to put (a sword) back in its case

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Bear-baiting (a bear chained to a stake and attacked by dogs) was a popular entertainment near the Globe; Macbeth's image makes him both fierce and trapped. Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand. Characterization: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable. Irony: His confidence in the prophecy. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "not born of woman? Such a one / Am I to fear, or none" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Thou wast born of woman" slowly and put it in my own words: After killing Young Siward in single combat, Macbeth says the boy was born of woman. Next, craft. I notice he speaks as if the prophecy makes him invulnerable, mocking the dead young man. The strongest word is "woman": it recalls the witches' promise that no man born of a woman could harm him. Then, effect. Why is Macbeth so confident after killing Young Siward? My answer: Macbeth believes the prophecy protects him; his confidence is about to collapse when he meets Macduff, which shows how the witches' riddles have trapped him.

> *Thou wast born of woman* *(Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Thou wast born of woman" slowly and put it in my own words: After killing Young Siward in single combat, Macbeth says the boy was born of woman. Next, craft. I notice he speaks as if the prophecy makes him invulnerable, mocking the dead young man. The strongest word is "woman": it recalls the witches' promise that no man born of a woman could harm him. Then, effect. Why is Macbeth so confident after killing Young Siward? My answer: Macbeth believes the prophecy protects him; his confidence is about to collapse when he meets Macduff, which shows how the witches' riddles have trapped him.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The bear image: trapped, fighting. Fate and free will. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: False security. (Bear-baiting image.)

> *They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course* *(Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The bear image: trapped, fighting. Fate and free will.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: False security. (Bear-baiting image.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the last false confidence? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VII develops the idea of the last false confidence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. When the text says “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth), it shows this directly. He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the last false confidence? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VII develops the idea of the last false confidence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. When the text says “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth), it shows this directly. He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman."

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief? Ask: is Macbeth brave or deluded?
Anchor question: Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief?
Facilitation: Ask: is Macbeth brave or deluded?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the last false confidence? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. (“Thou wast born of woman”, Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the last false confidence? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. (“Thou wast born of woman”, Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the last false confidence. Key takeaway: false security.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable.
- **Irony:** His confidence in the prophecy.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** false security.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “not born of woman? Such a one / Am I to fear, or none” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth).
- **equivocation:** "Fair is foul": appearances and words that mean two things, from the witches to the Porter to the prophecies. In this scene: “shouldst be; / By this great clatter, one of greatest note / Seems bruited. Let me find him, fortune! / And more I beg not” (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) Bear-baiting image.
- “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) Macbeth's confidence.
- “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff) Macduff seeks him.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped.
Evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth)
Reasoning: He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
professes (verb)	declares	*This way, my lord; the castle's gently render'd: The tyrant's people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do bravely in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do.*	
clatter (noun)	a loud rattling noise	*There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited.*	“clatter”: Origin: Middle English clatren. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/clatter#Etymology)
	deserving hatred		

hateful (adjective)		*The devil himself could not pronounce a title More hateful to mine ear.*	
bruited (verb)	announced loudly; proclaimed	*There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited.*	
sheathe (verb)	to put (a sword) back in its case	*I cannot strike at wretched kerns, whose arms Are hired to bear their staves: either thou, Macbeth, Or else my sword with an unbatter'd edge I sheathe again undeeded.*	
bravely (adverb)	courageously	*This way, my lord; the castle's gently render'd: The tyrant's people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do bravely in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do.*	

Discussion questions

1. Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Macduff say he cannot strike at? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Wretched kerns, whose arms are hired to bear their staves.
2. What animal does Macbeth compare himself to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A bear tied to a stake
3. Whom does Macbeth kill in this scene? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Young Siward
4. Why does Macbeth not fear Young Siward? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He was born of woman
5. Whom does Macduff want to fight? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Only Macbeth
6. What has happened to the castle? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It has been gently surrendered
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene VII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Macbeth, 'tied to a stake' like a baited bear, still fears no

man born of woman. He kills Young Siward in single combat and scorns swords 'brandish'd by man that's of a woman born.' Macduff enters seeking only Macbeth, refusing to strike at hired kerns. Siward tells Malcolm the castle is 'gently render'd' and that some of the tyrant's men fight on their side.

8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene VII”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act V, Scene VII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “This way, my lord; the castle’s gently render’d: The tyrant’s people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do bravely in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do.” What does “professes” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: professes: declares.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macduff refuse to fight anyone but Macbeth? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: His quarrel is personal and just; he seeks justice, not slaughter.
2. What does “Act V, Scene VII” suggest about the last false confidence? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the last false confidence? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth): Bear-baiting image. On characterization: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “That way the noise is.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene VII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Macbeth, 'tied to a stake' like a baited bear, still fears no man born of woman. He kills Young Siward in single combat and scorns swords 'brandish'd by man that's of a woman born.' Macduff enters seeking only Macbeth, refusing to strike at hired kerns. Siward tells Malcolm the castle is 'gently…
7. How does “Act V, Scene VII” build on “Act V, Scene VI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth): Macbeth's

confidence. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff): Macduff seeks him. On characterization: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth): Bear-baiting image. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does Macbeth's fighting spirit at the end restore any of the admiration we felt for him in Act I? Explain. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment about the tragic hero.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth): Macbeth's confidence. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff): Macduff seeks him. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth): Bear-baiting image. On characterization: Macbeth kills Young Siward

and believes himself invulnerable. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene VII”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the last false confidence. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth): Macbeth's confidence. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene VII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff): Macduff seeks him. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth): Bear-baiting image. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth): Macbeth's confidence. On irony: His confidence in the prophecy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene VII” treats the last false confidence with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff): Macduff seeks him. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene VIII” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the

course" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth): Bear-baiting image. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the last false confidence? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: "Thou wast born of woman" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth): Macbeth's confidence. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What animal does Macbeth compare himself to?
    A. A lion
    B. A bear tied to a stake
    C. A hawk
    D. A wolf

    Key: B (A bear tied to a stake)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "This way, my lord; the castle's gently render'd: The tyrant's people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do _____ in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do." Word bank: hateful, professes, clatter, bravely
    Key: bravely

3. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff say he cannot strike at?
    Sample answer: Wretched kerns, whose arms are hired to bear their staves.

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has happened to the castle?
    A. It has been abandoned to the Witches
    B. It still holds out
    C. It is burning
    D. It has been gently surrendered

    Key: D (It has been gently surrendered)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I cannot strike at wretched kerns, whose arms Are hired to bear their staves: either thou, Macbeth, Or else my sword with an unbatter'd edge I _____ again undeeded." Word bank: professes, sheathe, hateful, clatter
    Key: sheathe

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “The devil himself could not pronounce a title More hateful to mine ear.”, what does “hateful” most nearly mean?

   A. deserving hatred

   B. bravery and skill in battle

   C. paid out (money)

   D. a large outdoor fire

   Key: A (deserving hatred)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Macbeth kill in this scene?

   A. Lennox

   B. Macduff

   C. Young Siward

   D. Malcolm

   Key: C (Young Siward)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited.”, what does “bruited” most nearly mean?

   A. people who stay awake

   B. announced loudly; proclaimed

   C. to decide; to settle

   D. urging or tempting someone to act

   Key: B (announced loudly; proclaimed)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Macbeth not fear Young Siward?

   A. He is too young

   B. He has no armor

   C. He is alone

   D. He was born of woman

   Key: D (He was born of woman)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth: “They have tied me to a stake; I _____ fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course”

    Key: cannot

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Macduff want to fight?

    A. Anyone he meets

    B. Only Macbeth

    C. Seyton

    D. The hired soldiers

    Key: B (Only Macbeth)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Macduff refuse to fight anyone but Macbeth?

    Sample answer: His quarrel is personal and just; he seeks justice, not slaughter. The evidence is “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) — Bear-baiting image.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Macbeth's confidence. The evidence is “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: false security.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? False security.

    A. Guilt and conscience

    B. Ambition and its costs

    C. Fate and free will

    D. Appearance versus reality

    Key: C (Fate and free will)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Macduff seeks him. The evidence is “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, Macduff). This develops fate and free will: false security. The words “show” and “face” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how fate and free will develops from Act V, Scene VI to Act V, Scene VII. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm, the text reads “your leavy screens throw down” — Malcolm's command. In Act V, Scene VII, “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) — Bear-baiting image. False security.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited.”, what does “clatter” most nearly mean?

    A. an opportunity or advantage

    B. to make up; to form

    C. suspicion

    D. a loud rattling noise

    Key: D (a loud rattling noise)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene VII”?

    A. The last false confidence

    B. The murder and its first guilt

    C. The tyrant's end and a new order

    D. Defiance and despair

    Key: A (The last false confidence)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth).

    Sample answer: He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman.". The evidence is “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) — Macbeth's confidence. This develops fate and free will: false security.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Does Macbeth's fighting spirit at the end restore any of the admiration we felt for him in Act I? Explain.

    Sample answer: A judgment about the tragic hero. The evidence is “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-

like, I must fight the course" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) — Bear-baiting image. This develops fate and free will: false security. He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman.".

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene V, paragraph 14: "As I did stand my watch upon the hill, I look'd toward Birnam, and anon, _____, The wood began to move."
    Word bank: quickly, methought, famine, colours
    Key: methought

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act V, Scene V?
    A. "Let me endure your wrath, if't be not so: Within this three mile may you see it coming; I say, a moving grove."
    B. "Thou comest to use thy tongue; thy story quickly."
    C. "As I did stand my watch upon the hill, I look'd toward Birnam, and anon, methought, The wood began to move."
    D. "Gracious my lord, I should report that which I say I saw, But know not how to do it."
    Key: B ("Thou comest to use thy tongue; thy story quickly.")

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act V, Scene VII?
    A. "Such a one Am I to fear, or none."
    B. "What's he That was not born of woman?"
    C. "No; though thou call'st thyself a hotter name Than any is in hell."
    D. "Thou liest, abhorred tyrant; with my sword I'll prove the lie thou speak'st."
    Key: B ("What's he That was not born of woman?")

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in "Act V, Scene VII"? His confidence in the prophecy.
    A. Allusion
    B. Irony
    C. Metaphor
    D. Alliteration
    Key: B (Irony)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act V, Scene V, paragraph 12 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: "Gracious my lord, I should report that which I say I saw, But know not how to do it." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Act V, Scene V, paragraph 12) develops guilt and conscience: meaninglessness. Its words "report" and "should" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Let me endure your wrath, if't be not so: Within this three mile may you see it coming; I say, a moving grove." (Act V, Scene V, paragraph 16), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Act V, Scene VII, paragraph 17 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: "We have met with foes That strike beside us." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Act V, Scene VII, paragraph 17) develops guilt and conscience: false security. Its words "strike" and "beside" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Such a one Am I to fear, or none." (Act V, Scene VII, paragraph 3), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

27. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Bear-baiting image. The evidence is “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: false security.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) supports it: He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman.". But “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) complicates it: the line (Bear-baiting image) shows the same issue from another side, and its “cannot” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. Weighing the two passages, the claim survives, but only once it admits the tension the second passage creates.

29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene VII”? Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable.

    A. Characterization

    B. Simile

    C. Alliteration

    D. Allusion

    Key: A (Characterization)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 2, 10, 3, 11, 17, 5, 9, 7, 1, 12, 18, 14, 15, 19, 20	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	21, 2, 6, 11, 1, 10, 7, 4, 22, 12, 23, 15, 14, 24, 25, 26	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	21, 1, 9, 11, 17, 5, 4, 22, 23, 13, 27, 12, 14, 15, 28, 26	recall 7, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 5, 1, 7, 11, 10, 22, 13, 18, 23, 12, 15, 14, 16, 28, 20	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 3
AP	5, 11, 4, 2, 22, 18, 23, 12, 13, 14, 15, 25, 16, 20, 28, 26	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 5
College Freshman	21, 10, 17, 9, 22, 23, 12, 24, 19, 14, 15, 25, 28, 20, 26, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	21, 5, 7, 1, 22, 23, 12, 13, 15, 29, 14, 25, 26, 16, 20, 28	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Junior	11, 2, 5, 4, 22, 12, 13, 23, 15, 14, 24, 25, 26, 28, 16, 20	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Senior	21, 5, 17, 9, 22, 23, 12, 15, 19, 14, 24, 25, 20, 16, 28, 26	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	5, 2, 4, 22, 27, 23, 12, 13, 14, 24, 15, 25, 16, 26, 20, 28	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene VII,” how does Shakespeare show the last false confidence? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene VII, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the last false confidence? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene VII develops the idea of the last false confidence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene VII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the last false confidence. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene VII suggests about the last false confidence. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act V, Scene VII to complicate the reader's understanding of the last false confidence. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene VII within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the last false confidence responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene VII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the last false confidence follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene VII and its treatment of the last false confidence. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene VII as evidence for a larger claim about the last false confidence in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene VII as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the last false confidence. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *The devil himself could not pronounce a title More hateful to mine ear.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "hateful" most nearly mean?

   A. courageously

   B. announced loudly; proclaimed

   C. to put (a sword) back in its case

   D. deserving hatred

2. *That way the noise is. Tyrant, show thy face! If thou be'st slain and with no stroke of mine, My wife and children's ghosts will haunt me still. I cannot strike at wretched kerns, whose arms Are hired to bear their staves: either thou, Macbeth, Or else my sword with an unbatter'd edge I sheathe again undeeded. There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited. Let me find him, fortune! And more I beg not. Exit. Alarums.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene VII"?

   A. The discovery of the murder

   B. The murder of the innocent

   C. The last false confidence

   D. The moving wood

SAT key: 1. D (deserving hatred); 2. C (The last false confidence)

Lesson 30: Act V, Scene VIII

Focus: the tyrant's end and a new order

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Act V, Scene VIII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide (reported), severed head, combat death): Macbeth refuses to 'play the Roman fool' (suicide); Malcolm reports that Lady Macbeth is thought to have taken her own life; Macduff enters with Macbeth's head. Use the safe-messaging script; discuss the verdict on the Macbeths, not the methods.
Student preview: The ending includes deaths, a reported suicide and a severed head. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “Is Malcolm's description of the Macbeths fair? What does it leave out?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Macbeth refuses to 'play the Roman fool' and die on his own sword. Macduff finds him; Macbeth says he bears a charmed life, but Macduff reveals he was 'from his mother's womb untimely ripp'd.' Macbeth curses the 'juggling fiends' and refuses to yield; they fight. Siward learns his son died with his wounds on the front and accepts it. Macduff enters with Macbeth's head and hails Malcolm as king. Malcolm makes the thanes earls, speaks of 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen,' who is thought to have taken her own life 'by self and violent hands,' and invites all to see him crowned at Scone.

Background: Caesarean birth was rare and almost always fatal to the mother; Macduff's birth makes him 'not of woman born' in the narrow sense Macbeth never considered.

Significance: The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because.... Content note before we start: The ending includes deaths, a reported suicide and a severed head. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the equivocal prophecy completed.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: cheaply — at small cost; monsters — freaks shown for money; compass — to surround; juggling — cheating; tricking; usurper — one who seizes a throne without right. "compass": Origin: Old French compas. "usurper": Origin: Middle French usurpeur.
Words: cheaply: at small cost · monsters: freaks shown for money · compass: to surround · juggling: cheating; tricking · usurper: one who seizes a throne without right

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Caesarean birth was rare and almost always fatal to the mother; Macduff's birth makes him 'not of woman born' in the narrow sense Macbeth never considered. The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience. Characterization: Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king. Structure: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Watch for the prophecies: The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: "a charmed life, which must not yield / To one of woman born" (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Macduff was from his mother's womb / Untimely ripp'd" slowly and put it in my own words: Macduff tells Macbeth that he was untimely ripped from his mother's womb, not born in the usual way. Next, craft. I notice the dramatic revelation, which turns the prophecy's wording against Macbeth. The strongest word is "Untimely": it means too early and by force, a surgical birth. Then, effect. What does Macduff reveal, and what does it do to Macbeth? My answer: The witches' equivocation is exposed; Macbeth's last confidence is broken, though he still chooses to fight, and Macduff kills him and restores order.

> *Macduff was from his mother's womb / Untimely ripp'd* (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Macduff was from his mother's womb / Untimely ripp'd" slowly and put it in my own words: Macduff tells Macbeth that he was untimely ripped from his mother's womb, not born in the usual way. Next, craft. I notice the dramatic revelation, which turns the prophecy's wording against Macbeth. The strongest word is "Untimely": it means too early and by force, a surgical birth. Then, effect. What does Macduff reveal, and what does it do to Macbeth? My answer: The witches' equivocation is exposed; Macbeth's last confidence is broken, though he still chooses to fight, and Macduff kills him and restores order.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Macbeth's last defiance. Look at the craft: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected: The equivocal prophecy completed. (Macbeth's last defiance.)

> *Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, "Hold, enough* (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Macbeth's last defiance. Look at the craft: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected answer: The equivocal prophecy completed. (Macbeth's last defiance.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VIII develops the idea of the tyrant's end and a new order. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. When the text says "Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, "Hold, enough" (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth), it shows this directly. Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VIII develops the idea of the tyrant's end and a new order. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. When the text says "Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, "Hold, enough" (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth), it shows this directly. Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out? Ask: is "dead butcher" a fair verdict?
Anchor question: Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out?
Facilitation: Ask: is "dead butcher" a fair verdict?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. ("Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, "Hold, enough", Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. ("Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, "Hold, enough", Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the tyrant's end and a new order. Key takeaway: the equivocal prophecy completed.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king.
- **Structure:** Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the equivocal prophecy completed.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The witches' riddling prophecies (Birnam Wood, no man of woman born) feed Macbeth's false confidence and then destroy it. In this scene: “a charmed life, which must not yield / To one of woman born” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth).
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship (Duncan, Edward, Malcolm) is tied to natural order; tyranny to disorder. In this scene: “Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands / The usurper’s cursed head” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff) Caesarean birth.
- “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth) Macbeth's last defiance.
- “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm) Malcolm's verdict.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth.
> **Evidence:** “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth)
> **Reasoning:** Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
	at small cost		

cheaply (adverb)		*Some must go off: and yet, by these I see, So great a day as this is cheaply bought.*	
monsters (noun)	freaks shown for money	*Then yield thee, coward, And live to be the show and gaze o' the time: We'll have thee, as our rarer monsters are, Painted on a pole, and underwrit, "Here may you see the tyrant."*	
compass (verb)	to surround	*Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The usurper's cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my salutation in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!*	"compass": Origin: Old French compas. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/compass#Etymology)
juggling (adjective)	cheating; tricking	*And be these juggling fiends no more believed, That palter with us in a double sense; That keep the word of promise to our ear, And break it to our hope.*	
usurper (noun)	one who seizes a throne without right	*Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The usurper's cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my salutation in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!*	"usurper": Origin: Middle French usurpeur. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/usurper#Etymology)
salutation (noun)	a greeting	*Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The usurper's cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my salutation in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!*	"salutation": Origin: Old French salutacion; earlier Latin salutatio ("a greeting"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/salutation#Etymology)
prowess (noun)	bravery and skill in battle	*Your son, my lord, has paid a soldier's debt: He only lived but till he was a man; The which no sooner had his prowess confirm'd In the unshrinking station where he fought, But like a man he died.*	
charmed (adjective)	protected by magic	*Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a charmed life, which must not yield To one of woman born.*	"charmed": Origin of "charm": Old French charme ("chant"); earlier Latin carmen ("song"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/charm#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out?

2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does Siward react when told his son's wounds were on the front? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He accepts it: his son died as a soldier should; he would not wish him a fairer death.
2. Why will Macbeth not kill himself? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He will not play the Roman fool
3. What does Macduff reveal about his birth? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He was untimely ripped from his mother's womb
4. What does Macduff bring on stage? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Macbeth's head
5. What new title does Malcolm give the thanes? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Earls
6. Where will Malcolm be crowned? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At Scone
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act V, Scene VIII” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Macbeth refuses to 'play the Roman fool' and die on his own sword. Macduff finds him; Macbeth says he bears a charmed life, but Macduff reveals he was 'from his mother's womb untimely ripp'd.' Macbeth curses the 'juggling fiends' and refuses to yield; they fight. Siward learns his son died with his wounds on the front and accepts it. Macduff enters with Macbeth's head and hails Malcolm as king.…
8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene VIII”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act V, Scene VIII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Some must go off: and yet, by these I see, So great a day as this is cheaply bought.” What does “cheaply” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: cheaply: at small cost.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Macbeth finally understand when he calls the Witches 'juggling fiends… that palter with us in a double sense'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: The prophecies deceived through double meanings.
2. What does “Act V, Scene VIII” suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the structure in this scene shape what we understand about the tyrant's end and a new order? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff): Caesarean birth. On structure: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a charmed life, which must…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene VIII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Macbeth refuses to 'play the Roman fool' and die on his own sword. Macduff finds him; Macbeth says he bears a charmed life, but Macduff reveals he was 'from his mother's womb untimely ripp'd.' Macbeth curses the 'juggling fiends' and refuses to yield; they fight. Siward learns his son died with his…
7. How does “Act V, Scene VIII” build on “Act V, Scene VII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth): Macbeth's last defiance. On structure: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm):

Malcolm's verdict. On characterization: Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with appearance versus reality? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff): Caesarean birth. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Malcolm's final speech an ending we should trust? Consider what he leaves out about Macbeth and Lady Macbeth. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment on the ending's perspective.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth): Macbeth's last defiance. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm): Malcolm's verdict. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff): Caesarean birth. On characterization: Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene VIII”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the tyrant's end and a new order. [DOK 4 ·

thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth): Macbeth's last defiance. On structure: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene VIII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm): Malcolm's verdict. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff): Caesarean birth. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth): Macbeth's last defiance. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene VIII” treats the tyrant's end and a new order with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm): Malcolm's verdict. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve appearance versus reality? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff): Caesarean birth. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the tyrant's end and a new order? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth): Macbeth's last defiance. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where will Malcolm be crowned?
    A. At Forres
    B. At Scone
    C. At Dunsinane
    D. In London

    Key: B (At Scone)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “And be these juggling fiends no more believed, That palter with us in a double sense; That keep the word of promise to our ear, And break it to our hope.”, what does “juggling” most nearly mean?
    A. brass instruments sounded in battle
    B. to make up; to form
    C. cheating; tricking
    D. the state of being dressed and armed

    Key: C (cheating; tricking)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What new title does Malcolm give the thanes?
    A. Knights
    B. Earls
    C. Princes
    D. Dukes

    Key: B (Earls)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Your son, my lord, has paid a soldier’s debt: He only lived but till he was a man; The which no sooner had his _____ confirm’d In the unshrinking station where he fought, But like a man he died.” Word bank: monsters, compass, prowess, cheaply
    Key: prowess

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why will Macbeth not kill himself?
   A. He hopes to escape
   B. He will not play the Roman fool
   C. The Witches forbade it
   D. He wants to see Malcolm crowned

   Key: B (He will not play the Roman fool)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff bring on stage?
   A. Lady Macbeth's letter
   B. Macbeth's head
   C. Macbeth's sword
   D. Macbeth's crown

   Key: B (Macbeth's head)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Some must go off: and yet, by these I see, So great a day as this is cheaply bought.", what does "cheaply" most nearly mean?
   A. dangerous
   B. worries
   C. the notched wall along the top of a castle
   D. at small cost

   Key: D (at small cost)
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff reveal about his birth?
   A. He was born in England
   B. He is Banquo's son
   C. He was born in battle
   D. He was untimely ripped from his mother's womb

   Key: D (He was untimely ripped from his mother's womb)
9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff: "Macduff was from his _____'s womb / Untimely ripp'd"

   Key: mother
10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The usurper's cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my _____ in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!" Word bank: monsters, salutation, cheaply, compass

    Key: salutation
11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Then yield thee, coward, And live to be the show and gaze o' the time: We'll have thee, as our rarer monsters are, Painted on a pole, and underwrit, 'Here may you see the tyrant.'", what does "monsters" most nearly mean?
    A. gives orders to
    B. short knives used as weapons
    C. freaks shown for money
    D. a title of respect used to address a king

Key: C (freaks shown for money)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, ‘Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Macbeth's last defiance. The evidence is “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, ‘Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: the equivocal prophecy completed.
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Macbeth finally understand when he calls the Witches 'juggling fiends… that palter with us in a double sense'?
    Sample answer: The prophecies deceived through double meanings. The evidence is “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, ‘Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth) — Macbeth's last defiance.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Malcolm's verdict. The evidence is “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm). This develops fate and free will: the equivocal prophecy completed. The words “butcher” and “fiend” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene VIII”? Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed.
    A. Personification
    B. Simile
    C. Structure
    D. Setting

    Key: C (Structure)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how fate and free will develops from Act V, Scene VII to Act V, Scene VIII. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth, the text reads “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” — Bear-baiting image. In Act V, Scene VIII, “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff) — Caesarean birth. The equivocal prophecy completed.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, ‘Hold, _____”
    Key: enough
18. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Siward react when told his son's wounds were on the front?
    Sample answer: He accepts it: his son died as a soldier should; he would not wish him a fairer death.
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm: “this dead _____ and his fiend-like queen”
    Key: butcher
20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a _____ life, which must not yield To one of woman born.” Word bank: compass, monsters, cheaply, charmed
    Key: charmed

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene VIII"?

    A. Nature's revolt against the crime

    B. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

    C. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

    D. The tyrant's end and a new order

    Key: D (The tyrant's end and a new order)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Macduff was from his mother's womb / Untimely ripp'd" (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Caesarean birth. The evidence is "Macduff was from his mother's womb / Untimely ripp'd" (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff). This develops fate and free will: the equivocal prophecy completed.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The equivocal prophecy completed.

    A. Ambition and its costs

    B. Appearance versus reality

    C. Fate and free will

    D. Guilt and conscience

    Key: C (Fate and free will)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Malcolm's final speech an ending we should trust? Consider what he leaves out about Macbeth and Lady Macbeth.

    Sample answer: A judgment on the ending's perspective. The evidence is "Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, 'Hold, enough" (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth) — Macbeth's last defiance. This develops fate and free will: the equivocal prophecy completed. Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The _____'s cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my salutation in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!" Word bank: monsters, cheaply, usurper, compass

    Key: usurper

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene VIII, paragraph 24: "He's worth no more: They say he _____ well, and paid his score: And so, God be with him!" Word bank: warlike, parted, should, ground

    Key: parted

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene VIII, paragraph 3: "Why _____ I play the Roman fool, and die On mine own sword? whiles I see lives, the gashes Do better upon them." Word bank: friends, should, ground, warlike

    Key: should

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Act V, Scene VIII?

    A. "Enter, with drum and colours, Malcolm, old Siward, Ross, the other Thanes, and Soldiers."

    B. "I will not yield, To kiss the ground before young Malcolm's feet, And to be baited with the rabble's curse."

C. “Though Birnam wood be come to Dunsinane, And thou opposed, being of no woman born, Yet I will try the last.”

D. “Before my body I throw my warlike shield.”

Key: B (“I will not yield, To kiss the ground before young Malcolm’s feet, And to be baited with the rabble’s curse.”)

29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does this passage from Act V, Scene VIII, paragraph 23 reveal about the character or situation? “He’s worth more sorrow, And that I’ll spend for him.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Act V, Scene VIII, paragraph 23) shows the situation turning on ambition and its costs: the equivocal prophecy completed. The words “sorrow” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

30. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene VIII”? Macduff reveals he was ‘untimely ripped’; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king.

A. Characterization

B. Tone / mood

C. Hyperbole

D. Theme

Key: A (Characterization)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Caesarean birth. The evidence is “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff). This develops fate and free will: the equivocal prophecy completed. The words “mother” and “from” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Act V, Scene VIII, paragraph 12? “Before my body I throw my _____ shield.”

A. warlike

B. kinsmen

C. bloodier

D. ground

Key: A (warlike)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Act V, Scene VIII, paragraph 12 to the story's treatment of guilt and conscience: “Though Birnam wood be come to Dunsinane, And thou opposed, being of no woman born, Yet I will try the last.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Act V, Scene VIII, paragraph 12) develops guilt and conscience: the equivocal prophecy completed. Its words “opposed” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Enter, with drum and colours, Malcolm, old Siward, Ross, the other Thanes, and Soldiers.” (Act V, Scene VIII, paragraph 13), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating guilt and conscience as central.

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, ‘Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth).

Sample answer: Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage. The evidence is

"Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, 'Hold, enough'" (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth) — Macbeth's last defiance. This develops fate and free will: the equivocal prophecy completed.

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] In the line "Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The usurper's cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my salutation in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with…", what does "compass" most nearly mean?

    A. freaks shown for money

    B. cheating; tricking

    C. at small cost

    D. to surround

    Key: D (to surround)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 7, 18, 5, 4, 19, 1, 20, 9, 6, 21, 22, 13, 23, 14, 24	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	19, 5, 1, 25, 4, 11, 7, 20, 22, 12, 13, 14, 15, 23, 24, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	5, 26, 9, 11, 17, 25, 7, 27, 28, 29, 13, 14, 23, 30, 31, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Senior	26, 3, 32, 4, 5, 27, 9, 13, 28, 29, 15, 14, 23, 24, 33, 16	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 3
AP	6, 26, 20, 11, 25, 12, 29, 21, 13, 28, 14, 23, 24, 31, 33, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 4
College Freshman	4, 5, 11, 27, 1, 28, 29, 13, 34, 30, 23, 14, 16, 24, 31, 33	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	17, 25, 27, 32, 2, 1, 13, 29, 28, 14, 15, 23, 24, 31, 33, 16	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Junior	8, 19, 20, 9, 26, 29, 28, 13, 12, 23, 14, 15, 16, 33, 24, 31	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Senior	25, 2, 9, 1, 18, 29, 13, 21, 28, 34, 23, 14, 31, 16, 24, 33	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	4, 20, 35, 8, 11, 22, 21, 28, 12, 29, 13, 23, 14, 24, 16, 33	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 2, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene VIII," how does Shakespeare show the tyrant's end and a new order? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene VIII, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the tyrant's end and a new order? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene VIII develops the idea of the tyrant's end and a new order. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of

textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene VIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the tyrant's end and a new order. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene VIII suggests about the tyrant's end and a new order. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and structure), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act V, Scene VIII to complicate the reader's understanding of the tyrant's end and a new order. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene VIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the tyrant's end and a new order responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene VIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the tyrant's end and a new order follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene VIII and its treatment of the tyrant's end and a new order. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and structure, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene VIII as evidence for a larger claim about the tyrant's end and a new order in Macbeth. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene VIII as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the tyrant's end and a new order. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Macbeth.

SAT-style questions

1. *Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The usurper's cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my salutation in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!*

   As used in the text, what does the word "compass" most nearly mean?

   A. protected by magic

   B. a greeting

   C. bravery and skill in battle

   D. to surround

2. *Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a charmed life, which must not yield To one of woman born.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene VIII"?

   A. The tyrant's end and a new order

   B. The apparitions and false security

   C. Lady Macbeth's resolve

   D. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

SAT key: 1. D (to surround); 2. A (The tyrant's end and a new order)

Unit test

Macbeth: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What signal tells Macbeth to act?

   A. A knock at the gate

   B. A bell

   C. An owl's scream

   D. A trumpet

   Key: B (A bell)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene I, Macbeth: “I go, and it is done; the bell _____ me”

   Key: invites

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Under what condition will Banquo support Macbeth?

   A. If he is made Thane of Cawdor

   B. If Malcolm agrees

   C. If Fleance becomes king now

   D. If he loses no honor and keeps his allegiance clear

   Key: D (If he loses no honor and keeps his allegiance clear)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene I, Macbeth: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-_____ brain”

   Key: oppressed

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “So I lose none In seeking to _____ it, but still keep My bosom franchised and allegiance clear, I shall be counsell'd.” Word bank: augment, dudgeon, husbandry, allegiance

   Key: augment

6. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who carries the daggers back to Duncan's chamber?

   Sample answer: Lady Macbeth.

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Get on your nightgown, lest occasion call us, And show us to be watchers.”, what does “nightgown” most nearly mean?

   A. the parts that are mixed together to make something

B. spirits; ghosts

C. offenders

D. a dressing gown worn over night clothes

Key: D (a dressing gown worn over night clothes)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Had he not resembled My father as he slept, I had done't.", what does "resembled" most nearly mean?

   A. looked like

   B. reward or repayment

   C. a planner; one who devises

   D. checked; held back

   Key: A (looked like)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What word could Macbeth not say?

   A. Amen

   B. Goodbye

   C. Murder

   D. King

   Key: A (Amen)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why did Lady Macbeth not kill Duncan herself?

    A. She heard a noise

    B. She was afraid of the guards

    C. Macbeth forbade it

    D. He looked like her father as he slept

    Key: D (He looked like her father as he slept)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "No _____ like a fool; This deed I'll do before this purpose cool." Word bank: scepters, vanquish, boasting, pricking

    Key: boasting

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Until what happens will Macbeth never be vanquished?

    A. Banquo returns

    B. Malcolm returns

    C. Birnam Wood comes to Dunsinane

    D. The sun sets at noon

    Key: C (Birnam Wood comes to Dunsinane)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth decide after hearing Macduff has fled?

    A. To pardon Macduff

    B. To give up the crown

    C. To follow him to England

    D. To kill Macduff's wife and children

    Key: D (To kill Macduff's wife and children)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene I, All: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and _____ bubble”

    Key: cauldron

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene II, Son: “Then the liars and _____ are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them”

    Key: swearers

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who visits her and then leaves?

    A. Banquo's ghost

    B. Malcolm

    C. Ross

    D. Lennox

    Key: C (Ross)

17. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the son say about liars and swearers?

    Sample answer: They are fools: there are enough of them to beat the honest men and hang them up.

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “But I remember now I am in this earthly world; where to do harm Is often laudable, to do good sometime Accounted dangerous folly: why then, alas, Do I put up that womanly defence, To say I have done no harm?”, what does “laudable” most nearly mean?

    A. forced; acting against their will

    B. praiseworthy

    C. flags carried by an army

    D. bedrooms

    Key: B (praiseworthy)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macduff think of her husband's flight?

    A. It was wise and brave

    B. It was a trick

    C. It was madness, and he loves his family not

    D. It was ordered by the king

    Key: C (It was madness, and he loves his family not)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “To fright you thus, methinks, I am too savage; To do worse to you were fell cruelty, Which is too nigh your person.”, what does “methinks” most nearly mean?

    A. please (from "I pray thee")

    B. an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging

    C. it seems to me

    D. to defeat completely

    Key: C (it seems to me)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “At least we’ll die with harness on our back.”, what does “harness” most nearly mean?

    A. freaks shown for money

    B. bodies or forms

    C. a blessing

D. armor

Key: D (armor)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are.", what does "screens" most nearly mean?

    A. freaks shown for money

    B. lit the way for; guided

    C. coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army)

    D. declares

    Key: C (coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army))

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "This way, my lord; the castle's gently render'd: The tyrant's people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do bravely in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do.", what does "professes" most nearly mean?

    A. to stifle or suffocate

    B. declares

    C. raises sores on (an image of disgust)

    D. against the order of nature

    Key: B (declares)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited.", what does "clatter" most nearly mean?

    A. an opportunity or advantage

    B. to make up; to form

    C. suspicion

    D. a loud rattling noise

    Key: D (a loud rattling noise)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a _____ life, which must not yield To one of woman born." Word bank: compass, monsters, cheaply, charmed

    Key: charmed

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene VIII, Malcolm: "this dead _____ and his fiend-like queen"

    Key: butcher

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth: "Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, 'Hold, _____"

    Key: enough

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The _____'s cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my salutation in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!" Word bank: monsters, cheaply, usurper, compass

    Key: usurper

29. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Siward react when told his son's wounds were on the front?

    Sample answer: He accepts it: his son died as a soldier should; he would not wish him a fairer death.

30. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. The evidence is “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae). This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

31. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Macbeth admits his only motive. The evidence is “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth).

32. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Sleep as innocence destroyed. The evidence is “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.".

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene II”?

    A. The tyrant's end and a new order
    B. The murder of the innocent
    C. The murder and its first guilt
    D. The Witches' riddling world

    Key: C (The murder and its first guilt)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does the verse of this scene differ from the rest of the play, and why does that matter to editors?

    Sample answer: Rhyming tetrameter and songs suggest a later addition, probably by Middleton. The evidence is “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) — Overconfidence.

35. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hecate's complaint. The evidence is “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate). This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.".

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth)

    A. Graphic violence praised as service.
    B. The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious.
    C. He knows it is imaginary.
    D. Macbeth will act without thought.

Key: D (Macbeth will act without thought.)

37. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The equivocal prophecy. The evidence is “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition). This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

38. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: His followers obey from fear. The evidence is “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, Angus). This develops ambition: the stolen title does not fit.

39. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The strategy. The evidence is “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm). This develops fate and free will: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

40. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: His response. The evidence is “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness.

41. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Bear-baiting image. The evidence is “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: false security.

42. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). The evidence is “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae). This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

43. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. The evidence is “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". The words “little” and “clears” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

44. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene I”? Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle.

    A. Simile

    B. Structure

    C. Setting

D. Personification

Key: B (Structure)

45. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son).

Sample answer: The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother.". The evidence is “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son) — The son's wit. This develops masculinity and power: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.".

46. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene VI”? Malcolm's army throws down its branches and attacks.

A. Imagery

B. Simile

C. Symbolism

D. Plot

Key: D (Plot)

47. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The equivocal prophecy completed.

A. Ambition and its costs

B. Appearance versus reality

C. Fate and free will

D. Guilt and conscience

Key: C (Fate and free will)

48. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. The evidence is “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae). This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. The words “general” and “king” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position.

49. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. The evidence is “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff). This develops masculinity and power: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.". The words “natural” and “loves” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother.".

50. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff) shape its meaning? Consider

a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Caesarean birth. The evidence is “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff). This develops fate and free will: the equivocal prophecy completed. The words “mother” and “from” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.

51. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth say will clear them of the deed?

    A. A prayer

    B. A confession

    C. The Witches' charm

    D. A little water

    Key: D (A little water)

52. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What voice does Macbeth say he heard?

    A. Banquo's children shall be kings

    B. Sleep no more! Macbeth does murder sleep

    C. All hail, Macbeth

    D. Beware Macduff

    Key: B (Sleep no more! Macbeth does murder sleep)

53. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I hear a _____ At the south entry: retire we to our chamber: A little water clears us of this deed: How easy is it, then!”

    Word bank: resembled, knocking, nightgown, surfeited

    Key: knocking

54. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “No, this my hand will rather The _____ seas in incarnadine, Making the green one red.” Word bank: nightgown, multitudinous, surfeited, resembled

    Key: multitudinous

55. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, Macbeth: “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does _____ sleep”

    Key: murder

56. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Get on your nightgown, lest occasion call us, And show us to be _____.” Word bank: surfeited, watchers, nightgown, resembled

    Key: watchers

57. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “By the pricking of my thumbs, Something wicked this way comes.”, what does “pricking” most nearly mean?

    A. dangerous

    B. a greeting

    C. a tingling feeling

    D. spirits; ghosts

    Key: C (a tingling feeling)

58. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Second Witch say just before Macbeth enters?

    Sample answer: 'By the pricking of my thumbs, something wicked this way comes.'

59. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the bloody child say?

    A. Macduff is dead

    B. Fleance will be king

    C. Macbeth will die tonight

    D. None of woman born shall harm Macbeth

    Key: D (None of woman born shall harm Macbeth)

60. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Poor bird! thou'ldst never fear the net nor lime, The pitfall nor the gin.", what does "pitfall" most nearly mean?

    A. a trap for catching birds

    B. able to be attacked

    C. birds of the crow family

    D. announced loudly; proclaimed

    Key: A (a trap for catching birds)

61. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I am so much a fool, should I stay longer, It would be my disgrace and your _____: I take my leave at once." Word bank: laudable, discomfort, pitfall, diminutive

    Key: discomfort

62. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who warns her to flee?

    A. Macbeth

    B. Macduff

    C. Malcolm

    D. An unnamed messenger

    Key: D (An unnamed messenger)

63. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited.", what does "bruited" most nearly mean?

    A. people who stay awake

    B. announced loudly; proclaimed

    C. to decide; to settle

    D. urging or tempting someone to act

    Key: B (announced loudly; proclaimed)

64. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has happened to the castle?

    A. It has been abandoned to the Witches

    B. It still holds out

    C. It is burning

    D. It has been gently surrendered

    Key: D (It has been gently surrendered)

65. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What new title does Malcolm give the thanes?

    A. Knights

    B. Earls

C. Princes

D. Dukes

Key: B (Earls)

66. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Then yield thee, coward, And live to be the show and gaze o’ the time: We’ll have thee, as our rarer monsters are, Painted on a pole, and underwrit, ‘Here may you see the tyrant.’”, what does “monsters” most nearly mean?

A. gives orders to

B. short knives used as weapons

C. freaks shown for money

D. a title of respect used to address a king

Key: C (freaks shown for money)

67. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “And be these juggling fiends no more believed, That palter with us in a double sense; That keep the word of promise to our ear, And break it to our hope.”, what does “juggling” most nearly mean?

A. brass instruments sounded in battle

B. to make up; to form

C. cheating; tricking

D. the state of being dressed and armed

Key: C (cheating; tricking)

68. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff reveal about his birth?

A. He was born in England

B. He is Banquo's son

C. He was born in battle

D. He was untimely ripped from his mother's womb

Key: D (He was untimely ripped from his mother's womb)

69. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The usurper’s cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass’d with thy kingdom’s pearl, That speak my _____ in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!” Word bank: monsters, salutation, cheaply, compass

Key: salutation

70. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. The evidence is “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae). This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

71. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae)

A. Macbeth to the ghost.

B. Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).

C. Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters.

D. His followers obey from fear.

Key: B (Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).)

72. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, Lady Macbeth)

A. His followers obey from fear.

B. Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy.

C. Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).

D. Macduff's redefinition of manhood.

Key: B (Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy.)

73. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Lady Macbeth's attack. The evidence is “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she defines manhood as the will to murder.

74. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Overconfidence. The evidence is “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate). This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.".

75. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene VI”?

A. The guilt that will not wash away

B. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

C. The tyrant's end and a new order

D. Suspicion spoken through irony

Key: D (Suspicion spoken through irony)

76. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene II”?

A. The murder of the innocent

B. The guilt that will not wash away

C. The discovery of the murder

D. Life as a tale told by an idiot

Key: A (The murder of the innocent)

77. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Time. The evidence is “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness.

78. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Malcolm's command. The evidence is “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy is fulfilled.

79. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, ‘Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Macbeth's last defiance. The evidence is “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, ‘Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: the equivocal prophecy completed.

80. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Dramatis Personae”? The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, ‘general of the king's army’: they begin as equals,…
A. Alliteration
B. Allusion
C. Characterization
D. Symbolism
Key: C (Characterization)

81. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Her resolve. The evidence is “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she defines manhood as the will to murder. The words “sticking” and “courage” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

82. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth).
Sample answer: He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking. The evidence is “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) — Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.".

83. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. The evidence is “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate). This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.". The words “scorn” and “death” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

84. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition).
Sample answer: Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family. The evidence is “none of woman

born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition) — The equivocal prophecy. This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

85. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Act V, Scene IV"? Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers.

    A. Imagery

    B. Irony

    C. Plot

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: C (Plot)

86. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing" (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth).

    Sample answer: Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing.". The evidence is "it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing" (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) — Meaninglessness. This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness.

87. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Act V, Scene VIII"? Macduff reveals he was 'untimely ripped'; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king.

    A. Characterization

    B. Tone / mood

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Theme

    Key: A (Characterization)

88. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Banquo, general of the king's army" (Dramatis Personae) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. The evidence is "Banquo, general of the king's army" (Dramatis Personae). This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. The words "general" and "king" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position.

89. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Should this scene be staged in full or with the violence offstage? Defend your choice, considering the audience.

    Sample answer: A staging judgment balancing impact and care. The evidence is "Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them" (Act IV, Scene II, Son) — The son's wit. This develops masculinity and power: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.". The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother.".

90. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how fate and free will develops from Act V, Scene VII to Act V, Scene VIII. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth, the text reads "They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course" — Bear-baiting image. In Act V, Scene VIII, "Macduff was from his mother's womb / Untimely ripp'd" (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff) — Caesarean birth. The equivocal prophecy completed.

91. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Macbeth does murder sleep,’ the innocent sleep, Sleep that knits up the ravell’d sleave of care, The death of each day’s life, sore labour’s bath, Balm of hurt minds, great nature’s second course, Chief nourisher in…”, what does “nourisher” most nearly mean?

    A. dangerous

    B. people who held a position earlier

    C. something that feeds and sustains

    D. calls (someone) to come

    Key: C (something that feeds and sustains)

92. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Be lion-mettled, proud; and take no care Who chafes, who frets, or where conspirers are: Macbeth shall never vanquish’d be until Great Birnam wood to high Dunsinane hill Shall come against him.”, what does “vanquish” most nearly mean?

    A. to defeat completely

    B. the handle of a dagger

    C. without equal

    D. formally given the office and crown of king

    Key: A (to defeat completely)

93. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff: “He loves us not; / He wants the _____ touch”

    Key: natural

94. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Then the liars and _____ are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them.” Word bank: diminutive, laudable, pitfall, swearers

    Key: swearers

95. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But I remember now I am in this earthly world; where to do harm Is often laudable, to do good sometime Accounted dangerous folly: why then, alas, Do I put up that _____ defence, To say I have done no harm?”

    Word bank: laudable, pitfall, womanly, diminutive

    Key: womanly

96. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff: “Macduff was from his _____’s womb / Untimely ripp’d”

    Key: mother

97. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. The evidence is “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

98. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The hallucination. The evidence is “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

99. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene V"?

    A. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

    B. The discovery of the murder

    C. Hecate and the machinery of fate

    D. The ghost at the banquet

    Key: C (Hecate and the machinery of fate)

100. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Things have been strangely borne" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Understatement. The evidence is "Things have been strangely borne" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny.

101. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Irony. The evidence is "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny.

102. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf" (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Autumn imagery. The evidence is "I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf" (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.".

103. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane" (Act V, Scene IV, Siward)

    A. Paradox: every battle is lost by someone.

    B. His followers obey from fear.

    C. He shuts her out.

    D. Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls.

    Key: D (Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls.)

104. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Make all our trumpets speak" (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Battle. The evidence is "Make all our trumpets speak" (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy is fulfilled.

105. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Dramatis Personae"? 'Scotland; England': a divided map. England will be where the rightful heir and the forces of order gather.

    A. Setting

    B. Irony

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Simile

    Key: A (Setting)

106. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene I”? The dagger speech: Macbeth sees a dagger ‘of the mind,’ then real blood on it; he cannot tell imagination from reality.

A. Plot

B. Simile

C. Soliloquy

D. Foreshadowing

Key: C (Soliloquy)

107. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate).

Sample answer: She says "security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" and that Macbeth will "spurn fate, scorn death.". The evidence is “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate), which shows her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.".

108. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hecate says security is ‘mortals' chiefest enemy.’

A. Guilt and conscience

B. Fate and free will

C. Ambition and its costs

D. Appearance versus reality

Key: B (Fate and free will)

109. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene IV”? The audience sees the prophecy being fulfilled by human strategy.

A. Structure

B. Theme

C. Dramatic irony

D. Setting

Key: C (Dramatic irony)

110. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth).

Sample answer: He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman.". The evidence is “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) — Macbeth's confidence. This develops fate and free will: false security.

111. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why might Shakespeare keep the murder offstage? Evaluate the effect compared with showing it.

Sample answer: Judgment about offstage violence and the audience's imagination. The evidence is “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) — Sleep as innocence destroyed. This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking.

112. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how guilt and conscience develops from Act II, Scene I to Act II, Scene II. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Act II, Scene I, Macbeth, the text reads “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” — The hallucination. In Act II, Scene II, “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) — Sleep as innocence destroyed. Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.".

113. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The son's wit. The evidence is “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son). This develops masculinity and power: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.". The words “swearers” and “honest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother.".

114. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how fate and free will develops from Act V, Scene VI to Act V, Scene VII. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm, the text reads “your leavy screens throw down” — Malcolm's command. In Act V, Scene VII, “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) — Bear-baiting image. False security.

115. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Your _____ Hath left you unattended.” Word bank: nightgown, surfeited, constancy, resembled
Key: constancy

116. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth: “A _____ water clears us of this deed”
Key: little

117. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “He is about it: The doors are open; and the surfeited grooms Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg’d their possets, That death and nature do contend about them, Whether they live or die.”, what does “surfeited” most nearly mean?

A. sweet-smelling liquids

B. strongest; ruling over the rest

C. full of pity; compassionate

D. overfed; here, drunk

Key: D (overfed; here, drunk)

118. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does she tell her son about his father?

A. That he is dead and a traitor

B. That he will return tonight

C. That he is in prison

D. That he is king

Key: A (That he is dead and a traitor)

119. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Father’d he is, and yet he’s _____.” Word bank: pitfall, fatherless, laudable, diminutive
Key: fatherless

120. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Your son, my lord, has paid a soldier’s debt: He only lived but till he was a man; The which no sooner had his _____ confirm’d In the unshrinking station where he fought, But like a man he died.” Word bank: monsters, compass, prowess, cheaply

    Key: prowess

121. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Dramatis Personae”?

    A. The apparitions and false security

    B. Hecate and the machinery of fate

    C. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

    D. The cast and world of the play

    Key: D (The cast and world of the play)

122. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The son's wit. The evidence is “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son).

123. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. The evidence is “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff). This develops masculinity and power: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.".

124. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Malcolm's order. The evidence is “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm). This develops fate and free will: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

125. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Caesarean birth. The evidence is “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macduff). This develops fate and free will: the equivocal prophecy completed.

126. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae).

    Sample answer: Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position. The evidence is “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae) — Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. This develops masculinity and power: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

127. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Decision. The evidence is “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. The words “invites” and “done” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

128. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Macbeth cannot say ‘Amen’; he will ‘sleep no more.’

A. Ambition and its costs

B. Fate and free will

C. Appearance versus reality

D. Guilt and conscience

Key: D (Guilt and conscience)

129. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene IV”? Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him.

A. Diction / vocabulary

B. Simile

C. Tone / mood

D. Characterization

Key: D (Characterization)

130. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene VI”? Macduff has gone to England to seek help.

A. Simile

B. Diction / vocabulary

C. Characterization

D. Hyperbole

Key: C (Characterization)

131. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth).

Sample answer: He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". The evidence is “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) — Guilt as disease. This develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.".

132. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene VII”? His confidence in the prophecy.

A. Allusion

B. Irony

C. Metaphor

D. Alliteration

Key: B (Irony)

133. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Hyperbole of guilt. The evidence is “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". The words “blood” and “great” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking.

134. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) supports it: He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking. But “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) complicates it: the line (Sleep as innocence destroyed) shows the same issue from another side, and its “no” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

135. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The equivocal prophecy. The evidence is “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, Second Apparition). This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. The words “woman” and “born” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

136. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how masculinity and power develops from Act I, Scene VII to Act IV, Scene II. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth, the text reads “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” — Macbeth admits his only motive. In Act IV, Scene II, “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff) — Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not.".

137. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does Macbeth's fighting spirit at the end restore any of the admiration we felt for him in Act I? Explain.

Sample answer: A judgment about the tragic hero. The evidence is “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) — Bear-baiting image. This develops fate and free will: false security. He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman.".

138. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is Malcolm's final speech an ending we should trust? Consider what he leaves out about Macbeth and Lady Macbeth.

Sample answer: A judgment on the ending's perspective. The evidence is “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, ‘Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth) — Macbeth's last defiance. This develops fate and free will: the equivocal prophecy completed. Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.

139. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “Some must go off: and yet, by these I see, So great a day as this is cheaply bought.”, what does “cheaply” most nearly mean?

    A. dangerous

    B. worries

    C. the notched wall along the top of a castle

    D. at small cost

    Key: D (at small cost)

140. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macduff bring on stage?

    A. Lady Macbeth's letter

    B. Macbeth's head

    C. Macbeth's sword

    D. Macbeth's crown

    Key: B (Macbeth's head)

141. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hyperbole of guilt. The evidence is “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.".

142. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth)

    A. Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).

    B. Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood.

    C. The opening question: a world of storm and repetition.

    D. The chant; trochaic rhythm.

    Key: B (Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood.)

143. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Lady Macbeth says 'what's done is done' here; in V.i she says 'What's done cannot be undone.' How has the meaning changed?

    Sample answer: Here she tries to control regret; later the same idea becomes despair. The evidence is “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) — Lady Macbeth's despair.

144. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Twilight setting. The evidence is “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer). This develops fate and free will: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

145. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Macbeth will act without thought. The evidence is “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves

to kill Macduff's family immediately. The words “firstlings” and “shall” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

146. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm).

Sample answer: Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man.". The evidence is “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Malcolm) — Malcolm's advice. This develops masculinity and power: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.".

147. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene I”? Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose.

A. Theme

B. Allusion

C. Characterization

D. Simile

Key: C (Characterization)

148. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Should the dagger be shown on stage, or left invisible? Which choice better serves the play?

Sample answer: A staging argument tied to the open question of the supernatural. The evidence is “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) — The hallucination. This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done.".

149. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Are the Witches' prophecies lies? Argue whether deceiving with literal truth is worse than lying.

Sample answer: A judgment about deception through literal truth. The evidence is “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All), which shows the chant; trochaic rhythm. This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

150. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, Son) supports it: The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother.". But “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff) complicates it: Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

151. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Malcolm's command. The evidence is “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, Malcolm). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy is fulfilled. The words “screens” and “leavy” carry that meaning: they are the

charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Malcolm orders "your leavy screens throw down" and the trumpets become "harbingers of blood and death.".

152. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Battle. The evidence is “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, Macduff). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy is fulfilled. The words “trumpets” and “speak” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Malcolm orders "your leavy screens throw down" and the trumpets become "harbingers of blood and death.".

153. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What happens to the son?

A. The murderers kill him
B. He is taken prisoner
C. He escapes to England
D. He kills a murderer

Key: A (The murderers kill him)

154. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Why will Macbeth not kill himself?

A. He will not play the Roman fool
B. The Witches forbade it
C. He hopes to escape
D. He wants to see Malcolm crowned

Key: A (He will not play the Roman fool)

155. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae)

A. Sleep as innocence destroyed.
B. Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break.
C. The play's motto: moral values inverted.
D. His followers obey from fear.

Key: B (Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break.)

156. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth)

A. Her judgment of her husband.
B. Sleep as innocence destroyed.
C. Kingship without security means nothing.
D. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

Key: B (Sleep as innocence destroyed.)

157. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate)

A. The play's motto: moral values inverted.
B. Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless.
C. Banquo's image of nature and holiness.
D. He shuts her out.

Key: B (Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless.)

158. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene VII”? If it were done when 'tis done’: Macbeth reasons against the murder: Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest, and virtuous; the only spur is ‘vaulting ambition.

A. Hyperbole

B. Soliloquy

C. Simile

D. Symbolism

Key: B (Soliloquy)

159. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene II”? Blood on hands; ‘Macbeth does murder sleep’; ‘all great Neptune's ocean.’

A. Point of view

B. Irony

C. Imagery

D. Allusion

Key: C (Imagery)

160. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Macbeth chooses to go on. The evidence is “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The words “tedious” and “should” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

161. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth).

Sample answer: He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on. The evidence is “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) — Macbeth to the ghost. This develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

162. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble”

A. Act IV, Scene I

B. Act II, Scene II

C. Act V, Scene I

D. Act I, Scene VII

Key: A (Act IV, Scene I)

163. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Echo of "what's done is done.". The evidence is “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, Lady

Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: what she suppressed now speaks. The words “cannot” and “undone” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

164. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Guilt. The evidence is “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, Angus). This develops ambition: the stolen title does not fit. The words “sticking” and “murders” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

165. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Meaninglessness. The evidence is “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness. The words “nothing” and “sound” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

166. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene VII”? Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable.

A. Characterization

B. Simile

C. Alliteration

D. Allusion

Key: A (Characterization)

167. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, ‘Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth).
Sample answer: Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage. The evidence is “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, ‘Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth) — Macbeth's last defiance. This develops fate and free will: the equivocal prophecy completed.

168. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. The evidence is “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, Duncan). This develops appearance and reality: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. The words “construction” and “face” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires.".

169. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Her invocation. The evidence is “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. The words “thoughts” and “spirits” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.

170. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Her judgment of her husband. The evidence is “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. The words “kindness” and “nearest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.

171. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Violence breeds violence. The evidence is “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The words “blood” and “will” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.

172. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) supports it: He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on. But “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) complicates it: Macbeth chooses to go on, and its “no” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

173. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Understatement. The evidence is “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny. The words “strangely” and “borne” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.

174. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Autumn imagery. The evidence is “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". The words “enough” and “yellow” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.".

175. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Guilt as disease. The evidence is “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.". The words “diseased” and “minister” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased.".

176. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Time. The evidence is “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness. The words “morrow” and “petty” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing.".

177. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Macbeth's confidence. The evidence is “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: false security. The words “woman” and “wast” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman.".

178. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae)

A. Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won."

B. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

C. Sleep as innocence destroyed.

D. The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil.

Key: D (The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil.)

179. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo)

A. Banquo's image of nature and holiness.

B. He knows it is imaginary.

C. Paradox: every battle is lost by someone.

D. Malcolm as an obstacle.

Key: A (Banquo's image of nature and holiness.)

180. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Duncan's innocence. The evidence is “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan). This develops appearance and reality: a welcoming home that is a death-trap.

181. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Macduff)

A. Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight.

B. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

C. Malcolm as an obstacle.

D. Sleep as innocence destroyed.

Key: A (Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight.)

182. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Macbeth's confidence. The evidence is “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: false security.

183. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand”

A. Act III, Scene VI

B. Act II, Scene I

C. Act III, Scene V

D. Act I, Scene V

Key: B (Act II, Scene I)

184. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus”

A. Act III, Scene I

B. Act III, Scene IV

C. Act I, Scene I

D. Act V, Scene V

Key: A (Act III, Scene I)

185. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth).

Sample answer: She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder. The evidence is “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth), which shows he shuts her out. This develops guilt and conscience: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent.".

186. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze the word choice in “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: The murderers' failure. The evidence is “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, Second Murderer). This develops fate and free will: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. The words “affair” and “half” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

187. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene II”? A messenger warns them too late; murderers arrive.

A. Foreshadowing

B. Dramatic irony

C. Setting

D. Conflict

Key: B (Dramatic irony)

188. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze the word choice in “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Macduff's redefinition of manhood. The evidence is “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, Macduff). This develops masculinity and power: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man.". The words “shall” and “feel” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

189. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene V”? Life as a ‘brief candle,’ ‘a walking shadow,’ ‘a poor player,’ ‘a tale / Told by an idiot.’

A. Characterization

B. Hyperbole

C. Structure

D. Imagery

Key: D (Imagery)

190. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Macbeth admits his only motive. The evidence is “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she defines manhood as the will to murder. The words “ambition” and “intent” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.

191. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: He knows it is imaginary. The evidence is “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. The words “oppressed” and “creation” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done.".

192. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Sleep as innocence destroyed. The evidence is “Methought I heard a voice cry ‘Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more.". The words “murder” and “voice” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," which she will disprove in her sleepwalking.

193. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Irony. The evidence is “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny. The words “gracious” and

"pitied" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.

194. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, All) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The chant; trochaic rhythm. The evidence is "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, All). This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. The words "cauldron" and "trouble" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

195. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host" (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The strategy. The evidence is "thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host" (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm). This develops fate and free will: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. The words "numbers" and "thereby" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Malcolm orders "every soldier hew him down a bough," to "shadow / The numbers of our host.".

196. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "She should have died hereafter" (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: His response. The evidence is "She should have died hereafter" (Act V, Scene V, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: meaninglessness. The words "hereafter" and "should" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing.".

197. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Bear-baiting image. The evidence is "They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course" (Act V, Scene VII, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: false security. The words "cannot" and "course" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman.".

198. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? "A little water clears us of this deed" (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth)

A. Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic.

B. Graphic violence praised as service.

C. He knows it is imaginary.

D. He shuts her out.

Key: A (Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic.)

199. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, All) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The chant; trochaic rhythm. The evidence is "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron

bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, All). This develops fate and free will: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

200. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Macbeth, general of the king’s army”

A. Dramatis Personae

B. Act III, Scene III

C. Act III, Scene VI

D. Act II, Scene III

Key: A (Dramatis Personae)

201. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Claim: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth).

Sample answer: In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields. The evidence is “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth) — Lady Macbeth's attack. This develops masculinity and power: she defines manhood as the will to murder.

202. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Claim: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo).

Sample answer: Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair.". The evidence is “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo) — Banquo's last words. This develops fate and free will: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

203. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, Siward). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. The evidence is “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, Siward). This develops fate and free will: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. The words “confident” and “tyrant” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

204. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. The evidence is “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, First Witch). This develops appearance and reality: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. The words “lightning” and “thunder” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The witches' chant "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" collapses good and evil into each other, and their paradox "the battle's lost and won" warns that victory and defeat can be the same event.

205. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Duncan's innocence. The evidence is “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, Duncan). This develops appearance and reality: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. The words “recommends” and “pleasant” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either

would soften the effect. He says "this castle hath a pleasant seat," and Banquo describes "the temple-haunting martlet" nesting there, images of peace in the place of murder.

206. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Twilight setting. The evidence is “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, First Murderer). This develops fate and free will: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. The words “glimmers” and “streaks” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair.".

207. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Macbeth to the ghost. The evidence is “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. The words “canst” and “locks” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.

208. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how guilt and conscience develops from Act III, Scene II to Act III, Scene IV. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Act III, Scene II, Lady Macbeth, the text reads “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” — Lady Macbeth's despair. In Act III, Scene IV, “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, Macbeth) — Macbeth to the ghost. Guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

209. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Overconfidence. The evidence is “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate). This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.". The words “security” and “chiefest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She says "security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" and that Macbeth will "spurn fate, scorn death.".

210. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Hecate's complaint. The evidence is “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate). This develops fate and free will: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy.". The words “overbold” and “and” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She says "security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" and that Macbeth will "spurn fate, scorn death.".

211. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Malcolm's order. The evidence is “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm). This develops fate and free will: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. The words “soldier” and “before” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Malcolm orders "every soldier hew him down a bough," to "shadow / The numbers of our host.".

212. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “No more that thane of Cawdor shall deceive Our bosom interest: go _____ his present death, And with his former title greet Macbeth.” Word bank: disbursed, pronounce, furbish, overcharged

Key: pronounce

213. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Macbeth says his hand would rather turn the green sea red ('the multitudinous seas incarnadine'). How does this answer Lady Macbeth's 'A little water clears us'?

Sample answer: He knows the guilt is spiritual and limitless; she treats it as a stain. The evidence is “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, Lady Macbeth) — Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic.

214. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Claim: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All).

Sample answer: The witches' chant "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" collapses good and evil into each other, and their paradox "the battle's lost and won" warns that victory and defeat can be the same event. The evidence is “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, All), which shows the play's motto: moral values inverted. This develops appearance and reality: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.

215. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face”

A. Act III, Scene VI

B. Act IV, Scene II

C. Act III, Scene IV

D. Act I, Scene IV

Key: D (Act I, Scene IV)

216. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Malcolm as an obstacle. The evidence is “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth). This develops appearance and reality: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. The words “erleap” and “which” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

217. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Claim: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth).

Sample answer: She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power. The evidence is “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth) — Her invocation. This develops masculinity and power: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.

218. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy”

A. Act I, Scene IV

B. Act III, Scene V

C. Act I, Scene II

D. Act V, Scene III

Key: B (Act III, Scene V)

219. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Claim: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox).

Sample answer: He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses. The evidence is “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox) — Irony. This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny.

220. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d”

A. Act I, Scene IV

B. Act II, Scene III

C. Act V, Scene VIII

D. Act IV, Scene II

Key: C (Act V, Scene VIII)

221. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. The evidence is “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, Second Witch). This develops appearance and reality: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. The words “hurlyburly” and “battle” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The witches' chant "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" collapses good and evil into each other, and their paradox "the battle's lost and won" warns that victory and defeat can be the same event.

222. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. The evidence is “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth). This develops appearance and reality: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. The words “desires” and “light” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires.".

223. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Lady Macbeth's attack. The evidence is “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she defines manhood as the will to murder. The words “durst” and “were” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.

224. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Symbol of regicide. The evidence is “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, Old Man). This develops fate and free will: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

The words “towering” and “mousing” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

225. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Darkness by day. The evidence is “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, Ross). This develops fate and free will: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. The words “travelling” and “strangles” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

226. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Childlessness. The evidence is “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops ambition: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. The words “fruitless” and “sceptre” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.

227. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Torment. The evidence is “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent.". The words “scorpions” and “wife” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.

228. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Echoes Macbeth's ocean. The evidence is “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: what she suppressed now speaks. The words “perfumes” and “sweeten” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand.".

229. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, ‘Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Macbeth's last defiance. The evidence is “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, ‘Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, Macbeth). This develops fate and free will: the equivocal prophecy completed. The words “enough” and “cries” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.

230. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “From Fife, great king; Where the Norweyan _____ flout the sky And fan our people cold.” Word bank: furbish,

banners, overcharged, disbursed

Key: banners

231. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene II, Sergeant: “Till he _____’d him from the nave to the chaps”

Key: unseam

232. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: He knows it is imaginary. The evidence is “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

233. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene I”?

A. The army reveals itself

B. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

C. The apparitions and false security

D. Hecate and the machinery of fate

Key: C (The apparitions and false security)

234. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Claim: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth).

Sample answer: Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within. The evidence is “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, Macbeth) — Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. This develops fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

235. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Claim: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth).

Sample answer: Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires.". The evidence is “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, Macbeth) — Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. This develops appearance and reality: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind.

236. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene VI”? The martlet nesting in the castle's walls: an image of peace and trust.

A. Plot

B. Imagery

C. Theme

D. Structure

Key: B (Imagery)

237. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). Pick two words and explain what they

suggest.

Sample answer: Scotland under tyranny. The evidence is “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, Lennox). This develops appearance and reality: speech must be guarded under tyranny. The words “suffering” and “accursed” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

238. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene III”? He longs for ‘honour, love, obedience, troops of friends.’

A. Soliloquy

B. Foreshadowing

C. Diction / vocabulary

D. Structure

Key: A (Soliloquy)

239. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Claim: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm).

Sample answer: Malcolm orders "every soldier hew him down a bough," to "shadow / The numbers of our host.". The evidence is “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, Malcolm) — Malcolm's order. This develops fate and free will: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

240. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “your leavy screens throw down”

A. Act I, Scene VI

B. Act V, Scene VI

C. Act IV, Scene II

D. Act V, Scene III

Key: B (Act V, Scene VI)

241. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Graphic violence praised as service. The evidence is “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant). This develops ambition: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. The words “unseam” and “chaps” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Captain calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.

242. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Banquo's image of nature and holiness. The evidence is “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, Banquo). This develops appearance and reality: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. The words “haunting” and “martlet” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says "this castle hath a pleasant seat," and Banquo describes "the temple-haunting martlet" nesting there, images of peace in the place of murder.

243. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth) shape its

meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The hallucination. The evidence is “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. The words “toward” and “before” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done.".

244. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Banquo's last words. The evidence is “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, Banquo). This develops fate and free will: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. The words “treachery” and “good” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair.".

245. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “To the _____ tune and words.” Word bank: selfsame, shipman, enkindle, prologues

Key: selfsame

246. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene IV”? Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must ‘o'erleap.’

A. Hyperbole

B. Characterization

C. Diction / vocabulary

D. Setting

Key: B (Characterization)

247. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Appearance and reality. The evidence is “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, Lady Macbeth). This develops masculinity and power: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. The words “innocent” and “serpent” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

248. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene V”? Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is ‘too full o' the milk of human kindness,’ and calls on spirits to ‘unsex me here.’

A. Theme

B. Irony

C. Characterization

D. Personification

Key: C (Characterization)

249. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Claim: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I,

Macbeth).

Sample answer: He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done.". The evidence is “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, Macbeth), which shows he knows it is imaginary. This develops guilt and conscience: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

250. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene II”? Short, broken lines between Macbeth and Lady Macbeth after the murder show panic.

A. Personification

B. Conflict

C. Dialogue

D. Plot

Key: C (Dialogue)

251. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day”

A. Act V, Scene I

B. Act I, Scene III

C. Act I, Scene I

D. Act III, Scene III

Key: D (Act III, Scene III)

252. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene III”? Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes.

A. Plot

B. Personification

C. Hyperbole

D. Metaphor

Key: A (Plot)

253. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene V”? The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton.

A. Structure

B. Conflict

C. Setting

D. Allusion

Key: A (Structure)

254. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him”

A. Act III, Scene IV

B. Act V, Scene IV

C. Act IV, Scene II

D. Act II, Scene III

Key: B (Act V, Scene IV)

255. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene VIII”? Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed.

A. Personification

B. Structure

C. Conflict

D. Theme

Key: B (Structure)

256. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. The evidence is “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, Sergeant). This develops ambition: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. The words “deserves” and “brave” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The Captain calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.

257. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Banquo's warning. The evidence is “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, Banquo). This develops fate and free will: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. The words “instruments” and “oftentimes” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within.

258. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. The evidence is “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III, Porter). This develops appearance and reality: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. The words “equivocator” and “against” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth.

259. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Guilt as stain. The evidence is “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, Lady Macbeth). This develops guilt and conscience: what she suppressed now speaks. The words “damned” and “spot” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand.".

	Items (in order)	Mix

Rigor version		
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50	recall 29, inference 12, analysis 6, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	4, 51, 52, 53, 8, 54, 10, 55, 56, 57, 58, 14, 59, 60, 18, 61, 62, 15, 23, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 36, 76, 77, 78, 41, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 45, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90	recall 26, inference 12, analysis 9, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	9, 10, 52, 91, 8, 56, 6, 92, 93, 16, 94, 95, 17, 68, 65, 96, 67, 27, 29, 30, 70, 71, 97, 31, 98, 74, 99, 100, 101, 36, 102, 103, 40, 104, 41, 105, 106, 43, 107, 108, 84, 109, 110, 87, 111, 112, 113, 89, 114, 50	recall 19, inference 16, analysis 9, synthesis 6
HS Junior	56, 115, 116, 54, 6, 117, 16, 118, 119, 18, 20, 120, 65, 68, 67, 25, 121, 30, 71, 72, 98, 33, 100, 101, 36, 122, 123, 124, 39, 104, 79, 125, 126, 127, 128, 82, 129, 107, 108, 130, 131, 85, 132, 110, 133, 134, 135, 136, 137, 138	recall 16, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 6
HS Senior	91, 53, 10, 56, 116, 93, 15, 17, 118, 27, 139, 29, 140, 30, 71, 72, 73, 98, 141, 142, 143, 144, 100, 101, 102, 103, 77, 40, 41, 105, 126, 127, 43, 44, 84, 145, 45, 146, 147, 110, 87, 148, 111, 112, 149, 136, 150, 151, 152, 50	recall 13, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 9
AP	8, 52, 115, 94, 19, 153, 67, 154, 139, 155, 30, 156, 141, 157, 101, 75, 123, 40, 104, 41, 125, 42, 80, 158, 127, 159, 43, 160, 161, 108, 162, 145, 163, 164, 165, 166, 167, 168, 169, 170, 171, 172, 173, 135, 113, 174, 175, 176, 151, 177	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13
College Freshman	53, 91, 9, 153, 61, 16, 26, 140, 67, 178, 179, 180, 73, 99, 100, 36, 181, 78, 182, 79, 125, 42, 80, 127, 106, 183, 82, 184, 185, 186, 107, 187, 188, 131, 85, 189, 165, 48, 190, 191, 133, 192, 193, 135, 194, 113, 195, 176, 196, 197	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13
College Sophomore	52, 116, 20, 16, 26, 68, 178, 71, 198, 32, 100, 199, 36, 181, 40, 78, 41, 125, 200, 105, 81, 201, 127, 183, 202, 129, 83, 84, 45, 203, 85, 86, 167, 87, 204, 169, 205, 191, 133, 206, 207, 208, 209, 210, 193, 211, 195, 176, 152, 177	recall 6, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 16
College Junior	212, 8, 16, 118, 69, 29, 71, 121, 213, 37, 36, 181, 39, 78, 41, 214, 215, 216, 217, 183, 127, 160, 129, 218, 219, 45, 85, 165, 46, 110, 220, 48, 88, 204, 221, 222, 205, 223, 224, 225, 226, 227, 173, 194, 228, 211, 176, 196, 152, 229	recall 6, inference 9, analysis 16, synthesis 19
College Senior	230, 231, 68, 73, 232, 198, 100, 233, 181, 77, 182, 125, 200, 42, 105, 234, 235, 236, 81, 129, 83, 218, 219, 237, 145, 45, 238, 131, 239, 85, 165, 240, 87, 88, 241, 169, 242, 243, 192, 133, 225, 244, 210, 194, 135, 195, 196, 152, 197, 229	recall 3, inference 9, analysis 21, synthesis 17
Graduate / PhD	245, 61, 139, 121, 71, 122, 76, 40, 78, 246, 216, 247, 248, 81, 249, 250, 82, 184, 185, 251, 252, 160, 253, 107, 219, 188, 163, 164, 254, 165, 110, 255, 256, 257, 168, 205, 223, 243, 192, 133, 258, 226, 227, 244, 259, 195, 152, 197, 229, 50	recall 3, inference 6, analysis 23, synthesis 18

Final paper

Macbeth: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how William Shakespeare develops ambition and its costs across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Macbeth and argue how its meaning changes over the play and why that change matters to fate and free will.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Macbeth. Argue whether the play judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Macbeth finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of guilt and conscience. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the act, scene and line (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.
Organization	15					

		Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. The text makes this visible when it says “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae). Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Ambition and its costs

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Macbeth teaches about ambition and its costs. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops ambition and its costs in Macbeth. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops ambition and its costs across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of ambition and its costs. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of ambition and its costs in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of ambition and its costs, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Macbeth's treatment of ambition and its costs in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on ambition and its costs in Macbeth that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on ambition and its costs in Macbeth. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about ambition and its costs in Macbeth, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on ambition and its costs in Macbeth, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Fate and free will

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Macbeth teaches about fate and free will. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops fate and free will in Macbeth. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops fate and free will across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of fate and free will. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of fate and free will in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of fate and free will, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Macbeth's treatment of fate and free will in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on fate and free will in Macbeth that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on fate and free will in Macbeth. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about fate and free will in Macbeth, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on fate and free will in Macbeth, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Guilt and conscience

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Macbeth teaches about guilt and conscience. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops guilt and conscience in Macbeth. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops guilt and conscience across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of guilt and conscience. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of guilt and conscience in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of guilt and conscience, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Macbeth's treatment of guilt and conscience in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on guilt and conscience in Macbeth that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on guilt and conscience in Macbeth. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about guilt and conscience in Macbeth, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on guilt and conscience in Macbeth, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Appearance versus reality

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Macbeth teaches about appearance versus reality. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops appearance versus reality in Macbeth. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops appearance versus reality across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of appearance versus reality. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of appearance versus reality in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of appearance versus reality, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Macbeth's treatment of appearance versus reality in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on appearance versus reality in Macbeth that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on appearance versus reality in Macbeth. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about appearance versus reality in Macbeth, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on appearance versus reality in Macbeth, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Masculinity, power and violence

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Macbeth teaches about masculinity, power and violence. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops masculinity, power and violence across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of masculinity, power and violence. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of masculinity, power and violence, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Macbeth's treatment of masculinity, power and violence in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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